

Geography

Solar System And Its Planets

Q.1. What are the streams of charged particles ejected by the Sun into space called ?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Sunspots (b) Solar wind
(c) Solar flares (d) Coronal loops

Sol.1.(b) Solar wind. It is a constant stream of charged particles (mostly protons and electrons) that are released from the Sun's upper atmosphere, known as the corona. The solar wind blows in all directions. It continues moving at that speed for about 10 billion kilometers (six billion miles). Sunspots are dark surface spots, Solar flares are sudden bursts of energy, and Coronal loops are arcs of hot plasma shaped by magnetic fields.

Q.2. Which of the following systems can be affected by a solar storm?

1. GPS signal accuracy
2. Power transmission systems
3. Submarine communication cables
4. Pipeline infrastructure

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) 2 and 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, and 4 all of these

Sol.2.(d) 1, 2, 3, and 4 all of these. Solar storms release high-energy charged particles and electromagnetic radiation that disturb Earth's magnetosphere. This can disrupt GPS accuracy, power grids, submarine cables, and pipelines by inducing currents and affecting signal transmission. Hence, all four listed systems are vulnerable.

Q.3. Consider the following statements:

1. A solar eclipse- The Moon casts a shadow on Earth when it comes between the Sun and Earth.
2. A lunar eclipse- During the new moon phase, the Moon passes through the Earth's shadow.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) 1 only
(c) 2 only (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.3.(b) 1 only. Statement 2 : Incorrect. A lunar eclipse occurs at the full moon phase, not new moon. It happens when the Earth comes between the Sun and Moon, and Earth's shadow falls on the Moon.

Q.4. Which of the following is the correct sequence in the life cycle of a star like the Sun?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Protostar → White Dwarf → Red Giant → Main Sequence
(b) Nebula → Red Giant → Main Sequence → White Dwarf
(c) Main Sequence → Red Giant → White Dwarf
(d) Red Giant → Protostar → White Dwarf

Sol.4.(c) Main Sequence → Red Giant → White Dwarf.

The life cycle of a medium-sized star (like our Sun) follows a specific sequence:

1. Nebula / Protostar stage – Stars are born in large clouds of gas and dust (nebula). The contracting gas forms a protostar.
2. Main Sequence – The star spends most of its life in this stable phase, where hydrogen fusion occurs in the core (the Sun is currently in this stage).
3. Red Giant – After hydrogen in the core is exhausted, the star expands and cools to become a Red Giant.
4. White Dwarf – Finally, after shedding its outer layers (planetary nebula), the star's remaining dense core becomes a White Dwarf.

Q.5. How does the Faint Young Sun paradox challenge our understanding of early Earth's climate?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) It implies there was no liquid water on early Earth.
(b) It proves the Moon once had an atmosphere.
(c) It suggests that early solar output was too weak to prevent global freezing.
(d) It shows Earth was too hot due to excessive solar radiation.

Sol.5.(c) The Faint Young Sun paradox arises because about 4 billion years ago, the Sun's luminosity was only around 70% of its current strength, which should have left Earth frozen. However, geological evidence shows that liquid water existed, supporting life's early evolution. This paradox challenges climate science by suggesting that greenhouse gases or other warming mechanisms must have compensated for the weaker Sun, preventing global freezing and maintaining habitable conditions on early Earth.

Q.6. Which type of galaxy has no regular shape and is rich in gas and dust?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Elliptical Galaxy
(b) Lenticular Galaxies
(c) Irregular Galaxy
(d) Spiral Galaxy

Sol.6.(c) Irregular Galaxy. Irregular galaxies are those that lack a distinct shape (unlike elliptical or spiral galaxies). They are often rich in gas and dust, making them sites of active star formation. Examples include the Large Magellanic Cloud (LMC) and Small Magellanic Cloud (SMC) near the Milky Way. Elliptical Galaxy – Oval-shaped, contains older stars, and has little gas or dust. Lenticular Galaxies – A hybrid form between elliptical and spiral galaxies; disk-shaped but lacking significant spiral arms. Spiral Galaxy – Flat, rotating disk with spiral arms, contains gas, dust, and young stars (e.g., Milky Way).

Q.7. Which planet has the longest day in the solar system?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Venus (b) Mars (c) Jupiter (d) Earth

Sol.7.(a) Venus. A day on a planet is measured by its rotation period (time taken to complete one rotation on its axis). Venus rotates very slowly and in the opposite direction (retrograde rotation). One day on Venus (sidereal day) = 243 Earth days → the longest day in the solar system. Venus - Rotation period = 243 Earth days. Mars - Similar to Earth; 24 hours 37 minutes. Jupiter - Fastest rotation; ~9 hours 56 minutes (shortest day). Earth - 24 hours.

Q.8. Consider the following statements about the Geoid:

1. The term Geoid refers to the axis of the Earth.
2. The Earth is slightly flattened at the poles and bulges at the equator due to the outward force caused by its rotation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.8.(b) 2 only. Geoid refers to the shape of the Earth, not its axis.

Q.9. Who gave the expanding universe hypothesis?

- (a) Galileo Galilei
(b) Edwin Hubble
(c) James Clerk Maxwell
(d) CV Raman

Sol.9.(b) Edwin Hubble. The most popular argument regarding the origin of

the universe is the Big Bang Theory. It is also called the expanding universe hypothesis. Edwin Hubble, in 1920, provided evidence that the universe is expanding. As time passes, galaxies move further and further apart. Galileo Galilei is known for his contributions to astronomy, particularly with the use of the telescope.

Q.10. Which of the below statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: Callisto, Europa, and Ganymede are natural satellites of Jupiter.

Statement 2: Triton is the largest moon of Neptune.

- (a) Only Statement 1
- (b) Only Statement 2
- (c) Both Statement 1 and 2
- (d) None of the above

Sol.10.(c) Both Statement 1 and 2. Jupiter, the most massive planet of the solar system and the fifth in distance from the Sun. Revolution - 11 years and 11 months, Rotation - 9 hours 56 minutes.

Q.11. Which is, by far, the closest dwarf planet orbiting at only 2.8 times Earth's distance from the sun?

- (a) Ceres
- (b) Makemake
- (c) Eris
- (d) Pluto

Sol.11.(a) Ceres is the largest object in the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter, and it is the only dwarf planet located in the inner solar system. It was the first member of the asteroid belt to be discovered when Giuseppe Piazzi spotted it in 1801.

Q.12. Consider the following statements about a nebula:

1. A nebula is a cloud of dust and gas inside a galaxy, consisting mainly of hydrogen, helium, and other ionized gases.
2. Originally, the term nebula was used to describe only galaxies within the Milky Way.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.12.(a) 1 only. The term nebula was originally used for any diffuse astronomical object, including galaxies outside the Milky Way.

Q.13. A distinctive cross - shaped constellation best seen in the northern hemisphere during the summer and fall months around September is:

- (a) Cygnus
- (b) Ursa Major
- (c) Pegasus
- (d) Cassiopeia

Sol.13.(a) Cygnus. It is a northern constellation on the plane of the Milky Way, deriving its name from the Latinized Greek word for swan.

Q.14. Consider the following statements regarding planetary atmospheres:

1. Venus has thick white and yellowish clouds of sulphuric acid in its atmosphere.
2. Mars' atmosphere is mainly composed of methane, with traces of sulfur dioxide.
3. Uranus is the coldest planet in the Solar System.
4. Venus is often referred to as the "morning star."

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 2
- (b) Only 1 and 2
- (c) Only 2 and 3
- (d) Only 3 and 4

Sol.14.(a) Only 2. Mars, fourth planet in the solar system in order of distance from the Sun and seventh in size and mass. It is a periodically conspicuous reddish object in the night sky. Mars' atmosphere is 95.32% carbon dioxide, with methane and sulfur dioxide.

Q.15. The colour of the surface of Mars is red because of the presence of large amounts of chemical compounds in it. What is the name of that compound?

- (a) Magnesium oxide
- (b) Tin oxide
- (c) Iron oxide
- (d) Nitrogen oxide

Sol.15.(c) Iron oxide. Mars appears reddish due to the presence of ferric iron in the form of red hematite (Fe_2O_3). The surface pressure of Mars is 610 Pascals, and its gravity is about one - third of Earth's. A Martian day lasts 24 hours and 37 minutes. Mars has two moons: Phobos and Deimos.

Q.16. Which dwarf planet orbits the sun in 310 years at a distance between 38.5 to 53 AU?

- (a) Eris
- (b) Ceres
- (c) Makemake
- (d) Pluto

Sol.16.(c) Makemake. It is the third-largest and second-brightest known dwarf planet. It was discovered in 2005. Pluto was discovered in 1930. It was initially classified as the ninth planet of the Solar System but was reclassified as a dwarf planet in 2006. Pluto has a natural satellite named 'Charon'.

Q.17. Which of the following is the second nearest star to Earth?

- (a) Proxima Centauri
- (b) Polaris
- (c) Sirius
- (d) Delta Velorum

Sol.17.(a) Proxima Centauri. It is the closest star to the sun, at a distance of 4.24 light - years. A light - year is the distance light travels in one year, which is about 9.461×10^{12} kilometers. Polaris (North Star) is located nearly directly above Earth's North Pole along its rotational axis. Sirius (Dog Star) is the brightest star in Earth's night sky. Delta Velorum is a triple star system in the southern constellation of Vela.

Q.18. Which of the following statements most accurately describes the planet Saturn?

- (a) It is a gas giant made up mostly of hydrogen and helium and the density is less than that of water
- (b) Its surface is reddish in colour.
- (c) It was the seventh planet discovered in the Solar System.
- (d) Its cloud-like outer regions consist of methane in the gaseous form and ammonia in crystalline form.

Sol.18.(a) Saturn's density (0.70 gm/cm^3) is less than that of water, making it the least dense planet in the solar system. If there were a body of water large enough, Saturn would theoretically float. The presence of methane and ammonia is more characteristic of Uranus and Neptune.

Q.19. Which of the following rocky planets is the fastest planet in our solar system – traveling through space at about 29 miles (47 kilometers) per second?

- (a) Earth
- (b) Mercury
- (c) Venus
- (d) Mars

Sol.19.(b) Mercury. It is the nearest to the sun. It takes only about 88 days to complete one round along its orbit. Venus: It is considered as 'Earth's - twin' because its size and shape are very much similar to that of the earth. Venus is also known as Lucifer. Earth is the fifth largest planet (in size). It is slightly flattened at the poles and its shape is described as a Geoid. Mars - The fourth planet from the Sun and it is a dusty, cold, desert world with a very thin atmosphere.

Q.20. Which of the following is one of the largest spiral galaxies?

- (a) NGC 6872
- (b) Milky Way
- (c) Cygnus A
- (d) Maffei 1

Sol.20.(a) NGC 6872, which is one of the largest spiral galaxies, spanning 522,000 light-years across, approximately five times the size of the Milky Way. It is located 212 million light-years from Earth in the southern constellation Pavo.

Q.21. Match the following planets with their approximate day length (rotation period):

List I (Planet)	List II (Day Length in Hours)
A. Mercury	i. 25
B. Venus	ii. 1,408
C. Mars	iii. 5,832
D. Neptune	iv. 16

- (a) A–ii, B–iii, C–i, D–iv
 (b) A–iii, B–ii, C–i, D–iv
 (c) A–ii, B–iv, C–i, D–iii
 (d) A–iv, B–iii, C–ii, D–i

Sol.21.(a) A–ii, B–iii, C–i, D–iv. Planet and Day Length in hours: Mercury (1,408), Venus (5,832), Earth (24), Mars (25), Jupiter (10), Saturn (11), Uranus (17). Mercury is nearest to the sun. It takes only about 88 days to complete one round along its orbit.

Q.22. Who was the first to develop a mathematical predictive heliocentric model of the solar system ?

- (a) Nicolaus Copernicus
 (b) Galileo Galilei
 (c) Pierre-Simon Laplace
 (d) Immanuel Kant

Sol.22.(a) Nicolaus Copernicus. Although Aryabhatta (5th century A.D.) hinted at astronomical ideas, Copernicus (1473 - 1543) developed the first mathematical heliocentric model, where planets revolved around a fixed Sun. Galileo supported this model, and Johannes Kepler later refined it by introducing elliptical orbits, now known as Kepler's laws.

Q.23. Who calculated the approximate location of the planet Neptune by studying gravity- induced disturbances in the motion of Uranus?

- (a) John Couch Adams
 (b) Percival Lowell
 (c) Johann Gottfried Galle
 (d) Urbain-Jean-Joseph Le Verrier

Sol.23.(d) Urbain - Jean - Joseph Le Verrier. He was a French astronomer and mathematician. Neptune is the eighth and most distant planet in our solar system, and it is the second coldest planet. It was discovered in 1846. It is the windiest planet in our solar system. One day on Neptune takes about 16 hours.

Q.24. Which of the below statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: Apogee is the point in the orbit of an object around the Earth where it is farthest from the Earth's center.

Statement 2: Perigee refers to the point where the Moon's orbit is closest to the

Earth.

- (a) Only Statement 1
 (b) Only Statement 2
 (c) Both Statement 1 and 2
 (d) None of the above

Sol.24.(c) Both Statement 1 and 2. Perihelion: The Earth closest to the Sun on 3rd January. Aphelion: The Earth farthest from the Sun on 4th July.

Q.25. Which of the below statements is/are incorrect?

Statement 1: The Big Dipper is an asterism formed by the seven brightest stars in the constellation Orion.

Statement 2: Ursa Major is the largest constellation in the entire sky.

- (a) Only Statement 1
 (b) Only Statement 2
 (c) Both Statement 1 and 2
 (d) None of the above

Sol.25.(c) Both Statement 1 and 2. Statement 1 is incorrect because the Big Dipper belongs to the constellation Ursa Major, not Orion. Statement 2 is also incorrect because Ursa Major (Great Bear) is the third - largest constellation in the sky and the largest constellation in the Northern Hemisphere.

Q.26. A constellation of the northern sky easily recognised by a group of five bright stars forming a slightly irregular 'W' is called:

- (a) Cassiopeia (b) Orion
 (c) Ursa Major (d) Cygnus

Sol.26.(a) Cassiopeia. It is a prominent constellation in the northern sky. It is visible during winter in the early part of the night. It looks like a distorted letter W or M.

Q.27. Assertion (A): Saturn is the second largest planet in our Solar System and has the most prominent ring system.

Reason (R): Saturn is larger than Jupiter and has Titan, the largest moon in the Solar System.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
 (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
 (c) A is true, but R is false.
 (d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.27.(c) A is true, but R is false. Our Solar System has eight planets which orbit the sun. In order of distance from the sun they are: Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune. Largest to smallest: Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune, Earth, Venus, Mars, Mercury. Saturn moon Titan is the

second largest moon after Ganymede (Jupiter's moon).

Q.28. _____ oblong orbit overlaps the orbit of Neptune.

- (a) Jupiter's (b) Pluto's (c) Venus' (d) Mars'

Sol.28.(b) Pluto's. Neptune is the outermost Jovian planet in the solar system. Until 2006 Pluto was the farthest planet from the Sun. In 2006, The International Astronomical Union (IAU) downgraded the status of Pluto to that of a dwarf planet. The Jovian planets are Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune, which are also known as the gas giants.

Q.29. Which of the following statements about planet Saturn is true?

- (a) Saturn is the fourth planet from the Sun and the largest planet in our solar system.
 (b) Satellites like Enceladus and Titan of Saturn are home to internal oceans, could possibly support life.
 (c) Saturn's environment is conducive to life.
 (d) Saturn is a massive ball made up mostly nitrogen.

Sol.29.(b) Saturn is the second largest planet, composed of hydrogen and helium. It has 146 moons. Titan - It is the largest moon of Saturn and the second largest moon in our solar system. Enceladus - It is the second nearest of the major regular moons of Saturn and the brightest of all its moons. It was discovered in 1789 by the English astronomer William Herschel. It is found that Titan has methane in its atmosphere and Enceladus has a liquid ocean with erupting plumes of gas and water.

Q.30. Which star is also known as the 'Pole Star' ?

- (a) The East star (b) The South star
 (c) The West star (d) The North star

Sol.30.(d) The North star. Polaris, also known as the North Star, is located almost directly above Earth's north pole along our planet's rotational axis. The imaginary line that runs through the Earth from the North Pole to the South Pole is called the Earth's axis of rotation. The Earth rotates around this axis, similar to how a top spins around its spindle.

Q.31. In 1905, who concluded with Thomas Chamberlain that the planets of the Solar System originated from an encounter between the Sun and another star?

- (a) James Hutton (b) Inge Lehmann

- (c) Charles Lyell (d) Forest Moulton

Sol.31.(d) Forest Moulton. He was an American astronomer and mathematician known for his contributions to celestial mechanics. He co-developed the Chamberlin-Moulton planetesimal hypothesis, which proposed a model for the formation of the solar system. According to this hypothesis, planets formed from smaller bodies called planetesimals through the process of accretion.

Q.32. Perihelion is when Earth is ____.

- (a) under the sun
(b) farthest from the sun
(c) nearest to the sun
(d) above the sun

Sol.32.(c) nearest to the sun. On 3rd January, the earth is the nearest to the sun (147 million km). Aphelion is the point of the Earth's orbit that is farthest away from the Sun.

Q.33. Which is the most widely accepted model to explain the formation and evaluation of the solar system?

- (a) Cloud hypothesis
(b) Gas hypothesis
(c) Nebular hypothesis
(d) Solar hypothesis

Sol.33.(c) Nebular hypothesis - The planets were formed out of a cloud of material associated with a youthful sun, which was slowly rotating. The theory was developed by Immanuel Kant. But Mathematician Laplace revised it in 1796. Other Hypothesis: Big Bang Theory - Propounded by George Lamaitre related to the origin of the universe.

Q.34. Which trend is found about the distance between the galaxies?

- (a) Unpredictable (b) Decreasing
(c) Constant (d) Increasing

Sol.34.(d) Increasing. In 1929, Edwin Hubble announced that almost all galaxies appeared to be moving away from us. He found that the universe was expanding - with all of the galaxies moving away from each other. This phenomenon was observed as a redshift of a galaxy's spectrum.

Q.35. Consider the following statements regarding terrestrial planets:

1. Terrestrial planets are primarily composed of rocks and metals.
2. Mercury, Venus, Earth, and Mars are classified as terrestrial planets.
3. Terrestrial planets can be further categorised into silicate, iron, coreless, and carbon (diamond)

planets.

4. The atmosphere of all terrestrial planets is primarily made up of hydrogen and helium.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1, 2 and 3 (b) Only 1 and 2
(c) Only 2, 3 and 4 (d) All of the above

Sol.35.(a) Only 1, 2 and 3. In our solar system, planets are broadly classified into two categories: terrestrial and Jovian. Terrestrial planets (Mercury, Venus, Earth, and Mars) are small, rocky, and relatively close to the Sun. Jovian planets (Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune) are gas giants, much larger and further from the Sun.

Q.36. Which scientist thought of the concept of the steady state of the universe?

- (a) Harold Jeffrey (b) Edwin Hubble
(c) Fred Hoyle (d) Pierre - Laplace

Sol.36.(c) Fred Hoyle. Steady - State Theory : It is a theoretical model in which the Universe is constantly expanding but with a fixed average density. The theory was put forward by three scientists Sir Hermann Bondi, Thomas Gold, and Sir Fred Hoyle in 1948.

Q.37. Which of the below statements is/are incorrect?

Statement 1: Comets are cosmic snowballs of frozen gases, rock, and dust that orbit the Sun.

Statement 2: Meteorites are stars that fall from space and burn completely before reaching the Earth's surface.

- (a) Only Statement 1
(b) Only Statement 2
(c) Both Statement 1 and 2
(d) None of the above

Sol.37.(b) Only Statement 2. Meteorites - When a meteoroid survives its trip through the atmosphere and hits the ground, it's called a meteorite. Meteorites typically range between the size of a pebble and a fist.

Q.38. What is the radius of the earth?

- (a) 7456 km (b) 6371 km
(c) 5619 km (d) 4728 km

Sol.38.(b) 6371 km. Earth Distance from the Sun (150 million km), Surface area: 510.1 million km², Land area: 149 million km², Gravity: 9.8 m/s².

Q.39. Each orbit of the International Space Station (ISS) takes ____minutes.

- (a) 80 - 82 (b) 85 - 87 (c) 90 - 93 (d) 83 - 86

Sol.39.(c) 90-93. In 24 hours, the space

station makes 16 orbits of Earth, traveling through 16 sunrises and sunsets.

Q.40. Match the following planets with their approximate rotation period (one spin on its axis):

List I (Planet)	List II (Rotation Period)
A. Earth	i. 17 hours 14 min
B. Jupiter	ii. 1 day (23 hours 56 min)
C. Saturn	iii. 9 hours 56 min
D. Uranus	iv. 10 hours 40 min

- (a) A-ii, B-iii, C-iv, D-i
(b) A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
(c) A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i
(d) A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii

Sol.40.(a) A-ii, B-iii, C-iv, D-i.

Q.41. In early 1610, who discovered with his newly invented telescope that Jupiter has four moons?

- (a) Simon Marius (b) Tycho Brahe
(c) Galileo Galilei (d) Johannes Kepler

Sol.41.(c) Galileo Galilei. He was an Italian astronomer and scientist. He described the rings of Saturn, the phases of Venus, sunsets, and the bumpy lunar surface. The four moons he discovered were: Io, Europa, Ganymede, and Callisto.

Q.42. Who was the first to accurately describe the rings of Saturn as a disc around the planet in 1655?

- (a) Hideki Yukawa
(b) Galileo Galilei
(c) Christiaan Huygens
(d) Giovanni Cassini

Sol.42.(c) Christiaan Huygens. His other inventions include the pendulum clock, centrifugal governor, and magic lantern.

Q.43. The moon completes _____ rotation on its axis as it completes one revolution around the Earth.

- (a) 3 (b) 2 (c) 1 (d) 4

Sol.43.(c) 1. The Moon is Earth's only natural satellite circling the planet at an average distance of 384,400 kilometers. The Moon's presence helps stabilize our planet and moderate our climate. The radius of the Moon is 1.74×10^6 m. Huygens is the Moon's tallest mountain.

Q.44. Which of the following statements regarding the moon is correct?

- I. The size of the illuminated part of the moon visible from the Earth increases each day after the new moon day.
 - II. After the full moon day, the sunlit part of the moon visible from the Earth decreases in size every day.
- (a) Both I and II (b) Only I
(c) Neither I nor II (d) Only II

Sol.44.(a) Both I and II. When there are two full moons within a month, the second full moon is called a Blue Moon, When a full moon occurs at its perigee (the moon is closest to the earth) it is called a Supermoon.

Q.45. The _____ radiation belts are giant swaths of magnetically trapped highly energetic charged particles that surround Earth.

- (a) Van Allen (b) Aurora
(c) Kuiper (d) Chinook

Sol.45.(a) Van Allen. An aurora is a natural phenomenon which is characterized by a display of a natural-coloured (green, red, yellow or white) light in the sky.

Q.46. In which of the following periods is the meteor shower named Quadrantids generally visible from Earth?

- (a) August/September
(b) October/November
(c) May/June
(d) December/January

Sol.46.(d) December / January.

Quadrantids are best viewed in the Northern Hemisphere during the night and predawn hours. They are also known for their bright fireball meteors. The Quadrantids can produce over 100 meteors per hour in a moonless sky.

Q.47. Consider the following statements regarding solar eclipses:

1. A solar eclipse occurs when the Moon passes between the Earth and the Sun.
2. Types of solar eclipse include Total, Hybrid, Annular, and Partial.
3. In an annular solar eclipse, the Moon appears smaller than the Sun and does not completely cover it.
4. A penumbral eclipse is a type of solar eclipse.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1, 2 and 3 (b) Only 1 and 3
(c) Only 2 and 4 (d) All of the above

Sol.47.(a) Only 1, 2 and 3. Penumbral (Lunar eclipse). A solar eclipse occurs when the Moon passes between the Earth and the Sun. Types of solar eclipse: Total (Completely blocking the face of the Sun), Hybrid (the Moon is farther away from Earth, it appears smaller than the Sun and does not completely cover the Sun) and Annular (when Sun is at or near its farthest point from Earth).

Q.48. In which of the following months may the meteor shower named Lyrids be

seen from Earth?

- (a) April (b) February (c) June (d) August

Sol.48.(a) April. The radiant point for the Lyrid meteor shower is near the constellation Lyra, which has the bright star Vega in the east.

Longitudes and Latitudes

Q.49. At what latitude does the easterly jet stream blow over peninsular India during the summer months?

- (a) 24°N (b) 30°N (c) 14°N (d) 28°N

Sol.49.(c) 14°N. The Jet Stream is a geostrophic wind blowing horizontally through the upper layers of the troposphere, generally from west to east. The tropical easterly jet stream, located between 8 and 35 degrees north latitude, is connected to the southwest monsoon in India.

Q.50. In which month is the InterTropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) located around 20°N-25°N latitude (over the Gangetic plain) ?

- (a) May (b) August (c) June (d) July

Sol.50.(d) July. The Inter Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) is a low pressure zone located at the equator where trade winds converge, and so, it is a zone where air tends to ascend. The Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone located around 20°N-25°N latitudes (over the Gangetic plain) in July month is sometimes called the monsoon trough.

Q.51. Which of the below statements is/are incorrect?

Statement 1: Longitude directly determines the temperature of ocean waters.

Statement 2: Ocean currents influence ocean water temperature by transporting warm and cold water masses.

- (a) Only Statement 1
(b) Only Statement 2
(c) Both Statement 1 and 2
(d) None of the above

Sol.51.(a) Only Statement 1. Statement 1 is incorrect because longitude does not directly affect ocean water temperature. Factors determining ocean water temperature : Latitude - Affects the amount of solar radiation received. Unequal distribution of land and water - Affects heat absorption and distribution. Ocean currents - Transport heat and cold water masses globally.

Q.52. Which of the following statements is INCORRECT regarding the Coriolis

force?

- (a) It deflects the wind to the right in the north and left in the south.
(b) It is directly proportional to the angle of altitude
(c) Deflection is less when the wind is high
(d) It is absent at the equator.

Sol.52.(c) Deflection is less when the wind is high. Coriolis force : An apparent force caused by the earth's rotation. The Coriolis force acts perpendicular to the pressure gradient force (pressure gradient force is perpendicular to an isobar). It is maximum at the poles and is absent at the equator. The Coriolis force also affects ocean currents.

Q.53. Which of the below statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: The Torrid Zone lies between the Tropic of Cancer (23.5° N) and the Tropic of Capricorn (23.5° S).

Statement 2: The Frigid Zones are located between the Tropics and the Arctic/Antarctic Circles.

- (a) Only Statement 1
(b) Only Statement 2
(c) Both Statement 1 and 2
(d) None of the above

Sol.53.(a) Only Statement 1. The zones located between the Tropics and the Arctic/Antarctic Circles are the Temperate Zones. The Frigid Zones are the coldest regions, located between the Arctic Circle (66.5° N) and the North Pole, and between the Antarctic Circle (66.5° S) and the South Pole. The Torrid Zone experiences high temperatures year-round due to direct sunlight.

Q.54. Which is the Standard Meridian of India?

- (a) 81°30' E (b) 82°30' E
(c) 83°30' E (d) 84°40' E

Sol.54.(b) 82°30' E. The Standard Meridian of India, which passes through Mirzapur in Uttar Pradesh, also crosses the following states: Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, and Andhra Pradesh.

Q.55. Which of the following sets of statements are correct about Inter Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) ?

- A. The ITCZ is a broad trough of low pressure in equatorial latitudes.
- B. This is where the northeast and the southeast trade winds converge.
- C. The ITCZ is the equatorial trough normally positioned about 5°N of the equator and remains there throughout the year.

D. The ITCZ moves over to the plane of Ganga in Summer.

- (a) Only A and C (b) A, B and C
(c) Only B and C (d) A, B and D

Sol.55.(d) A, B and D. Intertropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) - The region that circles the Earth, near the equator, where the trade winds of the Northern and Southern Hemispheres come together. Seasonal shifts in the location of the ITCZ drastically affects rainfall in many equatorial nations, resulting in the wet and dry seasons of the tropics rather than the cold and warm seasons of higher latitudes.

Q.56. During October-November, the apparent movement of the sun is towards the ____.

- (a) North (b) North-East
(c) North-West (d) South

Sol.56.(d) South. The position of the rising sun keeps on moving towards the south in the period from 21st June to 22nd December. This period is called **Dakshinayan**. From 22nd December to 21st June, the sun keeps on moving towards the north. This period is called **Uttarayan**.

Q.57. Match the following waterbodies with the locations they separate:

List I (Channel)	List II (Separates)
A. 8° Channel	i. Andaman Islands and Nicobar Islands
B. 9° Channel	ii. Minicoy and Maldives
C. 10° Channel	iii. Minicoy & Lakshadweep main group
D. 11° Channel	iv. Amindivi Islands & Cannanore Islands

- (a) A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv
(b) A-iii, B-ii, C-iv, D-i
(c) A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
(d) A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i

Sol.57.(a) A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv.

Q.58. The southern part of India lies in the _____ belt.

- (a) rain (b) temperate (c) polar (d) warm

Sol.58.(d) Warm. The Tropic of Cancer passes through the middle of India. The southern parts being closer to the Equator, experience high temperatures throughout the year. The northern parts on the other hand lie in the warm temperate zone.

Q.59. Which of the following states of India is NOT crossed by the Tropic of Cancer (23°30' N)?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Chhattisgarh (d) Kerala

Sol.59.(d) Kerala. The Tropic of Cancer (23°30' N) passes through eight states in India - Gujarat (Jasdan), Rajasthan (Kalinjarh), Madhya Pradesh (Shajapur), Chhattisgarh (Sonhat), Jharkhand (Lohardaga), West Bengal (Krishnanagar), Tripura (Udaipur) and Mizoram (Champhai).

Q.60. On which of the following two dates does the equinox fall?

- (a) 21 June and 23 September
(b) 21 March and 21 June
(c) 21 March and 23 September
(d) 23 September and 22 December

Sol.60.(c) 21 March and 23 September.

Equinox is the situation when the equator receives the vertical rays of the Sun and day and night are equal. Spring equinox - 21st March, Autumn equinox - 23 September. 21st June (winter solstice in Southern Hemisphere, Summer solstice in Northern hemisphere) - The rays of the sun fall directly on the Tropic of Cancer. 22 December (Summer solstice in Southern hemisphere, winter solstice in Northern Hemisphere) - The rays of the sun fall directly on the Tropic of Capricorn.

Q.61. From the north most to south most point of India, what is the extent of India?

- (a) 4109 km (b) 2914 km
(c) 3214 km (d) 3785 km

Sol.61.(c) 3214 km. Extent of India: East to west (2,933 km), land frontier (15,200 km), coastline (7,516.6 km). The westernmost point (Ghuar Moti in Kutch). The easternmost point (Kibithu in Arunachal Pradesh). Indira Col (northernmost point). Indira Point (Great Nicobar Island, Andaman sea) is the Southernmost point of India while Kanyakumari is the southernmost point of the Indian Mainland.

Q.62. What is the zone between the arctic circle and north pole called?

- (a) Torrid zone
(b) Frigid zone
(c) North temperate zone
(d) South temperate zone

Sol.62.(b) Frigid zone. The North Frigid Zone, between the North Pole at 90° N and the Arctic Circle at 66°33'48.7" N, covers 4.12% of Earth's surface.

Q.63. Consider the following statements:

1. Isochrones are lines joining points located at equal travel time from a common centre.
2. Isohalines are lines connecting points of equal temperature in the ocean.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.63.(a) Only 1. **Isohaline** - A line drawn on a map to indicate connecting points of equal salinity in the ocean.

Isonomal - A line on a chart connecting points of equal abundance values of a plant species sampled in different sections of an area. **Isobronts** - A line drawn through geographical points at which a given phase of thunderstorm activity occurred simultaneously.

Q.64. 1° latitude is equal to approximately _____ km.

- (a) 111 (b) 145 (c) 133 (d) 122

Sol.64.(a) 111 km. This distance decreases marginally as one travels to poles and increases marginally as one goes towards the equator.

Continents and Oceans

Q.65. What is the primary reason for the asymmetrical distribution of continents and oceans across the Earth's surface?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Seafloor spreading and plate tectonics
(b) Earth's elliptical orbit
(c) Magnetic anomalies in the core
(d) Variations in solar radiation

Sol.65.(a) The Earth's continents are fragments of a once-unified supercontinent (Pangaea) that have been continuously drifting, colliding, and rearranging due to the movement of tectonic plates. This dynamic process, driven by seafloor spreading at mid-ocean ridges and subduction at trenches, has resulted in the current, uneven arrangement of landmasses and ocean basins, such as the land-heavy Northern Hemisphere and the ocean-dominated Southern Hemisphere.

Q.66. Consider the following statements:

1. The Arabian Sea, located in the North Indian Ocean, covers an area of about 3.86 million square kilometres.
2. The Arabian Sea has higher salinity due to high evaporation and low influx of fresh water.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.66.(c) Both 1 and 2. The North Indian Ocean is a region of the Indian Ocean

that includes the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea. The Red Sea is located between Africa and Asia. The Java Sea is located in Indonesia, between the islands of Java and Borneo. The Andaman Sea is located in the northeastern part of the Indian Ocean.

Q.67. Which of the following is the largest crustal plate on Earth with an area of over 103,000,000 km²?

- (a) South American plate
- (b) African plate
- (c) Eurasian plate
- (d) Pacific plate

Sol.67.(d) Pacific plate : It is the largest oceanic plate. Plate Tectonics theory given by McKenzie, Parker and Morgan in 1967. It proposes that the earth's lithosphere is divided into seven major and some minor plates. Major plates : Antarctica and the surrounding oceanic plate; North American (with western Atlantic floor separated from the South American plate along the Caribbean islands) plate; South American (with western Atlantic floor separated from the North American plate along the Caribbean islands) plate; Pacific plate; India-Australia-New Zealand plate; Africa with the eastern Atlantic floor plate; Eurasia and the adjacent oceanic plate.

Q.68. Consider the following statements:

1. The Peninsular Plateau of India was earlier a part of the continent Africa.
2. The Peninsular Plateau of India was earlier a part of the continent North America.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.68.(b) Only 2. The peninsular plateau of India was a part of the supercontinent Gondwana, which included Africa, South America, Australia, and Antarctica. After breaking up from Gondwana, the Indian subcontinent drifted northwards and collided with Eurasia which formed the Himalayas.

Q.69. In the context of water bodies, Neap Tides occur :

- (a) when the earth, moon and sun line up in a straight line
- (b) when the sun and moon are on the opposite sides
- (c) when there is so much interference by continents
- (d) when the sun and moon are at right angles to each other

Sol.69.(d) During neap tide, gravitational

and centrifugal forces are divided. The high tides of a neap tide are lower than the average high tide and the low tides of a Neap tide are higher than the average low tide. Spring tides - When the sun, the moon and the earth are in a straight line, the height of the tide will be higher. These are called spring tides, and they occur twice a month.

Q.70. Which of the following is a landlocked Salt Lake in South-West Asia between Israel and Jordan?

- (a) Don Juan Pond
- (b) Aral Sea
- (c) Caspian Sea
- (d) Dead Sea

Sol.70.(d) Dead Sea. Its salinity of 340 grams per litre of water. The Dead Sea seawater has a density of 1.240 kg/L, which makes swimming in its waters similar to floating. The Caspian Sea is the world's largest saltwater lake by volume. The Aral Sea is located between Kazakhstan to the north and Uzbekistan to the south.

Q.71. Which ocean is encircling the continent of Antarctica and extends northward to 60 degrees south latitude?

- (a) Atlantic Ocean
- (b) Indian Ocean
- (c) Pacific Ocean
- (d) Southern Ocean

Sol.71.(d) Southern Ocean. It is the newest of the world's five oceans, officially designated as a separate ocean by the International Hydrographic Organization (IHO) in 2000. The Atlantic Ocean is between the Americas and Europe/Africa. The Indian Ocean is between Africa, Asia, and Australia. The Pacific Ocean is between Asia and the Americas.

Q.72. The name of the strait between the Pacific and Arctic oceans, separating the Chukchi Peninsula of the Russian Far East from the Seward Peninsula of Alaska, is the :

- (a) Davis Strait
- (b) Florida Strait
- (c) Bering Strait
- (d) Messina Strait

Sol.72.(c) Bering Strait. Davis Strait : It is located between Greenland and Baffin Island in Canada. It connects Baffin Bay with the Labrador Sea and is part of the Northwest Passage in the Arctic. Florida Strait : It is a channel of water located between the Gulf of Mexico and the Atlantic Ocean, separating the Florida Keys and Cuba. Strait of Messina : It is a narrow passage between the eastern coast of Sicily and the western coast of Calabria in southern Italy. It connects the Tyrrhenian Sea with the Ionian Sea.

Q.73. In 1596, who suggested in his work

'Thesaurus Geographicus' that the continents of the earth were not always located in their present positions ?

- (a) Louis Agassiz
- (b) Georges Cuvier
- (c) Abraham Ortelius
- (d) Dan Peter McKenzie

Sol.73.(c) Abraham Ortelius was a Dutch mapmaker who proposed in his work Thesaurus Geographicus that the continents were once joined together. This idea laid the groundwork for the continental drift theory, later fully developed by Alfred Wegener in 1912. Wegener suggested that all continents formed a single landmass called Pangaea ("all earth"), surrounded by a vast ocean known as Panthalassa ("all water").

Q.74. Which of the following is NOT a part of the ocean floor?

- (a) The continental shelf
- (b) The continental slope
- (c) The deep sea shelf
- (d) The deep sea plain

Sol.74.(c) The deep sea shelf. A continental shelf is the submerged edge of a continent beneath the ocean. The continental slope extends seaward from the shelf to the upper edge of a continental rise or the point where the slope begins to flatten. An abyssal plain, or deep sea plain, is a flat region on the ocean floor, typically found at depths between 3,000 and 6,000 meters. Oceanic deeps are the deepest parts of the ocean, covered with fine-grained sediments such as clay and silt. Examples of oceanic landforms : Abyssal plains, Submarine canyons, Deep ocean trenches, Guyots, Seamounts, Mid-ocean ridges, Abyssal plains, etc.

Q.75. The thermocline layer is the _____ layer of the ocean.

- (a) second
- (b) third
- (c) fourth
- (d) first

Sol.75.(a) Second. Scientists have divided the ocean into five main layers. Epipelagic Zone - The surface layer from the surface to 200 meters. Mesopelagic Zone - The twilight zone or the midwater zone. Bathypelagic Zone - The midnight zone or the dark zone. Abyssopelagic Zone - The water temperature is near freezing, and there is no light at all. Hadalpelagic Zone - The deepest point in the ocean is located in the Mariana Trench.

Q.76. In 1962, who published 'The History of Ocean Basins', which outlined the theory of how tectonic plates could

move, later called 'sea floor spreading' ?

- (a) Alfred Wegener
- (b) Louis Bauer
- (c) Harry Hammond Hess
- (d) George Edward Backus

Sol.76.(c) Harry Hammond Hess, an American geologist and naval officer. He discovered that the oceans were shallower in the middle and identified the presence of Mid Ocean Ridges, raised above the surrounding generally flat sea floor (abyssal plain) by as much as 1.5 km. Seafloor spreading is a geologic process in which tectonic plates—large slabs of Earth's lithosphere—split apart from each other.

Q.77. Which of the following is the correct match between column-A and column-B ?

Column - A (Elements in earth crust)	Column - B (Total % in earth crust)
i. Oxygen	a. 8%
ii. Silicon	b. 28%
iii. Aluminium	c. 47%
iv. Iron	d. 5%

- (a) i-a, ii-b, iii-c, iv-d
- (b) i-c, ii-a, iii-b, iv-d
- (c) i-c, ii-b, iii-a, iv-d
- (d) i-b, ii-a, iii-c, iv-d

Sol.77.(c) i-c, ii-b, iii-a, iv-d. Abundances of other Element in the **Earth's Crust**: Calcium (Ca) - 3.63%, Sodium (Na) - 2.83%, Potassium (K) - 2.59%, Magnesium (Mg) - 2.09% and others - 1.41%. Earth has three layers: crust (upper layer), mantle (middle layer), and core (lower layer).

Q.78. Continental Shelf which is the shallowest part of the ocean has an average gradient of:

- (a) 1° or even less
- (b) 2° or even less
- (c) 8° or even less
- (d) 5° or even less

Sol.78.(a) 1° or even less. The **Continental Shelf** is the extended margin of each continent occupied by relatively shallow seas and gulfs. About Continental Shelf : The shelf typically ends at a very steep slope, called the shelf break. Their width varies globally, with an average of about 80 km, but can be narrower or even absent in some regions, such as the coasts of Chile and the west coast of Sumatra.

Q.79. Living organisms have been on Earth for how much percent of Earth's history?

- (a) 60%
- (b) 40%
- (c) 80%
- (d) 20%

Sol.79.(c) 80%. Taking Earth's age as nearly 4.6 Billion Years (BY), instead of 13.7 BY from the Big Bang, unicellular life

appeared nearly 3.8 BY ago. This percentage is $3.8/4.6 \times 100 = 82.6\%$, nearly.

Q.80. Choose the correct statement(s) related to 'continentality'.

- A. The sea exerts a moderating influence on climate.
 - B. As the distance from the sea increases, the people experience extreme weather conditions.
 - C. As one goes from the surface of the earth to higher altitudes, the atmosphere becomes less dense and temperature decreases.
- (a) B and C
 - (b) Only C
 - (c) A and C
 - (d) A and B

Sol.80.(d) A and B. Continentality (i.e. very hot during summers and very cold during winters) found in inland areas. Continental climates are common between 40° and 70° north latitude and experience large temperature differences between day and night.

Q.81. Consider the following statements about oceanic trenches:

- 1. The Mariana Trench in the Pacific Ocean is the deepest point on Earth, with a depth of about 11,022 metres.
- 2. The Java Trench, located in the Indian Ocean, is deeper than the Tonga Trench in the Southwestern Pacific Ocean.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.81.(a) 1 only. Java Trench (also known as the Sunda Trench): Located in the northeastern Indian Ocean, its maximum depth is approximately 7,725 metres. Tonga Trench: Located in the Pacific Ocean near the Tonga Islands, its deepest point (Horizon Deep) is approximately 10,882 metres. Other Trenches: Puerto Rico Trench (8,400 m) - Atlantic Ocean; South Sandwich Trench (7,432 m) - Southern Ocean.

Q.82. What does El Niño refer to ?

- (a) Hot water current
- (b) Pressure water current
- (c) High air pressure
- (d) Low air pressure

Sol.82.(a) Hot water current. The term El Nino (Little Boy in Spanish) - Warming of the ocean surface, or above-average sea surface temperatures, in the central and eastern tropical Pacific Ocean on the coast of Peru. El nino leads to weakening of trade winds in a region. La Nina (Little Girl in Spanish) - The periodic cooling of

ocean surface temperatures in the central and east-central equatorial Pacific.

Q.83. Which of the following oceans is surrounded by the continent of North America and South America to the east?

- (a) Pacific Ocean
- (b) Atlantic Ocean
- (c) Indian Ocean
- (d) Arctic Ocean

Sol.83.(a) Pacific Ocean (world's largest and deepest ocean): It represents 45 percent of the global ocean surface. The International Date Line (established in 1884) passes through the mid-Pacific Ocean. The Atlantic Ocean is surrounded by the continents of North and South America to the west, and Europe and Africa to the east. The Indian Ocean is bordered by Asia to the north, Africa to the west, and Australia to the east.

Q.84. Consider the following statements:

- 1. Due to the attraction of the Sun and the Moon, ocean water generally experiences two high tides and two low tides in a day.
- 2. Diurnal tides occur when there are two high tides and two low tides each day.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.84.(a) Only 1. When the Earth, Sun, and Moon line up, their gravitational power combines to make exceptionally high tides where the bulges occur, called spring tides, as well as very low tides where the water has been displaced. When the Sun is at a right angle to the Moon, moderate tides, called neap tides. There are generally three types of tides: **Diurnal** - One high and low tide each day, **Semi-diurnal** - Two high and low tides each day, and **Mixed** - Two high and low tides each day of different heights.

Q.85. Which of the following oceans extends into the Mediterranean Sea ?

- (a) Indian Ocean
- (b) Pacific Ocean
- (c) Atlantic Ocean
- (d) Arctic Ocean

Sol.85.(c) Atlantic Ocean is the 2nd largest ocean in the world. The Mediterranean is an intercontinental sea spread between Europe, North Africa, and Western Asia and connected to the Atlantic Ocean through the strait of Gibraltar.

Q.86. The Mohorovicic (Moho) discontinuity separates ?

- (a) Earth's lithosphere and asthenosphere
- (b) Earth's atmosphere and hydrosphere

- (c) Earth's crust and the inner core
(d) Earth's crust and the mantle

Sol.86.(d) Earth's crust and the mantle. Moho discontinuity - It occurs at an average depth of about 8 kilometers beneath the ocean basins and 32 kilometers beneath continental surfaces.

Q.87. Which is the correct sequence of oceans according to size (from largest to smallest) ?

- (a) Pacific Ocean > Antarctic Ocean > Indian Ocean > Atlantic Ocean
(b) Pacific Ocean > Indian Ocean > Antarctic Ocean > Atlantic Ocean
(c) Pacific Ocean > Atlantic Ocean > Indian Ocean > Antarctic Ocean
(d) Pacific Ocean > Indian Ocean > Atlantic Ocean > Antarctic Ocean

Sol.87.(c) Pacific Ocean, the world's largest, was named by Ferdinand Magellan. The International Date Line passes through it.

Q.88. The percentage of earth's water found in the oceans is _____.

- (a) 94 percent (b) 97.2 percent
(c) 90.2 percent (d) 92.2 percent

Sol.88.(b) 97.2 percent. Water covers **71 percent** of Earth's surface. Distribution of Earth's water: **Oceans (97.2%)**, Glaciers (2.1%), Groundwater (0.61 percent); Freshwater lakes (0.009 percent), Inland seas (0.008 percent), Soil Moisture (0.005 percent), Atmosphere (0.001 percent), Rivers (0.0001 percent). 2.7 % of earth's water is fresh.

Q.89. How thick is the lithosphere?

- (a) 25 to 45 km (b) 10 to 25 km
(c) 10 to 200 km (d) 5 to 10 km

Sol.89.(c) 10 to 200 km. The lithosphere is the outermost and mechanical layer of the Earth that consists of the entire crust and the top-most portion of the mantle. Mechanically, the earth's layers can be divided into lithosphere, asthenosphere (80-200 km), mesospheric mantle, outer core, and inner core.

Q.90. The crust is the Earth's outermost layer that is less than _____ percent of Earth by mass, with oceanic crust and continental crust often consisting of more felsic rocks.

- (a) 5 (b) 1 (c) 2 (d) 10

Sol.90.(b) 1. The average density of oceanic crust is 3.0 g/cm^3 , while continental crust has an average of 2.7 g/cm^3 . The mass of the continental crust is 2.195. The continental crust (about 30 km) is composed of lighter (felsic)

sodium potassium aluminum silicate rocks, like granite. The oceanic crust (about 5 km) is composed of dense (mafic) iron magnesium silicate igneous rocks, like basalt.

Q.91. Consider the following statements:

1. The movement of Earth's plates is classified into three main types of tectonic boundaries.
2. Convergent, divergent, and transform are the three primary types of plate movements.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.91.(c) Both 1 and 2. The movement of the plates creates three types of tectonic boundaries: convergent, where plates move into one another; divergent, where plates move apart; and transform, where plates move sideways in relation to each other.

Q.92. Movement of fault lines can cause:

- (a) a flood (b) sudden rain
(c) an earthquake (d) a storm

Sol.92.(c) An earthquake. It is a sudden shaking or trembling of the earth which lasts for a very short time. Earthquakes tend to occur at the boundaries of earth's plates. These boundaries are known as fault zones. Over 80 percent of earthquakes occur around the edges of the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the **'Ring of Fire'**. Instrument used for measuring Earthquake: Seismograph.

Q.93. What is the average salinity of the Indian ocean?

- (a) 350 o/oo (b) 35 o/oo
(c) 3.5 o/oo (d) 3 o/oo

Sol.93.(b) 35 o/oo (35 parts per thousand). **Salinity** is the amount of salt present in 1000 grams of water. A salinity of 24.7 % has been regarded as the upper limit to fix 'brackish water'.

Q.94. Tsunami is NOT caused by:

- (a) Hurricanes
(b) volcanic eruptions
(c) undersea landslides
(d) Earthquakes

Sol.94.(a) Hurricanes. Tsunamis are giant waves caused by earthquakes or volcanic eruptions under the sea.

Q.95. Which of the following is a warm current?

- (a) Labrador current (b) Falkland current
(c) Canary current (d) Gulf stream

Sol.95.(d) Gulf stream current in the North Atlantic and the Kuroshio Current in the North Pacific are warm currents.

Warm Currents - Alaskan Current, Tsushima Current, Brazilian Current etc.

Cold Current - Labrador Current, Canary Current, Benguela Current, Falkland Current, South Indian Ocean Current, Okhotsk Current, Humboldt or Peruvian Current etc.

Q.96. Consider the following statements regarding oceanic landforms:

1. An Atoll is a group of islands found in tropical oceans, consisting of coral reefs and a central depression.
2. A guyot is a shallow body of water separated from the ocean by a barrier reef.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.96.(a) 1 only. Guyot is an undersea mountain. Lagoons are shallow bodies of water that are separated from the ocean by a barrier reef. Seamounts are underwater mountains that rise above the ocean floor but do not reach the surface.

Q.97. Ocean acidification is the ongoing decrease in the pH of the Earth's oceans, caused by the uptake of _____ from the atmosphere.

- (a) Methane (b) carbon dioxide
(c) nitrogen (d) argon

Sol.97.(b) Carbon dioxide. **Ocean acidification** is the worldwide reduction in the pH of seawater as a consequence of the absorption of large amounts of carbon dioxide by the oceans. It results in the alteration of marine food chains and food supply to humans.

Q.98. Consider the following statements regarding the lowest known point on Earth:

1. Challenger Deep is located in the western Pacific Ocean.
2. The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest coral reef located in Australia.
3. Factorian Deep is the deepest point in the Pacific Ocean.

Which of the statements given above is incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) 3 only (d) 1 and 3

Sol.98.(c) 3 only. The lowest known point on earth is called Challenger Deep, which is present in the Pacific Ocean. **Factorian Deep** is the new deepest point in Antarctica's Southern Ocean. The

Great Blue Hole is a giant marine sinkhole off the coast of Belize.

Q.99. In coastal areas, during the night, wind blows from land to sea because:

- (a) low pressure is created on land
- (b) land cools slower than water
- (c) water cools slower than land
- (d) high pressure is created at sea

Sol.99.(c) water cools slower than land.

The wind blowing from land towards the sea is the **Land breeze**. The wind blowing from the sea towards the land is a **sea breeze**. Both are induced by differences that occur between the heating or cooling of the water surface and the adjacent land surface.

Q.100. The process of seepage of water into the ground is called ____.

- (a) Infiltration (b) depletion
- (c) Storage (d) replenishment

Sol.100.(a) Infiltration occurs when surface water enters the soil.

Q.101. Which water body covers an area of $1,55,58,000 \text{ km}^2$ and makes up only 4.3% of the global ocean?

- (a) Atlantic Ocean (b) Arctic Ocean
- (c) Southern Ocean (d) Indian Ocean

Sol.101.(b) Arctic Ocean is the smallest and shallowest of the world's five major oceans.

Q.102. Consider the following statements about the Sargasso Sea:

1. The Sargasso Sea is the only sea in the world that does not have a land boundary.
2. It is located in the Pacific Ocean and is named after the presence of brown Sargassum seaweed.

Which of the statements given above is incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.102.(b) Only 2. The Sargasso Sea is the only sea in the world without a land boundary. It is bounded entirely by ocean currents (North Atlantic Gyre: Gulf Stream, North Atlantic Current, Canary Current, North Equatorial Current). Statement 2 is incorrect - Sargasso Sea lies in the Atlantic Ocean. It is named so because of the presence of brown Sargassum seaweed.

Q.103. Match the following Seismic Zones of India with their characteristics:

List I (Seismic Zone)	List II (Characteristic)
A. Zone II	1. Least seismically

	active region
B. Zone III	2. Moderate seismic activity
C. Zone IV	3. High seismic activity
D. Zone V	4. Most seismically active region

- (a) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4 (b) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
- (c) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (d) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

Sol.103.(a) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4. The Bureau of Indian Standards has classified regions in India into **4 seismic zones** on the basis of historical seismic activity. These are zones II, III, IV and V. The magnitude scale used to measure earthquakes ranges from **1 to 12**.

Q.104. The ____ is responsible for Earth's magnetic field.

- (a) inner core (b) mantle
- (c) outer core (d) crust

Sol.104.(c) outer core. On Earth, flowing liquid metal in the outer core of the planet generates electric currents. The rotation of Earth on its axis causes these electric currents to form a magnetic field which extends around the planet.

Q.105. Consider the following statements regarding Gondwanaland:

1. Gondwanaland included present-day South America, Africa, Madagascar, India, Australia, and Antarctica.
2. North America was also a part of Gondwanaland.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.105.(b) 2 only. Gondwana was a large landmass, sometimes referred to as a supercontinent. The remnants of Gondwana make up around two-thirds of today's continental area, including South America, Africa, Antarctica, Australia, Zealandia, Arabia, and the Indian subcontinent.

Neighbouring Countries of India

Q.106. Which of the following is in geographical proximity to Sri Lanka?

- (a) Only Karaikal (b) Karaikal and Yanam
- (c) Only Mahe (d) Only Yanam

Sol.106.(a) Only Karaikal. Karaikal is a town in the Union Territory of Puducherry. Sri Lanka, formerly known as Ceylon, is an island nation in South Asia. Located in the Indian Ocean, southwest of the Bay of Bengal, it is separated from

the Indian peninsula by the Gulf of Mannar and the Palk Strait. Sri Lanka shares a maritime border with the Maldives to the southwest and India to the northwest.

Q.107. Which of the following pairs do NOT share any borders?

- (a) Bhutan and Arunachal Pradesh
- (b) Bhutan and Meghalaya
- (c) Bhutan and West Bengal
- (d) Bhutan and Assam

Sol.107.(b) Bhutan and Meghalaya. The Indian states of West Bengal (183 km), Arunachal Pradesh (217 km), Sikkim (32 km), and Assam (267 km) share their boundaries with Bhutan. The Kingdom of Bhutan and the Republic of India are separated by a 699 km long, regional border.

Q.108. Which of the following countries has the highest Hindu population after India?

- (a) Bhutan (b) Sri Lanka
- (c) Myanmar (d) Nepal

Sol.108.(d) Nepal. After India, the next nine countries with the largest Hindu populations are, in decreasing order : Nepal, Bangladesh, Indonesia, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, the United States, Malaysia, the United Arab Emirates and the United Kingdom.

Q.109. Assertion (A): New Moore Island, also known as South Talpatti, is geographically closest to Bangladesh.

Reason (R): It is located in the Bay of Bengal near the maritime boundary between India and Bangladesh.

- (a) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are correct, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is correct, but R is incorrect
- (d) A is incorrect, but R is correct

Sol.109.(a) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A.

Q.110. Consider the following statements:

1. The Maldives are located to the south of Lakshadweep Islands of India.
 2. The capital of Maldives is Male.
- Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.110.(c) Both 1 and 2. The Maldives are a group of coral atolls that were formed from the crowns of an ancient volcanic mountain range.

Q.111. Consider the following statements regarding boundary lines of India:

1. The McMahon Line is the boundary between India and China.
2. The Radcliffe Line forms the boundary between India and Pakistan.
3. The Durand Line separates Pakistan and Afghanistan.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Sol.111.(d) 1, 2 and 3. Pakistan shares a border with India, defined by the Radcliffe Line (International Border) and the Line of Control. India has 15,106.7 Km of land border and a coastline of 7,516.6 Km including island territories. India shares the longest border with Bangladesh about 4,096.7 km and Shortest with Afghanistan about 106 km. The Durand line separates Pakistan and Afghanistan.

Q.112. Which trek in Bhutan is considered to be the crown jewel of Bhutanese trekking?

- (a) Jumolhari Trek
(b) Dagala Thousand Lakes Trek
(c) Snowman Trek
(d) Laya Gasa Trek

Sol.112.(c) Snowman Trek. It is a 27 day track. Other Treks in Bhutan - Jumolhari Trek, Dagala Thousand Lakes trek, Laya Gasa Trek, Druk Path Trek, Tsaluna Trek, etc. Treks in India - Kalindi Khal Trek, Stok Kangri Trek, Auden's Col Trek, Chadar Trek, etc.

Q.113. Consider the following statements regarding the Sino-Indian border (LAC):

1. The Line of Actual Control (LAC) is divided into three sectors – Western, Central, and Eastern.
2. The Eastern sector of the LAC lies across Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand states.

Which of the above statements is incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.113.(b) 2 only. The Indian Military has divided the LAC (Line of Actual Control) into 3 sectors - Western sector across Ladakh and the Chinese-held Aksai Chin, The central sector across Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand states, and the eastern sector across Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh states.

Q.114. Match the following mountain

passes with the countries/borders they are associated with:

Pass	Country / Border
A. Khyber Pass	1. India–China border
B. Pangsau Pass	2. India–Myanmar border
C. Karakoram Pass	3. Pakistan and Afghanistan border
D. Zojila Pass	4. India (Ladakh –Srinagar link)

(a) A–3, B–2, C–1, D–4

(b) A–2, B–3, C–1, D–4

(c) A–3, B–4, C–2, D–1

(d) A–1, B–2, C–3, D–4

Sol.114.(a) A–3, B–2, C–1, D–4.

Q.115. Consider the following statements:

1. The Sunderban forest is part of the world's largest delta and contains the largest mangrove forests.
2. The Sunderban forest is shared between India and Bangladesh.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.115.(c) Both 1 and 2. Sunderban forest is the only mangrove habitat in the world for Panthera tigris species.

Indian Drainage System

Q.116. Which of the following rivers forms a delta along the Eastern Coastal Plains ?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Narmada (b) Tapi
(c) Mahi (d) Godavari

Sol.116.(d) Godavari. The Godavari River, also called the Dakshina Ganga or Ganga of the South, forms a large delta along the Eastern Coastal Plains before draining into the Bay of Bengal. It is the second longest river in India after the Ganga. Major delta-forming rivers on the east coast: Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, and Kaveri. On the other hand, west-flowing rivers like Narmada, Tapi, and Mahi do not form deltas; they form estuaries because of their short course and fast flow into the Arabian Sea.

Q.117. Which of these rivers does not originate in the Peninsular Plateau of India ?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Godavari (b) Ganga
(c) Krishna (d) Cauvery

Sol.117.(b) Ganga. The Ganga River does not originate in the Peninsular

Plateau. Instead, it originates from the Gangotri Glacier in the Himalayas at Gaumukh in Uttarakhand. Origins of the other rivers : Godavari – Trimbakeshwar near Nasik, Maharashtra (Western Ghats). Krishna – Mahabaleshwar near Jor village, Maharashtra (Western Ghats). Cauvery (Kaveri) – Talakaveri in the Brahmagiri Hills, Karnataka (Western Ghats).

Q.118. Consider the following statements regarding the Ghaghara River system:

1. The Ghaghara originates from the Mapchachungo glacier in the Himalayas.
2. It forms a deep gorge at Shishapani before entering the plains.
3. It merges with the Ganga at Allahabad after receiving the Sarda River.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Only 1 and 3 (b) Only 1 and 2
(c) Only 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3 are correct

Sol.118.(b) Only 1 and 2. The Ghaghara River originates from the Mapchachungo glacier in the Tibetan Himalayas. It carves a deep gorge at Shishapani before entering the plains of Nepal. Statement 3 is incorrect because the Ghaghara joins the Ganga river near Chhapra in Bihar, not at Allahabad.

Q.119. The Alaknanda River originates from which of the following?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Satopanth Glacier (b) Zemu Glacier
(c) Milam Glacier (d) Gangotri Glacier

Sol.119.(a) Satopanth Glacier. The Alaknanda River, a major tributary of the Ganga, originates from the Satopanth Glacier near Badrinath in Uttarakhand, at an elevation of about 3,650 metres. It flows through important confluences (prayags) such as Vishnuprayag, Nandprayag, Karnaprayag, Rudraprayag, and Devprayag, where it finally meets the Bhagirathi River to form the Ganga. In contrast, the Gangotri Glacier is the source of the Bhagirathi River, the Zemu Glacier feeds the Teesta in Sikkim, and the Milam Glacier gives rise to the Goriganga in Uttarakhand.

Q.120. Read the given below statements carefully and choose the correct option:

Assertion (A): The Chambal River is known for its badland topography called the Chambal ravines.

Reason (R): The Chambal flows through

a deep gorge and eroded terrain before joining the Yamuna.

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
 (b) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
 (c) A is true, but R is false.
 (d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.120.(b) The Chambal basin is famous for deep ravines formed due to intensive gully erosion, a classic example of badland topography. The Chambal indeed flows through a rugged, eroded landscape, cutting gorges and ravines before meeting the Yamuna in Etawah district (U.P.). The badland topography (ravines) is formed because of severe erosion by the river and its tributaries in the soft alluvial soils of the Chambal basin. Hence, the reason correctly explains the assertion. Chambal and its tributaries (Kalisindh, Banas, Sindh) intensify erosion. These ravines stretch across Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Uttar Pradesh.

Q.121. Which of the following is an erosional landform created primarily by river action?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Moraine (b) Delta (c) Gorge (d) Levee

Sol.121.(c) Gorge.

A gorge is a deep, narrow valley with steep sides, formed when a river cuts vertically into its bed through the process of erosion, especially in the upper course where the river has a steep gradient. It is a classic erosional landform created by river action. Moraine – Depositional landform created by glaciers, consisting of rock debris. Delta – Depositional feature formed at the river's mouth due to deposition of sediments. Levee – A natural or artificial embankment formed alongside a river, also depositional in nature.

Q.122. Consider the following statements regarding the evolution of India's major drainage systems:

1. The ancient Indo-Brahma river is believed to have split into three major drainage systems over time.
2. The Ganga and its Himalayan tributaries represent the central drainage system.
3. The western drainage system consists of the Brahmaputra and its tributaries.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Only 2 and 3

- (b) All 1, 2 and 3 are correct

- (c) Only 1 and 3

- (d) Only 1 and 2

Sol.122.(d) Only 1 and 2. The Indo-Brahma River system is believed to be an ancient unified river that later broke into three drainage systems: the Indus (western), the Ganga (central), and the Brahmaputra (eastern). The Ganga and its Himalayan tributaries like Yamuna, Ghaghara, Gandak, and Kosi form the central drainage system. However, the Brahmaputra and its tributaries constitute the eastern drainage system, not the western one.

Q.123. Which river is the main source of water for the Hirakud Dam?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Godavari River (b) Krishna River
 (c) Mahanadi River (d) Narmada River

Sol.123.(c) Mahanadi River. The Hirakud Dam, located near Sambalpur in Odisha, is built across the Mahanadi River. It is one of the world's longest earthen dams (25.8 km) and serves multiple purposes—irrigation, hydroelectric power generation, and flood control in the Mahanadi delta.

Q.124. The Jog Falls in Karnataka is formed from which river?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Godavari (b) Kaveri
 (c) Sharavathi (d) Krishna

Sol.124.(c) Sharavathi.

Jog Falls, also called Gerosoppa Falls or Joga Falls, is one of the highest plunge waterfalls in India (about 253 meters). It is located in Shivamogga district, Karnataka. It is a major hydroelectric power source as well, with the Sharavathi Hydroelectric Project built nearby.

Godavari – Flows mainly through Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh. Kaveri – Famous for Shivanasamudra and Hogenakkal Falls, not Jog Falls. Krishna – Flows through Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh; associated with Almatti and Srisailem dams.

Q.125. Trishulganga is a stream of the river:

- (a) Ghaghara (b) Beas
 (c) Godavari (d) Gandak

Sol.125.(d) Gandak. It comprises two streams, namely Kaligandak and Trishulganga. It rises in the Nepal Himalayas between the Dhaulagiri and Mount Everest and drains the central part of Nepal. It enters the Ganga plain in

Champan district of Bihar and joins the Ganga at Sonpur near Patna.

Q.126. Select the odd one from the following saltwater lakes on the basis of their formation?

- (a) Pulicat lake (b) Kolleru lake
 (c) Chilika lake (d) Sambhar lake

Sol.126.(d) Sambhar lake: The largest inland saltwater lake in India situated in Rajasthan. Pulicat lake (Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu), Kolleru lake (Andhra Pradesh), and Chilika lake (Odisha) - are all coastal saltwater lakes, formed by the seawater entering the lake through creeks or rivers.

Q.127. The Zaskar and the Nubra are tributaries of which river?

- (a) Mahanadi (b) Ganga
 (c) Indus (d) Kaveri

Sol.127.(c) Indus (Sindhu) originates from a glacier near Bokhar Chu in the Tibetan region at an altitude of 4,164 m in the Kailash Mountain range. Tributaries - Chenab River, Jhelum River, Ravi River, Satluj River, Beas River, Shyok River, Gilgit River, Hunza River, Swat River, Kunnar River, Kurram River, Gomol River, and Kabul River.

Q.128. Which of the following rivers flows north of the Tropic of Cancer in India?

- (a) Mahanadi (b) Tapi
 (c) Penganga (d) Yamuna

Sol.128.(d) Yamuna. Originates - Yamunotri Glacier, Flows through the Himalayan foothills before entering the Indo-Gangetic Plain. Tributaries - Tons, Hindon, Chambal, Sind, Betwa, and Ken. The Yamuna River joins the Ganges River near Prayagraj (Allahabad). The Mahi River is the only river in India that crosses the Tropic of Cancer twice. Originates in the Vindhya Mountains in Madhya Pradesh, flows through Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Gujarat, and drains into the Arabian Sea.

Q.129. Consider the following statements regarding the origin of major Indian rivers:

1. The spout emerging from the mouth of a cow statue in the Mahadev Temple at Mahabaleshwar is considered the source of the Krishna River.
2. The Godavari River originates from Trimbakeshwar in the Nashik district of Maharashtra.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.129.(c) Both 1 and 2. Krishna is the second largest east flowing Peninsular river which rises near Mahabaleshwar in Sahyadri. Origin of rivers : Kaveri - originates at Talakaveri, which is located on the Brahmagiri range in the Kodagu (Coorg) district of Karnataka. Narmada - rises from Maikala range near Amarkantak in Madhya Pradesh.

Q.130. What is the salt measurement in hypersaline lagoons?

- (a) 30 to 35 (b) Less than 5
(c) Less than 100 (d) More than 100

Sol.130.(d) More than 100. Hypersaline lagoons are extreme environments with salt concentrations significantly higher than typical seawater. While normal ocean salinity is around 35 parts per thousand (3.5%), hypersaline lagoons can have salt concentrations exceeding 100 parts per thousand (10%). These environments are typically found in arid regions with high evaporation rates and limited water input, such as the Dead Sea.

Q.131. In which state of India is kund or Tanka used for water harvesting ?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Punjab

Sol.131.(a) Rajasthan. This region faces extreme arid conditions and low rainfall, so local communities have developed innovative systems to conserve and store water. Water harvesting structures in other States: Kere (large tanks) in Karnataka, Cheruvu in Andhra Pradesh, Bandharas and Tals in Maharashtra, Surangam in Kerala, Eris (tanks) in Tamil Nadu, Bhundis in Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

Q.132. Consider the following statements regarding continental shelves:

1. The Siberian shelf in the Arctic Ocean is the largest continental shelf in the world.
2. A continental shelf is the edge of a continent that lies under the ocean.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.132.(c) Both 1 and 2. A continental shelf is the edge of a continent that lies under the ocean. Continents are the seven main divisions of land on Earth. A continental shelf extends from the

coastline of a continent to a drop-off point called the shelf break. Example of a Continental Shelf Landform: Siberian Shelf, Arctic Ocean.

Q.133. Which of the following is the transboundary river between India and Pakistan?

- (a) Indus (b) Ravi (c) Beas (d) Jhelum

Sol.133.(b) Ravi. This river flows through north-western India and eastern Pakistan. It, along with the Beas and Sutlej rivers, was allocated to India under the Indus Water Treaty. Indus River : This river originates in western Tibet, passes through Kashmir, and flows into Pakistan before falling into the Arabian Sea. It, along with the Chenab and Jhelum rivers, was allocated to Pakistan under the Indus Water Treaty of 1960.

Q.134. In which state of India was the Neeru-Meeru programme introduced for construction of water harvesting structures?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Punjab

Sol.134.(a) Andhra Pradesh. The Neeru-Meeru (Water and You) program was launched by the Water Conservation Mission (WCM), on May 1, 2000. It was a Water conservation and poverty alleviation initiative.

Q.135. Identify a water-harvesting system found in Jaisalmer.

- (a) Guls (b) Johads (c) Khadins (d) Kuls

Sol.135.(c) Khadins. 'Rooftop rainwater harvesting' was commonly practised to store drinking water, particularly in Rajasthan. In arid and semi-arid regions, agricultural fields were converted into rain fed storage structures that allowed the water to stand and moisten the soil like the 'khadins' in Jaisalmer and 'Johads' in other parts of Rajasthan. In hill and mountainous regions, people built diversion channels like the 'guls' or 'kuls' of the Western Himalayas for agriculture.

Q.136. Which of the following rivers marks the eastern-most boundary of the Himalayas ?

- (a) Kali (b) Teesta
(c) Satluj (d) Brahmaputra

Sol.136.(d) Brahmaputra River flows through the northeastern part of India, originating from the Angsi Glacier in Tibet and passing through Arunachal Pradesh before entering Assam. The Teesta River rises in the Pauhunri

Mountain of the eastern Himalayas and flows through the Indian states of Sikkim and West Bengal. The Satluj River originates in Raksas Tal near Mansarovar in Tibet. The Kali River flows through the Uttara Kannada district of Karnataka.

Q.137. Which of the following peninsular rivers falls into the Arabian Sea?

- (a) Mahanadi river (b) Krishna river
(c) Sabarmati river (d) Godavari river

Sol.137.(c) Sabarmati river. It is one of the major west-flowing rivers in India. It originates from Aravalli hills. Mahanadi river: Origin - Sihawa (South of Amarkantak) near Raipur (Chhattisgarh). It flows through Chhattisgarh and Odisha and drains into the Bay of Bengal.

Q.138. Consider the following statements:

1. The Yamuna, Gandak, and Kosi are important tributaries of the river Ganga.
2. The Lohit River is not a tributary of the Ganga; rather, it is a tributary of the Brahmaputra.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.138.(c) Both 1 and 2. The river **Ganga** emerges from Gangotri Glacier and ends at Bay of Bengal. Ganges is the longest river of India. It is 2,525 km long. Its tributaries include Yamuna, Gandak, Ramganga, Son, Ghaghra, Gomti, Kosi, Tamsa, Punpun, and Mahananda. **Brahmaputra** river originates under the name of Siang or Dihang, from the Chemayungdung glacier of the Kailash range near the Mansarovar lake. It enters India west of Sadiya town in Arunachal Pradesh. **Tributaries:** Dibang, Lohit, Siang, Burhi Dihing, Tista, and Dhansari.

Q.139. Which of the following are west flowing rivers?

- (a) Godavari and Mahanadi
(b) Krishna and Kaveri
(c) Ganga and Yamuna
(d) Mahi and Sabarmati

Sol.139.(d) Mahi and Sabarmati. Mahi River originates from Vindhyachal Hills, Madhya Pradesh and meets in Bay of Khambhat. Major West-flowing rivers - Indus, Narmada, and Tapi. Major East-flowing rivers: Ganga, Brahmaputra, Mahanadi, Krishna, and Godavari. Major peninsular rivers - Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri, Narmada, and Tapi.

Q.140. Which of the following rivers is an east flowing river?

- (a) Mahi river (b) Narmada river
(c) Godavari river (d) Tapi river

Sol.140.(c) Godavari river. It rises in the Nasik district of Maharashtra and discharges its water into the Bay of Bengal. It is 1,465 km long with a catchment area spreading over 3.13 lakh square kilometers. The Penganga, the Indravati, the Pranhita, and the Manjra are its principal tributaries. The Mahi (Origin, Northern slope of Vindhyas), Narmada (Origin, Amarkantak), and Tapi (Origin, Betul) rivers flow westward, draining into the Arabian Sea.

Q.141. Consider the following statements:

1. The confluence of the Bhagirathi and Alaknanda rivers is at Devaprayag.
2. The Mandakini river meets the Alaknanda at Karnaprayag.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.141.(a) 1 only. The Five Prayags are sacred river confluences in Uttarakhand. At Devaprayag, the Bhagirathi and Alaknanda rivers meet. At Rudraprayag, the Mandakini and Alaknanda rivers converge. At Nandaprayag, the Nandakini joins the Alaknanda. At Karnaprayag, the Pindar meets the Alaknanda, and at Vishnuprayag, the Dhauliganga merges with the Alaknanda.

Q.142. Which state of India has the maximum number of large dams?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Odisha (d) Rajasthan

Sol.142.(a) Maharashtra leads in large dams, followed by Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat. Major dams in Maharashtra include Jayakwadi, Koyna, and Radhanagari. India's first dam, Kallanai, was built over 2,000 years ago. Notable post-independence dams include Hirakud (1957), Gandhisagar (1960), Bhakra-Nangal (1963), and Nagarjuna Sagar (1967).

Q.143. In which group of states does the Luni River flow?

- (a) Bihar and West Bengal
(b) Andhra Pradesh and Telangana
(c) Rajasthan and Gujarat
(d) Maharashtra and Karnataka

Sol.143.(c) Rajasthan and Gujarat. The Luni River begins near Pushkar valley in two branches called the Saraswati and

the Sabarmati. These two branches merge at Govindgarh, and from there, the river flows out of the Aravalli as the Luni. It continues westward until Telwara, then turns southwest to join the Rann of Kutch (Gujarat).

Q.144. Consider the following statements regarding the land of Sapta Sindhu mentioned in Vedic literature:

1. The Aryans lived in the land known as Sapta Sindhu, meaning the land of seven rivers.
2. The seven rivers included Indus, Sutlej (Sutudri), Ravi (Parusni), Chenab (Asikni), Jhelum (Vitasta), Beas (Vipas), and Saraswati.
3. The Shipra River, flowing through Ujjain in Madhya Pradesh, was also one of the rivers of Sapta Sindhu.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Sol.144.(c) 3 only. The Shipra (Kshipra), a 195 km tributary of the Chambal River in Madhya Pradesh, flows across the Malwa Plateau, passing through Ujjain, Ratlam, and Mandsaur before joining the Chambal. The Sapta Sindhu, mentioned in Vedic literature, refers to the "Land of Seven Rivers" in Punjab, home to early Aryan settlements.

Q.145. Which of the following rivers originates from the Himalayas?

- (a) Godavari (b) Tapi
(c) Narmada (d) Ganga

Sol.145.(d) Ganga. Origin: Gangotri glacier near Gaumukh (3,900 m) in the Uttarkashi district of Uttarakhand. Here, it is known as the Bhagirathi. It cuts through the Central and the Lesser Himalayas in narrow gorges. At Devprayag, the Bhagirathi meets the Alaknanda; hereafter, it is known as the Ganga (length 2,525 km). Other river origin: Godavari - Brahmagiri hills; Tapi - Satpura range; Narmada - Maikal ranges.

Q.146. Subansiri, Jia Bharali, Dhansiri and Puthimari are the major tributaries of which river?

- (a) Godavari (b) Mahanadi
(c) Brahmaputra (d) Bhagirathi

Sol.146.(c) Brahmaputra. The principal tributaries of the rivers are as follows: Godavari: Pravara, Purna, Manjra, Penganga, Wardha, Wainganga, Pranhita (the combined flow of Wainganga, Penganga, and Wardha), Indravati, Maner, and Sabri. Mahanadi: Seonath, Hasdeo, Mand, and Ib join Mahanadi from the left,

while Ong, Tel, and Jonk join from the right. Bhagirathi: Bhilangna River, Kedar Ganga, Jadh Ganga, etc.

Q.147. On which river in India was the Somasila Dam built?

- (a) Krishna river (b) Tapi river
(c) Pennar river (d) Sabarmati river

Sol.147.(c) Pennar river. It originates in the Nandi Hills, Karnataka, and flows through Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh before emptying into the Bay of Bengal. The Somasila dam is situated in the Nellore district (Andhra Pradesh). Famous dams and the rivers they are built on: Koyna Dam (Koyna River), Idukki Dam (Periyar River).

Q.148. The largest inland salt lake 'Sambhar' is located in the _____ of India.

- (a) north - east (b) north - west
(c) south - west (d) south - east

Sol.148.(b) north - west. Sambhar Salt Lake (located in Rajasthan) spans 230 square kilometers. It is a significant depression in the Aravalli Range and is commonly referred to as the salt lake of Rajasthan. The lake receives water from six rivers: Mantha, Rupangarh, Khari, Khandela, Medtha and Samod.

Q.149. Which of the following rivers is called 'Singi Khamban' in Tibet?

- (a) Indus (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Kosi (d) Sutlej

Sol.149.(a) Indus. It enters Pakistan near Chilas in the Dardistan region. Brahmaputra: Originates from the Chemayungdung glacier in the Kailash range and is known as Tsangpo in Tibet. Sutlej: Originates near Mansarovar in Tibet, where it is called Langchen Khambab. River Kosi: Originates near Mount Everest and is known as the sorrow of Bihar due to frequent flooding.

Q.150. Match the pair correctly:

National Waterways	Stretch
a) NW-1	1. Kakinada - Puducherry
b) NW-2	2. Kottapuram- Kallam
c) NW-3	3. Allahabad - Haldia
d) NW-5	4. Sadiya- Dhubri
	5. Talcher - Dhamra

- (a) a-1, b-2, c-4, d-5 (b) a-3, b-4, c-2, d-5
(c) a-4, b-3, c-5, d-1 (d) a-2, b-5, c-3, d-1

Sol.150.(b) a-3, b-4, c-2, d-5. NW-1 is the longest waterway in India, stretching 1,620 kilometers from Haldia to Allahabad. NW-69 is the smallest (5 km) waterway in India. It is part of the Manimuthar River in Tamil Nadu.

Q.151. Consider the following statements regarding Chilika Lake:

1. Chilika Lake is located to the south of the Narmada delta.
2. It is Asia's largest brackish water lagoon and India's first Ramsar wetland site (1981).

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.151.(a) 1 only. Chilika Lake is located to the south of the Mahanadi delta. Chilika Lake, Asia's largest and the world's second-largest lagoon, spans Puri, Khurda, and Ganjam districts in Odisha. Nalabana Island, a bird sanctuary, lies in the middle of Chilika Lake, while Satapada, where the lake meets the Bay of Bengal, is home to Irrawaddy dolphins.

Q.152. Delhi ridge is the water divide between which of the following rivers?

- (a) Ganges and Sind
(b) Indus and Mahi
(c) Ganges and Indus
(d) Ganges and Yamuna

Sol.152.(c) Ganges and Indus. The uplift of the Potwar Plateau during the Pleistocene upheaval in the western Himalayas rises the Delhi ridge. The major water dividers of India: Vindya range: Divided the Ganga drainage basin and Narmada river valley. Satpuda range: Divided Narmada river and Tapi river valley.

Q.153. Consider the following statements regarding the canal systems and Doabs of Punjab:

1. The Bist Doab Canal System lies between the Sutlej and Beas rivers.
2. The Makhu Canal System, built in 1950, draws water from the Sutlej river.
3. Doab Bari lies between the Beas and Chenab rivers.

Which of the statements given above is incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

Sol.153.(c) 3 only. Punjab's Doab systems include: Doab Chaj (Chenab and Jhelum), Doab Rachna (Ravi and Chenab), Doab Bari (Beas and Ravi, also called Majha), and Suj Doab (Satluj and Yamuna, part of the Malwa region).

Q.154. Which of the following pairs of Indian rivers is west flowing?

- (a) Krishna and Kaveri
(b) Mahanadi and Krishna

- (c) Narmada and Tapi
(d) Mahanadi and Godavari

Sol.154.(c) Narmada and Tapi. Narmada River (Rewa River), the longest west-flowing river, originates from the Maikal ranges and flows through Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, and Maharashtra. The Tapi River, the second-largest west flowing river, originates from Betul district in Madhya Pradesh and flows parallel to the Narmada. Other important west-flowing rivers include Periyar, Bharathappuzha, Netravati, Sharavathi, and Mandovi.

Q.155. Match the following dams with the rivers on which they are built.

a. Hirakud Dam	(i) Chambal river
b. Nagarjuna Sagar Dam	(ii) Narmada River
c. Sardar Sarovar Dam	(iii) Krishna River
d. Tehri Dam	(iv) Mahanadi river
e. Rana Pratap Sagar dam	(v) Bhagirathi river

- (a) a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-v, e-i
(b) a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-v, e-iv
(c) a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i, e-v
(d) a-iii, b-iv, c-ii, d-v, e-i

Sol.155.(a) a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-v, e-i. The Hirakud Dam, one of the longest in the world, is located near Sambalpur District, Odisha. The Nagarjuna Sagar Dam, a masonry dam, spans the border between Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. The Sardar Sarovar Dam, a concrete gravity dam, is situated near Kevadiya in Gujarat's Narmada District. The Tehri Dam, a multi-purpose rock and earth-fill embankment dam, is in New Tehri, Uttarakhand. The Rana Pratap Sagar Dam, a gravity masonry dam, stands 53.8 meters high in Rawatbhata, Rajasthan.

Q.156. Which of the following rivers is joined by river Chambal from the south?

- (a) Kosi (b) Yamuna (c) Teesta (d) Ganga

Sol.156.(b) Yamuna. It rises from the Yamunotri Glacier in the Himalayas. It flows parallel to the Ganga and as a right the bank tributary meets the Ganga at Allahabad. Its biggest tributary is Chambal River on the right. Other important tributaries include the Hindon, Sarda, and Giri rivers on the right and Betwa and Sindh on the left.

Q.157. Choose the coasts that are running along the Arabian sea.

- A. Northern Circars, B. Malabar,
C. Konkan, D. Coromandel
(a) Only A and C (b) A, B and C
(c) B, C and D (d) Only B and C

Sol.157.(d) Only B and C. The western coast, between the Western Ghats and the Arabian Sea, is a narrow plain with three sections: Konkan (Mumbai to Goa) in the north, Kannad Plain in the center, and Malabar Coast in the south. On the Bay of Bengal side, the plains are wide and level, called the Northern Circar in the north and the Coromandel Coast in the south.

Q.158. Which river flows into the Wular lake in the north and then into Baramulla?

- (a) Beas (b) Sutlej (c) Jhelum (d) Ravi

Sol.158.(c) Jhelum River originates from a spring at Verinag in the southeastern part of the Kashmir Valley. It first flows northward into Wular Lake, located in the northwestern part of the valley. After leaving Wular Lake, it changes direction, flowing southwards. At Baramulla, the river enters a gorge in the hills, carving a steep-sided narrow passage through the Pir Panjal Range below Baramulla. Eventually, it merges with the Chenab River at Trimmu.

Q.159. Which river originates from 'Rakshastal north-western tip' near Mansarovar?

- (a) Sutlej River (b) Narmada River
(c) Ravi River (d) Tapi River

Sol.159.(a) Sutlej River enters India through the Shipki La Pass in the Kinnaur district of Himachal Pradesh. It is an east bank tributary of the Indus River, meeting the Indus at Mithankot in Pakistan. Also known as Shatadru in ancient times, the Satluj is the only Indus tributary originating from Tibet. The Bhakra-Nangal Dam is built across the Satluj, and the Indira Gandhi Canal also draws water from it.

Q.160. Consider the following statements regarding drainage patterns in India:

1. Radial drainage pattern is formed when rivers discharge their waters into a central depression or lake, as in Loktak Lake (Manipur).
2. Centripetal drainage pattern is formed when rivers originate from a hill and flow in all directions, as in the case of Narmada.

Which of the above statements are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.160.(c) Both 1 and 2. The drainage system formed when rivers discharge their waters from all directions in a lake

or depression, as in the case of Loktak Lake in Manipur, is called Centripetal. Radial drainage pattern: When the rivers originate from a hill and flow in all directions. Example - Narmada.

Q.161. In which of the following districts is Baira Siul Dam located ?

- (a) Bilaspur (b) Chamba
(c) Kinnaur (d) Mandi

Sol.161.(b) Chamba. The Baira Siul hydroelectric plant is an operational hydroelectric power facility located in Chaurah, Himachal Pradesh. It is a type of Earthen / Gravity & Masonry dam. Length: 160m and Height: 53m. River: Baira + Bhaled + Siul / Ravi. Other dam of Himachal Pradesh and district: Pandoh Dam and Bassi Dam (Mandi), Kol Dam and Bhakra dam (Bilaspur), Karchham-Wangtoo Dam (Kinnaur), Chamera Dam (Chamba), Parbati Dam (mandi).

Q.162. Choose the correct statement about the peninsular rivers.

- A. The Narmada rises in the Malwa plateau.
B. The Godavari rises from the slopes of the Western Ghats near Nashik.
C. The Mahanadi rises in the highlands of Chhattisgarh.
D. The Krishna rises from a spring near Mahabaleshwar.
(a) Only A, B and C (b) Only A, C and D
(c) A, B, C and D (d) Only B, C and D

Sol.162.(d) Only B, C and D. The Narmada River rises from the Amarkantak Plateau in Anuppur district in Madhya Pradesh. The Peninsular drainage system : It is older than the Himalayan river. These rivers are characterised by fixed course, absence of meanders and non-perennial flow of water. Most of the major rivers (except Narmada and Tapi which flow east to west) flow from west to east. The Chambal, the Sind, the Betwa, the Ken, the Son, originating in the northern part of the Peninsula belong to the Ganga river system.

Q.163. Consider the following statements regarding India's water treaties with its neighbours:

1. The Farakka Treaty (1996), signed with Bangladesh, relates to the sharing of Ganga waters.
2. The Mahakali Treaty (1996) was signed between India and Pakistan.

Which of the above statements is incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.163.(b) 2 only. Farakka water -sharing treaty - It was signed by then PM H. D. Deve Gowda (India) and PM Sheikh Hasina Wajed (Bangladesh). India's treaty with its Neighbours: Nepal Treaty - Mahakali treaty (1996), and Pakistan - Indus Waters Treaty (1960).

Q.164. Which of the following statements is NOT correct about River Ganga ?

- (a) River Ganga flows from the Himalayas all the way to the Bay of Bengal.
(b) River Ganga in India is more than 2500 km long and is the most populated river basin in the world.
(c) River Ganga and its river basin support lots of wonderful wildlife, particularly river dolphins, otters, freshwater turtles, and gharials.
(d) The water level of River Ganga never depends on monsoon and climatic condition of the Himalaya.

Sol.164.(d) The Ganga river depends on the rains brought by the southwesterly monsoon winds from July to October as well as on the flow from melting Himalayan snow. The Wildlife Institute of India conducted a survey revealing that 49% of the Ganga River has high biodiversity.

Q.165. In which district of Uttarakhand does the Ramganga river originate from the Doodhatoli ranges?

- (a) Almora (b) Champawat
(c) Chamoli (d) Pauri Garhwal

Sol.165.(d) Pauri Garhwal. The Ramganga is a smaller river that begins near Gairsain in the Garhwal mountains. It changes direction to the southwest after crossing the Shiwalik and enters the plains of Uttar Pradesh near Najibabad. It eventually joins the Ganga near Kannauj.

Q.166. Trishulganga is a stream of the river:

- (a) Godavari (b) Ghaghara
(c) Beas (d) Gandak

Sol.166.(d) Gandak. It comprises two streams, namely Kaligandak and Trishulganga. It rises in the Nepal Himalayas between the Dhaulagiri and Mount Everest.

Q.167. The drainage basin of the Godavari river is present in which of the following states of India ?

- (a) Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu
(b) Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra, Andhra

Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, and Odisha

- (c) Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu
(d) Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, and Odisha

Sol.167.(b) Godavari River (Dakshin Ganga) - Second longest river in India after the Ganges River. Origin - Trimbakeshwar near Nashik in Maharashtra. It has the largest Peninsular River system and falls into the Bay of Bengal.

Q.168. Identify the dam that is located in South India.

- (a) Gandhi Sagar dam (b) Tilaiya dam
(c) Mettur dam (d) Rihand dam

Sol.168.(c) Mettur dam: Built on Kaveri river and located at Mettur, Salem District (Tamil Nadu). Gandhi Sagar dam - Built on Chambal River and located in the Mandsaur district (Madhya Pradesh). Tilaiya dam - Constructed by Damodar Valley Corporation across Barakar River, in Koderma district (Jharkhand).

Q.169. Which east-flowing river basin covers the states of Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Orissa and has a drainage area of 39,033 sq km ?

- (a) Sarada (b) Baitarani
(c) Brahmani (d) Nagavali

Sol.169.(c) Brahmani river (second largest river in Odisha): It is formed by the confluence of the Shankh and Koel rivers, both join at Veda Vyasa near Rourkela (Odisha). Baitarani: It originates from Gonasika hills and drains into the Bay of Bengal. Nagavali (Langulya): It rises in the Eastern Ghats. Sarada: Originated from Kalapani in the Himalayas and flows along Nepal's western border with India and joins Ghaghra River.

Q.170. Which ports belong to the western coast of India ?

- (a) Kandla port, Mormugao port, Kochi port
(b) Kandla port, Mormugao port, Chennai port
(c) Kandla port, Mormugao port, Kolkata port
(d) Kandla port, Haldia port, Kochi port

Sol.170.(a) Ports in India: West Coast - Mumbai, Jawaharlal Nehru (Maharashtra), New Mangalore (Karnataka). East Coast - V. O. Chidambaram formerly Tuticorin, Ennore, Chennai Port (Tamil Nadu), Paradip (Orissa), Kolkata, Haldia (West

Bengal), Port Blair, Haddo (Andaman and Nicobar Islands).

Q.171. Dihang and Lohit are rivers in which of the following regions?

- (a) Jammu and Kashmir
- (b) Sikkim and Manipur
- (c) Arunachal Pradesh and Assam
- (d) Punjab and Himachal

Sol.171.(c) Arunachal Pradesh and Assam. Dihang River - The Brahmaputra rises in Tibet, where it is known as Tsangpo and crosses over into India in Arunachal Pradesh under the name of Dihang. Lohit River - It originates in eastern Tibet, in the Zayal Chu range and surges through Arunachal Pradesh for 200 km, before emptying into the Brahmaputra river in the plains of Assam.

Q.172. Consider the following statements regarding major ports of India:

1. Kandla Port (Deendayal Port), located in the Gulf of Kutch (Gujarat), was developed in the 1950s after Independence to ease pressure on the Mumbai Port.
2. Visakhapatnam Port was developed after Independence to replace Karachi Port, which went to Pakistan during partition.

Which of the above statements is incorrect?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.172.(b) 2 only. Visakhapatnam Port, also known as Vizag Port, is a major Indian port located on the east coast, in Andhra Pradesh. It's a natural harbor and one of India's 12 major ports, serving as a key gateway for cargo and trade, particularly for the eastern coast of India.

Q.173. Which river basin originates from the Western Ghats range of Karnataka state and has many tributaries such as the Noyyal, Kabini, Arkavathi and Amaravathi?

- (a) Sabarmati
- (b) Brahmani
- (c) Kaveri
- (d) Periyar

Sol.173.(c) Kaveri river basin falls in 3 States (Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala) and a Union Territory (Puducherry). It originates in the foothills of Western Ghats at Talakaveri. Tributaries - Shimsha, Hemavati, Bhavani, Lokapavani.

Q.174. The Jog Falls, one of the highest waterfalls in India is the cataract of which river?

- (a) Narmada
- (b) Tungabhadra
- (c) Sharavati
- (d) Cauvery

Sol.174.(c) Sharavati - It originates at a place called Ambutheertha in the Thirthahalli taluk (Karnataka). **Tungabhadra** River is formed by the confluence of the Tunga River and the Bhadra River. The two rivers originate in Mudigere Taluk of Chikmagalur District (Karnataka).

Q.175. With a stretch of about 724 km, which river is one of the most important rivers of peninsular India?

- (a) Tapi
- (b) Beas
- (c) Palar
- (d) Bhavani

Sol.175.(a) Tapi River - It flows through the states of Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Gujarat. The river originates in the Satpura Mountains in Madhya Pradesh and flows westwards before emptying into the Arabian Sea.

Q.176. Which river originates from the southern part of Devarayanadurga hill in Tumkur district, and flows for about 221 km before joining Kaveri?

- (a) Shimsha river
- (b) Girna river
- (c) Ghataprabha river
- (d) Waghur river

Sol.176.(a) Shimsha River (a tributary of the river Kaveri). Shimsha has a waterfall at Shimshapura in Malavalli Taluk (Mandya district, Karnataka). Devarayanadurga is a small hill station located in the Indian state of Karnataka. Girna River - It originates near Kem Peak in western ghats of Maharashtra and is a tributary of Tapi river. Ghataprabha River - Right bank tributary of the Krishna River. Waghur River - It originates near Ajanta in the Aurangabad district of Maharashtra.

Q.177. Which of the following lakes is the longest in India?

- (a) Vembanad lake
- (b) Kanjia lake
- (c) Ansupa lake
- (d) Wular lake

Sol.177.(a) Vembanad lake (Kerala) : Length 83.72 km and Width 14.48 km. It is connected to the Arabian Sea. The lake is known for its backwaters (a network of canals and waterways). Kanjia Lake - Odisha. Ansupa Lake - Odisha.

Q.178. Which river from the following flows through a rift valley?

- (a) Tapi
- (b) Brahmaputra
- (c) Sabarmati
- (d) Ganga

Sol.178.(a) Tapi. Rift valley : It is a lowland region that forms where Earth's tectonic plates move apart. **Famous rift valleys** : Great Rift Valley (East Africa), East Rift Valley or Hualien - Taitung (Taiwan), Baikal Rift Valley (Southern Siberia).

Q.179. Consider the following

statements regarding the Beas River:

1. The Beas River, a tributary of the Indus, originates near the Rohtang Pass at an altitude of about 4,000 meters.
2. Its ancient name was Vipasha.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.179.(c) Both 1 and 2. Tributaries of the Beas river : Parbati, Banganga, Tirthan, Suketi, Sainj, Gaj, Chakki and Uhaul.

Q.180. Which is the biggest tributary of the upper Brahmaputra that originates in the Tibetan Himalayas and winds its way into India through Arunachal Pradesh?

- (a) Subansir
- (b) Yerla
- (c) Musi
- (d) Aner

Sol.180.(a) Subansiri. Tributaries of Brahmaputra River: Ronganadi, Dikrong, Buroi, Borgong, Jiabharali, Dhansiri (North), Puthimari, Manas, Beki, Sonkosh are the main tributaries on the North while the Noadehing, Buridehing, Desang, Dikhow, Bhogdoi, Dhansiri (South), Kopilli, Kulsi, Krishnai, Dhdhnoi, Jinjiran are the main tributaries on the South.

Q.181. Which of the following rivers originates near Sihawa in Raipur district of Chhattisgarh, flows through Odisha, and eventually empties into the Bay of Bengal?

- (a) Mahanadi
- (b) Krishna
- (c) Godavari
- (d) Cauvery

Sol.181.(a) Mahanadi - The largest river of Odisha state. Krishna River originates near Mahabaleshwar in the Satara district of Maharashtra. It flows through Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, and Andhra Pradesh before emptying into the Bay of Bengal.

Q.182. Assertion (A): Rajasthan is not a part of the Tapi River Basin.

Reason (R): The Tapi River originates in the Satpura range (Betul district, Madhya Pradesh) and flows westward through Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Gujarat before draining into the Arabian Sea.

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.182.(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Tapi River - A river in central India that flows

westwards before draining into the Arabian Sea. Origin - In Satpura range in the Gawilgarh hills of the northern part of the Deccan Plateau (In Betul district, Madhya Pradesh). The Tapi river is known as the 'Gateway of International trade' as it conducts much international trade.

Q.183. Which of the following is not a freshwater lake in India?

- (a) Pulicat (b) Loktak
(c) Bhimtal (d) Nainital

Sol.183.(a) Pulicat Lake (Andhra Pradesh) is the second largest brackish water lagoon in India, (after Chilika Lake, Odisha).

Q.184. Which state ranks first with a total length of 31.2 thousand km of rivers and canals, which is about 17% of the total length of rivers and canals in the country?

- (a) Kerala (b) West Bengal
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.184.(c) Uttar Pradesh - Fourth largest state according to area and 1st state in population. Longest canal in India - Indira Gandhi Canal, **Longest river** - Ganga River (2525 km), Origin - Gangotri. Longest canal of Uttar Pradesh - Sharda Canal.

Q.185. Tila, Seti and Beri are the tributaries of :

- (a) Tamsa (b) Ghaghara
(c) Mahi (d) Sabarmati

Sol.185.(b) Ghaghara. It originates in the glaciers of Mapchachungo and a major left - bank tributary of the Ganges River. Its Tributaries: The left bank tributaries - Bheri, Sarju, Kuwana, Rapti, Chhoti Gandak and the right bank tributaries - Seti, Dahawar, Sarda, Budhi Ganga.

Q.186. What is the name of the branch of river Godavari that joins the Bay of Bengal flowing through the Yanam enclave of the union territory of Puducherry?

- (a) Kapila (b) Indravati
(c) Gautami (d) Bhavani

Sol.186.(c) Gautami. The Godavari basin extends over states of Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Odisha in addition to smaller parts in Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka and Union territory of Puducherry. **Projects** - Polavaram Irrigation Project, Kaleshwaram, Sadarmat Anicut, Inchampalli, Sriram Sagar.

Q.187. Consider the following statements regarding types of waterfalls:

1. A cataract is a waterfall with an enormous volume of water.
2. In a cascade waterfall, water descends vertically, losing all contact with the bedrock.
3. In a horsetail waterfall, water descends in distinctly separate flows.
4. In a punchbowl waterfall, water maintains continuous contact with the bedrock.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Sol.187.(a) 1 only. Types of Waterfalls: Horsetail - Descending water maintains some contact with bedrock. Plunge - Water descends vertically, losing contact with the bedrock surface. Block - Water descends from a relatively wide stream or river. Multi-step - A series of waterfalls one after another of roughly the same size each with its own sunken plunge pool. Segmented - Distinctly separate flows of water form as it descends. Cascade - Water descends a series of rock steps. Punchbowl - Water descends in a constricted form and then spreads out in a wider pool.

Q.188. Which of the following rivers does NOT flow in Kerala State?

- (a) Bharathapuzha (b) Periyar
(c) Pamba (d) Penner

Sol.188.(d) Penner - It rises in Nandi Hills in Chikballapur District of Karnataka and falls into the Bay of Bengal. **Bharathapuzha (Ponnani)** river is Kerala's second longest West Flowing River, draining into the Arabian Sea.

Q.189. A long, winding ridge of stratified sand and gravel is known as:

- (a) whorl (b) esker (c) lop (d) arch

Sol.189.(b) Esker. These are ridges made of sands and gravels, deposited by glacial meltwater flowing through tunnels within and underneath glaciers, or through meltwater channels on top of glaciers. Other depositional landforms: **Drumlins** are smooth oval shaped ridge-like features composed mainly of glacial till with some masses of gravel and sand.

Q.190. Consider the following statements regarding dams in India:

1. Almatti Dam of Karnataka is built over the Krishna River.
2. Mullaperiyar Dam of Kerala is built over the Kaveri River.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.190.(a) Only 1. Other dams on Krishna river - Achakdani (Maharashtra), Achler (Maharashtra). Mullaperiyar is on the Periyar River. River (Dams) : Kaveri {Alalur (Karnataka), Amaravathi, (Tamil Nadu)}.

Q.191. Which of the following statements is correct regarding large dams?

- I. They have social problems because they displace a large number of peasants and tribals without adequate compensation or rehabilitation.
- II. They have Environmental problems because they contribute enormously to deforestation and the loss of biological diversity.

- (a) Only I (b) Both I and II
(c) Only II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.191.(b) Both I and II. Advantages of Dams - Irrigation, tourist attraction, flood control, hydro power generation, etc. **Disadvantages of dams** - High construction cost, unbalanced sedimentation, deforestation, ecological imbalance, endangered aquatic life etc.

Q.192. Consider the following statements regarding Indian rivers:

1. The Banas River originates from the Khamnor Hills of the Aravalli Range in Rajasthan and is a tributary of the Chambal River.
2. The Tapi River originates from the Satpura Range in Rajasthan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.192.(a) Only 1. Tapi originates from Satpura ranges in Madhya Pradesh. The **Banas** river originates from the Khamnor hills of the Aravali range. It is a tributary of the Chambal River. It is also known as "Van ki Asha". Length of Banas: 512 km. Tributaries: Kothari, Dai, Dheel, Menali etc.

Q.193. Jabalpur is located on the banks of which of the following rivers?

- (a) Ganga (b) Godavari
(c) Chambal (d) Narmada

Sol.193.(d) Narmada (Reva River, 1312 km): India's 5th longest and largest west-flowing river, running through a rift valley between the Vindhya and Satpura ranges.

Q.194. Which of the following is not an important river of Malwa plateau?

- (a) Chambal river (b) Mahanadi river
(c) Ken river (d) Betwa river

Sol.194.(b) Mahanadi. Rivers of Malwa plateau - Mahi River, Ken river, Shipra River, Chambal River, Betwa River.

Q.195. Consider the following statements regarding the Ganga-Brahmaputra basin:

1. The region of the Ganga-Brahmaputra basin lies between 10°N to 30°N latitudes.
2. The Brahmaputra originates from Mount Kailash peak in Nepal.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.195.(b) Only 2. The Brahmaputra originates in the north of the Himalayas near Mansarovar Lake in the Purang district of Tibet (Known as Yarlung Tsangpo in Tibet), (other names : Siang/Dihang River) India, and Bangladesh (Jamuna River). The Delta formed by Ganga Brahmaputra is Sunderban Delta (largest delta in the world).

Q.196. Kadana Dam of Gujarat is built over which of the following rivers?

- (a) Mahi (b) Manjira
(c) Tapti (d) Sabarmati

Sol.196.(a) Mahi River. Indian Rivers and Dams: Sabarmati River - Dharoi Dam (Gujarat). Tapti River - Hatnur Dam (Maharashtra), Ukai Dam (Gujarat), Girna Dam (Maharashtra), Dahigam Weir (Maharashtra). Krishna River - Nagarjuna sagar Dam (Telangana). Manjira River - Singur Dam and Nizam Sagar dam (Telangana). Banas River - Bisalpur Dam (Rajasthan).

Q.197. Which of the following rivers forms the Dhuandhar falls?

- (a) Tapi (b) Narmada
(c) Godavari (d) Mahanadi

Sol.197.(b) Narmada. The Dhuandhar Falls is located in the Jabalpur district of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.198. Which among the following lakes connects the twin cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad?

- (a) Kanwar (b) Salim Ali
(c) Hussain Sagar (d) Periyar

Sol.198.(c) Hussain Sagar: A heart - shaped lake in Hyderabad, Telangana, built by Ibrahim Quli Qutb Shah; Fed by

the River Musi. Salim Ali lake - Aurangabad, Kanwar lake - Bihar, Periyar lake - Kerala.

Q.199. In which state of India is Tawa dam located?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Haryana
(c) Rajasthan (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.199.(d) Madhya Pradesh - Indra Sagar dam, largest in state (Narmada river), Gandhisagar Dam (Chambal River), Bargi Dam (Narmada River). Uttar Pradesh - Rihand dam also known as Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar. Haryana - Kaushalya Dam (Yamuna River), Anangpur Dam (Hakra River). Gujarat - Sardar Sarovar Dam (Narmada River). Rajasthan - Rana Pratap Sagar (Chambal river).

Q.200. Consider the following arrangements of rivers from North to South in India:

1. Indus → Chenab → Ravi → Beas → Satluj
2. Satluj → Ravi → Indus → Chenab → Beas
3. Indus → Ravi → Beas → Chenab → Satluj
4. Satluj → Indus → Chenab → Ravi → Beas

Which of the above arrangements is correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2 (c) Only 3 (d) Only 4

Sol.200.(a) Only 1. Indus (Sindhu) river - Source (Lake Manasarovar), Satluj (Lake Rakshastal in Tibet), Ravi (Multhan tehsil of Kangra district of Himachal Pradesh), Chenab (Baralacha Pass in Himachal Pradesh) etc.

Q.201. Which state in India is the source of river Ghaggar?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand
(c) Haryana (d) Himachal Pradesh

Sol.201.(d) Himachal Pradesh (Shivalik hills). It flows through Punjab, Haryana and then into Rajasthan. It flows only during the monsoon season. It is known as Hakra river in Pakistan. The main tributaries of the Ghaggar are the Kaushalya river, Markanda, Sarsuti, Tangri and Chautang.

Q.202. India and Sri Lanka are joined by a group of islets forming _____.

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi Setu
(b) Sisseri River Bridge
(c) Bhupen Hazarika Bridge
(d) Adam's Bridge

Sol.202.(d) Adam's Bridge (Rama Setu), is a chain of limestone shoals, between

Pamban Island (Rameswaram Island), Tamil Nadu, India, and Mannar Island, Sri Lanka. Mahatma Gandhi Setu (Bihar), Sisseri River Bridge (Arunachal Pradesh), Bhupen Hazarika bridge (Connects Assam and Arunachal Pradesh).

Q.203. Pushkar lake is situated in which district of Rajasthan?

- (a) Jaipur (b) Ajmer (c) Bikaner (d) Alwar

Sol.203.(b) Ajmer. Freshwater Lakes in Rajasthan: Ajmer - Ana Sagar Lake, Lake Foy Sagar; Alwar - Siliserh Lake; Banswara - Anand Sagar Lake and Dailab Lake; Bundi - Jait Sagar Lake, Kanak Sagar Lake, and Nawar Sagar Lake; Dungarpur - Gaib Sagar Lake; Jaisalmer - Gadsisar Lake; Jodhpur - Balsamand Lake, Kailana Lake; Kota - Kishore Sagar Lake; Rajsamand - Rajsamand Lake; Udaipur - Doodh Talai, Fateh Sagar Lake, Jaisamand Lake, Udai Sagar Lake, and Pichola Lake.

Q.204. What is the meaning of the term Moraine?

- (a) Melting of accumulated snow
(b) Material transported and deposited by glacier
(c) Valley with vertical sides and wide floor
(d) The higher level tributary

Sol.204.(b) A moraine is material left behind by a moving glacier. This material is usually soil and rock. Moraines are divided into four main categories: lateral moraines, medial moraines, supraglacial moraines, and terminal moraines.

Q.205. Which of the following ports is known as 'Diamond Harbour'?

- (a) Port Blair (b) Kochi
(c) Kolkata (d) Mangalore

Sol.205.(c) Kolkata Port (Haldia seaport) is the only riverine Major Port situated on the Hugli river in West Bengal. Cochin Port or Kochi port lies on two islands in the Vembanadu Lake; Willingdon Island and Vallarpadam and is important for the export of spices and salt.

Q.206. Consider the following statements about lakes of India:

Statement I: Wular Lake in Jammu & Kashmir, one of Asia's largest freshwater lakes, is of tectonic origin and is fed by the Jhelum River.

Statement II: Dal Lake in Jammu & Kashmir is also of tectonic origin. Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only II (b) Both I and II
(c) Only I (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.206.(c) Only I. Wular Lake, located in Jammu and Kashmir, is South Asia's largest freshwater lake. Formed by tectonic activity, it is fed by the Jhelum River and Madhumati stream. In 1990, it was designated a Ramsar Wetland of International Importance. Dal Lake, located in Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir's summer capital, is an urban lake and the union territory's second largest. It is popularly known as the "Lake of Flowers," "Jewel in the Crown of Kashmir," or "Srinagar's Jewel."

Q.207. Tsomgo Lake is a glacial lake located in which of the following states?

- (a) Meghalaya (b) Punjab
(c) Sikkim (d) Gujarat

Sol.207.(c) Sikkim. Tsongmo Lake (Changu Lake) remains frozen during the winter season. It is revered as a holy lake by the people of Sikkim.

Q.208. The Ganga plain extends between two rivers?

- (a) Yamuna and Teesta
(b) Ghaggar and Teesta
(c) Ghaggar and Bhagirathi
(d) Ganga and Teesta

Sol.208.(b) Ghaggar and Teesta. Six Physiographic Divisions of India - 1. The Himalayan Mountains 2. The Northern Plains 3. The Peninsular Plateau 4. The Indian Desert 5. The Coastal Plains 6. The Islands. The Western part of the Northern Plain is referred to as the Punjab Plains. Brahmaputra plain lies in the state of Assam.

Q.209. Which river basin covers an area of $65,145 \text{ km}^2$, of which about 80% lies in Maharashtra?

- (a) Krishna (b) Narmada
(c) Godavari (d) Tapi

Sol.209.(d) Tapi Basin is situated in the northern part of the Deccan Plateau. Nearly 80% of the basin lies in the State of Maharashtra.

Q.210. Which state does the Brahmaputra river enter when it takes a U turn at Namcha Barwa?

- (a) Mizoram (b) Assam
(c) Nagaland (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Sol.210.(d) Arunachal Pradesh. The catchment area of the Brahmaputra (Tsangpo) river falls in four countries (Tibet, Bhutan, India, and Bangladesh).

Q.211. Which river basin covers an area of $8,60,000 \text{ km}^2$ and is spread across 11 Indian states?

- (a) Mahanadi basin (b) Ganga basin
(c) Indus basin (d) Brahmaputra basin

Sol.211.(b) Ganga Basin - 11 States. Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Rajasthan, West Bengal, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh and Delhi. **Indus Basin** - Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan and Jammu & Kashmir. **Brahmaputra Basin** - Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, West Bengal, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Sikkim.

Q.212. Which river rises near Mhow in the Malwa plateau of Madhya Pradesh?

- (a) Chambal (b) Mahi
(c) Varuna (d) Betwa

Sol.212.(a) Chambal. Varuna River (Tributary of Ganga River originates in Phulpur in the Prayagraj district). **Betwa River** (originates from Hoshangabad, Vindhya Range, Madhya Pradesh).

Q.213. In ancient times, which river was also known as 'Pooni' in Tamil which is the fourth largest river flowing in the southeast direction through the states of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu?

- (a) Kaveri River (b) Satluj River
(c) Ravi River (d) Tapi River

Sol.213.(a) Kaveri River. It is a sacred river in southern India. It rises on Brahmagiri Hill of the Western Ghats in southwestern Karnataka state and drains into the Bay of Bengal through Pondicherry.

Q.214. The Hundru Fall lies along the course of which of the following rivers?

- (a) Damodar (b) Sone
(c) Mahanadi (d) Subarnarekha

Sol.214.(d) Subarnarekha. It is located in Ranchi District. Rajrappa waterfalls occur at the confluence of River Bhairavi and river Damodar.

Q.215. River Ken is one of the major rivers of the Bundelkhand region of central India and flows through two states, Madhya Pradesh and _____.

- (a) Gujarat (b) Maharashtra
(c) Rajasthan (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.215.(d) Uttar Pradesh. River Ken It is a tributary of the Yamuna. **The important tributaries of Ken** - Alona, Bearma, Sonar, Mirhasan, Shyamari, Banne, Kutri, Urmil, Kail and Chandrawal.

Q.216. Which of the following rivers form Kunchikal waterfall in Karnataka?

- (a) Mandavi (b) Varahi
(c) Urmodi (d) Kabini

Sol.216.(b) Varahi. Kunchikal Falls is located in Nidagodu village near Masthikatte in Shimoga district of state Karnataka. It cascades down rocky boulders and the total height of fall is 455 meters.

Q.217. Consider the following statements regarding the Indus River:

Statement I: The Indus was called Vitasta by the Iranians and Greeks about 2500 years ago.

Statement II: The term Vipasa is the Sanskrit origin of the word "Hindus".

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.217.(d) Neither I nor II. The river Indus was called Hindos by the Iranians and the Greeks about 2500 years ago. The word is derived from the Sanskrit word "Sindhu", which means "river".

Q.218. On which of the following rivers is Pakistan constructing a dam named Diamer Basha' dam?

- (a) Indus (b) Jhelum (c) Sutlej (d) Chenab

Sol.218.(a) Indus. It is located between Kohistan district in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Diamer district in Gilgit Baltistan, Pakistan administered Kashmir.

Q.219. Which of the following waterfalls is in the state of Goa?

- (a) Dudhsagar (b) Duduma
(c) Gokak (d) Shivasamudram

Sol.219.(a) Dudhsagar Falls is a four-tiered waterfall on the Mandovi River. Duduma Falls lies on the border of Koraput (Odisha) and Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh). Gokak Falls is on the Ghataprabha River in Belagavi, Karnataka. Shivasamudram Falls is located in Chamarajanagar and Mandya districts, Karnataka.

Q.220. Which of the following is the largest west flowing river in Rajasthan?

- (a) Luni (b) Chambal
(c) Banganga (d) Banas

Sol.220.(a) Luni River originates in the Pushkar valley, Aravalli Range, flows through the Thar Desert, and ends in the Rann of Kutch, Gujarat.

Q.221. Which of the following states has the largest catchment area of Godavari Basin?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Maharashtra
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Telangana

Sol.221.(b) Maharashtra. Banganga,

Kadva, Shivana, Purna, Kadam, Pranahita, Indravati, Taliperu, Sabari, Nasardi, Pravara, Sindphana, Manjira, Manair, Kinnerasani are tributaries of Godavari river.

Q.222. Consider the following statements regarding the Muhuri River:

Statement I: The Muhuri River is a transnational river between India and Bangladesh.

Statement II: The Muhuri River originates in Tripura and later merges with the Feni River before draining into the Bay of Bengal.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.222.(c) Both I and II.

Q.223. In which Indian state is the 'Bhushi Lake' located?

- (a) Punjab (b) Rajasthan
(c) Gujarat (d) Maharashtra

Sol.223.(d) Maharashtra. Popular Lakes in Maharashtra - Upvan Lake, Vihar Lake, Powai Lake, Rankala Lake, Panshet Lake, Ganesh Lake, Venna Lake, Lonar Lake.

Q.224. Which Indian state is the source of the rivers Brahmani, Kharkai and Subarnarekha?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Bihar
(c) Jharkhand (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.224.(c) Jharkhand. Other rivers in Jharkhand - Sone, Barakar, Damodar, Ajay, South Koel, Shankh, and North Koel river.

Q.225. Gurdwara Patalpuri Sahib is located on the bank of river ____.

- (a) Yamuna (b) Ganga (c) Sutlej (d) Beas

Sol.225.(c) Sutlej. Gurdwara Patalpuri Sahib located in Rupnagar district of Punjab. Guru Hargobind Ji in 1644 as well as Guru Har Rai Ji in 1661 were cremated here.

Q.226. Which of the following is a tributary of the river Brahmaputra that flows through Bhutan?

- (a) Wang Chhu River (b) Sittaung River
(c) Ayeyarwady River (d) Chindwin River

Sol.226.(a) Wang Chhu River. Bhutan has four major rivers, named Drangme Chhu, Mo Chhu, Wang Chhu and Torsa Chhu. The Brahmaputra is one of the largest rivers of the Indian Subcontinent.

Q.227. In which of the following states is Anchar Lake located?

- (a) Jammu and Kashmir (b) Assam
(c) Bihar (d) Meghalaya

Sol.227.(a) Jammu and Kashmir. It is located near the Soura area in the city of Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir. The lake is connected with the famous Dal Lake.

Q.228. Yerla, Warna and Dindi are tributaries of the _____ river system.

- (a) Brahmaputra (b) Godavari
(c) Kaveri (d) Krishna

Sol.228.(d) Krishna.

Q.229. Consider the following statements regarding hydrological units:

Statement I: A watershed is a natural geo-hydrological unit of land that collects water and drains it through a common point by a system of streams.

Statement II: Watersheds are classified based on their area — Macro (>50,000 ha), Sub-watershed (10,000–50,000 ha), Milli (1,000–10,000 ha), Micro (100–1,000 ha), and Mini (1–100 ha).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.229.(c) Both I and II. A watershed, also known as a drainage basin or catchment area, is an area of land where all the surface water from rain, snowmelt, etc., converges and drains into a single point, such as a river, lake, or other body of water.

Q.230. A channel of a canal where water flows under the influence of gravity is called ____.

- (a) lift channel (b) command area
(c) warabandi system (d) flow channel

Sol.230.(d) flow channel. It is the flow of water induced by the effect of gravity. The surface of the flowing liquid is at atmospheric pressure and free to air. The example of open channel flow includes flow in canal, river, etc.

Q.231. On which river is Peacock Island located?

- (a) Mahanadi (b) Ganga
(c) Brahmaputra (d) Yamuna

Sol.231.(c) Brahmaputra. Peacock Island or Umananda Island is the smallest inhabited river island in the middle of river Brahmaputra, flowing through the city of Guwahati. Its name derives from Assamese Uma. It is also known as Bhasmachal.

Q.232. Which of the following is Uttarakhand's first gravity dam?

- (a) Tehri dam (b) Baigul dam
(c) Dhora dam (d) Song dam

Sol.232.(d) Song dam which is to be built on the foothills of Mussoorie on the Song river to meet the water shortage of the state during the summers.

Q.233. Consider the following statements about the rivers of Nepal:

Statement I: The Karnali River, also called Ghaghara, originates on the Tibetan Plateau near Lake Manasarovar.

Statement II: The Seti River is the longest river of Nepal.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.233.(b) Only II. The Karnali River is the longest river of Nepal. The river cuts through the Himalayas in Nepal and eventually joins the Sharda River at Brahmaghat in India, becoming the Ghaghara River

Q.234. Which type of dam is a temporary dam constructed to exclude water from the specific area?

- (a) Coffor (b) Impounding
(c) Detention (d) Debris

Sol.234.(a) coffer. It is built to permit damming, diversion, or dewatering and construction of a permanent structure in a dry area. A **detention dam** is built to catch surface runoff and stream water flow to regulate the water flow in areas below the dam. Detention dams are commonly used to reduce the damage caused by flooding or to manage the flow rate through a channel.

Q.235. Suryadhar lake is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Himachal Pradesh
(b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Uttarakhand
(d) Meghalaya

Sol.235.(c) Uttarakhand. Famous Lakes in Uttarakhand - Auli Artificial Lake, Baraadsar Lake, Bedni Kund, Bhalu Dam, Bhimtal Lake, Bhulla Tal, Bisurital, Brahmatal Trek etc.

Q.236. In which of the following states is the Sirki Waterfall located?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Himachal Pradesh (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.236.(a) Arunachal Pradesh. Other Waterfalls - The Nuranang Waterfall, the Bap Teng Kang Waterfall.

Q.237. Rain is liquid ____.

- (a) precipitation (b) condensation
(c) decantation (d) sedimentation

Sol.237.(a) Precipitation is any product of the condensation of atmospheric water vapor that falls under gravitational pull from clouds. The main forms of precipitation include drizzling, rain, sleet, snow, ice pellets, graupel and hail.

Q.238. Which of the following dams is located in Jharkhand?

- (a) Koyna (b) Maithon
(c) Mettur (d) Sardar Sarovar

Sol.238.(b) Maithon dam is on the river Barakar in the district Dhanbad of Jharkhand. It has an underground power station, the first of its own kind in the whole of SouthEast Asia.

Q.239. Assertion (A): The mouth of the Indus River lies to the north of the Tropic of Cancer.

Reason (R): The rivers Mahanadi, Krishna, and Godavari lie to the south of the Tropic of Cancer.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.239.(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. The Tropic of Cancer is an imaginary line on the Earth's surface, located at approximately 23.5 degrees North latitude. In India, the Tropic of Cancer passes through eight states: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, and Mizoram

Q.240. What kind of depositional landforms are formed when streams flowing from higher levels break into foot slope plains of low gradient?

- (a) Point bars (b) Flood plains
(c) Alluvial fans (d) Natural levees

Sol.240.(c) Alluvial fans. A point bar is a depositional feature made of alluvium that accumulates on the inside bend of streams and rivers below the slip-off slope. An alluvial fan is a triangle-shaped deposit of gravel, sand, and even smaller pieces of sediment, such as silt

Q.241. Where is the Baglihar Dam located?

- (a) Gujarat
(b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Jammu & Kashmir
(d) Telangana

Sol.241.(c) Jammu and Kashmir. Baglihar dam is a run-of-the-river power project on the Chenab river. Important Dams - Kadana Dam (Gujarat), Chamara Dam (Himachal Pradesh), Singur Dam (Telangana).

World Drainage System

Q.242. Which of the following has the highest salinity?

- (a) Great salt lake (b) Lake Van
(c) Red sea (d) Dead sea

Sol.242.(b) Lake Van. Being the largest lake in Turkey, it has the highest salinity (330%). As a saline soda lake fed by small streams, it is one of the few endorheic lakes over 3,000 square kilometers. High salinity usually prevents it from freezing, despite high altitude and winter temperatures below 0 °C (32 °F).

Q.243. Consider the following statements about river landforms:

1. A river in its middle course is capable of forming meanders due to both erosion and deposition.
2. Landforms such as V-shaped valleys and waterfalls are typically associated with the upper course of a river.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.243.(c) Both 1 and 2. A meander is a U-shaped bend in a river formed by erosion and deposition. A V-shaped valley is created by river erosion. A waterfall is where water drops vertically over a ledge. A delta forms at a river's mouth where it meets the sea or ocean.

Q.244. As of 2021, which is the world's largest drainage basin with an area of about 70,00,000 km² ?

- (a) Congo basin (b) Amur basin
(c) Amazon basin (d) Nile basin

Sol.244.(c) Amazon basin. The Amazon Basin, formed by numerous tributaries, drains parts of Brazil, Peru, Bolivia, Ecuador, Colombia, and a small section of Venezuela. It lies directly on the equator and experiences a hot, humid climate year-round, with both day and night feeling equally warm and sticky. High rainfall, high temperature, and high humidity are the features of the basin.

Q.245. Which of the following is the largest artificial lake of Asia?

- (a) Naini Lake (b) Bhopal Lake
(c) Dal Lake (d) Chilika Lake

Sol.245.(b) Bhopal Lake, also known as Bhojtal, was created in the 11th century by King Bhoja of the Paramara dynasty. It is situated in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, and is constructed on Kolans river. Lakes in Madhya Pradesh: Sangram Sagar, Shahpura lake. Dal Lake - It is often referred to as Srinagar's Jewel, is a freshwater lake located in Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir.

Q.246. Which river originates south of the equator and flows north through north-eastern Africa to drain into the Mediterranean Sea?

- (a) Lena River (b) Nile River
(c) Amazon River (d) Congo River

Sol.246.(b) Nile River. Its length is about 6,695 kilometers (4,160 miles). The Nile basin is huge and includes parts of Tanzania, Burundi, Rwanda, Congo (Kinshasa), Kenya. Other important rivers of the world : Lena River : Origin - Baikal range, Drains - Laptev Sea. Amazon River : Origin - Andes Mountains, Drains - Atlantic Ocean. Congo River (cross the equator twice) : Origin - Africa Rift, Drains - Atlantic Ocean.

Q.247. Where are Huka Falls located ?

- (a) Germany (b) Spain
(c) New Zealand (d) Australia

Sol.247.(c) New Zealand. Huka Falls is on the Waikato River. Major Waterfalls: New Zealand - Kitekite Falls, Dawson Falls, Taranaki Falls, Owaharoa Falls. Germany - Triberger Waterfall, Todtnau falls. Spa. Australia - Wallaman Falls, Millaain - Salto del Nervion, Fervenza do Ezaro Millaa falls, Liffey Falls, Russell Falls. Angel Falls in Venezuela is the highest waterfall in the world.

Q.248. Consider the following statements about lakes:

1. Red Lake is located in the United Kingdom.
2. Chilka Lake, Sambhar Lake, Loktak Lake and Wular Lake are examples of important lakes of India.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.248.(a) 1 only. Red Lake is located in the USA. Country and Lakes: USA - Abert, Ontario, Erie, Huron, Michigan. India - Chilka Lake, Sambhar Salt Lake, Loktak Lake, Wular Lake. Canada - Aberdeen Lake, Lake Abitibi. Brazil - Agua Vermelha. Australia - Lake Alexandrina, Lake Amadeus. Scotland - Loch Lomond.

Q.249. Which of the following is the highest navigable lake in the world?

- (a) Huron (b) Titicaca
(c) Superior (d) Como

Sol.249.(b) Titicaca - Situated 3810 m above sea level and is situated between Peru to the west and Bolivia to the east, South America.

Q.250. What is the total number of rivers including tributaries in Bangladesh?

- (a) About 1000 (b) About 800
(c) About 700 (d) About 500

Sol.250.(c) About 700. Bangladesh : It has four major river systems – The Brahmaputra - Jamuna, the Ganges - Padma, the Surma - Meghna and the Chittagong region river system. **Chittagong** is the largest and most important seaport in Bangladesh.

Q.251. Which sea, located in the north-western part of the Indian Ocean, joins the Gulf of Oman in the north-west and the Gulf of Aden in the south-west and covers a total area of 1,491,000 square miles?

- (a) Arabian Sea (b) Mediterranean Sea
(c) Caribbean Sea (d) Coral Sea

Sol.251.(a) Arabian Sea forms part of the sea route between Europe and India. Name of Straits and Joining Seas - Strait of Gibraltar (Atlantic Ocean with the Mediterranean Sea), Sunda Strait (Java Sea and Indian Ocean), Messina Strait (island of Sicily and the southern tip of mainland Italy), Bab-el-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea and Gulf of Aden), North Channel (Irish Sea and Atlantic Ocean).

Q.252. Consider the following statements regarding important straits and channels:

1. The Grand Channel lies between Great Nicobar Island and Indonesia's Sumatra Island.
2. The Coco Strait lies between Sumatra and Java islands.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.252.(b) 2 only. The Coco Strait is between the North Andaman islands and the Coco Islands of Myanmar. Sumatra and Java are separated by the Sunda Strait.

Q.253. The city of _____ is located at the mouth of the Yangtze River.

- (a) Shanghai (b) Beijing
(c) Lhasa (d) Guangzhou

Sol.253.(a) Shanghai. Yangtze river (approximately 6300 km) is the longest river of both China and Asia. It rises in the mountains of Qinghai province of China.

Q.254. Which is the correct sequence of lakes according to depth (from maximum to minimum) ?

- (a) Caspian Sea > Tanganyika > Vostok > Baikal
(b) Baikal > Caspian Sea > Tanganyika > Vostok
(c) Baikal > Tanganyika > Caspian Sea > Vostok
(d) Caspian Sea > Baikal > Tanganyika > Vostok

Sol.254.(c) Baikal (world's deepest lake): Depth - 5,387 ft, Location - Russia. Tanganyika: Depth - 4,823 ft, Location - Central Africa on the borders of Tanzania, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Zambia and Burundi. Caspian Sea: Depth - 3,363 ft, Location - Kazakhstan, Turkmenistan, Iran, Azerbaijan, and Russia. Vostok: Depth - about 3000 ft, Location - Antarctica.

Minerals and Energy Resources in India

Q.255. Name the state which is the largest producer of lignite coal ?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Gujarat
(c) Rajasthan (d) Tamil Nadu

Sol.255.(d) Tamil Nadu. Coal is a vital mineral in India, mainly used for thermal power generation and iron smelting. It is found in Gondwana and Tertiary deposits, with about 80% being non-coking bituminous coal. Major Gondwana coalfields lie in the Damodar Valley, with Jharia being the largest and Raniganj the second. Important coal mining centres include Singrauli, Korba, Talcher, Chanda-Wardha, and Singareni, while Tertiary coal is found in Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, and Nagaland. Lignite deposits occur in Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Gujarat, and Jammu & Kashmir.

Q.256. Name the major coal producing region located in Telangana state?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Singareni Coalfield
(b) Raniganj Coalfield
(c) Talcher Coalfield
(d) Jharia Coalfield

Sol.256.(a) Singareni Coalfield. These coal reserves are located in the Pranhita

-Godavari Valley and are managed by The Singareni Collieries Company Limited (SCCL), a government-owned coal mining company. This coalfield is a crucial source of coal for the power plants and other industries in Southern India. Major coalfields in India: Raniganj Coalfield (West Bengal), Talcher Coalfield (Odisha), Jharia (Jharkhand), Korba (Chhattisgarh).

Q.257. Which of the following river valleys is NOT known for coal deposits in India ?

- (a) Mahanadi (b) Satluj
(c) Godavari (d) Son

Sol.257.(b) Satluj. The Satluj originates in the 'Raksas tal' near Mansarovar at an altitude of 4,555 m in Tibet where it is known as Langchen Khambab. Satluj, is the longest of the five rivers that flow through the historic crossroads region of Punjab in northern India and Pakistan. The Damodar Valley is particularly rich in coal and is known as the "Ruhr of India" because of its similarities to the coal-rich Ruhr region of Germany.

Q.258. Match the following mineral deposits with their respective states:

List – I (Mineral Deposits/Regions)	List – II (States)
(a) Panchpatmali (Bauxite)	1. Madhya Pradesh
(b) Balaghat (Manganese)	2. Odisha
(c) Khetri (Copper)	3. Andhra Pradesh
(d) Nellore Belt (Mica)	4. Rajasthan

- (a) a-2, b-1, c-4, d-3 (b) a-2, b-3, c-4, d-1
(c) a-3, b-4, c-1, d-2 (d) a-4, b-1, c-2, d-3

Sol.258.(A) a-2, b-1, c-4, d-3. Panchpatmali deposits in Koraput district are the most important bauxite deposits in the state. Important Mines deposit in India: Balaghat mines (Madhya Pradesh), Khetri mines (Rajasthan), Maikal hills (Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh), Nellore mica belt (Andhra Pradesh), Kudremukh mines (Karnataka).

Q.259. Which of the following is a precious mineral?

- (a) Hematite (b) Mica
(c) Bauxite (d) Platinum

Sol.259.(d) Platinum. It is used in hard disk drives, thermocouples, optical fibers, LCDs, turbine blades, and spark plugs. Hematite: A common iron ore used in iron production. Platinum-based drugs cisplatin, carboplatin, and oxaliplatin are

widely used for chemotherapeutic eradication of cancer. Mica: A group of silicate minerals used in various industrial applications, including electronics and construction. Bauxite: The primary ore of aluminum.

Q.260. Which type of coal is found in Damodar valley?

- (a) Anthracite (b) Lignite
(c) Bituminous (d) Peat

Sol.260.(c) Bituminous is a type of coal with a carbon content ranging from 60% to 80% and a relatively low moisture content, making it highly efficient for energy production. It has a high calorific value. The Damodar Valley, located in the states of Jharkhand and West Bengal in eastern India, is renowned for its extensive bituminous coal deposits. This region is part of the Jharia and Raniganj coalfields, which are significant contributors to India's coal production.

Q.261. Which of the following is an inosilicate amphibole mineral used in highway construction and as railroad ballast?

- (a) Shale (b) Olivine
(c) Geyserite (d) Hornblende

Sol.261.(d) Hornblende: It is an inosilicate amphibole mineral. Uses: Highway construction: As an aggregate for road bases and surfaces. Railroad ballast: To provide drainage and stability under railroad tracks.

Q.262. Which coal is low-grade, brown and soft with high moisture content?

- (a) Metallurgical (b) Lignite
(c) Bituminous (d) Anthracite

Sol.262.(b) Lignite. Bituminous: Medium-grade, black, and less moisture content than lignite, used for electricity, industrial, and domestic purposes. Anthracite: High-grade, hard, black, and very low moisture content, used for residential heating and industrial processes. Tamil Nadu is the largest producer of lignite in India.

Q.263. Match the following renewable sources of energy with their producing regions in India correctly.

Renewable source of energy	Regions in India
1. Tidal energy	a. Gulf of Khambhat
2. Wind energy	b. Nagercoil
3. Geo Thermal energy	c. Puga valley

- (a) 1-c, 2-b, 3-a (b) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c
(c) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c (d) 1-b, 2-c, 3-a

Sol.263.(b) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c. Renewable energy comes from natural sources that are regenerated more quickly than they are used up. They are natural and self-replenishing, and usually have a low or zero-carbon footprint. Examples of renewable energy sources include wind power, solar power, bioenergy (organic matter burned as a fuel) and hydroelectric.

Q.264. The district of Shivamogga that is famous for its Iron-Ore and Manganese mineral is located in which state of India?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Jharkhand
(c) Maharashtra (d) Rajasthan

Sol.264.(a) Karnataka. Other famous mines in India: Panna and Bunder Project - Madhya Pradesh. West Singhbhum, Pahadia, Kunderkocha and Parasi - Jharkhand. Bailadila iron ore and Dalli-Rajhara - Chhattisgarh. Ratnagiri - Maharashtra. Sundergarh, Joda, Keonjhar and Jajpur - Odisha.

Q.265. Match the following Nuclear Power Plants with their respective states:

List - I (Nuclear Power Plant)	List - II (State)
(a) Narora	1. Karnataka
(b) Kakrapar	2. Gujarat
(c) Kudankulam	3. Tamil Nadu
(d) Kaiga	4. Uttar Pradesh

- (a) a-1, b-2, c-3, d-4 (b) a-2, b-3, c-4, d-1
(c) a-3, b-4, c-1, d-2 (d) a-4, b-2, c-3, d-1

Sol.265.(d) a-4, b-2, c-3, d-1. Operational Nuclear power plants in India: Kakrapar Atomic Power Station (Gujarat), Madras Atomic Power Station (Tamil Nadu), Kaiga Nuclear Power Plant (Karnataka), Rajasthan Atomic Power Station (Rajasthan), Tarapur Atomic Power Station (Maharashtra), Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant (Tamil Nadu).

Q.266. Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh states are rich with _____ material deposits.

- (a) gold (b) petroleum
(c) silicon (d) coal

Sol.266.(d) Coal. Jharkhand - 40% of the country's total mineral resources are available here. It produces coking coal, uranium, and pyrite. Jharkhand ranks 1st in the production of coal, mica, kyanite, and copper in India. Major coal fields include Jharia, Bokaro, Karanpura, Hutar, Auranga, Daltonganj, Deoghar, and Rajmahal. Chhattisgarh: A leading producer of coal, dolomite, bauxite, and iron ore. Major coal-producing areas

include Korea, Korba, Raigarh, and Sarguja districts.

Q.267. The Salal Project, also called the Salal Hydroelectric Power Station, is on which river?

- (a) Chenab (b) Krishna
(c) Ganga (d) Ravi

Sol.267.(a) Chenab. Salal Hydroelectric Power Station is a run-of-the-river power project in the Reasi district of Jammu and Kashmir. The project has a capacity of 690 MW. The beneficiary states are Uttar Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Chandigarh & Rajasthan. Important hydel power stations and the rivers on which they are located: Bhakra Nangal (Sutlej River), Gandhi Sagar Dam (Chambal River), and Nagarjuna Sagar Dam (Krishna River).

Q.268. Consider the following statements regarding sources of energy:

- Solar power and geothermal energy are examples of conventional sources of energy.
- Coal, petroleum, natural gas, and nuclear energy are conventional sources of energy.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.268.(a) Only 1. Mineral fuels like coal, petroleum and natural gas (known as fossil fuels), nuclear energy minerals, are the conventional sources of energy. These conventional sources are exhaustible resources.

Q.269. The Durg-Bastar-Chandrapur iron ore belt lies in _____ states.

- (a) Maharashtra and Karnataka
(b) Chhattisgarh and Maharashtra
(c) Maharashtra and Telangana
(d) Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

Sol.269.(b) Chhattisgarh and Maharashtra. The Durg-Bastar-Chandrapur iron ore belt stretches across the Durg and Bastar districts in Chhattisgarh and the Chandrapur district in Maharashtra. Iron ore mines in India: Bailadila (Chhattisgarh), Joda (Odisha), Noamundi (Jharkhand), and Kudremukh (Karnataka).

Q.270. Which of the following agencies is responsible for the operation and maintenance of the Hazira-Vijaypur-Jagdishpur pipeline?

- (a) Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited
(b) Gas Authority of India Limited

- (c) Indian Oil Corporation Limited
(d) Oil and Natural Gas Commission

Sol.270.(b) Hazira-Vijaipur-Jagdishpur (HVJ) is India's first cross-country natural gas pipeline commissioned in 1987-88 with compressor stations at Hazira, Jhabua (Madhya Pradesh), Vijaipur (Madhya Pradesh) and Auraiya (Uttar Pradesh). It transports natural gas from Hazira in Gujarat to Jagdishpur in Uttar Pradesh.

Q.271. According to the Indian Mineral Yearbook 2018, which state alone accounts for 72% of the magnetite deposits in India?

- (a) West Bengal (b) Maharashtra
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Karnataka

Sol.271.(d) Karnataka is the leading producer of iron ore in India, with major deposits located in the Bellary-Hospet, Chitradurga, and Shimoga regions. Other significant iron ore-producing states include Odisha, Jharkhand, and Chhattisgarh.

Q.272. NALCO is an Indian government enterprise, dealing with which of the following minerals?

- (a) Bauxite (b) Iron (c) Mica (d) Copper

Sol.272.(a) Bauxite. National Aluminium Company Limited (NALCO), a 'Navratna' public sector undertaking (PSU) established in 1981. Headquarters - Bhubaneswar, Odisha. Odisha has the largest bauxite reserves in India. Lohardaga in Jharkhand is known as the land of bauxite mines.

Q.273. Which of the following are major coal fields in India?

- (a) Jharia and Raniganj
(b) Jhunjhunu and Alwar
(c) Satara and Pune
(d) Coimbatore and Madurai

Sol.273.(a) Jharia and Raniganj. Jharkhand is home to several significant coalfields, including Jharia (the largest), Bokaro, Dhanbad, Giridih, Karanpura, Ramgarh, and Daltonganj. Major coal fields : West Bengal - Dalingkot (Darjeeling) Birbhum, Chinakuri. Madhya Pradesh - Singrauli, Suhagpur. Odisha - Talcher. Other Minerals in India : Copper - Found in Jhunjhunu and Alwar in Rajasthan. Limestone - Commonly found in Coimbatore and Madurai in Tamil Nadu.

Q.274. Which is the world's largest PV Solar Park located in one of the Indian states ?

- (a) Pavagada Solar Park
(b) Bhadla Solar Park
(c) Dholera Solar Park
(d) Harshad Solar Park

Sol.274.(b) Bhadla Solar Park. It is located in Rajasthan's Jodhpur district, spans 14,000 acres. The Pavagada Solar Park, located in Karnataka's Tumkur district. It was developed by Karnataka Solar Power Development Corporation (KSPDCL). Dholera Solar Park - Gujarat. Harshad Solar Park - Gujarat.

Q.275. Consider the following statements regarding coal deposits in India:

1. Tertiary coal deposits are mainly found in Bihar and Haryana.
2. Lignite occurs in the Himalayan states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.275.(c) Both 1 and 2. Tertiary coals, which include lignite and sub-bituminous coal, occur in Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya and Nagaland. It is extracted from Darangiri, Cherrapunji, Mewlong and Langrin (Meghalaya); Makum, Jaipur and Nazira (Assam); Namchik - Nampuk (Arunachal Pradesh) and Kalakot (Jammu and Kashmir). The brown coal or lignite occurs in the coastal areas of Tamil Nadu, Pondicherry, Gujarat and Jammu and Kashmir.

Q.276. Koderma Gaya Hazaribagh belt is known for the production of which of the following minerals?

- (a) Bauxite (b) Mica (c) Coal (d) Copper

Sol.276.(b) Mica deposits are found on the northern edge of the Chota Nagpur Plateau, with the Koderma - Gaya - Hazaribagh belt in Jharkhand leading production. Major mica-producing regions include Gaya, Hazaribagh, Ajmer, Beawar, Bhilwara, Udaipur, Dungarpur, Banswara, and Nellore. The main mica-producing states are Jharkhand, Rajasthan, and Andhra Pradesh.

Q.277. Which of the following is NOT among the commercial sources of energy?

- (a) Petroleum (b) Electricity
(c) Fuel wood (d) Hydropower

Sol.277.(c) Fuel wood. It is a non-commercial or traditional source of energy, primarily used for domestic purposes such as cooking and heating.

Commercial sources of energy are typically: Fossil fuels (petroleum, coal, natural gas), Electricity (produced from a variety of energy sources), Hydropower (electricity generated from water resources).

Q.278. The Mumbai High region in the Arabian Sea is known for mining _____.

- (a) uranium (b) coal
(c) copper (d) mineral oil

Sol.278.(d) Mineral Oil. Other oil cities/states in India : Digboi is known as the Oil City of Assam where the first oil well in Asia was drilled. Surma Valley (Assam), Rajasthan (Largest producer of Petroleum in India), Gujarat.

Q.279. Match List I (Iron ore mines) with List II (States) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List I (Mines)	List II (States)
(a) Joda	(i) Andhra Pradesh
(b) Gua and Noamundi	(ii) Chhattisgarh
(c) Bailadila	(iii) Jharkhand
(d) Guntur	(iv) Odisha

(a) a - iv, b - iii, c - ii, d - i

(b) a - ii, b - iv, c - iii, d - i

(c) a - iii, b - i, c - ii, d - iv

(d) a - i, b - iii, c - ii, d - iv

Sol.279.(A) a - iv, b - iii, c - ii, d - i. Noamundi and Gua are Iron ore Mines. Iron ore mines in Jharkhand: Kiriburu, Meghahatuburu, Chiria. Major reserves of haematite iron in India: Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Goa. Iron ore mines in India: Bailadila (Chhattisgarh), Balda Block, Joda (Odisha).

Q.280. According to the Indian Minerals Yearbook 2020, which state has the highest production of manganese in India ?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Odisha (d) Maharashtra

Sol.280.(b) Madhya Pradesh (33%), followed by Maharashtra (24%) and Odisha (18%). Other Mineral producing states: Iron Ore - Odisha, Chhattisgarh and Karnataka. Chromite - Odisha, Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. Nickel - Odisha, Jharkhand. Cobalt - Jharkhand, Odisha, Nagaland. Coal - Jharkhand, Orissa, Chhattisgarh. Petroleum - Maharashtra, Gujarat.

Q.281. Which district of Madhya Pradesh is a leading producer of copper?

- (a) Balaghat (b) Jabalpur
(c) Bhopal (d) Gwalior

Sol.281.(a) Balaghat (Largest producer district of copper in India). Other Copper producing States (India) - Rajasthan (Khetri), Jharkhand (Singhbhum). Largest Copper producer (World) - Chile. Top Minerals Producers (India) - Bauxite (Odisha), Gold (Karnataka), Silver (Rajasthan), Coal (Jharkhand), Uranium (Andhra Pradesh).

Q.282. Which of the following is an open pit copper mine ?

- (a) Malanjkhand (b) Bastar
(c) Singhbhum (d) Ballari

Sol.282.(a) Malanjkhand (Madhya Pradesh). Open-pit mining (opencast mining) - A surface mining technique that extracts minerals from an open pit in the ground. Copper Mines in India : Khetri (Rajasthan), Singhbhum (Jharkhand), Kolihan (Rajasthan), Surda (Jharkhand) etc.

Q.283. Which of the following regions in India is nicknamed as the storehouse of minerals?

- (a) Deccan Plateau (b) Western Ghats
(c) Chota Nagpur (d) Himalayas

Sol.283.(c) Chota Nagpur Plateau is a rich source of minerals, including mica, bauxite, copper, limestone, iron ore, coal, manganese ore, and chromite.

Q.284. What are the main energy sources for earth's internal heat engine?

- (a) Radiogenic heat and oceanic tide heat
(b) Heat from volcanoes and solar heat
(c) Solar heat and oceanic tide heat
(d) Radiogenic heat and primordial heat

Sol.284.(d) The Earth's heat is the internal heat that arises from two sources : The decay of radioactive isotopes in crustal rocks and the mantle, and primordial heat left over from the planet's fiery formation. Geothermal energy is the heat produced deep in the Earth's core.

Q.285. Consider the following statements about Thermal Power Plants in Gujarat:

1. The Mundra Thermal Power Plant is located in Kutch district of Gujarat.
2. Wanakbori Thermal Power Station is located in Rajasthan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.285.(a) Only 1. Other Power plants in Gujarat: Jhanor-Gandhar Thermal Power

Station, Kawas Thermal Power Station, Essar Power Gujarat Limited, Kutch Lignite Thermal Power Station, Sabarmati Thermal Power Station, Sikka Thermal Power Station, Surat Lignite Thermal Power Station, Ukai Thermal Power Station, Wanakbori Thermal Power Station.

Q.286. The Bailadila range of Chhattisgarh is famous for which of the following minerals ?

- (a) Copper (b) Bauxite
(c) Iron ore (d) Coal

Sol.286.(c) Iron ore. Types of Iron Ore – Haematite, Magnetite, Limonite and Siderite. Mines and Iron deposit in India: Chhattisgarh - Dalli-Rajhara; Jharkhand - Noamundi mines; Karnataka - Kemmangundi (Baba Budan hills), Sandur (Bellary); Rajasthan - Jaipur, Udaipur, Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Bhilwara, Alwar, Bharatpur, Dausa and Banswara; Andhra Pradesh - Kurnool, Guntur, Cuddapah, Anantapur, Nellore; Kerala - Naduvallur, Eleyettimala, Nanminda, Alampara; Tamil Nadu - Kanjamalai, Mudumalai Hills (Salem district).

Q.287. The approximate amount of silica present in cement is:

- (a) between 27% and 35%
(b) between 37% and 45%
(c) between 17% and 25%
(d) between 47% and 55%

Sol.287.(c) Between 17% and 25%. Cement - It was first introduced in England in 1824 by Joseph Aspdin. Composition of Cement: Lime (60-65%), Silica (17-25%), Alumina (3-8%), Magnesia (1-3%), Iron oxide (0.5-6%), Calcium Sulfate (0.1-0.5%), Sulfur Trioxide (1-3%), Alkaline (0-1%).

Q.288. Consider the following statements regarding oil production in India:

1. Assam is the oldest oil-producing state of India, with Digboi being the first oil reserve.
2. Rajasthan is currently the largest producer of petroleum in India.
3. Major oil fields of Gujarat include Ankleshwar and Kalol.
4. Maharashtra is the second largest producer of petroleum in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Sol.288.(a) 1, 2 and 3 only. The largest producer of petroleum in India is Rajasthan, followed by Gujarat and

Assam. Oil fields of Rajasthan: Mangla, Bhagyam, Kameshwari. Gujarat oil fields: Ankleshwar, Kalol. Naharkatiya and Moran - Hugrijan are important oil fields of Assam.

Q.289. Kawas Thermal Power Station is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Maharashtra
(c) West Bengal (d) Rajasthan

Sol.289.(a) Gujarat. Thermal power station in India: Gujarat - Kutch, Sikka, Dhuvaran. Maharashtra - Bhusawal, Trombay, Khaparkheda. Rajasthan - Chhabra, Barsingsar, Suratgarh, Kota. West Bengal - Farakka Super, Kolaghat, Bakreshwar.

Q.290. The main mineral constituents of the continental mass are ____ and ____ .

- (a) silica, magnesium
(b) silica, alumina
(c) oxygen, carbon
(d) alumina, magnesium

Sol.290.(b) Silica, alumina. It is often termed Sial (Si-silica and Al - aluminum). **Earth** (three layers): Crust, Mantle, and Core. **Crust** (outermost) - It is about 5 km thick under the oceans and about 30 km thick under the continents. **Mantle** - The major constituent elements are silicon and Magnesium. **Core** (mostly Iron and nickel) - This is the innermost layer of the earth.

Q.291. Which state among the following has the largest reserves of gold ore in India as of 2021?

- (a) Jharkhand (b) Rajasthan
(c) Bihar (d) Karnataka

Sol.291.(c) Bihar. Karnataka (Land of Gold) produces 80% of the gold in India. **Three goldfields in India** - Kolar Gold Field (Karnataka), Kolar Hutti Goldfield (Karnataka) and Ramgiri Gold Fields (Andhra Pradesh). Largest producer of Gold in the world - **China**. The largest producers of gold ore - Bihar (44%), Rajasthan (25%), Karnataka (21%), West Bengal (3%) and Jharkhand (2%).

Q.292. Which of the following statements regarding coal is NOT correct?

- (a) Anthracite is the highest quality hard coal.
(b) Coal that has been buried deep and subjected to increased temperatures is bituminous coal.
(c) Lignite is a low-grade brown coal, which is soft with high moisture content.
(d) Metallurgical coal is high grade lignite coal which has a special value for

smelting iron in blast furnaces.

Sol.292.(d) Coal is the most important and abundant fossil fuel in India. It is variously referred to as the 'black gold' or 'black diamond'. It contains carbon, volatile matter, moisture, and ash.

Q.293. Which of the following is NOT a major iron ore belt in India?

- (a) Maharashtra - Goa belt
- (b) Haryana - Rajasthan belt
- (c) Odisha - Jharkhand belt
- (d) Durg - Bastar - Chandrapur belt

Sol.293.(b) Haryana-Rajasthan belt. The major iron ore belts in India are **Odisha-Jharkhand** belt : High grade haematite ore is found in Badampahar mines in the Mayurbhanj and Kendujhar districts.

Q.294. The largest wind farm cluster of India is located in _____.

- (a) Gujarat (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Maharashtra (d) Karnataka

Sol.294.(b) Tamil Nadu. The name of this wind farm is Muppandal Wind Farm, located in Muppandal, Kanyakumari district, Tamil Nadu. It is an onshore wind farm with a capacity of 1,500 MW. The largest wind farm in the world is the Gansu Wind Farm in China.

Q.295. The major resources of Gondwana coal, which are metallurgical coal is located in_____.

- (a) Damodar valley (b) Chambal valley
- (c) Krishna valley (d) Narmada valley

Sol.295.(a) Damodar valley (West Bengal -Jharkhand). Jharia, Raniganj, Bokaro are important coalfields. The Godavari, Mahanadi, Son and Wardha valleys also contain coal deposits.

Q.296. Peat coal has ____ carbon and ____ moisture content?

- (a) High, Low (b) Low, high
- (c) High, High (d) Low, Low

Sol.296.(b) Low, high. Peat is a soft, dark brown coal that is formed from dead and decaying organic matter. It has an energy density of 15 MJ/kg. It has a low heating capacity. India has the fifth-largest coal reserves in the world. **Coal India Limited** (CIL) (Public Sector Undertaking) was established on 1 November 1975 under the ownership of the Ministry of Coal. Headquarters: Kolkata.

Q.297. Which of the following minerals is NOT found in rivers (alluvial placers) and on the coast, especially beaches (beach placers)?

- (a) Tin (b) Bauxite (c) Platinum (d) Gold

Sol.297.(b) Bauxite deposits are formed by the decomposition of a wide variety of rocks rich in aluminium silicates.

Q.298. Consider the following statements regarding Export Processing Zones (EPZs) in India:

1. Falta Export Processing Zone is located in West Bengal.
2. An Export Processing Zone (EPZ) is a customs area that allows import of machinery and raw materials for manufacturing export goods without payment of duty.
3. Farakka is also an Export Processing Zone in West Bengal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Sol.298.(a) 1 and 2 only. Farakka is known for its barrage, not an EPZ.

Agriculture

Q.299. Given below are the Assertion and Reason, choose the correct options regarding both the statements.

Assertion (A): Seasonal agricultural practices, such as stubble burning, have no significant impact on AQI levels in India.

Reason (R): Stubble burning is a controlled practice that doesn't release substantial pollutants into the atmosphere.

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) A is true, but R is false.
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (c) Both A and R are false.
- (d) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

Sol.299.(c) Both A and R are false. Seasonal stubble burning in North India is a major cause of severe air pollution, raising AQI to hazardous levels. This uncontrolled practice releases large amounts of PM2.5, PM10, carbon monoxide, and toxic gases into the atmosphere.

Q.300. High honey yield and gentle behaviour in bees for commercial beekeeping can be achieved through one of the following methods:

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Using wild bee species with aggressive defence traits
- (b) Frequently relocating hives to prevent bees from settling
- (c) Avoiding bee farms and relying solely on natural honey collection

(d) Introducing Italian bees that collect more honey and remain in hives longer

Sol.300.(d) Italian bees (*Apis mellifera ligustica*) are preferred in commercial apiculture because they are gentle in nature, highly productive, and stay longer in hives. They gather more nectar compared to indigenous species, making them suitable for large-scale honey production. Unlike wild or aggressive species, they are easier to manage, ensuring higher yield and safer beekeeping practices.

Q.301. Match the columns:

Column A (Cropping Season)	Column B (Major Crops - Shuffled)
A. Kharif (June-September)	1. Vegetables, Fruits, Fodder
B. Rabi (October-March)	2. Rice, Cotton, Bajra, Maize, Jowar, Tur
C. Zaid (April-June)	3. Wheat, Gram, Rapeseeds and Mustard, Barley

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) A-3, B-2, C-1 (b) A-2, B-1, C-3
- (c) A-1, B-2, C-3 (d) A-2, B-3, C-1

Sol.301.(d) A-2, B-3, C-1. Kharif Crops (Monsoon season: June–Sept). Sown with onset of monsoon, harvested in autumn. Examples: Rice, Cotton, Bajra, Maize, Jowar, Tur (Pigeon pea). Rabi Crops (Winter season: Oct–March). Sown in winter, harvested in spring. Examples: Wheat, Gram, Rapeseed, Mustard, Barley. Zaid Crops (Summer season: April–June). Short-season crops grown between Rabi and Kharif. Examples: Vegetables, Fruits (melon, cucumber), Fodder.

Q.302. Match the local names of shifting agriculture with the states where they are practiced:

List I (Local Name)	List II (State/Region)
a. Penda	1. Odisha
b. Bringa	2. Andhra Pradesh
c. Dahiya	3. Madhya Pradesh
d. Jhumming	4. North-Eastern region

- (a) a-2, b-1, c-3, d-4 (b) a-1, b-2, c-3, d-4
- (c) a-3, b-2, c-1, d-4 (d) a-2, b-3, c-1, d-4

Sol.302.(a) a-2, b-1, c-3, d-4. In India, shifting agriculture is called 'Bewar' or 'Dahiya' in Madhya Pradesh, 'Podu' or 'Penda' in Andhra Pradesh, 'Pama Dabi' or 'Koman' or 'Bringa' in Odisha, 'Kumari' in Western Ghats, 'Valre' or 'Waltre' in South-eastern Rajasthan, 'Khil' in the Himalayan belt, 'Kuruwa' in Jharkhand,

and 'Jhumming' in the North-eastern region.

Q.303. The term 'Aus', 'Aman' and 'Boro' are associated with which crop in India?
(a) Maize (b) Wheat (c) Jute (d) Paddy

Sol.303.(d) Paddy is basically a tropical crop. 'Aus', 'Aman' and 'Boro' are grown in states like Assam, West Bengal, and Odisha throughout the year. Aus: Sown in the summer, along with pre-monsoonal rains, and harvested in the autumn. Aman: Sown in the monsoon and harvested in the winter. Boro: Sown in the winter and harvested in the summer.

Q.304. Which type of tea in large amount is exported from India to importing countries?

- (a) Herbal tea (b) Regular tea
(c) Green tea (d) Black tea

Sol.304.(d) Black tea. India is the world's second largest tea producer after China. The types of tea exported through India are: Black tea, Regular tea, Green tea, Herbal tea, Masala tea, and Lemon tea. The majority of the tea exported out of India is black tea which makes up about 96% of the total exports.

Q.305. The people of Himachal Pradesh make channels to bring water from a glacier or rainwater to villages for the function of mainly irrigation. These channels are locally known as:

- (a) Khadins (b) Guls or Kuls
(c) Johads (d) Baori

Sol.305.(b) Guls or Kuls. In hill and mountainous regions, people built diversion channels like the 'guls' or 'kuls' of the Western Himalayas for agriculture. Water harvesting system: 'Rooftop rain water harvesting' was commonly practised to store drinking water, particularly in Rajasthan. In arid and semi-arid regions, agricultural fields were converted into rain fed storage structures that allowed the water to stand and moisten the soil like the 'khadins' in Jaisalmer and 'Johads' in other parts of Rajasthan. Roof top rain water harvesting is the most common practice in Shillong, Meghalaya.

Q.306. Which of the following states is the biggest producer of Pulses?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Haryana
(c) Punjab (d) Bihar

Sol.306.(a) Madhya Pradesh. Based on the production estimates for the year 2022-23, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Rajasthan are the top three pulses producing states in the country. India is

the largest producer of pulses in the world.

Q.307. Which of the following statements correctly defines the green revolution?

- (a) It is a new strategy in agriculture to produce food grains, especially wheat and rice.
(b) It is a new strategy to increase the share of the forest.
(c) It is a new strategy to use green colour for all purposes.
(d) It is a new strategy to use only herbal products.

Sol.307.(a) The Green Revolution, starting in the 1960s, aimed to achieve food security and reduce food imports, particularly in India. It involved the introduction of high-yielding variety seeds, mechanized farming, improved irrigation, and the use of pesticides and fertilizers.

Q.308. According to the Agricultural and Processed food products Export Development Authority (APEDA) 2020-2021, which state of India has the first rank in grapes production?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Karnataka
(c) Bihar (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.308.(a) Maharashtra. APEDA was established in 1986, operates under the Ministry of Commerce and Trade to promote the export of agricultural and processed food products.

Q.309. The green revolution technology resulted in an increase in production of cereal production from 72.4 million tons in 1965-66 to _____ million tons in 1978-79.

- (a) 150.8 (b) 165.9 (c) 131.9 (d) 141.2

Sol.309.(c) 131.9. The cereal production was increased due to three factors: (i) Increase in net area under cultivation; (ii) Growing two or more crops in a year on the same piece of land; and (iii) Use of HYV seeds.

Q.310. Consider the following statements regarding the Second Green Revolution Cell:

1. The headquarters of the Second Green Revolution (SGR) Cell is located at ICAR-Research Complex for Eastern Region (RCER), Patna.
2. The benefits of the first Green Revolution were mainly confined to the eastern region of India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only

- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.310.(a) 1 only. The Second Green Revolution (SGR) Cell was created by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, Government of India to improve agricultural productivity and livelihood in the Eastern region of India because the benefits of first Green Revolution were mainly confined to north-western states of Haryana, Punjab and western Uttar Pradesh.

Q.311. Which of the following statements about the aims of National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA) of India is/are correct?

1. To make agriculture more productive.
 2. To make agriculture more sustainable.
 3. To promote organic farming.
- (a) Only 1 is correct.
(b) Only 2 and 3 are correct.
(c) 1, 2 and 3 are correct.
(d) Only 1 and 2 are correct.

Sol.311.(c) 1, 2 and 3 are correct. National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA) has been made operational from the year 2014-15 which aims at making agriculture more productive, sustainable, remunerative and climate resilient by promoting location specific integrated /composite farming systems; soil and moisture conservation measures; comprehensive soil health management; efficient water management practices and mainstreaming rainfed technologies.

Q.312. What was a significant negative environmental impact of the Green Revolution?

- (a) Deforestation
(b) Soil degradation
(c) Increase in air pollution
(d) Ozone layer depletion

Sol.312.(b) Soil degradation. The Green Revolution caused soil fertility loss through the use of chemical fertilizers. Chemical fertilizers also kill bacteria and other microorganisms in the soil. Green Revolution also led to groundwater depletion due to extensive tubewell irrigation, impacting long-term environmental resources.

Q.313. How was the growth in all food grains after the Green Revolution?

- (a) Unitary (b) Proportionate
(c) Unpredictable (d) Disproportionate

Sol.313.(d) Disproportionate. Larger farmers with more resources were able to afford the necessary inputs, like

high-yield variety (HYV) seeds, fertilizers, and irrigation, and thus reaped greater benefits. Smaller farmers often lacked access to these resources and faced higher risks, as the HYV crops were more vulnerable to pests, potentially causing severe losses. About 65 percent of the country's population continued to be employed in agriculture even as late as 1990.

Q.314. What was the main objective of the Second Green Revolution in India?

- (a) Ensuring food security in the western states
- (b) Promoting conventional agricultural practices
- (c) Focusing on holistic development in agriculture
- (d) Increasing the use of chemical fertilizers and pesticides

Sol.314.(c) In the second phase of the green revolution (mid-1970s to mid-1980s), the HYV technology spread to a larger number of states and benefited more variety of crops. The spread of green revolution technology enabled India to achieve self-sufficiency in food grains.

Q.315. Which of the following movements created regional disparities between large and small farmers in India?

- (a) Green revolution (b) Yellow revolution
- (c) Pink revolution (d) Blue revolution

Sol.315.(a) Green revolution in India started with the aim of increasing India's agricultural production to make India self-sufficient in food grains.

Q.316. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- I. The first green revolution led to over-exploitation of natural resources.
- II. The second Green Revolution was more focused on Southern India.
- III. The second green revolution ensured in achieving sustainable livelihood security.

- (a) I and III (b) Only II
- (c) II and III (d) I and II

Sol.316.(a) I and III. The Second Green Revolution focuses on sustainable agriculture in eastern India, rainfed areas, and small farmers, promoting climate-resilient practices and livelihood security.

Q.317. What action was taken by the government to celebrate the achievement of the Green Revolution in agriculture?

- (a) Released a regular salary for the

farmers

- (b) Distributed free food to all the people
- (c) Released a special stamp, 'Wheat Revolution'
- (d) Distributed green vegetables to the people

Sol.317.(c) Green Revolution : The term was first used by William Gaud, with Norman Borlaug recognized as its global father and M.S. Swaminathan was the father of the Green Revolution in India. India adopted a new agricultural strategy, boosting wheat and rice production. In July 1968, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi commemorated its success by releasing a special stamp titled "Wheat Revolution."

Q.318. What is the economic justification for subsidies in the agriculture sector?

- (a) It is mostly used to provide benefits for rich farmers.
- (b) It is a part of government expenditure in the service sector.
- (c) It is an incentive to provide the benefits of advanced technology and decrease the cost of production.
- (d) It is used to provide benefits for capital goods producers in agriculture.

Sol.318.(c) Agricultural subsidies support food security and development by helping farmers boost production, improve food availability, and reduce poverty. Input subsidies lower costs, incentivize adoption, increase productivity, and stimulate economic growth.

Q.319. In West Bengal, how many rice crops are grown in a year?

- (a) Three (b) Two (c) Four (d) One

Sol.319.(a) Three. In states like Assam, West Bengal, and Odisha, three paddy crops are grown annually: Aus, Aman, and Boro.

Q.320. In the given main characteristics of farming which is NOT a characteristic of the Indian commercial farming?

- (a) Slash and burn
- (b) Insecticides and pesticides
- (c) Chemical fertilisers
- (d) High yielding variety seeds

Sol.320.(a) Slash and burn farming is a form of shifting agriculture where natural vegetation is cut down and burned to clear the land for cultivation. In commercial farming, higher doses of modern inputs are used to obtain higher productivity. The degree of commercialization in agriculture varies from one region to another. For example,

rice is a commercial crop in Haryana and Punjab, but in Odisha, it is a subsistence crop.

Q.321. Which of the following types of crops are sown after the end of the monsoon season?

- (a) Kharif crops (b) Zaid crops
- (c) Rabi crops (d) Vital crops

Sol.321.(c) Rabi crops. It is an agricultural crop that is sown in the winter and harvested in the spring.

Q.322. Which of the following is NOT one of the consequences of the Green Revolution?

- (a) Employment of agricultural workers increased
- (b) Rising prices and a shift in the mode of payment of agricultural workers from payment in cash to payment in kind (grain)
- (c) Wages of agricultural workers increased
- (d) The rich grew richer and many of the poor stagnated or grew poorer

Sol.322.(b) Impact of Green Revolution : Positive - Increase in production and productivity of food grains, reduction in hunger, and technological advancements in agriculture. Negative - Decline in Soil fertility, High production costs, Regional disparities.

Q.323. Match the following names of primitive forms of cultivation in different states correctly.

States	Name of Primitive form of cultivation
1. Madhya Pradesh	a. Penda
2. Andhra Pradesh	b. Bewar
3. Odisha	c. Kuruwa
4. Jharkhand	d. Bringa

- (a) 1-a, 2-b, 3-d, 4-c (b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c
- (c) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d (d) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d

Sol.323.(b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c.

Q.324. Match the items in List I with those in List II.

List I	List II
i. Blue revolution	a. Oilseeds
ii. Yellow revolution	b. Overall horticulture
iii. Round revolution	c. Fish
iv. Golden revolution	d. Potato

- (a) i-b, ii-c, iii-d, iv-a (b) i-d, ii-a, iii-b, iv-c
- (c) i-c, ii-a, iii-d, iv-b (d) i-b, ii-d, iii-a, iv-c

Sol.324.(c) i-c, ii-a, iii -d, iv-b. Agricultural Revolutions in India: Green Revolution - To increase agricultural productivity, White Revolution - Milk production, Black

Revolution - Petroleum products, Brown Revolution - Leather / Cocoa / Non-Conventional Products, Golden Fiber Revolution - Jute Production, Silver Revolution - Egg Production / Poultry Production, Red Revolution - Meat Production / Tomato Production.

Q.325. Which of the following types of crops are sown at the beginning of the monsoon season?

- (a) Rabi crops (b) Kharif crops
(c) Vital crops (d) Zaid crops

Sol.325.(b) Kharif crops. These crops are typically planted during June to September and harvested in the post-monsoon season (October to November). Examples of Kharif crops include rice, maize, cotton, and sorghum. Rabi crops are sown after the monsoon season, usually in the winter months (October to December), and harvested in the spring (March to May). Zaid crops are grown in the intervening period between Kharif and Rabi seasons, typically in the summer months (March to June).

Q.326. Which of the following statement/s about the Green Revolution is/are CORRECT?

- I. India became self-sufficient with the introduction of the Green Revolution.
II. The Green Revolution led to loss of nutrients in the soil from farming the same crop over and over again.
III. The Green Revolution led to depletion of fresh ground water.

- (a) Only I and III (b) Only I and II
(c) I, II and III (d) Only II

Sol.326.(c) I, II and III. The Green Revolution resulted in a great increase in production of food grains (especially wheat and rice) due to the introduction into developing countries of new, high-yielding variety (HYV) seeds. The green revolution enabled the government to procure sufficient amounts of food grains to build a stock which could be used in times of food shortage.

Q.327. Which of the following statements are true about the positive impact of the Green Revolution (GR) on yield levels in India?

- I. During the post GR period, the yield of rice grew at a much faster rate than that of wheat.
II. GR technology had penetrated more in wheat crop than in the rice crop.
III. During post GR period, the area under rice achieved a relatively slow growth when compared to the area under wheat.

- (a) Only II and III (b) Only I and III
(c) Only I and II (d) I, II and III

Sol.327.(a) Only ii and iii. The Green Revolution technology had a greater impact on wheat crops than on rice crops. Important Crops in the Revolution: Main crops were - Wheat, Rice, Jowar, Bajra and Maize. Non-food grains were excluded from the ambit of the new strategy. Wheat remained the mainstay of the Green Revolution for years. Mankombu Sambasivan Swaminathan is known as the "Father of India's Green Revolution" for his work to increase food production and alleviate world hunger.

Q.328. Which of these is NOT true of the second phase of the green revolution?

- (a) It was adopted by farmers living in dry and semi-arid regions of India.
(b) It was launched in areas with a significant shift from dry to wet (irrigated) cultivation.
(c) It covered the period of the 1960s and 1970s.
(d) It covered the period of the 1980s.

Sol.328.(c) The use of HYV seeds was restricted to the more affluent states such as Punjab, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu in the 1st Phase (Mid 1960s to mid-1970s). In the second phase of the green revolution (mid-1970s to mid-1980s), the HYV technology spread to a larger number of states and benefited more variety of crops.

Q.329. Who among the following is NOT associated with the Green Revolution?

- (a) Norman Borlaug
(b) P Chidambaram
(c) Chidambaram Subramaniam
(d) MS Swaminathan

Sol.329.(b) P Chidambaram. Green Revolution: Initiated by - Norman Borlaug (1960s). He is known as the 'Father of Green Revolution' in world. He received the Nobel prize (1970) for developing High yielding varieties (HYVs) of wheat. M.S. Swaminathan (Father of Green Revolution in India). The Green revolution came under the third five year plan (1961-66). Chidambaram Subramaniam was an Indian politician and agricultural scientist who played a crucial role in India's Green Revolution. Award - Bharat Ratna (1998).

Q.330. Identify the crop which is grown in Kharif cropping season in Northern States of India.

- (a) Mustard (b) Rice (c) Gram (d) Barley

Sol.330.(b) Rice. Kharif is sown during

the rainy season, typically from June to September in India. Examples include paddy, maize, soybean, groundnut, and cotton. Rabi grows in the winter season, from October to March. Examples include wheat, gram, peas, mustard, and linseed. In between the rabi and the kharif seasons, there is a short season during the summer months known as the Zaid season. Examples are watermelon, muskmelon, cucumber.

Q.331. In which of the following ways were farmers encouraged to begin to use high yielding variety seeds?

- (a) Farmers' children were given free education in government colleges and universities.
(b) Agricultural labourers were paid wages directly by the government.
(c) Farmers were given monetary support in cash to cultivate food grains.
(d) The government provided seeds and other inputs at prices lower than those prevailing in the market.

Sol.331.(d) Farmers were encouraged to use high-yielding variety (HYV) seeds during the Green Revolution through various forms of support from the government. The government made HYV seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, and irrigation systems available at subsidized prices, meaning they were cheaper than market rates. This helped reduce the financial burden on farmers and incentivized them to adopt new agricultural technologies. HYV seeds are resistant to insects and diseases and are known for their high yields.

Q.332. Which of the following is NOT an agro-based industry?

- (a) Jute (b) Fertiliser
(c) Sugar (d) Edible oil

Sol.332.(b) Fertiliser. Agro-based industries depend on agricultural raw materials, producing mainly consumer goods. Major industries include cotton, jute, textiles, and edible oil. India's first sugar mill was established in Pratappur, Uttar Pradesh, in 1903. The Sugar Cane Act of 1934 allowed state governments to set the minimum price for sugarcane.

Q.333. Which of the following is NOT true with regard to the Green Revolution?

- (a) Cultivation became more intensive in nature.
(b) In its second phase, there was a shift to from dry to wet (irrigated) cultivation in dry and semi-arid regions of India.
(c) Cultivation became more extensive in nature.

(d) There was change in the cropping pattern and types of crops grown in its second phase.

Sol.333.(c) The Green Revolution did not focus on expanding the area under cultivation but rather on making the existing land more productive (intensive cultivation), using modern inputs and technology.

Q.334. Which crops are benefitted from the temperate cyclones arising from the Mediterranean Sea that cause rainfall in Punjab?

- (a) Cash crops (b) Kharif crops
(c) Rabi crops (d) Zaid crops

Sol.334.(c) Rabi crops. Temperate cyclones cause rainfall in Punjab, Haryana, Delhi and western Uttar Pradesh. The precipitation is in the form of snowfall in the lower Himalayas. It is this snow that sustains the flow of water in the Himalayan rivers during the summer months. The precipitation goes on decreasing from west to east in the plains and from north to south in the mountains.

Q.335. In July 1968, Indira Gandhi, the then Prime Minister of India, officially recorded impressive strides of the Green Revolution in agriculture by releasing a special stamp entitled _____.
(a) Wheat Revolution (b) Fasal Kranti
(c) Harit Kranti (d) Green Revolution

Sol.335.(a) Wheat Revolution (Part of Green Revolution) was initiated under the Third Five Year Plan (1961-66) by introducing high-yielding varieties of seeds of rice and wheat.

Q.336. Which of the following reasons can be attributed to the excessive pressure on agricultural land in India?

- A. Right of inheritance
B. Size of unprofitable land holding
C. Division of land
D. Multiple cropping
(a) Only A and B (b) B, C and D
(c) A, C and D (d) A, B and C

Sol.336.(d) A, B and C. Reasons that cause pressure on Agriculture: The right of inheritance, Division of land, Rising population, Use of Excessive Chemical Fertilizer, Salinization of soil, Desertification, Urbanisation, Waterlogging, Climate Change, Droughts, Pollution etc.

Q.337. Which of the following countries is related with high yielding variety seeds that are used as part of Green Revolution policies in India?

- (a) Russia (b) Mexico
(c) China (d) The US

Sol.337.(b) Mexico. Green Revolution - A period that began in the 1960s during which agriculture in India was converted into a modern industrial system by the adoption of technology (The use of high yielding variety (HYV) seeds, mechanised farm tools, irrigation facilities, pesticides, and fertilizers).

Q.338. Consider the following statements regarding rice varieties in India:

1. IR8, also called Miracle Rice, was first harvested in 1967 and helped India overcome a massive famine.
2. Golden Rice, developed in 1998, is genetically modified to contain pro-vitamin A.
3. PETA is the high-yielding semi-dwarf rice variety developed by the International Rice Research Institute (IRRI) in 1967.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3 only

Sol.338.(d) 2 and 3 only. IR8 is a high-yielding semi-dwarf rice variety developed by the International Rice Research Institute (IRRI). Golden rice: A transgenic rice having a gene for carotene. It was first introduced in 1999 by Ingo Potrykus and Peter Beyer. It contains pro-vitamin A which upon ingestion is converted to vitamin A in the human body.

Q.339. For Kharif crops, the temperature required for farming is above 25 degrees Celsius with high humidity and annual rainfall above _____ cm.

- (a) 16 (b) 50 (c) 100 (d) 35

Sol.339.(c) 100. Kharif crops are sown during the monsoon season, which lasts from June to September in India.

Q.340. Consider the following statements regarding the Green Revolution in India:

1. Punjab was the most transformed state due to the Green Revolution.
2. The Green Revolution had maximum impact in Punjab, Haryana, and western Uttar Pradesh.
3. The eastern region, including Assam, Bihar, West Bengal, and Odisha, was the most benefitted from the Green Revolution.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Sol.340.(a) 1 and 2 only. Statement 3 is incorrect because the eastern region had minimal impact, not maximum, from the Green Revolution.

Q.341. The agricultural land below the main canal water level forms the _____.

- (a) command area (b) lift system
(c) flow system (d) warebandi

Sol.341.(a) command area. Lift system - Water is lifted from lower level to higher level with the help of pumps and other equipment. Flow system - The type of irrigation in which water is available at a higher level to enable supply to the land by gravity flow. Warabandi - It is a system of rotation of supply of water according to a predetermined schedule as per area and crop needs specifying the day, time and duration of supply to each holding to ensure equitable water distribution among farmers of an outlet command.

Q.342. _____ land is suitable for regular cropping.

- (a) Arable (b) Barren
(c) Marginal (d) Urban

Sol.342.(a) Arable land is the land under temporary crops, temporary meadows for mowing or for pasture, land under market or kitchen gardens, and temporary fallow. It is capable of being ploughed and used to grow crops. Barren land - Land that normally cannot be brought under cultivation with the available technology. Marginal land - Land that has little or no agricultural Value.

Q.343. Which group of crops belong to fibre crops and are produced on a large scale in India ?

- (a) Gram and tur (b) Jute and hemp
(c) Tea and coffee (d) Wheat and rice

Sol.343.(b) Jute and Hemp. Jute is known as Golden Fibre. It grows well on well-drained fertile soils in the floodplains. Major Jute producing states (West Bengal, Bihar, Assam, Odisha and Meghalaya).

Q.344. Which of the following crops is the only genetically modified (GM) crop approved for commercial cultivation in India?

- (a) Bt Brinjal (b) Mustard
(c) Bt Cotton (d) Tomato

Sol.344.(c) Bt Cotton. GM crops : These are derived from plants whose genes are artificially modified, usually by inserting

genetic material from another organism. India approved the release of Bt cotton (Cry 1 AC) for commercial cultivation in 2002 - Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu. The best known variety of GM rice is golden rice.

Q.345. Consider the following statements:

1. Extensive cultivation refers to farming on large farms with moderately low inputs of labour and capital.
2. Hybrid cultivation is the practice of cultivating crops only on small plots of land with no use of hybrid seeds.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.345.(b) 2 only. Hybrid cultivation - It involves the use of hybrid seed varieties (created by crossbreeding two or more genetically distinct plants). Example - Wheat - Sonalika and Kalyan Sona, Rice - Jaya and Ratna.

Q.346. Which of the following crops is classified as fine grain?

- (a) Bajra (b) Ragi (c) Maize (d) Wheat

Sol.346.(d) Wheat. India produces a variety of cereals, which are classified into fine grains (rice, wheat) and coarse grains (jowar, bajra, maize, ragi, etc.).

Q.347. Which of the following is the most suitable application of rainwater harvesting?

- (a) Used in cooking
(b) Irrigation
(c) Water for pets
(d) Use for industrial purposes

Sol.347.(b) Irrigation. Rainwater harvesting is the process of collecting, storing, and purifying rainwater from rooftops, parks, roads, and open grounds. It is used for drinking, domestic needs, livestock, small irrigation, and replenishing groundwater levels.

Q.348. What is meant by subsistence agriculture?

- (a) Agricultural output is sufficient for the country.
(b) Agriculturists produce primarily for themselves.
(c) Agriculture generates sufficient income.
(d) Agriculturists produce primarily for the market.

Sol.348.(b) Types of Subsistence Farming : Primitive subsistence farming

or shifting cultivation (oldest form of agriculture) - It happens on a self-sufficient basis, and farmers raise food according to their family's needs. The trees are cut down and burnt and the cleared land is cultivated. Other names: Shifting cultivation or slash and burn cultivation. **Intensive subsistence farming** - The farmer cultivates a small plot of land using simple tools and more. More than one crop is cultivated during a year.

Q.349. Which of the following states of India still uses the ancient bamboo drip irrigation method?

- (a) Telangana (b) Meghalaya
(c) Maharashtra (d) Chhattisgarh

Sol.349.(b) Meghalaya. Bamboo drip irrigation system is tapping stream and spring water by using bamboo pipes.

Types of Irrigation systems: Well and Tube well, Canal, Tank, Drip, Sprinkler, Furrow, Surge, Ditch. The word Meghalaya means "abode of clouds". 'Krem Liat Prah' Longest cave of India is in Meghalaya. **Hills:** Garo, Khasi, Jaintia.

Q.350. Which of the following classification bases of industry applies to the products - cotton, jute, wool, silk textile, rubber, tea, sugar, coffee, edible oil?

- (a) Key industries
(b) Consumer industries
(c) Agro based industries
(d) Mineral based industries

Sol.350.(c) Agro-based industries use plant and animal products as raw materials. Mineral-based industries, like iron and steel, copper smelting, and cement, use mineral ores. Consumer industries produce goods for direct consumer use, such as sugar, toothpaste, paper, sewing machines, and fans.

Q.351. Consider the following statements regarding Census of India 2011:

1. 4.6% of the total workforce was engaged in manufacturing and allied sector activities.
2. The total number of agricultural workers was 263.1 million as per Census 2011

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.351.(a) 1 only. 54.6% of the total workforce is engaged in Agriculture and allied sector activities. Census 2011 was conducted by the Registrar General of India. The total number of agricultural

workers in the country : 263.1 million (118.8 million cultivators and 144.3 million agricultural labourers) in 2011. The workforce participation rate for females was 25.51% against 53.26% for males.

Q.352. Cultivation of rice needs high rainfall _____.

- (a) Low temperature and low humidity
(b) High temperature and low humidity
(c) High temperature and high humidity
(d) Low temperature and high humidity

Sol.352.(c) High temperature and high humidity. Fertile riverine alluvial soil is best for rice cultivation. It is a type of Kharif crop. West Bengal is the largest rice-producing state in India. China is the world's largest producer of rice followed by India. Methane is the gas produced by the rice field.

Q.353. Consider the following statements:

1. The cultivation of tea was introduced on the Baba Budan Hills in India.
2. Baba Budan introduced the coffee plant to Chikkamagaluru, Karnataka in 1670.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.353.(a) 1 only. The cultivation of Coffee was introduced on the Baba Budan Hills in India. Baba Budan introduced the coffee plant to Chikkamangalur, Karnataka in 1670. Growth of coffee was encouraged during the time of General Sir Mark Cubbon in 1834. Types of coffee bean : Arabica, Robusta, Excelsa and Liberica. Coffee producer country: 1st - Brazil. 2nd - Vietnam.

Q.354. Dr D.S. Athwal was known as the 'Father of _____ Revolution in India'.

- (a) Oilseed (b) Rice (c) Millet (d) Wheat

Sol.354.(d) Wheat. Father of Agricultural revolutions in India: **Green** Revolution (Agriculture) - M.S. Swaminathan, **White** Revolution or Operation flood (Milk/ Dairy products) - Dr. Varghese Kurien, **Blue** Revolution (Fish and Aqua) - Dr. Arun Krishnan and Dr. Harilal Chaudhari, **Golden** Revolution (Fruits, Honey, Horticulture) - Nirpakh Tutaj, **Silver** Revolution (Eggs) - Indira Gandhi, **Yellow** Revolution (Oil Seeds) - Sam Pitroda, **Pink** Revolution (Pharmaceuticals, Prawns, Onion) - Durgesh Patel, **Brown** Revolution (Leather, Coco) - Hiralal Chaudri, **Red** Revolution (Meat, Tomato) -

Vishal Tewari.

Q.355. Consider the following statements regarding the Agricultural Census in India:

1. The Agricultural Census in India is conducted every six years.
2. The Agriculture Census has been conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture since 1980-81

Which of the above statement(s) is/are incorrect?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.355.(c) Both 1 and 2. Agricultural Census is conducted in India at an interval of 5 years. It is conducted following the broad guidelines of the decennial World Census of Agriculture (WCA) developed by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations. The Agriculture Census has been conducted by the Ministry of Agriculture since 1970-71. "The Eleventh Agricultural Census" (2021-22) Launched by The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare.

Q.356. Which of the following is termed as "sericulture"?

- (a) Cultivation of grapes
(b) Growing of fruits
(c) Breeding of fish
(d) Commercial rearing of silk worms

Sol.356.(d) Commercial rearing of silkworms. 'Bombyx mori', 'Eri', 'Muga' and 'Tasar' are silkworm species used in sericulture. These are used to produce silk fiber (protein) from their silk glands. Moriculture refers to the cultivation of mulberry plants. **Other types of farming:** Aviculture (birds), Apiculture (bees), Pisciculture (fish), Viticulture (grapes), Fungiculture (mushroom), Arboriculture (tree), Silviculture (fodder crops), Olericulture (vegetables).

Q.357. There are regions where farmers specialize in vegetables only. This type of farming is known as ____.

- (a) Mixed farming (b) Pastoral farming
(c) Dairy farming (d) Truck farming

Sol.357.(d) Truck farming. Mixed farming includes crop cultivation and raising animals. Pastoral farming involves livestock, such as cattle, sheep, and goats, while dairy farming focuses on milk production from cows.

Q.358. Which among the following terms means growing of fruits?

- (a) Apiculture (b) Arboriculture
(c) Pomiculture (d) Sericulture

Sol.358.(c) Pomiculture. Apiculture - The maintenance of honeybees and hives. Arboriculture - Cultivation of trees, shrubs, and woody plants for shading and decorating.

Q.359. It is a tropical as well as a subtropical crop. It grows well in hot and humid climates with a temperature of 21°C to 27°C and an annual rainfall between 75cm and 100cm. Which of the crops is being talked about in the information given above?

- (a) Sugarcane (b) Cotton
(c) Maize (d) Rubber

Sol.359.(a) Sugarcane. India is the second-largest producer of sugarcane after Brazil. Maize - Grown in tropics, sub-tropics and temperate regions. Rubber - Equatorial crop produced primarily for the manufacture of latex for industrial use.

Q.360. Cotton requires ____ temperature, light rainfall or irrigation, ____ frost-free days and bright sun-shine for its growth.

- (a) high, 210 (b) low, 150
(c) low, 210 (d) high, 150

Sol.360.(a) High, 210. Cotton crop requires light rainfall or irrigation and bright sunshine for its growth. It comes under the Kharif Crop.

Q.361. In India initially HYVP was implemented in about how much area?

- (a) 5 million hectares
(b) 3 million hectares
(c) 4 million hectares
(d) 2 million hectares

Sol.361.(d) 2 million hectares. HYVP (High Yielding Variety Programme) was restricted to only five crops – Wheat, rice, jowar, bajra and maize. The high yielding variety of seeds (resistant to insects and diseases) played an important role in the Green Revolution of India.

Q.362. In rainforests which kind of cultivation is practiced?

- (a) Dry farming (b) Vertical farming
(c) Terrace farming (d) Slash and burn

Sol.362.(d) Slash and burn cultivation or swidden cultivation, is commonly practiced in rainforest areas.

Q.363. The Purple revolution was launched by the Union Ministry of Science & Technology in Jammu and Kashmir. This revolution is related to cultivation of which crop?

- (a) Marigold (b) Kashmiri Rose
(c) Lavender (d) Himalayan Indigo

Sol.363.(c) Lavender. The Purple

Revolution was initiated in 2016 through the Aroma Mission of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). In India, the lavender crop is cultivated in low rainfall regions and on the slopes of hills of Himachal Pradesh (HP) and Uttar Pradesh (UP).

Q.364. Consider the following statements regarding types of agriculture:

1. Soilless agriculture is called Hydroponics.
2. In Dry farming, crops are cultivated without irrigation in regions of limited rainfall.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.364.(c) Both 1 and 2. In shifting agriculture, a clearing is made in the forest, usually on the slopes of hills. Dry farming is the cultivation of crops without irrigation in regions of limited moisture, typically less than 20 inches of precipitation annually.

Q.365. The word agriculture is derived from the Latin words ager and culture. What does 'ager' mean?

- (a) Rocks (b) Soil (c) Water (d) Plants

Sol.365.(b) Soil. The English word agriculture derives from the Latin ager (field) and colo (cultivate) signifying, when combined, the Latin agricultura: field or land tillage. Agriculture is the art and science of cultivating the soil, growing crops and raising livestock. It is the backbone of the Indian economy.

Q.366. India lost a large proportion of ____ growing area to Pakistan during partition.

- (a) sunflower (b) jute
(c) soyabean (d) cotton

Sol.366.(d) Cotton is a key fiber and cash crop in India, with Gujarat and Maharashtra as leading producers. The first cotton mill, Bombay Spinning and Weaving Company, was established in Bombay on 7 July 1854. Madhya Pradesh is the largest producer of soybeans, Karnataka of sunflower, and West Bengal of jute.

Q.367. Which of the following is the main food crop of the semi-arid areas of central and southern India?

- (a) Jowar (b) Maize (c) Bajra (d) Ragi

Sol.367.(a) Jowar is mainly concentrated in the peninsular and central India. Karnataka is the highest maize producer.

Rajasthan is the state with the highest yield of bajra in India. Karnataka is the leading producer of ragi in the country followed by Tamil Nadu, Uttarakhand, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh.

Q.368. Which of the following is a well-known variety of coffee initially brought to India from Yemen?

- (a) Gesha (b) Arabica
(c) Canephora (d) Charrieriana

Sol.368.(b) Arabica is grown in Karnataka (Kodagu, Chikkamagaluru, Hassan), Kerala (Malabar region), and Tamil Nadu (Nilgiris, Yercaud, Kodaikanal).

Q.369. Assertion (A): Taramira is a variety of oilseed cultivated mainly in the drier regions of north-western India.

Reason (R): Arabica, Robusta, and Liberica are major varieties of oilseed crops in India.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true, but R is false
(d) A is false, but R is true

Sol.369.(c) A is true, but R is false.

Taramira is an important oilseed crop of drier regions of north-western India. The oil is not directly eaten, although it is mixed with mustard oil to increase the pungency of the latter. Arabica, Robusta, and the less common Liberica and Excelsa are the four main types of coffee beans.

Soil

Q.370. Consider the following characteristics:

1. High moisture-retaining capacity, often developing deep cracks during dry hot weather.
2. Ideal for tea and apple cultivation due to high fertility and cold climate preference.
3. Rich in lime, iron, magnesia, and alumina, but poor in phosphoric contents.

Which of the above characteristics are primarily associated with Black Soils?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 1 and 3
(c) Only 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3 are correct

Sol.370.(b) Only 1 and 3. Black soils, also called Regur soils, have high moisture-retaining capacity due to their clay content, causing swelling when wet and deep cracks when dry. They are rich in lime, iron, magnesia, and alumina but

lack phosphoric acid, nitrogen, and organic matter. These soils are ideal for cotton, sugarcane, jowar, and wheat cultivation. Tea requires well-drained, acidic, loamy soils (like Laterite soil) in humid hilly regions, while apples grow best in loamy soils of colder climates.

Q.371. Which of the following statements correctly differentiates Alluvial soils from Red and Yellow soils? SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Alluvial: from rocks; Red/Yellow: river-transported
(b) Alluvial: older types most fertile; Red/Yellow: colored by iron
(c) Alluvial: sandy loam to clay; Red/Yellow: sandy loam, less fertile uplands
(d) Alluvial: rich in phosphorus and humus; Red/Yellow: rich in potash

Sol.371.(c) Alluvial soils exhibit a wide range of textures from sandy loam to clay, depending on the river's depositional environment. In contrast, Red and Yellow soils, especially in upland regions, are often coarser, such as sandy loam, and are generally less fertile than the nutrient-rich alluvial soils found in river plains.

Q.372. Which of the following agro-climatic and soil conditions is most suitable for the cultivation of wheat? SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Arid crop; temperature above 40°C; sandy loam soil
(b) Subtropical crop; high humidity; laterite soil
(c) Temperate crop; winter temp 10-15°C, summer 21-26°C; clay loam soil
(d) Tropical crop; 30-35°C temperature; sandy soil

Sol.372.(c) Wheat is a rabi crop in India and thrives best under cool winters and warm summers. The ideal climatic and soil conditions are: Temperature: Sowing: around 10-15°C, Ripening/Harvesting: around 21-26°C, Rainfall: Moderate rainfall (75-100 cm), with irrigation support in drier regions. Soil: Well-drained clay loam or alluvial soil, rich in humus, is best for wheat cultivation.

Q.373. Consider the following statements about plateaus:

1. The Deccan Lava Plateau in India is very fertile because it is rich in black soil, which is highly suitable for farming.
2. The African Plateau is famous for its fertile black soil, whereas the Katanga Plateau is primarily known for

agriculture.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.373.(b) Only 2. Deccan lava plateau is a volcanic plateau in west-central India that was formed by the solidification of lava from deep within the Earth. It is a triangular landmass that lies to the south of the river Narmada. The African plateau is famous for gold and diamond mining. The Katanga Plateau in the Democratic Republic of the Congo is known for its rich deposits of copper and uranium.

Q.374. In a laterite soil profile, which of the following elements is present in an excessive amount?

- (a) Iron (b) feldspar (c) Nitrogen (d) Lime

Sol.374.(a) Iron. Laterite soil contains excess iron due to intense leaching in high rainfall and temperature areas. The leaching process removes lime and silica, leaving iron oxide and aluminum compounds. These soils are poor in nitrogen, phosphate, and calcium, making them less fertile naturally. However, after adding manures and fertilizers, they are suitable for tree crops like cashew nuts.

Q.375. Which of the following factors is primarily responsible for soil formation?

- (a) Weathering (b) Irrigation
(c) Degradation (d) Mining

Sol.375.(a) Weathering : It involves the breakdown of rocks and minerals into smaller particles through exposure to environmental factors like wind, water, ice, temperature fluctuations and others. Irrigation : It supports agriculture and affects soil moisture. Degradation : This refers to the deterioration of soil quality. Mining : It can disturb existing soils.

Q.376. Which of the following is the main cause of land degradation in Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh?

- (a) Intensive use of manure
(b) Over-irrigation
(c) Deforestation due to mining
(d) Overgrazing

Sol.376.(c) Deforestation due to mining.

Human activities like deforestation, over-grazing, mining, and quarrying significantly contribute to land degradation. Deforestation due to mining has severely impacted states like Jharkhand and Odisha. Over-grazing affects Gujarat, Rajasthan, and Madhya Pradesh, while excessive irrigation

causes waterlogging and soil degradation in Punjab, Haryana, and western Uttar Pradesh.

Q.377. Which is the largest part of the northern plains and is formed of older alluvium?

- (a) Terai (b) Bhabar
(c) Bhangar (d) Khadar

Sol.377.(c) Bhangar. It is characterized by slightly elevated terraces and is composed of older, more compact sediments compared to the newer and more fertile alluvial deposits found in the Khadar regions. The Bhangar area is less fertile due to the presence of calcareous deposits known as "Kankar."

Q.378. Which unit is used to measure the concentration of contaminants in soil and sediment?

- (a) DPMO (b) TDS (c) PPBB (d) PPM

Sol.378.(d) PPM (Parts per million) is commonly used to express very dilute concentrations of substances in various environmental contexts, including soil and sediment analysis.

Q.379. In which of the following processes nutrients or contaminants are carried away by water or moved into the lower layer of the soil?

- (a) Leaching (b) Bleaching
(c) Sowing (d) Ploughing

Sol.379.(a) Leaching: It occurs as excess water removes water-soluble nutrients out of the soil, by runoff or drainage. It is an environmental problem for agricultural professionals whether chemical-heavy fertilisers or chemicals are swept out and find their way into water bodies.

Q.380. Assertion (A): The black soil of the Deccan Plateau is deficient in phosphorus.

Reason (R): Black soil is rich in iron, lime, calcium, potassium, aluminum, and magnesium but poor in nitrogen and organic matter.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true, but R is false.
(d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.380.(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. Black soil or cotton soil is good for moisture and good for growing cotton, sugarcane, wheat, jawar, rice, citrus fruits, sunflower, linseed, etc. Black soil requires minimum

tillage because of its self-cultivating feature.

Q.381. Laterite soil develops as a result of which of the following reasons?

- (a) Compaction
(b) Leaching
(c) High temperature only
(d) Sedimentation

Sol.381.(b) Leaching - It is used to extract the substances from the solids. Laterite Soil: It develops in areas with high temperature and high rainfall. These are the result of intense leaching due to tropical rains. It is commonly found in Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Madhya Pradesh and the hilly areas of Odisha and Assam. Laterite Soil is most suitable soil for growing coffee in India

Q.382. The black soil area of the _____ is known as the Deccan Trap.

- (a) Northern Plains
(b) Peninsular Plateau
(c) Coastal Plains
(d) Himalayan Mountains

Sol.382.(b) Peninsular Plateau. It is an ancient landmass composed mainly of igneous and metamorphic hard crystalline rocks. It was formed due to the breaking and drifting of Gondwanaland. Deccan Plateau - A triangular landmass that lies to the south of the river Narmada. Black Soil Covers most of the deccan plateau which includes part of Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh and some part of Tamil Nadu.

Q.383. In which of the following states of India is the maximum extent of alluvial soil found?

- (a) Telangana (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Maharashtra

Sol.383.(b) Uttar Pradesh. Alluvial Soil found in northern plains and the river valleys. It is rich in potash but poor in phosphorus. Two types of alluvial soil : Khadar - New alluvium, deposited by floods annually, which enriches the soil by depositing fine silts. Bhangar - Old alluvium, deposited away from the flood plains. Alluvial soils are intensively cultivated.

Q.384. What is the type of soil composed of silt and dust?

- (a) Loam (b) Marl (c) Loess (d) Podsol

Sol.384.(c) Loess. Properties : Colour - Yellowish Brown, Homogeneous and Highly Porous. Mostly Found (India) - Kashmir Valley. Loam - The type of Soil

composed of sand, silt, and clay soil. Marl - The type of soil composed of Clays and Silt. Podsol - The soil derives from either quartz-rich sands and sandstone or sedimentary debris from magmatic rocks.

Q.385. Consider the following statements about soils in India:

1. Red and Yellow soils together cover about 40% of the total area of India.
2. Black soil, also called Regur soil, is suitable for cotton cultivation.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.385.(a) Only 1. Alluvial soil is found on about 40% of the total area of India. It is deposited by surface water, commonly found in river valleys and northern plains. It is highly fertile and rich in humus and lime. Crops cultivated on it include sugarcane, rice, maize, wheat, oilseeds, and pulses.

Q.386. The colour of the alluvial soils varies from _____.

- (a) pale white to warm white
(b) light orange to dark orange
(c) orange to red
(d) light grey to ash grey

Sol.386.(d) light grey to ash grey. Alluvial soils are formed by the deposition of sediments from rivers and streams. These sediments are typically composed of sand, silt, and clay, which are all light-coloured materials. The colour of the alluvial soils can also be affected by the presence of organic matter, which can give them a darker colour. Light orange to dark orange is the colour of laterite soils. Orange to red is the colour of red soils.

Q.387. Which of the following is an example of micronutrient supplied by soil?

- (a) Potassium (b) Iron
(c) Calcium (d) Sulphur

Sol.387.(b) Iron. Soil is a major source of nutrients needed by plants for growth. Macronutrients in soil - Nitrogen (N), Phosphorus (P), Potassium (K), Calcium (Ca), Magnesium (Mg) and Sulphur (S). Micronutrients in soil - Chlorine (Cl), Boron (B), Iron (Fe), Manganese (Mn), Copper (Cu), Zinc (Zn), Nickel (Ni) and Molybdenum (Mo).

Q.388. Which of the following statements is NOT correct regarding fertilizers?

- (a) They are prepared in factories
(b) They are very rich in plant nutrients

- (c) They provide humus to the soil
(d) They are man-made inorganic salt

Sol.388.(c) Humus is the organic component of soil that is formed by the decomposition of plant and animal matter. It can be produced naturally or through a process called composting. Manures are used to provide humus in soil.

Q.389. Arid soils are characteristically developed in _____, which exhibit characteristic arid topography.

- (a) Southern Uttar Pradesh
(b) Western Uttar Pradesh
(c) Western Rajasthan
(d) Southern Rajasthan

Sol.389.(c) Western Rajasthan. In India, the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) has classified soils into 8 categories. They are: Alluvial Soil, Black Cotton Soil, Red & Yellow Soil, Laterite Soil, Mountainous or Forest Soil, Arid or Desert Soil, Saline and Alkaline Soil, Peaty and Marshy Soil.

Q.390. Which of the following pairs of 'soil - characteristics' is correct?

- I. Sandy - proportion of fine particles is relatively higher
II. Clayey - greater proportion of big particles
(a) Only I (b) Neither I nor II
(c) Both I and II (d) Only II

Sol.390.(b) Neither I nor II. Sandy Soil : Consists of small particles of weathered rock; One of the poorest types of soil for growing plants (very low nutrients and poor water holding capacity); Good for the drainage system; Usually formed by the breakdown or fragmentation of rocks like granite, limestone and quartz. Clay Soil : Smallest particles (tightly packed together with each other with very little or no airspace); Good water storage qualities; Very sticky to touch when wet but smooth when dried; Densest and heaviest type of soil which does not drain well or provide space for plant roots to flourish.

Q.391. Which of the following factors of soil formation determines the accumulation of the soil ?

- (a) Fauna (b) Flora
(c) Relief (d) Parent rock

Sol.391.(c) Relief: Altitude and slope, determine accumulation of soil. Other Factors: Fauna is all of the animal life present in a particular region or time. Flora is all the plant life present in a

particular region or time, generally the naturally occurring native plants.

Q.392. Statement I: In terrace farming, different crops are grown in alternate rows and are sown at different times to protect the soil from rain wash.

Statement II: In contour ploughing, different crops are grown in alternate rows and are sown at different times to protect the soil from rain wash.

- (a) Only Statement I is correct
(b) Only Statement II is correct
(c) Both Statements I and II are correct
(d) Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct

Sol.392.(d) Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct. Intercropping crops are grown in alternate rows and are sown at different times to protect the soil from rain wash. Contour ploughing - Process of cutting furrows into the slope of the land in order to control the flow of water.

Q.393. In which of the soil conservation methods in the coastal and dry regions, rows of trees are planted to check the wind movement to protect soil cover?

- (a) Mulching (b) Shelter belts
(c) Rock dam (d) Contour barriers

Sol.393.(b) Shelterbelts. Mulching: The bare ground between plants is covered with a layer of organic matter like straw. It helps to retain soil moisture. Contour barriers: Stones, grass, soil are used to build barriers along contours. Trenches are made in front of the barriers to collect water.

Q.394. Identify the step that is NOT a part of decomposition.

- (a) Leaching (b) Humification
(c) Catabolism (d) Soil erosion

Sol.394.(d) Soil erosion is the denudation or wearing away of the upper layer of soil. It is a form of soil degradation. There are five steps of decomposition. These are fragmentation, leaching, catabolism, humification, and mineralization.

Q.395. Statement I: Climate, parent material, and topography are important factors that influence soil formation.

Statement II: Landslides are a major factor responsible for soil formation.

- (a) Only Statement I is correct
(b) Only Statement II is correct
(c) Both Statements I and II are correct
(d) Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct

Sol.395.(a) Only Statement I is correct.

Soil formation is influenced mainly by climate, parent material, topography, organisms, and time; landslides do not affect soil formation directly.

Q.396. What do you call the weight a soil can withstand before severe damage occurs to the structure of the soil?

- (a) Field capacity (b) Bearing capacity
(c) Bulk density (d) Buffering capacity

Sol.396.(b) Bearing capacity is the capacity of soil to support the loads that are applied to the ground above. Field capacity is the amount of soil moisture or water content held in the soil after excess water has drained away and the rate of downward movement has decreased. Bulk density is defined as the mass of the many particles of the material divided by the total volume they occupy. Buffer capacity refers to the amount of acid or base a buffer can neutralise before the pH changes by a large amount.

Q.397. _____ develops on crystalline igneous rocks in areas of low rainfall in the eastern and southern part of the Deccan Plateau.

- (a) Red soil (b) Black soil
(c) Alluvial soil (d) Arid soil

Sol.397.(a) Red soil. It contains a high percentage of iron content, which is responsible for its colour.

Q.398. Consider the following statements regarding soil horizons:

Statement I: The A-horizon, also called the topsoil, contains humus and is rich in organic materials.

Statement II: The C-horizon is also called humus layer and is rich in organic matter. Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.398.(a) Only I. A-horizon layer is the top layer of soil which is also known as a humus layer and is mainly rich in organic materials. B-horizon is typically a mineral subsurface horizon and is a zone of accumulation, called illuviation. C-horizon : This soil layer lies beneath the B horizon and consists essentially of the more or less weathered parent rock. Bedrock: Bedrock in geology is a solid rock that lies under loose softer material within the crust of Earth or another terrestrial planet.

Q.399. _____ are thick deposits of glacial

clay and other materials embedded with moraines.

- (a) Karewas (b) Bhabars
(c) Duars (d) Duns

Sol.399.(a) Karewas are **lacustrine deposits** (deposits in a lake) in the valley of Kashmir and in the Bhaderwah valley of the Jammu division of Jammu and Kashmir. These are the flat-topped mounds that border the Kashmir valley on all sides.

Q.400. _____ is a deep red soil found in tropical regions and often developed on mafic igneous bedrock.

- (a) Arid (b) Pedocal
(c) Laterite (d) Saline

Sol.400.(c) Laterite. Arid soils are formed from the fragmentation of adjacent rocks and are largely blown from the Indus valley area and coastal regions. Saline soils are formed whenever climate, soil, and hydrological conditions favor the accumulation of soluble salts in the root zone.

Q.401. Consider the following statements:

Statement I: Diastrophism is the process that moves, elevates or builds up portions of the Earth's crust.

Statement II: Weathering is the process of molten rock (magma) erupting onto the Earth's surface.

Which of the following is correct?

- (a) Both Statement I and II are correct
(b) Both Statement I and II are incorrect
(c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is incorrect
(d) Statement I is incorrect but Statement II is correct

Sol.401.(c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is incorrect. Denudation is the process of wearing away the Earth's surface by weathering and erosion. Volcanism is the process of molten rock (magma) erupting onto the Earth's surface.

Vegetation

Q.402. Name the state in which The Bhitarkanika Mangroves are located?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Odisha (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) West Bengal

Sol.402.(a) Odisha. The Bhitarkanika Mangroves ecosystem is one of the largest in India and is situated in the Kendrapara district. It is known for its rich biodiversity, including saltwater crocodiles, migratory birds, and

mangrove forests. The area is protected as the Bhitarkanika National Park and is recognized for its ecological importance.

Q.403. The Ebony, Mahogany, Cinchona etc. are trees found in which type of forests in India?

- (a) Tropical Deciduous Forests
(b) Thorny Forests
(c) Mangrove Forests
(d) Tropical Evergreen Forests

Sol.403.(d) Tropical Evergreen Forests are restricted to heavy rainfall areas of the Western Ghats and the island groups of Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar, upper parts of Assam and Tamil Nadu coast. Other trees are rosewood, and rubber. Tropical Deciduous Forests - Teak, Bamboos, sal, shisham. Thorny Forests - Acacias, palms, euphorbias and cacti. Mangrove Forests - Sundari trees, Palm, Coconut.

Q.404. Consider the following statements regarding forests in India:

Statement I: Magnolia and Laurel trees are typically found in Montane forests of India.

Statement II: Montane forests show variation with altitude, including evergreen broad-leaf trees between 1000–2000 meters and coniferous trees between 1500–3000 meters.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.404.(c) Both I and II. In mountainous areas, temperature decreases with altitude, leading to a change in vegetation. Between 1000–2000 meters, wet temperate forests with evergreen broad-leaf trees like oaks and chestnuts are found. Between 1500–3000 meters, coniferous trees such as pine, deodar, and cedar dominate, mainly on the southern slopes of the Himalayas. Higher elevations feature temperate grasslands, and above 3600 meters, alpine vegetation takes over with trees like silver fir, junipers, and pines.

Q.405. _____ leaves are used to make bidis.

- (a) Neem (b) Champa (c) Betel (d) Tendu

Sol.405.(d) Tendu tree (Diospyros melanoxylon Roxb.) belonging to Family Ebenaceae.

Q.406. Sundari trees are found in which type of forests in India?

- (a) Mangrove forests
(b) Tropical deciduous forests

- (c) The thorn forests and scrubs
(d) Tropical evergreen forests

Sol.406.(a) Mangrove forests. Sundari tree is the most abundant tree in the mangrove forests of the Sunderban delta in West Bengal and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. The Sunderbans are named after the Sundari tree. Mangrove forests grow only at tropical and subtropical latitudes near the equator because they cannot withstand freezing temperatures. Uppu ponna, Boddu ponna, Urada, Mada, Telli Mada, Gundu mada, Kadili, Palm, coconut, keora, agar and Bella are some of the typical vegetation of the mangroves.

Q.407. Which of the following states has mangrove forests?

- (a) Telangana (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Rajasthan (d) Manipur

Sol.407.(b) Andhra Pradesh. Mangroves are practically evergreen with thick leathery leaves. Such types of forests are found in the deltas of Sundarbans, Mahanadi, the Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri rivers and in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Q.408. In which of the following regions is the tropical evergreen forests found in India?

- (a) Eastern Ghats (b) Western Ghats
(c) Rann of Kutch (d) Thar Desert

Sol.408.(b) Western Ghats. Tropical evergreen forests are found on the western slopes of the Western Ghats, northeastern hills, and Andaman and Nicobar Islands. They thrive in warm, humid areas with over 200 cm of annual rainfall and temperatures above 22°C. These forests are dense, with tall trees reaching up to 60 meters and remain green year-round. Common species include rosewood, mahogany, and ebony.

Q.409. In which of the following parts of India are thorn forests and scrub forests found?

- (a) South-eastern India
(b) North-eastern India
(c) North-western India
(d) South-western India

Sol.409.(c) North-western India. Thorn and scrub forests are a type of natural vegetation found in regions that receive less than 70 cm of annual rainfall. These regions typically experience dry and arid climatic conditions, and the vegetation here has adapted to conserve water and withstand harsh environments. It is found in parts of northwestern India,

central Deccan Plateau, and parts of the Thar Desert. The main plant species include Acacia (Babool), Cactus, Euphorbias, and Palms.

Q.410. Which of the following statements is NOT true about the moist deciduous forests of India?

- (a) They grow in regions with rainfall of 100-200 cm.
- (b) They are found in the foothills of Himalayas.
- (c) They are found in the plains of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.
- (d) Sal, amla, shisham and mahua are some of the main species of these forests.

Sol.410.(c) Moist deciduous forests exist mostly in the eastern part of the country – northeastern states, along the foothills of the Himalayas, Jharkhand, West Odisha and Chhattisgarh, and on the eastern slopes of the Western Ghats. The dry deciduous forests are found in areas having rainfall between 100 cm and 70 cm. These forests are found in the rainier parts of the Peninsular plateau and the plains of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.

Q.411. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: Deciduous forests are found on the foothills of the Himalayas.

Statement 2: Alpine forests occur at altitudes between 2,900 to 3,500 m in the Himalayas.

- (a) Only Statement 1 is correct
- (b) Only Statement 2 is correct
- (c) Both Statement 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither Statement 1 nor 2 is correct

Sol.411.(c) Both Statement 1 and 2 are correct. Deciduous is an evergreen forest where a majority of the trees remain "green" throughout the year because they shed leaves not seasonally but at various periods of the year. Example - Maple, oak, and elm. Alpine forests : Example - Spruce and birch.

Q.412. In the Himalayas, the _____ temperature with increasing altitude causes the change in vegetation.

- (a) increasing (b) decreasing
- (c) fluctuating (d) stable

Sol.412.(b) decreasing. The Himalayan ranges show change in vegetation from tropical to tundra. Since air is less dense at higher altitudes, its molecules are spread farther apart than they are at sea level. These molecules have fewer collisions, so they produce less heat. At the bottom of the mountain, the

temperature is high year-round while it is much cooler at the top due to which it is covered with snow.

Q.413. Which one of the following statements regarding vegetation strata is NOT correct?

- (a) Trees fall under the Top vertical strata.
- (b) The Second vertical contains shrubs and small trees.
- (c) The Bottom vertical contains medium-sized shrubs and trees.
- (d) The Middle vertical includes medium-sized shrubs and trees.

Sol.413.(c) Bottom vertical - It contains the shortest plants in a forest ecosystem, such as mosses and ferns.

Q.414. The natural vegetation of India is broadly divided into _____ groups.

- (a) 7 (b) 9 (c) 6 (d) 5

Sol.414.(d) 5. Vegetation of India – Tropical evergreen forest, Tropical deciduous forest, Thorny bushes, Mountain vegetation and Mangrove forests.

Q.415. In which type of forests are wild donkeys and camels found in India?

- (a) Tropical evergreen forest
- (b) Mountain forest
- (c) Thorny forests and bushes
- (d) Mangrove forest

Sol.415.(c) Thorny forests and bushes.

Animals found in different forests in India: Tropical Evergreen Forests - Elephants, Monkeys, Lemurs and Deer. Montane Forests - Leopard, Yak, Sheep and Goat. Mangrove forest - Royal Bengal Tiger. In terms of area, Madhya Pradesh has the largest forest area in the country. It is followed by Arunachal Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha and Maharashtra.

Q.416. Sal, acacia and bamboo, which are types of Dry Tropical Forest, receive what amount of annual rainfall?

- (a) From 51 cm to 151 cm
- (b) Between 200 and 250 cm
- (c) 251 cm or more
- (d) Below 25 cm

Sol.416.(a) From 51 cm to 151 cm. Tropical forests (rainforests): A rainforest is an area of tall, mostly evergreen trees and a high amount of rainfall, Earth's oldest living ecosystems, with some surviving in their present form for at least 70 million years. **Types of Tropical forests** - Evergreen Rain (200 cm or more), Monsoon Deciduous (100 to 200 cm), Tropical Savanna (50 to 100

cm), Dry Thorny Scrub (Semi-arid) (25 to 50 cm), Desert (Arid) (Below 25 cm).

Q.417. Which of the following is the most widespread forest type in India?

- (a) Littoral and Swamp Forest
- (b) Tropical Thorn Forests
- (c) Montane Forests
- (d) Tropical Deciduous Forests

Sol.417.(d) Tropical Deciduous Forests (Monsoon Forests): It Found in India along the Equator belt between the tropic of Cancer and the tropic of Capricorn, (Major states - Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Some Parts of Maharashtra).

Q.418. What type of vegetation is found in the plateau of Meghalaya, Sahyadri and the central and southern islands of the Nicobar group?

- (a) Dry Tropical Deciduous Vegetation
- (b) Dry Tropical Thorny Vegetation
- (c) Alpine Vegetation
- (d) Moist Tropical Semi - Evergreen Vegetation

Sol.418.(d) Moist Tropical Semi - Evergreen Vegetation are transitional forests between tropical wet evergreen forests and tropical deciduous forests. Examples - Laurel, rosewood, mesua, white cedar. Tropical Dry Deciduous Vegetation - Occurs in an irregular wide strip running from the foot of the Himalayas to Kanyakumari except in Rajasthan, Western Ghats and West Bengal. Example - Teak, bamboo. Tropical Thorn Forests - Found in Rajasthan, south-western Punjab, western Haryana, Kachchh and neighbouring parts of Saurashtra. Example - Babool, neem, cactii.

Q.419. Plant varieties like bamboo, epiphytes, aini, semul, gutel and mundane are found in which type of Indian forest?

- (a) Alpine forest
- (b) Montane temperate forest
- (c) Moist tropical forest
- (d) Dry tropical forest

Sol.419.(c) Moist tropical forests have 200-250 cm annual rainfall, 24-27°C temperature. **Alpine forest** - Common in both the main Himalayan regions as well as the barren cold deserts of the Trans Himalaya. Examples - Black juniper and willow. **Montane temperate forest** - Mainly generated in Northern middle Himalayas ranges (1801 to 3001 m) and Southern Niligiri higher Mountain ranges. Examples - Ferns, oak and maple. **Dry tropical forest** - Mainly found in Indian

Northern Hilly regions and some states of Southern India. Examples - Sal, acacia, mangoes.

Q.420. Which of the following states is associated with the tropical thorn forests?

- (a) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- (b) West Bengal
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Mizoram

Sol.420.(c) Madhya Pradesh. Tropical Thorn Forests and Scrubs (receive rainfall less than 50 cm) - It includes semi - arid areas of south west Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. Trees like - Babool, ber, wild date palm, Khair tree.

Q.421. Mosses and lichens are found in which kind of forest?

- (a) Tropical Rainforest
- (b) Temperate Forest
- (c) Coniferous Forest
- (d) Tundra Forest

Sol.421.(d) Tundra Forest - It has relatively little rain and extremely cold temperatures. It is composed of dwarf shrubs, sedges, and grasses.

Q.422. Major plantations are found in the _____ region of the world.

- (a) Tropical
- (b) Grassland
- (c) Temperate
- (d) Desert

Sol.422.(a) Tropical. Plantation crops - A type of commercial farming where a single crop of tea, coffee, sugarcane, cashew, rubber, banana or cotton are grown. Major plantations - Rubber in Malaysia, coffee in Brazil, tea in India and Sri Lanka. Major food crops - Wheat, rice, maize and millets. Jute and cotton are fibre crops.

Q.423. Which of the following is an example of a terrestrial ecosystem?

- (a) Ponds
- (b) River
- (c) Grasslands
- (d) Oceans

Sol.423.(c) Grasslands. Terrestrial ecosystem - It is a land-based community of species that includes biotic and abiotic interactions in a specific area. Examples - Forest, Grasslands, Tundra, Desert. Aquatic ecosystem - It is related to water. It includes Freshwater ecosystem (Pond, lake, river) and Marine ecosystem (Ocean, sea or estuary). Kelp is a type of large, brown seaweed that grows in shallow, nutrient-rich saltwater near coastal fronts around the world.

Q.424. Which of the following

statements is incorrect?

Statement 1: Taiga forests are found in the higher latitudes (50°–70°) of the Northern Hemisphere and are mainly coniferous.

Statement 2: Tundra forests are coniferous and found in the higher latitudes of the Northern Hemisphere.

- (a) Only Statement 1 is incorrect
- (b) Only Statement 2 is incorrect
- (c) Both statements are incorrect
- (d) Neither statement is incorrect

Sol.424.(b) Only Statement 2 is incorrect. Taiga - Trees found are mainly cone-bearing trees like spruce, pine, fir, and hemlock. Veld - Open, uncultivated country or grassland in southern Africa. Tundra - A vast, flat, treeless Arctic region of Europe, Asia, and North America in which the subsoil is permanently frozen. Llanos - A vast tropical grassland plain situated to the east of the Andes in Colombia and Venezuela, in northwestern South America.

Q.425. In India, trees of which forest type shed their leaves for about six to eight weeks in dry summer?

- (a) Tropical Deciduous Forests
- (b) Tropical Evergreen Forests
- (c) Montane Forests
- (d) Tropical Thorn Forests and Scrubs

Sol.425.(a) Tropical Deciduous Forests.

These forests spread over regions which receive rainfall between 70-200 cm. Tendu, palas, amaltas, bel, khair, axlewood, etc are the common trees of these forests.

Q.426. In India, what is the mean annual average temperature in subtropical vegetation zone ?

- (a) Above 24° C
- (b) 7°C to 17°C
- (c) Below 7°C
- (d) 17°C to 24°C

Sol.426.(d) 17°C to 24°C. Natural vegetation - The plant life that grows in an area without the influence of human activity. Types - Forests, Grasslands (divided into savannas, steppes and prairies, depending on the climate and other environmental factors), Deserts (These are arid regions with very little rainfall and sparse vegetation), Tundra (This is a cold, treeless region found in the Arctic and on high mountain slopes), Wetland (These are areas with water-logged soil, such as marshes).

Q.427. Which of the following pairs of countries - name of grassland is correct?
I. Argentina - Pampas, II. Brazil - Steppe
(a) Neither I nor II (b) Only II

- (c) Only I
- (d) Both I and II

Sol.427.(c) Only I. Steppe - Europe and North Asia, Brazil - Campos, Pustaz-Hungary, Prairies - USA, Veld - South Africa, Downs - Australia, Canterbury - New Zealand, Savannah - Africa, Taiga - Europe and Asia.

Q.428. The wet temperate type of forests are found between a height of _____ metres.

- (a) 2000 and 3000
- (b) 1500 and 3000
- (c) 1000 and 2000
- (d) 500 to 1000

Sol.428.(c) 1000 and 2000. Wet temperate forests: Average annual rainfall and temperature in wet temperate forests are 150-300 cm and 11°C-14°C respectively. The relative humidity is over 80% on average. Oak trees and chestnut trees are found here. Other important species include Chilauni, Indian chestnut, Deodar, Machilus, Cinnamomum, Litsea, Plum, Blue pine, Birch, Oak, Hemlock, etc.

Q.429. Thorny bushes are found in _____ region.

- (a) mediterranean
- (b) polar
- (c) dry desert
- (d) high rainfall

Sol.429.(c) dry desert. In areas where there is less than 70 cm of rainfall, thorn forests and shrubs are found in the natural vegetation. This type of vegetation is found in the north-western parts of the country, which include the semi-arid regions of Gujarat, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana.

Q.430. Consider the following statements about forests:

Statement I: Temperate evergreen forests are mainly located in the mid-latitudinal coastal regions such as southeastern USA, southern China, and southeastern Brazil.

Statement II: Tropical rainforests are mainly located in the mid-latitudinal coastal regions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.430.(a) Only I. Temperate evergreen forests are mainly located in the mid-latitudinal coastal regions. Tropical rainforests are mainly located in the tropics, between the latitudes of 23.5°N (the Tropic of Cancer) and 23.5°S (the Tropic of Capricorn)—the tropics.

Q.431. The birds like pheasant and monals are found in which type of forest?

- (a) Temperate deciduous forest
- (b) Tropical evergreen forest
- (c) Temperate evergreen forest
- (d) Mediterranean forests

Sol.431.(a) Temperate deciduous forest.

As we go towards higher latitudes, there are more temperate deciduous forests. These are found in the north eastern part of the USA, China, New Zealand, Chile and also found in the coastal regions of Western Europe. They shed their leaves in the dry season. Common trees include oak, ash, and beech. Animals commonly found in these forests are deer, foxes, and wolves.

Q.432. A species of grass named _____ is on the verge of extinction due to its insensitivity towards the environment.

- (a) Helianthus annuus
- (b) Saccharum officinarum
- (c) Hubbardia heptaneuron
- (d) Bellis perennis

Sol.432.(c) Hubbardia heptaneuron. The native range of this species is India (Karnataka). It is an annual and grows primarily in the seasonally dry tropical biome. Helianthus annuus (Common Sunflower).

Q.433. What type of forests are found north and south of the equator between 40° and 60° where rainfall is high, between 500-1500 mm in a year?

- (a) Taiga forests
- (b) Coniferous forests
- (c) Mediterranean forests
- (d) Temperate deciduous forests

Sol.433.(d)

Temperate deciduous forests.

Q.434. Which type of biome is located in Eastern North America, Western Europe, and Northeast Asia?

- (a) Tropical Rainforest Biomes
- (b) Coniferous Forest Biomes
- (c) Aquatic Biomes
- (d) Deciduous Forest Biomes

Sol.434.(d) Deciduous Forest Biomes -

This biome experiences all four seasons, these forests are divided into **five zones** based on the heights of the trees. The soil is particularly fertile and nutrient-rich and is located in North America (Canada, the United States, and Mexico), Europe, and western regions of Asia (Japan, China, North Korea, South Korea, and parts of Russia).

Q.435. Consider the following statements regarding Social Forestry in India:

Statement I: The National Commission

on Agriculture (1976) classified Social Forestry into 5 categories.

Statement II: The motto of the social forestry is good management and protection of the forest with the development of the environment.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.435.(a) Only I. The National Commission on Agriculture (1976) classified Social Forestry into 3 categories - Urban forestry, Rural forestry and Farm forestry. Social forestry means the management and protection of forests and afforestation on barren lands with the purpose of helping in the environmental, social and rural development.

Q.436. Which of the following statements about forests is INCORRECT?

- (a) In a forest, trees form the uppermost layer of vegetation.
- (b) Forests protect the soil from erosion.
- (c) In a forest, shrubs form the lowest layer of vegetation.
- (d) Forests influence climate, water cycle and air quality.

Sol.436.(c) The layer of vegetation in the forest which is just below the shrub layer is called the herb layer. The herb layer consists mainly of herbs, ferns and grasses. This layer is the lowest layer of vegetation in the forest (having leafy plants). Very little sunlight remains for the plants in the herb layer.

Q.437. Coringa is a beautiful _____ forest where the Godavari joins the backwaters of Bay of Bengal.

- (a) evergreen
- (b) coniferous
- (c) mangrove
- (d) deciduous

Sol.437.(c) Mangrove. Coringa is the second largest mangrove formation in India, next to Sundarbans. The Coringa mangroves are bordered on the northern side by Kakinada Bay.

Q.438. Which of the following trees will you find in the Littoral forests?

- (a) Chinara
- (b) Ebony
- (c) Sundari
- (d) Cypress

Sol.438.(c) Sundari tree is found in Sundarbans delta in West Bengal in Mangrove forest (Littoral forests).

Climate

Q.439. Which of the following is NOT a primary factor affecting the variation of

insolation on Earth?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Presence of water bodies in an area
- (b) Rotation of the Earth on its axis
- (c) Transparency of the atmosphere
- (d) Angle of inclination of the Sun's rays

Sol.439.(a) Presence of water bodies in an area.

Insolation refers to the incoming solar radiation received on Earth's surface. Its primary variation depends on factors like the rotation of the Earth on its axis, which causes day and night; the angle of inclination of the Sun's rays, which changes with latitude and seasons; and the transparency of the atmosphere, which determines how much radiation penetrates through clouds, dust, and gases. The presence of water bodies, however, influences the distribution and moderation of temperature rather than the actual amount of insolation received.

Q.440. The highest rainfall in India gets recorded in the Khasi and Jaintia Hills. In which state will you find these hills?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Meghalaya
- (b) Nagaland
- (c) Arunachal Pradesh
- (d) Assam

Sol.440.(a) Meghalaya. The Khasi and Jaintia Hills are part of the Garo-Khasi-Jaintia range, which forms the central and eastern parts of the state of Meghalaya. These hills are renowned for receiving some of the highest rainfall in the world. Their unique funnel-like topography traps the moisture-laden winds from the Bay of Bengal branch of the Southwest Monsoon, forcing them to rise and shed their moisture as extremely heavy orographic rainfall. Mawsynram and Cherrapunji (Sohra), the two wettest places on Earth, are located in the Khasi Hills.

Q.441. Tropical cyclones originate over which of the following regions?

- (a) Bay of Bengal, Arabian Sea and the Indian Ocean
- (b) Mediterranean Sea, Pacific Ocean and the Indian Ocean
- (c) Bay of Bengal, Arabian Sea and the Atlantic Ocean
- (d) Mediterranean Sea, Arabian Sea and the Indian Ocean

Sol.441.(a) A tropical cyclone is formed over warm ocean waters near the equator. The centre of a cyclone is very calm and clear with very low air pressure. The average speed is 120 kmph. They move from east to west under the influence of trade winds.

Q.442. Which of the following statements regarding orographic rainfall is correct?

- (a) It occurs mainly during summer and is common over equatorial doldrums in the Congo basin.
- (b) This type of precipitation occurs when warm, humid air strikes on a mountain range.
- (c) This precipitation is heavy but of short duration, highly localised and is associated with minimum amount of cloudiness.
- (d) This type of precipitation is characterised by seasonal reversal of winds that carry oceanic moisture.

Sol.442.(b) Orographic rainfall occurs when moist air hits a mountain and is forced to rise. As the air ascends, it cools, leading to condensation and saturation. The excess moisture then falls as precipitation on the windward slopes.

Q.443. The climatic diversity of India is characterised by its distinctiveness, and one of the following factors does NOT contribute to it is _____.

- (a) longitudinal extent
- (b) latitudinal extent
- (c) topography
- (d) vegetation

Sol.443.(b) The latitudinal extent influences temperature and rainfall patterns due to variations in solar energy and atmospheric density. However, it is not a major factor contributing to India's climatic diversity compared to longitudinal extent, topography, and vegetation.

Q.444. Which state lies in the rain shadow region of the Arabian Sea branch of the southwest monsoon?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Goa
- (d) Kerala

Sol.444.(a) Tamil Nadu. The Bay of Bengal monsoon branch strikes Myanmar and southeast Bangladesh, but the Arakan Hills deflect much of it towards India. It enters West Bengal and Bangladesh from the south - southeast, splitting into two branches. One moves westward along the Ganga plains to the Punjab plains, while the other ascends the Brahmaputra valley, causing rains in the northeast. A sub-branch hits Meghalaya's Khasi hills. The Tamil Nadu coast remains dry as it lies parallel to the Bay of Bengal monsoon branch and in the rain-shadow region of the Arabian Sea branch.

Q.445. Match the following hot winds with their respective regions:

List I (Hot Winds)	List II (Regions)
a. Loo	i. North Africa & South Europe
b. Chinook	ii. North and Northwestern India
c. Sirocco	iii. Guinea Coast
d. Harmattan	iv. USA (Rocky Mountain region)

- (a) a - ii, b - iv, c - i, d - iii
- (b) a - iii, b - ii, c - i, d - iv
- (c) a - ii, b - i, c - iv, d - iii
- (d) a - iv, b - iii, c - ii, d - i

Sol.445.(A) a - ii, b - iv, c - i, d - iii. Loo - These are strong, gusty, hot, dry winds blowing during the day over the north and northwestern India. In West Bengal, similar storms are known as 'Kaal Baisakhi'. They blow in the summer season. Other hot winds - Foehn (Europe), Santa Ana (USA), Harmattan (Guinea coast), Khamsin (Egypt).

Q.446. The climate of a place is NOT affected by which of the following?

- (a) Relief
- (b) Type of soil
- (c) Location
- (d) Distance from the sea

Sol.446.(b) Type of soil. Climate refers to the long-term conditions of a specific region. The changes in climate within a region are influenced by its atmospheric and environmental conditions. The six major factors that influence the climate of a location are latitude, altitude, pressure, and wind systems, distance from the sea (continentality), ocean currents, and relief features.

Q.447. Which region in India receives less rainfall in summer, but heavy rainfall in winter season due to the retreating north easterly winds?

- (a) Southern coastal region
- (b) Western coastal region
- (c) Northern coastal region
- (d) Eastern coastal region

Sol.447.(d) Eastern coastal region stretches from West Bengal in the north to Tamil Nadu in the south and passes through Andhra Pradesh and Odisha. The retreating or North-East monsoon brings heavy rainfall to the Coromandel coast from October to December. This monsoon, blowing from land to sea, gathers moisture and causes rain, making it the primary rainy season for southeastern India, including Tamil Nadu. The Coromandel coast lies between Pulicat Lake and Kanyakumari.

Q.448. Consider the following statements regarding pre-monsoon rains

in India:

Statement I: Mango showers are pre-monsoon rains that occur in Kerala, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu.

Statement II: Kalbaisakhi, also known as Nor'westers, are violent thunderstorms occurring during summer in West Bengal and Assam.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.448.(c) Both I and II. Mango showers are pre-monsoon rains that occur at the end of the summer season, helping the mangoes ripen; These are also called April rains.

Q.449. The tropical cyclones in Australia are known as _____.

- (a) hurricanes
- (b) willy-willies
- (c) cyclones
- (d) typhoons

Sol.449.(b) willy-willies. Tropical cyclones are intense low-pressure areas that form in the atmosphere between 30° N and 30° S latitudes. They can extend up to 1,000 km horizontally and 12-14 km vertically from the surface. Tropical cyclones rotate counterclockwise in the Northern Hemisphere and clockwise in the Southern Hemisphere. Their names in different countries : Hurricanes - United States, Typhoons - China Sea and Pacific Ocean, Cyclones - Indian Ocean.

Q.450. What is the duration of monsoon in India?

- (a) 100-120 days
- (b) 40-60 days
- (c) 150-200 days
- (d) 50-80 days

Sol.450.(a) 100-120 days. The monsoon season in India lasts from June to September. The southwest monsoon (summer monsoon) brings the majority of annual rainfall, blowing from the sea to land across the Indian Ocean, Arabian Sea, and Bay of Bengal. In contrast, the northeast monsoon (winter monsoon) blows from land to sea.

Q.451. Which of the following group of months is the coldest in North India?

- (a) February and March
- (b) September and October
- (c) December and January
- (d) October and November

Sol.451.(c) In December and January, temperatures decrease from south to north, with the Northern Plains averaging 10°C to 15°C, while Chennai on the eastern coast sees averages of 24°C to 25°C. Days are warm, and nights are cold during this period.

Q.452. Which of the following parts of the mountain will receive the most rainfall from moisture-laden winds?

- (a) Windward side (b) Leeward side
(c) Upward side (d) Relief side

Sol.452.(a) Windward side - The on-shore moisture laden winds are forced to rise after striking against the mountains and give heavy rainfall on the windward side. Leeward side - It receives little to no rainfall and is known as the rain shadow area. Orographic rainfall occurs when saturated air mass comes across a mountain.

Q.453. Which theory describes the collective effects of changes in Earth's movements on its climate over thousands of years?

- (a) Milankovitch theory
(b) Copernicus' heliocentric theory
(c) Plate tectonics theory
(d) Continental drift theory

Sol.453.(a) Milankovitch theory.

Copernican heliocentrism, proposed by Copernicus in 1543, positions the Sun at the center, with Earth and other planets orbiting it. Plate tectonics is a scientific theory that explains how major landforms are created as a result of Earth's subterranean movements.

Q.454. Which of the following groups of places in India has little differences in day and night temperatures?

- (a) Chennai and Thiruvananthapuram
(b) Jaipur and Jaisalmer
(c) Bhopal and Indore
(d) Jammu and Kashmir

Sol.454.(a) Chennai and Thiruvananthapuram. Thar desert experiences the highest diurnal range of temperature. This is because of the fact that sand (found in ample quantity in this region) gains and loses heat very quickly. As a result of this phenomenon, there is a wide difference between day and night temperatures in this region. The day temperature may rise to 50°C and drop down to near 15°C the same night. There is no sea closer to this area and hence there is no moderating effect.

Q.455. Which of the following statements about climate is INCORRECT?

- (a) India's climate has characteristics of tropical as well as subtropical climates.
(b) Coastal areas of India experience less contrasts in temperature conditions as compared to the interior of the country.

(c) 'Monsoon' type of climate is found mainly in south and southeast Asia.

(d) India experiences comparatively stronger winters as compared to central Asia.

Sol.455.(d) Central Asia generally experiences stronger winters compared to India due to its continental location and lack of moderating influences like large bodies of water. The Climate of India is the tropical monsoon climate type with regional variations in temperature, precipitation, and amount of rainfall because of the large geographical area.

Q.456. Western disturbances are responsible for:

- (a) dusty storms in eastern coastal area of India
(b) hot winds during summers in northern India
(c) extremely chilled weather of north-east India
(d) rainfall during winters in north-western part of India

Sol.456.(d) The western cyclonic disturbances which enter the Indian subcontinent from the west and the northwest during the winter months, originate over the Mediterranean Sea and are brought into India by the westerly jet stream.

Q.457. According to Koeppen's Scheme of classification of climate, which of the following characteristics is associated with 'Group E'?

- (a) The average temperature of the coldest month is -3°C or below
(b) The average temperature for all months is below 10°C
(c) The average temperature of the coldest month is higher than -3°C but below 18°C
(d) The average temperature of the coldest month is 18°C or higher

Sol.457.(b) Climatic Groups According to Koeppen: A - Tropical: Average temperature of the coldest month is 18°C or higher. B - Dry Climates: Potential evaporation exceeds precipitation. C - Warm Temperate: The average temperature of the coldest month of the (Mid-latitude) climates is higher than minus 3°C but below 18°C. D - Cold Snow Forest Climates: The average temperature of the coldest month is minus 3°C or below. H - High Land: Cold due to elevation.

Q.458. El Nino is a climate pattern that describes the unusual warming of

surface waters in which ocean?

- (a) Indian Ocean (b) Pacific Ocean
(c) Atlantic Ocean (d) Arctic Ocean

Sol.458.(b) Pacific Ocean. El Nino is a complex weather system that occurs every 3-7 years, causing droughts, floods, and extreme weather globally. It involves warm ocean currents off Peru's coast in the Eastern Pacific, affecting various regions, including India. El Nino is an extension of the warm equatorial current that temporarily replaces the cold Humboldt (Peruvian) Current, increasing water temperatures by 10°C.

Q.459. In the context of local storms of hot weather season, Nor'Westers are:

- (a) the pre-monsoon showers that are a common phenomenon in Kerala and coastal areas of Karnataka
(b) the dreaded evening thunderstorms in Bengal and Assam
(c) the hot, dry and oppressing winds blowing in the Northern plains from Punjab to Bihar with higher intensity between Delhi and Patna
(d) a nearby wind that blows coffee flowers in Kerala

Sol.459.(b) Nor Westers : Their notorious nature can be understood from the local nomenclature of 'Kalbaisakhi', a calamity of the month of Baisakh. These showers are useful for tea, jute and rice cultivation. In Assam, these storms are known as "Bardoli Chheerha". Some Famous Local Storms: Blossom Shower: Useful for coffee flowers blooming in Kerala. Loo : Hot, dry and oppressing winds blowing in the Northern plains.

Q.460. Which of the following States / Union Territories of India receives the highest average annual rainfall?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Ladakh
(c) Meghalaya (d) Delhi

Sol.460.(c) Meghalaya. The maximum rainfall of this season is received in the north-eastern part of the country. Mawsynram in the southern ranges of the Khasi Hills receives the highest average rainfall in the world. Mawsynram, the wettest place on the earth is also reputed for its stalagmite and stalactite caves. Rainfall in the Ganga valley decreases from the east to the west. Rajasthan and parts of Gujarat get scanty rainfall.

Q.461. One term for the continuous movement of water through the lithosphere, atmosphere and hydrosphere is:

- (a) hydro equilibrium cycle
- (b) hydrological cycle
- (c) hydrostatical equilibrium
- (d) water circulation

Sol.461.(b) hydrological cycle.

Components of the Hydrological Cycle :
Evaporation - Water changes from liquid to gas, primarily from bodies of water.

Q.462. Identify a type of season that is NOT a part of the four seasons of India.

- (a) The southeast monsoon season
- (b) The southwest monsoon season
- (c) The hot weather season
- (d) The cold weather season

Sol.462.(a) The southeast monsoon season. Four main seasons can be identified in India : The hot weather season (March to May), The southwest monsoon season (June to September), The post - monsoon or retreating monsoon season (October to December), The cold weather season (January to February).

Q.463. What is the name of the cold phase of the ENSO climate pattern that describes the unusual cooling of the surface waters of the region ?

- (a) NINO-3 region
- (b) ENSO-neutral
- (c) Trans-Nino
- (d) La Nina

Sol.463.(d) La Nina. In La Nina, the tropical Pacific trade winds become very strong and an abnormal accumulation of cold water occurs in the central and eastern Pacific Ocean. El Nino is a climate pattern that describes the unusual warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean. El Nino is the "warm phase" of a larger phenomenon called the El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO).

Q.464. Sea ice helps determine Earth's climate. According to this, what percentage of the sunlight falling on sea ice is reflected back into space ?

- (a) 80%
- (b) 70%
- (c) 75%
- (d) 85%

Sol.464.(a) 80%. Sea ice reflects a significant portion of sunlight, which is essential for regulating Earth's temperature. As sea ice diminishes, more solar energy is absorbed by the ocean, resulting in higher temperatures. This change affects global climate patterns and contributes to the acceleration of climate change. Albedo is the percentage of solar radiation reflected by a given surface.

Q.465. Who is best known for his testimony on climate change to

congressional committees in the 1980s, which helped raise wider awareness of the global warming issue?

- (a) James Hansen
- (b) Shen Kuo
- (c) Joseph Fourier
- (d) Svante Arrhenius

Sol.465.(a) James Hansen. He is referred to as the "father of global warming" because of his early warnings about the phenomenon in the 1980s.

Q.466. According to the Koppen climate classification system, 'Am' is the code for which type of climate?

- (a) Tropical wet and dry climate
- (b) Tropical monsoon climate
- (c) Humid subtropical climate
- (d) Marine west coast climate

Sol.466.(b) Tropical monsoon climate. Koeppen's Classification of Climatic Regions of India is based on mean annual and monthly temperature and precipitation data. He identified five major climatic groups: four based on temperature (A, C, D, E for humid climates) and one on precipitation (B for dry climates). These groups are further divided into types, indicated by small letters that describe seasonality: f (no dry season), m (monsoon), w (winter dry), and s (summer dry). Climatic Regions of India: Amw, As, Aw, BShw, BWhw, Cwg, Dfc, Et, E.

Q.467. Assertion (A): The climate of a particular place is controlled by six major factors.

Reason (R): Latitude, altitude, pressure and wind system, distance from the sea, ocean currents, and relief features are the six main controls of climate.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false
- (d) A is false, but R is true

Sol.467.(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

Q.468. When was the Indian Meteorological Department, which collects data on temperature, rainfall, wind, etc., and makes weather forecasts, established by the Government of India?

- (a) 1873
- (b) 1879
- (c) 1876
- (d) 1875

Sol.468.(d) 1875. Indian Meteorological Department - An agency of the Ministry of Earth Sciences of the Government of India. It is the principal agency responsible for meteorological observations, weather forecasting and seismology. Formed - 15 January 1875.

Headquarters - New Delhi. Regional offices - Chennai, Mumbai, Kolkata, Nagpur, Guwahati and New Delhi.

Q.469. Choose the INCORRECT statement related to monsoon.

- (a) The intensity and position of the high - pressure area, east of Madagascar, affects the Indian Monsoon
- (b) The Southwest Monsoon winds blow over the warm oceans, gather moisture and bring widespread rainfall over the mainland of India.
- (c) The difference in pressure over Tahiti (Pacific Ocean), and Darwin in northern Australia (Indian Ocean) is computed to predict the intensity of the monsoons.
- (d) The western cyclonic disturbances occur due to withdrawal or the retreat of the monsoon

Sol.469.(d) Western Cyclonic Disturbances are weather phenomena of the winter months brought in by the westerly flow from the Mediterranean region. They usually influence the weather of the north and north-western regions of India. It originates over the Mediterranean: The region which includes the Mediterranean Sea and seven Member States, either partially (France, Portugal, Italy, Spain) or completely (Greece, Malta, Cyprus).

Q.470. Which winds blow across the Asian continent at latitudes north of the Himalayas roughly parallel to the Tibetan highlands ?

- (a) Trade winds
- (b) Jet streams
- (c) Southwest winds
- (d) Northwest winds

Sol.470.(b) Jet streams - A narrow belt of high altitude (above 12,000 m) westerly winds in the Troposphere. Their speed varies from about 110 km/h in summer to about 184 km/h in winter. The polar jet is located between the 50°-60° latitude lines in both the northern and southern hemispheres. The subtropical jet is located around the 30° latitude line.

Q.471. What type of climate is found in North Western Europe, West Coast of North America, North of California, Southern Chile, South-eastern Australia and New Zealand?

- (a) Tropical wet and dry climate
- (b) Cold snow forest climate
- (c) Marine west coast climate
- (d) Subtropical steppe climate

Sol.471.(c) Marine west coast climate - Under the Koppen Climate Classification, it comes under Warm Temperate (Mid-Latitude) Climates (Group C) and is

represented by 'Cfb'.

Q.472. Choose the INCORRECT statement out of the following.

- (a) There is an increase in rainfall generally from east to west in the Northern Plains.
- (b) Most parts of the country receive rainfall from June to September.
- (c) The annual precipitation in Meghalaya is over 400 cm.
- (d) Some parts like the Tamil Nadu's coast gets a large portion of its rains during October and November.

Sol.472.(a) Rainfall decreases from the east to the west in Northern India because there is a decrease in the moisture content of the winds. The monsoon approaches the Indian landmass in two branches: The Arabian Sea branch (The monsoon winds originating over the Arabian Sea) and the Bay of Bengal branch.

Q.473. In which type of rainfall, winds move out from a high-pressure area with wind direction clockwise in the northern hemisphere, and anti-clockwise in the southern hemisphere ?

- (a) Cyclones (b) Convection
- (c) Anticyclone (d) Orography

Sol.473.(c) Anticyclone - It is the center of high pressure, surrounded by closed isobars. Due to Coriolis force, blowing winds are deflected from their paths to the right in the Northern hemisphere (Clockwise) and left in the Southern hemisphere (Anti clockwise). Cyclones that develop in the mid and high latitudes, beyond the tropical regions, are referred to as middle latitude or extratropical cyclones.

Q.474. According to the Koppen classification, Which regions experience cold humid winters with short summers?

- (a) South of Goa
- (b) Western Rajasthan
- (c) Arunachal Pradesh
- (d) Northern Madhya Pradesh

Sol.474.(c) Arunachal Pradesh. Koeppen identified a close relationship between the distribution of vegetation and climate.

Q.475. What is the usual term used to describe the climate of India ?

- (a) Polar climate (b) Tropical monsoon
- (c) Desert climate (d) Arid climate

Sol.475.(b) Tropical monsoon. A monsoon is a seasonal change in the direction of the prevailing, or strongest,

winds of a region. It always blows from cold to warm regions. The Indian Meteorological Department (IMD) designates four official seasons: Winter (December to early April); Summer or pre-monsoon (April to June); Monsoon or rainy (June to September) and Post-monsoon (October to December).

Q.476. What is 'Mahawat' in India ?

- (a) Cold waves during the winter season
- (b) Cloud burst during the monsoon season
- (c) Cyclonic rainfall during the winter season
- (d) Hot and dry winds during the summer season

Sol.476.(c) Mahawat is the total amount of rainfall in the cold weather season, that is the winter season which is caused by the western cyclonic disturbances in the north and north-western part of India.

Q.477. The target for the first commitment period of the Kyoto Protocol is to reduce emissions of greenhouse gasses by 5.2% from 1990 levels?

- (a) 6 (b) 10 (c) 8 (d) 7

Sol.477.(a) 6. Kyoto Protocol: It was adopted on 11 December 1997 and entered into force on 16 February 2005. It was adopted in Kyoto, Japan. It was the result of the Rio-1992 and the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). Kyoto Protocol cover emissions of the six main greenhouse gases Carbon dioxide (CO₂), methane (CH₄), nitrous oxide (N₂O), hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs), perfluorocarbons (PFCs), and sulfur hexafluoride (SF₆).

Q.478. In the context of mapping climate data, what term refers to a line drawn through all points on a map that contain the same amount of cloud?

- (a) Isohels (b) Isocheim
- (c) Isoneph (d) Isochalaz

Sol.478.(c) Isoneph. Isocheim - A line on a map connecting points having the same average temperature in winter. Isohel - A line on a map connecting points having the same duration of sunshine. Isochalaz - A line of constant frequency of hail storms.

Q.479. According to Koeppen's Scheme, which type of climate is denoted by 'Cwg' in India?

- (a) Monsoon with dry winter
- (b) Semi-arid steppe climate

(c) Polar type

(d) Monsoon with dry summer

Sol.479.(a) Monsoon with dry winter - It is mostly found in the Ganga Plain, eastern Rajasthan, Assam, and the Malwa Plateau. Amw (Monsoon type with a short dry winter season): This climate is found in the western coastal region, south of Mumbai.

Q.480. Which of the following is incorrectly matched?

- (a) Montane climate - Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Jharkhand
- (b) Tropical monsoon climate - The Western Ghats, the Malabar Coast And Southern Assam
- (c) Tropical semi-arid (steppe) climate - Karnataka, central Maharashtra, some parts of Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Hot desserts, arid climate - rajasthan and some parts of Gujarat

Sol.480.(a) Montane climate - Found in Assam, Nagaland, Mizoram, Meghalaya, Manipur, Arunachal Pradesh, Higher hills of Tamil Nadu.

Q.481. The centre of a cyclone is a calm area. It is called the_____of the storm.

- (a) base (b) focal point
- (c) eye (d) trigger point

Sol.481.(c) Eye. The eye of a storm is usually circular and typically 25-40 miles in diameter. It is surrounded by an eyewall, where the most severe weather of a cyclone occurs.

Q.482. What would happen if the difference in pressure in Tahiti was negative?

- (a) Above average late monsoon
- (b) Drought
- (c) Below average and late monsoon
- (d) Above average and early monsoon

Sol.482.(c) The difference in pressure over Tahiti (Pacific Ocean) and Darwin in Northern Australia (Indian Ocean) is computed to predict the intensity of the monsoons. Factors Affecting Monsoon - The shift of the position of Inter Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ); The presence of the high-pressure area, east of Madagascar; Heating of The Tibetan plateau in summers; The movement of the jet streams; Southern Oscillation (SO) - Change of pressure between south Pacific Ocean and eastern Indian Ocean.

Q.483. What type of climate occurs along the west coast of continents in subtropical latitudes between 30°-40° latitudes, covering Central California,

Central Chile along the coast in South East and South Western Australia?

- (a) Subtropical steppe climate
- (b) Humid subtropical climate
- (c) Mediterranean climate
- (d) Marine west coast climate

Sol.483.(c) Mediterranean climate: Clear skies and high temperatures; hot, dry summers and cool, wet winters. The climate is not extreme because of cooling from water bodies. This unique seasonal pattern makes it ideal for growing crops like olives, grapes, and citrus fruits.

Q.484. Consider the following statements regarding the climate of the hills of the Western Ghats:

Statement I: The average temperature in the hills of the Western Ghats is usually below 25°C.

Statement II: Western Ghats are intervein by major rivers like the Godavari, Krishna and Pennar.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.484.(a) Only I. Western Ghats are known as the Sahyadri Hills. It covers six states - Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala. The Eastern Ghats are intervein by major rivers like the Godavari, Krishna and Pennar.

Q.485. Which winds are also known by the name of 'Roaring Forties' ?

- (a) Polar easterlies
- (b) westerly winds
- (c) Polar winds
- (d) Trade winds

Sol.485.(b) Westerly Wind. The polar easterlies are one of the five primary wind zones, known as wind belts, that make up our atmosphere's circulatory system. Polar winds begin near the North and South Poles. The trade winds are air currents closer to Earth's surface that blow from east to west near the equator.

Q.486. Which among the following wind is associated with extreme cold and dryness?

- (a) Monsoon Winds
- (b) Westerlies
- (c) Trade Winds
- (d) Polar Easterlies

Sol.486.(d) Polar Easterlies. They emanate from the polar highs, areas of high pressure around the North and South Poles. They flow to low-pressure areas in sub-polar regions. Easterlies (blow from the east) - It is the name of the permanent winds that come from the direction of their origin. Monsoon Winds -

They are caused when the air over land gets heated and rises, causing winds to blow from the ocean toward land. Westerlies - Prevailing winds from the west toward the east in the middle latitudes.

Q.487. The summer months experience _____ in the northern part of India.

- (a) rising air pressure
- (b) falling air pressure
- (c) decreasing temperature
- (d) heavy rain

Sol.487.(b) Falling air pressure. An elongated low-pressure area develops in the region extending from the Thar Desert in the northwest to Patna and Chotanagpur plateau in the east and southeast towards the end of May. Circulation of air begins to set in around this trough. InterTropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) - Low pressure region around which the southeast trade winds and the northeast trade winds converge.

Q.488. The day to day condition of the atmosphere at a place with respect to the temperature, humidity, rainfall, wind speed etc. is called _____ at that place.

- (a) climate
- (b) weather
- (c) environment
- (d) ecology

Sol.488.(b) Weather. Climate - It is the long-term average of weather conditions, including temperature, humidity, precipitation, wind patterns, and other atmospheric elements, in a particular region over an extended period, typically 30 years or more.

Q.489. Which of the following pressure belts is known as the horse latitude?

- (a) Equatorial Low Pressure
- (b) Sub - Polar Low Pressure
- (c) High Pressure
- (d) Sub - Tropical High Pressure

Sol.489.(d) Subtropical high pressure belts (Horse latitude) extend 30° N and 30° S. It is formed because the warm air rising from the equator moves towards the tropics in both hemispheres. Equatorial Low - Pressure belt extends from 0 to 5° North and South. The subpolar low pressure belt extends around latitudes 60° to 70° North and South. High Pressure belts are located at 70°- 90° North and South latitudes. There are majorly seven Pressure Belts on the surface of Earth i.e., the Equatorial Low, two Subtropical Highs, two Subpolar Lows, and two Polar Highs.

Q.490. When the grains of sand are very fine and light, the wind can carry it over a

very long distance. When such sand is deposited in large areas, it is called_____.

- (a) loess
- (b) moraines
- (c) mushroom
- (d) stacks

Sol.490.(a) Loess. It is a clastic, predominantly silt-sized sediment that is formed by the accumulation of wind - blown dust.

Q.491. Consider the following statements about the main reasons for the excessive cold in north India during the cold weather season and identify which of the statements are correct.

1. States like Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan, being far away from the moderating influence of sea, experience continental climate.
2. The snowfall in the nearby Himalayan ranges creates a cold wave situation.
3. Around February, the cold winds coming from the Caspian Sea and Turkmenistan bring a cold wave along with frost and fog over the northwestern parts of India.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) 1 and 3 only

Sol.491.(c) 1, 2 and 3. Coastal areas have moderate temperatures because the land absorbs and radiates heat much faster than sea. So, during the day cool air from the sea rushes towards the land and during the night cool air from the land rushes towards the sea.

Q.492. Low annual range of temperature and high annual rainfall are characteristics of a _____.

- (a) Mediterranean climate
- (b) temperate climate
- (c) tropical humid climate
- (d) cold climate

Sol.492.(c) Tropical Humid Climate: Low range of temperature, Rainfall exceeds evapotranspiration for at least 270 days in a year, between Tropic of Cancer and Capricorn.

Q.493. Which of the following codes signify Cold Climate with Dry Winters according to Koeppen's classification?

- (a) EF
- (b) Df
- (c) ET
- (d) Dw

Sol.493.(d) Dw. Koeppen recognised six major climatic groups based on seasonal precipitation and temperature patterns. The six main groups are A (tropical), B (arid), C (temperate), D (continental), E (polar) and H (highland).

Q.494. The cold snow forest climate is found largely in the continental region in the Northern Hemisphere between _____ northern latitudes in Europe, Asia

and North America

- (a) 40°- 70° (b) 30°- 50°
(c) 80°- 110° (d) 15°- 20°

Sol.494.(a) 40°-70°. India has a tropical climate because of the Himalayan mountain.

Q.495. In early November, the low Pressure conditions shift over the Bay of Bengal. This transfer is related to cyclonic low pressure, which originates over _____.

- (a) Andaman Sea (b) Sea of Japan
(c) Caspian Sea (d) Pacific Ocean

Sol.495.(a) Andaman Sea (Burma sea in Thai) is a body of water to the southeast of the Bay of Bengal, south of Myanmar, west of Thailand and east of the Andaman Islands; it is a part of the Indian Ocean.

Industries

Q.496. Name the port that is privately owned by the Adani Group?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Visakhapatnam Port, Andhra Pradesh
(b) Chennai Port, Tamil Nadu
(c) Kandla Port, Gujarat
(d) Mundra Port, Gujarat

Sol.496.(d) Mundra Port, Gujarat. Mundra Port, located in Gujarat, is India's largest private commercial port, owned and operated by the Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) under the Adani Group. It handles bulk, container, and liquid cargo, and has emerged as a key hub for India's international trade, unlike other government-owned major ports.

Q.497. Select the INCORRECT statement from the following.

- (a) The development of the cotton textile industry in Britain led to the decline of Indian textile producers.
(b) Cotton clothes made in England had driven Indian clothes out of the markets of Europe and America in the beginning of the 20th century.
(c) The Sale and Devang communities of South India were famous for weaving.
(d) The first cotton textile mill in India was established in Bombay in 1854.

Sol.497.(b) By the beginning of the 20th century, India was not competing in European and American markets because British policies had already eliminated Indian textile exports to these regions by the 19th century. The decline of Indian textiles in international markets occurred much earlier, during the late

18th and 19th centuries, following the Industrial Revolution in Britain.

Q.498. Identify the oldest iron and steel company of India from the following options.

- (a) Tata Iron & Steel Company (TISCO)
(b) Visvesvaraiya Iron & Steel Works
(c) Indian Iron & Steel Company (IISCO)
(d) Mysore Iron & Steel Works

Sol.498.(a) Tata Iron and Steel Company (TISCO): Founded by Jamsetji Tata and Dorabji Tata in 1907, It is located in Jamshedpur (Jharkhand). Visvesvaraya Iron and Steel Plant: Founded in 1923, this plant is situated in Bhadravathi (Karnataka), and specializes in the production of pig iron and steel. Indian Iron and Steel Company (IISCO): Established in 1918, IISCO is an integrated steel plant located in Burnpur (West Bengal) and is part of Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL).

Q.499. Identify the group of districts that are NOT an example of industrial districts of India.

- (a) Cuttack and Kota
(b) Kanpur and Agra
(c) Alwar and Bhiwani
(d) Jabalpur and Bhopal

Sol.499.(c) Alwar and Bhiwani. Cuttack (Odisha) is known for textile and handicraft industries, especially the silver filigree (Tarakasi) work. Kota (Rajasthan) is famous for its engineering and chemical industries. Kanpur is a significant industrial hub, historically known for its leather and textile industries. It is sometimes called the "Manchester of the East." Agra is widely known for its tourism, but it also has industries related to leather goods, footwear, and marble stone carving. Jabalpur (Madhya Pradesh) is known for ordnance factories, defense-related industries, and manufacturing units. Bhopal (Madhya Pradesh) is a major industrial center with industries like electrical goods, chemicals, and the famous Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL).

Q.500. Consider the following statements about industries in India:

Statement I: BHEL (Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited) is a public sector industry established in 1964, headquartered in New Delhi.

Statement II: Reliance, Tata, and Adani Groups are public sector industries.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.500.(a) Only I. Reliance Industries Limited is an Indian multinational company based in Mumbai, Maharashtra. It was founded by Dhirubhai Ambani. The Tata Group is one of India's oldest and largest business conglomerates. It was founded in 1868 by Jamsetji Tata. The Adani Group is an Indian multinational conglomerate based in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. It was founded in 1988 by Gautam Adani.

Q.501. Which of the following is an example of a major industrial region of India?

- (a) Chota Nagpur region
(b) Bhojpur-Munger
(c) Jaipur-Ajmer
(d) Bilaspur-Korba

Sol.501.(a) Chota Nagpur region. India has several industrial regions like Mumbai-Pune cluster, Bangalore-Tamil Nadu region, Hugli region, Ahmedabad-Baroda region, Chottanagpur industrial belt, Vishakhapatnam-Guntur belt, Gurgaon-Delhi-Meerut region and the Kollam-Thiruvananthapuram industrial cluster.

Q.502. Where was the first successful textile mill established in India?

- (a) Kolkata (b) Surat
(c) Mumbai (d) Jaipur

Sol.502.(c) Mumbai. The first successful textile mill in India was the Bombay Spinning and Weaving Company, established in 1854 in Bombay (now Mumbai) by Cowasjee Nanabhoy Davar, a Parsi businessman and banker. Located in Tardeo, Bombay, it began production in 1856.

Q.503. Where is the oldest centre of lace work located in Gujarat?

- (a) Kutch (b) Rajkot
(c) Jamnagar (d) Ahmedabad

Sol.503.(c) Jamnagar. Crafts Centers of Gujarat : Kutch - Known for its rich tradition in embroidery and textile crafts. Surat - It is an important silk weaving center of India and is famous for silk brocades. Rajkot - It is popular for traditional and folk silver jewelry. Palitana - Known for making bronze sculptures. Ahmedabad (Manchester of India) - Famous for cotton textile works. The first cotton textile mill was started in 1861.

Q.504. There is a cable manufacturing facility at HCL in Rupnarainpur. It belongs

to which state?

- (a) Haryana (b) Assam
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) West Bengal

Sol.504.(d) West Bengal. West Bengal along with their notable industries: Durgapur (Iron and Steel), Kharagpur (Chemicals), Haldia (petrochemicals), Darjeeling (tea), Chittaranjan (Electric locomotives), Asansol (Coal, Iron and Steel), Kalyani (Heavy Engineering), Rishra (Textiles).

Q.505. According to the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion, which of the following is NOT a core industry ?

- (a) Jute (b) Fertilisers
(c) Crude oil (d) Electricity

Sol.505.(a) Jute. The eight core industries are- Coal, Crude oil, Natural Gas, Petroleum refinery products, Fertilizer, Cement, Steel, and Electricity generation.

Q.506. Select the INCORRECT pair of the location of the refinery and its state from the following

- (a) Bina Refinery - Madhya Pradesh
(b) Numaligarh Refinery - Assam
(c) Koyali Refinery - Gujarat
(d) Tatipaka Refinery - Telangana

Sol.506.(d) Tatipaka Refinery - Telangana. Tatipaka Oil Refinery is located in the East Godavari district in Andhra Pradesh. It was set up on 3rd September 2001. Some list of oil refineries: Vadinar Refinery (Gujarat), Kochi Refinery (Kerala), Mangalore Refinery (Karnataka), Paradip Refinery (Odisha), Barauni Refinery (Barauni in Bihar).

Q.507. Which group of states was concentrated in the cotton production in the early years to develop textile industry?

- (a) West Bengal and Odisha
(b) Punjab and Haryana
(c) Maharashtra and Gujarat
(d) Bihar and West Bengal

Sol.507.(c) Maharashtra and Gujarat. Cotton is a tropical crop and it is raised in India as a Kharif crop. Climatic condition - Temperatures between 21 degrees Celsius and 30 degrees Celsius. It grows best in Black soil. India grows both short staple (Indian) cotton as well as long staple (American) cotton called 'narma' in north-western parts of the country.

Q.508. Where was the first cement plant located in India in the year 1904 ?

- (a) Jaipur (b) Rajkot
(c) Chennai (d) Hyderabad

Sol.508.(c) Chennai. South India Industries Limited in Madras, made an initiative to manufacture Portland cement. India entered into the Cement Era in 1914, when the Indian Cement Company Ltd. started manufacturing Cement in Porbandar in Gujarat.

Q.509. Consider the following statements about oilfields in India:

Statement I: Digboi and Naharkatiya oilfields are located in Assam.

Statement II: Ankaleshwar, Kalol, Mehsana, Nawagam, Kosamba and Lunej oilfields are located in Maharashtra.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.509.(a) Only I. Digboi Oilfield : One of the oldest oil fields in Asia, discovered in 1867, and home to Asia's oldest oil refinery (Established in 1901). It is located in Tinsukia district, Assam. Naharkatiya Oilfield : Discovered in 1953, with oil production starting in 1954. It is located in Dibrugarh district, Assam. Other Oil Refineries in Assam - Noonmati Refinery, Numaligarh Refinery, and Bongaigaon Refinery. Kosamba, Lunej, Mehsana, Nawagam, Ankleshwar and Kalol are oil-producing regions located in Gujarat.

Q.510. Which of the following cities is called the Silicon Valley of India due to its prominence in the IT industry ?

- (a) Bengaluru (b) Dehradun
(c) Hyderabad (d) Gurugram

Sol.510.(a) Bengaluru. Nicknames of Indian Cities: Hyderabad - City of Pearls; Gurugram - Millennium City; Korba - Power Hub of India; Jamshedpur - Steel Capital of India; Nalanda - The Land of Knowledge; Guntur - Land of Chillies; Kashmir - Switzerland of India; Pondicherry - Paris of the East; Coimbatore - Manchester of South India; Chennai - Detroit of Asia.

Q.511. Which of the following is the only vertically - integrated, primary copper producer in India ?

- (a) Sterlite Industries
(b) Jhagadia Copper Limited
(c) Hindalco Industries (Birla Copper)
(d) Hindustan Copper Limited

Sol.511.(d) Hindustan Copper Limited. It is a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Mines. The company was

incorporated on 9th November 1967, under the Companies Act, 1956. Headquarters - Kolkata.

Q.512. Consider the following statements regarding gold mines in India:

1. The Kolar region of Karnataka is famous for its gold fields and is also called the "Golden City of India."
2. Hutti Gold Mines is located in Jharkhand, is among the largest gold producers in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.512.(a) Only I. Kolar - Golden City of India. It is popularly known as the land of Silk, Milk, Mango, Gold. Other Gold mines - Hutti Gold Mines (Karnataka), Lava Gold Mines (Jharkhand), Sonbhadra Mine (Uttar Pradesh), Parasi (Jharkhand), Dadam (Haryana).

Q.513. Which state in India has the highest number of aluminium smelting plants?

- (a) Odisha (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Maharashtra (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.513.(a) Odisha. Aluminum smelting plants - Korba, Alupuram, Renukoot, Mettur, Hirakud, Angul, Jharsuguda and Faridabad. Aluminium Companies in India - Hindustan Aluminium Company (Mumbai, Maharashtra), Vedanta Limited (Jharsuguda, Odisha), Sacheta Metals (Mumbai, Maharashtra).

Q.514. Which of the following industries is its own major consumer in India?

- (a) Iron and steel (b) Aviation
(c) Automobile (d) Chemical

Sol.514.(d) Chemical. India is the 6th largest producer of chemicals in the world and 3rd in Asia. Also the fourth-largest producer of agrochemicals after the United States, Japan and China.

Q.515. Which city in India is known as the 'Detroit of India' due to its automobile industry?

- (a) Chennai (b) Mumbai
(c) Bengaluru (d) Pune

Sol.515.(a) Chennai - It is contributing more than 40% of the country's auto parts and vehicles. The World's major automotive giants that operate in Chennai are TVS, Ashok Leyland, Royal Enfield, TI Cycle, TAFE, Hyundai, Mitsubishi etc.

Q.516. The Kudremukh Mines are

located in which of the following states?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Chhattisgarh
(c) Maharashtra (d) Odisha

Sol.516.(a) Karnataka. Kudremukh Mines is an iron ore mine located in the Bellary, Chitradurga, Chikkamagaluru, Tumkur belt. Other Iron ore mines : Chhattisgarh - Rowghat Mines, Bailadila. Odisha - Balda Block, Joda East, Gorumahisani, Jajang Rungta. Madhya Pradesh - Agaria Iron Ore mine.

Q.517. In which of the following regions in India are there high-grade iron ore deposits?

- (a) Western Rajasthan
(b) Southern Punjab
(c) Eastern Uttar Pradesh
(d) Northern Odisha

Sol.517.(d) Northern Odisha. The iron ore mines are located near the coal fields in the northeastern plateau region. Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka, Goa, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu account for approximately 95% of total iron ore reserves. Iron Ore and Percentage of iron : Magnetite - 72 %, Hematite - 60-70 %, Limonite - 40 to 60%, Siderite - 48 %.

Q.518. Which is the first integrated steel plant in the public sector in India?

- (a) The Visvesvaraya Iron and Steel Limited
(b) Rourkela Steel Plant
(c) The Salem Steel Plant
(d) Indian Iron and Steel Company

Sol.518.(b) Rourkela Steel Plant (Odisha - 1959). Established with the help of West German Industrial Corporations. Steel plants built in India during the Second Five Year Plan (FYP): Durgapur Steel Plant (West Bengal - Britain Cooperation), Bhilai Steel Plant (Chattisgarh - USSR Cooperation).

Q.519. Which is the oldest aluminium refinery plant in India?

- (a) The Damanjodi Plant
(b) The Muri Alumina Plant
(c) The Mettur Plant
(d) The Belgaum Plant

Sol.519.(b) The Muri Alumina Plant - Situated near Chota Muri at Swarnarekha River in Ranchi (Jharkhand). It was commissioned in 1948. Its capacity is 450 Kilo tonne per annum (present). The Mettur Plant, Tamil Nadu. Damanjodi - Located in the Koraput district (Odisha), famous for discovery of bauxite mines and setting up of NALCO (National Aluminium Company Limited).

Q.520. With respect to value addition in the textile industry, knitting is followed by which procedure?

- (a) Garment manufacture
(b) Spinning
(c) Fiber production
(d) Dyeing and finishing

Sol.520.(d) Dyeing and finishing. In the textile industry, the process begins with fiber production, followed by spinning to create yarn, and then knitting or weaving to form fabric. Next comes dyeing, printing, and finishing to enhance the fabric, and finally, garment manufacturing, involving cutting and sewing. Thus, the step following knitting is dyeing and finishing.

Q.521. Which of the following is dark reddish coloured stone used as raw material in aluminum smelting?

- (a) Mica (b) Gypsum
(c) Bauxite (d) Conglomerate

Sol.521.(c) Bauxite.

Q.522. The Paithani saree weaving industry is in which state?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Maharashtra (d) Assam

Sol.522.(c) Maharashtra. They are woven by hand. They are made from very fine mulberry silk.

Biosphere Reserves

Q.523. Which of the following statements best links a current conservation initiative for the Great Indian Bustard with its geographical location?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) National Avian Research Centre in Maharashtra conducted habitat simulation for GIB.
(b) Kalyan Sanctuary in Karnataka now houses the largest wild GIB population.
(c) India's first successful artificial insemination of GIB took place in the National Breeding Centre in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan.
(d) A GIB conservation breeding centre was set up in Kutch, Gujarat for desert climate adaptation.

Sol.523.(c) The Great Indian Bustard (GIB) is critically endangered, with its last viable wild population mainly surviving in Rajasthan's Desert National Park. To save the species, the National Bustard Breeding Centre (NBBC) was established in Jaisalmer and Pokhran, Rajasthan. In

June 2021, India achieved the milestone of the first successful artificial insemination and captive breeding of GIB here.

Q.524. What is the role of National Parks under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) To promote tourism
(b) To protect wildlife and their habitats
(c) To regulate trade
(d) To oversee elections

Sol.524.(b) To protect wildlife and their habitats. Under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, National Parks are designated areas aimed at protecting wildlife and preserving natural habitats. Human activities like hunting, grazing, forestry, or private land use are strictly prohibited inside National Parks. Unlike sanctuaries, even private land rights cease once an area is declared a National Park. While tourism may occur in a regulated manner, its primary objective remains the conservation of ecosystems and protection of biodiversity.

Q.525. Which of the following Biosphere Reserves is correctly matched with its state?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Seshachalam Hills - Andhra Pradesh
(b) Dehang-Dibang - Meghalaya
(c) Pachmarhi - Gujarat
(d) Dibru-Saikhowa - Manipur

Sol.525.(a) Seshachalam Hills - Andhra Pradesh. The Seshachalam Hills are located in the southern part of Andhra Pradesh and were designated as a Biosphere Reserve in 2010. This area is part of the Eastern Ghats and encompasses the famous Tirumala Venkateswara Temple. The Dehang-Dibang Biosphere Reserve is located in the state of Arunachal Pradesh. The Pachmarhi Biosphere Reserve is situated in the Satpura Range of Madhya Pradesh. The Dibru-Saikhowa National Park and Biosphere Reserve is located in the state of Assam.

Q.526. Match the following Wildlife Sanctuaries (Column A) with their respective States (Column B). Choose the option correct option:

Column A (Wildlife Sanctuary)	Column B (State)
1. Gandhi Sagar WLS	a. Assam
2. Sonai Rupai WLS	b. Madhya Pradesh
3. Kaimur WLS	c. Telangana
4. Eturnagaram WLS	d. Bihar

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c (b) 1-a, 2-c, 3-b, 4-d
(c) 1-d, 2-c, 3-a, 4-b (d) 1-c, 2-d, 3-a, 4-b

Sol.526.(a) Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in the foothills of the Himalayas in the Sonitpur district of Assam. Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary, the largest in the state, is located in the Kaimur district of Bihar. Etunagaram Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Mulugu district of Telangana. The Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary in Madhya Pradesh has been identified as the second potential home for cheetahs in India, after Kuno National Park.

Q.527. Read the below statements and choose the correct option:

Statement 1: India's first initiative to track Fishing Cats through radio-collars has been introduced at Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary.

Statement 2: Fishing Cats are primarily found in coastal wetlands and mangrove ecosystems.

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Both Statements 1 and 2 are correct
(b) Neither Statement 1 nor 2 is correct
(c) Only Statement 1 is correct
(d) Only Statement 2 is correct

Sol.527.(a) The Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Dehradun, in collaboration with the Andhra Pradesh Forest Department, has undertaken India's first Fishing Cat Collaring Project at Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary (Andhra Pradesh) to track the movements and behaviors of these endangered felines. Fishing Cats (*Prionailurus viverrinus*) are semi-aquatic wildcats that predominantly inhabit wetland ecosystems, including coastal wetlands, swamps, marshes, tidal creeks, and mangrove forests. These habitats are critical to their survival and hunting behavior.

Q.528. Match the following.

1. Ranthambore National Park	(a) Tamil Nadu
2. Bandipur National Park	(b) Rajasthan
3. Mudumalai National Park	(c) Karnataka

- (a) 1-a, 2-c, 3-b (b) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c
(c) 1-c, 2-b, 3-a (d) 1-b, 2-c, 3-a

Sol.528.(d) 1-b, 2-c, 3-a.

Q.529. Which of the following protected areas are located in Telangana?

- I. Kawal Tiger Reserve
II. Pranahita Wildlife Sanctuary

III. Nagarjuna Sagar-Srisailem Tiger Reserve

IV. Kinnerasani Wildlife Sanctuary

- (a) Only I and II (b) Only II and III
(c) Only I, II, III and IV (d) Only I and III

Sol.529.(c) Only I, II, III and IV. Kawal Tiger Reserve is located at Adilabad district in Telangana. It was declared a wildlife sanctuary in 1965 and later became part of the Kawal Tiger Reserve under Project Tiger in 2012.

Q.530. The Betul, Hoshangabad and Chhindwara districts of Madhya Pradesh is a part of which of the following Biosphere Reserves?

- (a) Manas (b) Seshachalam
(c) Agasthyamalai (d) Pachmarhi

Sol.530.(d) Pachmarhi Biosphere Reserve is recognized for its rich biodiversity and has been designated as a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve in 2009. The Satpura mountain ranges across India from west to east and Pachmarhi lies directly in its centre. It comprises three protection sites: the Bori Sanctuary, Satpura National Park and Pachmarhi Sanctuary. Other Biosphere Reserve: Manas (Assam), Seshachalam (Andhra Pradesh), Agasthyamalai (Kerala and Tamil Nadu).

Q.531. As of the June 2021, how many biosphere reserves are established in India?

- (a) 18 (b) 20 (c) 26 (d) 15

Sol.531.(a) 18. The Government of India started the Biosphere Reserve scheme in 1986. This is guided by the UNESCO MAB programme, as India is a signatory to the landscape approach supported by MAB. The Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve was the first and Oldest biosphere reserve in India established in 1986.

Q.532. Which national park in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands is home to species like Megapode, crab-eating Macaque, Nicobar Pigeon, and Giant Robber Crab?

- (a) Raimona National Park
(b) Campbell Bay National Park
(c) Mouling National Park
(d) Papikonda National Park

Sol.532.(b) Campbell Bay National Park, established in 1992, spans 426.23 square km and is part of the Great Nicobar Biosphere Reserve. Other notable parks include Raimona National Park in Assam (famous for elephants and tigers), Mouling National Park in Arunachal Pradesh (known for temperate

forests and Himalayan wildlife), and Papikonda National Park in Andhra Pradesh (noted for Eastern Ghats biodiversity).

Q.533. Consider the following statements regarding Tadoba National Park:

- I. Tadoba National Park is located in Chandrapur district of Maharashtra.
II. It was declared a National Park in 1956.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.533.(a) Only I. In 1955, Tadoba National Park was given the designation of a National Park. Other National Parks of Maharashtra are Chandoli National Park, Navegaon National Park, Gugamal National Park, Sanjay Gandhi National Park.

Q.534. In which state is the Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve located?

- (a) Assam (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Odisha (d) Uttarakhand

Sol.534.(d) Uttarakhand. Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve included in UNESCO World Heritage site in 1988. Some biosphere reserves in India: Cold Desert (Himachal Pradesh), Khangchendzonga (Sikkim), Dihang - Dibang (Arunachal Pradesh), Manas (Assam), Dibru - Saikhowa (Assam), Nokrek (Meghalaya), Panna (Madhya Pradesh), Pachmarhi (Madhya Pradesh).

Q.535. Select the natural habitat of the Asiatic Lion from the following.

- (a) Gir forest
(b) Sundarbans
(c) Kanha National Park
(d) Saranda forest

Sol.535.(a) Gir forest. Asiatic lions are an endangered species and their 534 is restricted only to the Gir National Park situated in Gujarat. India is the only country in the world to have both tigers and lions. Tigers are found in the forests of Madhya Pradesh, the Sundarbans of West Bengal. Number of Lions in India - 674. The first tiger reserve in India was established in 1973 (Project Tiger).

Q.536. Which of the following statements is/are correct

- I. Maximum National Parks in India are located in the state of Madhya Pradesh.
II. Mudumalai National Park is located in Kerala.

III. The Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History is located in Tamil Nadu.

- (a) Both I and II are correct
(b) Both I and III are correct
(c) Only III is correct
(d) Only I is correct.

Sol.536.(b) Both I and III are correct.

Q.537. Which biosphere of Southern Andhra Pradesh is home to many endemic species including the famous Red Sanders and Slender Loris?

- (a) Cold Desert (b) Pachmarhi
(c) Seshachalam (d) Agasthyamalai

Sol.537.(c) Seshachalam. It is a Biosphere Reserve situated in the Seshachalam Hill ranges of the Eastern Ghats in southern Andhra Pradesh, covering a total area of 4755.9 km². Seshachalam SLBR was designated in 2011. It is known for its large reserves of Red Sandalwood.

Q.538. The Keoladeo National Park is located in the state of _____.

- (a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Odisha (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.538.(b) Rajasthan. Keoladeo National Park in Bharatpur district was declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1985. States and National Parks: Rajasthan - Ranthambhore, Sariska. Gujarat - Gir, Marine. Odisha - Simlipal. Madhya Pradesh - Bandhavgarh, Fossil, Madhav, Sanjay-Dubri.

Q.539. Correctly match the following.

States	Bio-reserve
1. Assam	a. Pachmarhi
2. Madhya Pradesh	b. Nokrek
3. Odisha	c. Manas
4. Meghalaya	d. Similipal

- (a) 1-c, 2-a, 3-d, 4-b (b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c
(c) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d (d) 1-b, 2-c, 3-a, 4-d

Sol.539.(a) 1-c, 2-a, 3-d, 4-b.

Q.540. Match the following.

i) Gir National Park	a) Rhinos
ii) Rajaji National Park	b) Siberian cranes
iii) Keoladeo National Park	c) Lions
iv) Kaziranga National Park	d) Elephants

- (a) i-d, ii-b, iii-c, iv-a (b) i-d, ii-c, iii-a, iv-b
(c) i-c, ii-d, iii-b, iv-a (d) i-a, ii-b, iii-c, iv-d

Sol.540.(c) i-c, ii-d, iii-b, iv-a. Jim Corbett National Park (Uttarakhand) - Tiger; Sundarban National Park (West Bengal) - Bengal tiger; Dudhwa National

Park (Uttar Pradesh) - Swamp deer and Tiger; Silent Valley National Park (Kerala) - Lion Tailed Macaque; Orang National Park (Assam) - One Horned Rhinoceros and the Royal Bengal Tiger.

Q.541. Match the wildlife sanctuaries in column A with their corresponding states in column B.

Column A (Wildlife Sanctuaries)	Column B (States)
1. Tansa	a. Tamil Nadu
2. Guindy	b. Maharashtra
3. Orchha	c. Madhya Pradesh
4. Kaziranga	d. Assam

- (a) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d (b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d
(c) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c (d) 1-b, 2-c, 3-a, 4-d

Sol.541.(b) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d.

Q.542. Which of the following is declared as a Wild Ass Sanctuary?

- (a) Ladakh (b) Sunderbans
(c) Spiti Valley (d) Rann of Kachchh

Sol.542.(d) Rann of Kachchh (Gujarat). It is the only home to wild ass in India. The sanctuary was set up in 1972.

Q.543. Which of the following is the closest wild relative of domestic cattle protected in some of the famous national parks of India like Nagarhole and Bandipur?

- (a) Red angus (b) Asiatic buffalo
(c) Nilgai (d) Gaur

Sol.543.(d) Gaur. First population estimation exercise of the Indian Gaur (Bison) was carried out in the Nilgiris Forest Division (Tamil Nadu).

Q.544. Consider the following statements regarding Biosphere Reserves in India:

- Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve is located in Kerala.
- Dugong, the largest endangered marine mammal, is found in the Gulf of Mannar.
- Seshachalam Biosphere Reserve is situated in Andhra Pradesh.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Only III (d) I and II

Sol.544.(a) Only I. Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve (Tamil Nadu, India's first marine biosphere reserve). **Biosphere Reserves:** Khangchendzonga (Sikkim), and Pachmarhi (Madhya Pradesh).

Q.545. In which state is Gorumara National Park located?

- (a) Assam (b) West Bengal
(c) Uttarakhand (d) Bihar

Sol.545.(b) West Bengal. Gorumara National Park was established in 1994. It is primarily known for its population of Indian rhinoceros. Other National Parks : West Bengal - Jaldapara, Sunderban, Singalila, Neora. Assam - Kaziranga, Nameri, Manas. Uttarakhand - Jim Corbett, Rajaji, Gangotri. Bihar - Valmiki. Rajasthan - Ranthambore, Keoladeo. Madhya Pradesh - Kanha, Van Vihar, Satpura.

Q.546. The famous Nelapattu Bird Sanctuary is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.546.(b) Andhra Pradesh. Nelapattu Bird Sanctuary - It is an important breeding site for spot-billed pelicans (*Pelecanus philippensis*). Other bird sanctuaries in Andhra Pradesh - Kolleru, Uppalapadu, Telineelapuram and Telukunchi. Tamil Nadu - Karikili Birds Sanctuary, Chitrangudi. Karnataka - Ranganathittu, Attiveri. Madhya Pradesh - Ghatigaon, Karera Bustard Sanctuary.

Q.547. Which country is the only country in the world to have both tigers and lions?

- (a) Kenya (b) South Africa
(c) India (d) China

Sol.547.(c) India. The natural habitat of the Indian lion is the Gir forest in Gujarat. Tigers are found in the forests of Madhya Pradesh, the Sundarbans of West Bengal. Number of Lions in India - 674. In 2023, the tiger population in India was recorded at 3682.

Q.548. The Eld's deer subspecies, which is classified as endangered in the IUCN Red List, is found only in the:

- (a) Hemis National Park in Ladakh
(b) Ranthambore National Park in Rajasthan
(c) Keibul Lamjao National Park in Manipur
(d) Pench National Park in Madhya Pradesh

Sol.548.(c) Keibul Lamjao National Park in Manipur. IUCN Headquarter is at Gland, Switzerland. The 7 categories of the IUCN Red List are Data Deficient (DD), Least Concern (LC), Near Threatened (NT), Vulnerable (VU), Endangered (EN), Critically Endangered (CR), Extinct In The Wild (EW), Extinct (EX).

Q.549. Baghmara Pitcher Plant Sanctuary

is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Meghalaya (b) Goa
(c) Karnataka (d) Assam

Sol.549.(a) Meghalaya (South Garo Hills District). The sanctuary is named after a rare insectivorous Pitcher Plant that is endemic to this region only.

Q.550. Assertion (A): Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Nagaon district of Assam.

Reason (R): It lies on the northern bank of the Subansiri River.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

Sol.550.(c) A is true but R is false. Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary is a protected area located in the state of Assam. This wildlife sanctuary covers 70.13 km², on the south bank of the Brahmaputra River in Nagaon district.

Q.551. In which of the following Indian states is the Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary located?

- (a) Assam (b) Karnataka
(c) Sikkim (d) Chhattisgarh

Sol.551.(d) Chhattisgarh (Balodabazar district). It was established in 1976 under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972. The Jonk River flows through the sanctuary, which is a tributary of the Mahanadi river.

Q.552. In which of the following states is Kali Tiger Reserve located?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Karnataka
(c) Telangana (d) Assam

Sol.552.(b) Karnataka. Kali Tiger Reserve is a protected area and tiger reserve in Uttara Kannada district, in Karnataka. The park is a habitat of Bengal tigers, black panthers, and Indian elephants, amongst other distinctive fauna. The Kali River flows through the whole tiger reserve.

Q.553. Peppara Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in which of the following states?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Meghalaya
(c) Punjab (d) Kerala

Sol.553.(d) Kerala. Other Wildlife Sanctuaries in Kerala : Eravikulam, Periyar, Shendurney, Chinnar, Parambikulam, Idukki, Wayanad, Thattekad.

Q.554. Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Jharkhand

- (c) Sikkim (d) Kerala

Sol.554.(a) Karnataka.

Q.555. The wetland of Ashtamudi is located in:

- (a) Assam (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) Karnataka

Sol.555.(c) Kerala (in Kollam District). It has a unique wetland ecosystem and a large palm shaped waterbody. Ashtamudi Wetland is included in the list of wetlands of international importance.

Q.556. Which sanctuary is famous for endangered Estuarine Crocodiles conservation in India?

- (a) Indira Gandhi Wildlife Sanctuary
(b) Bhitarkanika Wildlife Sanctuary, Odisha
(c) Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary, Kerala
(d) Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary, Karnataka

Sol.556.(b) Bhitarkanika Wildlife Sanctuary (Odisha) is a Ramsar site and is one of India's biggest estuarine crocodile habitats and a major coastal ecosystem.

Q.557. Which wildlife sanctuary is a tri-state protected area in northern India? It is also famous for the Critically Endangered gharial, the red-crowned roofed turtle and the Endangered Ganges river dolphin?

- (a) National Chambal Sanctuary
(b) Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary
(c) Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary
(d) Bhadra Wildlife Sanctuary

Sol.557.(a) National Chambal Sanctuary is located on the Chambal River near the tri-point of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

Q.558. In which district of Karnataka is the Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary located?

- (a) Hassan (b) Mandya
(c) Udipi (d) Kodagu

Sol.558.(d) Kodagu (Coorg). Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary is situated on the border between Wayanad District of Kerala state on the south and Kodagu District in Karnataka on the north side.

Physiographic Division of India

Q.559. Which of the following plateaus is located in the northeastern part of India? SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Malwa Plateau
(b) Deccan Plateau
(c) Chota Nagpur Plateau
(d) Shillong Plateau

Sol.559.(d) Shillong Plateau. This plateau is part of the peninsular block separated from the Chota Nagpur Plateau by the Garo–Rajmahal Gap. It is known for its rich mineral resources and scenic landscape. Other plateau location: Malwa Plateau - Central India. Deccan Plateau - Southern & Central India. Chota Nagpur Plateau - Eastern India (Jharkhand, Odisha, West Bengal).

Q.560. Which of the following is a characteristic feature of the Western Coastal Plains?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Mangrove forests
(b) High rainfall
(c) Large deltas
(d) Lagoons and backwaters

Sol.560.(d) Lagoons and backwaters. The Western Coastal Plains are narrow plains lying between the Western Ghats and the Arabian Sea. A unique feature is the presence of lagoons and backwaters, especially in Kerala (e.g., Vembanad Lake). Unlike the Eastern Coastal Plains, which are broader and have large deltas (e.g., Ganga, Mahanadi), the Western Coastal Plains are narrow and do not support major delta formation.

Q.561. The Western Coastal Plains are narrower compared to the Eastern Coastal Plains because:

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) They receive less rainfall
(b) They are less populated
(c) They are older in formation
(d) They are bordered by the Western Ghats

Sol.561.(d) They are bordered by the Western Ghats. The Western Coastal Plains are much narrower than the Eastern Coastal Plains. This is because the Western Ghats run close and almost parallel to the Arabian Sea coast. As a result, there is very little flat land between the mountains and the sea. On the other hand, the Eastern Ghats are more eroded and lie farther from the Bay of Bengal. Hence, the Eastern Coastal Plains are wider, while the Western ones remain narrow.

Q.562. Select the correct order of the following plateaus and ranges from south to north in India.

- (a) Malwa Plateau, Vindhya Range, Satpura Range and Deccan Plateau
(b) Deccan Plateau, Vindhya Range, Satpura Range and Malwa Plateau
(c) Deccan Plateau, Satpura Range, Vindhya Range and Malwa Plateau

(d) Malwa Plateau, Satpura Range, Vindhya Range and Deccan Plateau

Sol.562.(c) Deccan Plateau: The southernmost plateau, covering parts of Maharashtra, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Telangana. Satpura Range: Located to the north of the Deccan Plateau and runs through Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. Vindhya Range: Lies further north of the Satpura Range, stretching across Madhya Pradesh and separating the northern plains from the southern plateaus. Malwa Plateau: Located to the north of the Vindhya Range, covering parts of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.

Q.563. Consider the following statements regarding temperature variation in deserts:

- I. Deserts experience extreme temperature variation between day and night due to low humidity and sparse vegetation.
- II. In the Thar Desert, daytime temperature can reach around 50°C, while nights may drop to nearly 15°C.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.563.(c) Both I and II. Desert like the 'Thar Desert' experience extreme temperature variations due to low moisture, sparse vegetation, and clear skies. Daytime temperatures can reach up to 50°C, while nights drop to around 15°C, creating a difference of about 35°C in 24 hours.

Q.564. Which physical feature of India prevents the cold winds from central Asia from entering the Indian subcontinent?

- (a) Indian plains (b) Indian desert
(c) Coastal area (d) Himalayas

Sol.564.(d) Himalaya : It acts as a natural barrier, blocking cold winds from Central Asia and protecting the climate of India. This mountain range effectively protects the subcontinent, and maintains its relatively warm temperatures. Coastal area : Allows winds from the sea to enter India.

Q.565. In which of the following districts of Rajasthan are the 'Barchans' found?

- (a) Udaipur (b) Jaisalmer
(c) Bhilwara (d) Alwar

Sol.565.(b) Jaisalmer. Barchan, crescent-shaped sand dune produced by the action of wind predominately from one direction. The Indian desert lies west of the Aravali Hills, with sandy plains and

sand dunes. It receives very low rainfall (below 150 mm annually) and has an arid climate with sparse vegetation.

Q.566. Purvanchal Himalayas does NOT comprise of :

- (a) Naga hills (b) Pir Panjal range
(c) Manipur hills (d) Mizo hills

Sol.566.(b) Pir Panjal Range in the Himalayas is a part of the Lesser Himalayas. The Pir Panjal Range starts near PatniTop in Jammu and Kashmir and runs through Himachal Pradesh to Garhwal. The Purvanchal Himalayas, also known as the Eastern Hills, are a mountain range in northeastern India. This range includes the Patkai Hills, the Naga Hills in Nagaland, the Manipur Hills in Manipur, and the Mizo Hills in Mizoram.

Q.567. Which of the following hills is located in the Eastern Ghats?

- (a) Naga hills (b) Khasi hills
(c) Shevaroy hills (d) Anamudi hills

Sol.567.(c) Shevaroy hills. The Eastern Ghats are a series of discontinuous low hills with an average elevation of 600 meters. They extend parallel to the east coast, from the southern part of the Mahanadi valley to the Nilgiri hills. The highest peak in this region is Jindhagada Peak (1,690 meters). Notable hills in the Eastern Ghats include : Mahendragiri and Niyamgiri hills in Odisha, Nallamala hills (Andhra Pradesh), and Kollimalai and Pachaimalai hills in Tamil Nadu.

Q.568. Consider the following statements regarding Mawsynram:

- I. Mawsynram, the wettest place on Earth, is located in the Jaintia Hills of Meghalaya.
- II. Cherrapunji receives more rainfall annually than Mawsynram.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.568.(d) Neither I nor II. In the southern ranges of Khasi hills is Mawsynram, which receives the highest rainfall in the world. Mawsynram, located about 16 kilometers west of Cherrapunji, is recognized as the wettest place on Earth, receiving a higher annual average rainfall than Cherrapunji.

Q.569. What is the name of the highest peak of the Eastern Ghats?

- (a) Kangchenjunga (b) Mahendragiri
(c) Khasi (d) Anamudi

Sol.569.(b) Mahendragiri. This hill was once believed to be the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats. However, in April 2011, a team led by Mr. Venkat Reddy Y found that the elevation of Mahendra Giri Hill is actually 1,501 meters. Jindhagada Peak: After this discovery, it was determined that the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats is Jindhagada Peak, which stands at 1,690 meters. It is located in the Araku Valley in Andhra Pradesh.

Q.570. Which sub-division of Himalayas are famous for Karewa formations ?

- (a) Sikkim Himalayas
(b) Arunachal Himalayas
(c) Uttarakhand Himalayas
(d) Kashmir Himalayas

Sol.570.(d) Kashmir Himalayas. Karewa - thick deposits of glacial clay and moraines. These are the flat topped mounds that border the Kashmir Valley on all sides. The other Himalayan sub-divisions are: Uttarakhand Himalayas: Between the Ravi and Kali rivers. Arunachal Himalayas: Between the Tista and Brahmaputra rivers. Sikkim Himalayas: Between the Kali and Teesta rivers.

Q.571. The Lushai Hills are also known as _____.

- (a) Khasi Hills (b) Mizo Hills
(c) Naga Hills (d) Patkai Hills

Sol.571.(b) Mizo Hills (Mizoram and Manipur). The highest point of Mizo hills is the Blue Mountain. Eastern Hills (The Purvanchal) are the southward extension of Himalayas running along the north-eastern edge of India.

Q.572. The central stretch of the Western Coastal Plains of India is known as the:

- (a) Coromandel coast (b) Konkan coast
(c) Malabar coast (d) Kannad plains

Sol.572.(d) Kannad plains (Between Goa and Mangalore). Malabar coast - Extends from the southern part of Goa to Kanyakumari.

Q.573. The Himalayas' outermost range is called _____.

- (a) Shiwaliks (b) Kanchenjunga
(c) Dhauladhar (d) Pir Panjal

Sol.573.(a) Shiwaliks. They extend over a width of 10-50 Km and have an altitude varying between 900 and 1100 metres. They have low hills like Jammu Hills, etc. Pir Panjal and Dhauladhar are important ranges of lesser Himalayas.

Q.574. In which direction is the general elevation of the peninsular plateau of

India?

- (a) From North to South
- (b) From South to North
- (c) From West to East
- (d) From East to West

Sol.574.(c) From West to East. The Peninsular Plateau of India lies south of the Northern Plains, with an average elevation of 600-900 m. It consists of smaller plateaus and hill ranges with river basins and valleys. The plateau is divided into three groups: Central Highlands (e.g., Malwa, Bundelkhand), Deccan Plateau (e.g., Maharashtra, Karnataka), and Northwestern Plateau (e.g., Aravalli, Vindhya, Satpura ranges).

Q.575. Which of the following hills is located in the Eastern most part of India?

- (a) Jaintia Hills
- (b) Khasi Hills
- (c) Garo Hills
- (d) Patkai Bum Hills

Sol.575.(d) Patkai Bum Hills. Patkai Hills (Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland and Upper Burma region of Myanmar). Western Ghats {Anamudi (highest peak), Mannamala, Meesapulimala, Doddabetta peak, Kolaribetta Peak, etc). The Mizo Hills, located in the southeastern Mizoram state, were formerly called Lushai Hills.

Q.576. Consider the following statements regarding the Eastern Ghats:

- I. The average elevation of the Eastern Ghats is about 600 metres.
- II. The Eastern Ghats are a continuous mountain range extending from Odisha to Tamil Nadu.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.576.(a) Only I. Eastern Ghats comprises the discontinuous and low hills that are highly eroded by the rivers such as the Mahanadi, the Godavari, the Krishna, the Cauvery, etc. The Eastern Ghats are a mesmerising mountain range that extends across the states of Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, and Tamil Nadu.

Q.577. Choose the correct statements about the islands of India.

- a. Lakshadweep Islands are composed of coral islands.
- b. Andaman and Nicobar islands are composed of coral islands.
- c. It is believed that Lakshadweep islands are an elevated portion of submarine mountains.
- d. It is believed that Andaman and Nicobar islands are an elevated portion of submarine mountains.

- (a) b and c
- (b) a and b
- (c) a and d
- (d) c and d

Sol.577.(c) a and d.

Q.578. What is the name of the physical feature that is the longitudinal valley lying between the Lesser Himalayas and the Siwalik in India?

- (a) Duns
- (b) Doab
- (c) Bhabhar
- (d) Terai

Sol.578.(a) Duns are structurally formed valleys covered with boulders and gravel from the erosion of the Himalayas and Shivalik uplands. Major duns in the region include Dehra, Kohtri, Chaukham, Patli, and Kota, with Dehradun being the largest at 35 km long and 25 km wide.

Q.579. The Himalayas have uplifted from which of the following geosynclines?

- (a) Tethys geosynclines
- (b) Appalachians geosynclines
- (c) Caledonian geosynclines
- (d) Aravalli geosynclines

Sol.579.(a) Tethys geosynclines. The northward drift of the Indian Plate resulted in the collision of the plate with the much larger Eurasian Plate. Due to this collision, the sedimentary rocks which were accumulated in the geosyncline known as the Tethys were folded to form the mountain system of western Asia and Himalaya.

Q.580. What is the name of the northern part of the western coastal plain between Mumbai and Goa?

- (a) Coromandel coast
- (b) Malabar coast
- (c) Kannad plain
- (d) Konkan coast

Sol.580.(d) Konkan coast. The central stretch of Arabian Sea is called the Kannad Plain, while the southern stretch is known as the Malabar coast. In the Bay of Bengal, the northern part is called the Northern Circar, and the southern part is the Coromandel Coast.

Q.581. Which of the following physiographic divisions of India has extensive alluvial soil?

- (a) The North Indian Plain
- (b) The Island Group
- (c) The Himalayan Range
- (d) The Great Indian Desert

Sol.581.(a) The North Indian Plain is formed by alluvial deposits brought by rivers such as the Indus, Ganga, and Brahmaputra. These plains stretch about 3,200 km from east to west and are divided into three zones: Bhabar, Terai, and Alluvial plains. Bhabar is a narrow belt near the Shiwalik foothills, while lies south of it. The alluvial plains include the

Khadar (new alluvium) and Bhangar (old alluvium).

Q.582. The Great Indian desert/Thar desert is located on the western margin of which of the following mountain ranges?

- (a) Vindhya range
- (b) Aravalli range
- (c) Eastern ghats
- (d) Satpura range

Sol.582.(b) Aravalli range. It runs approximately 670 km (430 mi) in a south-west direction, starting near Delhi, passing through southern Haryana and Rajasthan, and ending in Gujarat. The highest peak is Guru Shikhar at 1,722 metres (5,650 ft). Vindhya range forms a dividing line between the Ganges Plain and the Deccan Plateau. Satpura range is situated between two west flowing rivers - Narmada and Tapi.

Q.583. Choose the correct statements about the Western Ghats.

- a. The height of the Western Ghats progressively increases from north to south.
- b. Mahendragiri is the highest peak in the Western Ghats.
- c. The Western Ghats are higher than the Eastern Ghats.
- d. The height of the Western Ghats progressively decreases from north to south.

- (a) b, c and d
- (b) a and b
- (c) a and c
- (d) Only c and d

Sol.583.(c) a and c. The highest peak in the Western Ghats is Anamudi (2,695 metres).

Q.584. Which triangular plateau region of India lies south of the river Narmada?

- (a) Deccan plateau
- (b) Marwar plateau
- (c) Baghelkhand plateau
- (d) Malwa plateau

Sol.584.(a) Deccan plateau. Its broad base is flanked by the Satpura Range to the north, while the Mahadev, Kaimur Hills, and Maikal Range extend to the east. The Deccan Plateau is higher in the west and slopes gently eastwards.

Q.585. Geologically, which of the following physiographic divisions of India is supposed to be one of the most stable land blocks?

- (a) The Northern Plains
- (b) The Himalayas
- (c) The Peninsular Plateau
- (d) The Indian Desert

Sol.585.(c) The Peninsular plateau is a tableland composed of the old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic

rocks. This plateau consists of two broad divisions, namely, the Central Highlands and the Deccan Plateau. The part of the Peninsular plateau lying to the north of the Narmada river. The Indian desert lies towards the western margins of the Aravali Hills. It is an undulating sandy plain covered with sand dunes. The northern plain is formed of alluvial soil. The Himalayas, geologically young and structurally fold mountains stretch over the northern borders of India.

Q.586. With reference to the physical features of India, the 'Kayals' are _____.

- (a) Hillocks (b) backwaters
(c) mountain passes (d) valleys

Sol.586.(b) Backwaters: The inland water bodies, often formed by the merging of rivers and lakes or by the backflow of seawater, creating a network of interconnected waterways. In Kerala, these backwaters are locally known as kayals.

Q.587. Which of the following physical divisions of India is densely populated?

- (a) The North Indian Plains
(b) The islands
(c) The Himalayan Range
(d) The Thar Desert

Sol.587.(a) The North Indian Plains has been formed by the interplay of the three major river systems, namely the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra along with their tributaries, which makes its soil highly fertile. Alluvial soil is the major soil found in the plains. The swampy belt of the plains is known as terai.

Q.588. India accounts for what percent of the total geographical area of the world ?

- (a) 3.2 % (b) 5.2 % (c) 4.8 % (d) 2.4 %

Sol.588.(d) 2.4 %. The land mass of India has an area of 3.28 million square km. India is the seventh largest country in the world. Largest countries in the world: Russia, Canada, China, United States, Brazil, Australia, etc.

Q.589. The Standard Meridian of India (82°30'E) passes through _____ state of India.

- (a) Karnataka (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) West Bengal (d) Punjab

Sol.589.(b) Madhya Pradesh. The Standard Meridian - A longitude that determines a standard time for the whole country.

Q.590. Assertion (A): Rajasthan is the biggest state of India in terms of area.

Reason (R): Rajasthan has the maximum population among all Indian states.

- (a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

Sol.590.(c) A is true but R is false. Uttar Pradesh has the maximum population, not Rajasthan. Indian states biggest in terms of area: Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat. Smallest state (in terms of area) - Goa. Smallest Union Territories (in terms of area) - Lakshadweep, Daman and Diu, Chandigarh, Puducherry, Dadra and Nagar Haveli, Delhi.

Q.591. India's total length of coastline of the mainland including Andaman and Nicobar and Lakshadweep is _____

- (a) 7416.6 km (b) 7616 km
(c) 7516.6 km (d) 7716 km

Sol.591.(c) 7516.6 km. Length of Coastline of the Indian mainland - 6100 km. The Coast of the Indian mainland is surrounded by Arabian Sea in the west, Bay of Bengal in the east, and Indian Ocean in the south. India's coastline extends to Nine states (Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, and West Bengal). Largest coastline - Gujarat (1214 km).

Q.592. The plains from Ambala to the Sunderban stretch over nearly 1800 km, but the fall in its slope is hardly _____ metres.

- (a) 550 (b) 300 (c) 600 (d) 450

Sol.592.(b) 300. In other words, there is a fall of just one meter for every 6 km. Therefore, the river develops large meanders. Ambala is located on the water divide between the Indus and the Ganga river systems.

Q.593. Which of the following factors are responsible for railways having not developed much in the north-eastern parts of India?

1. Highly dissected topography
2. Dense forests
3. Low population density
4. Heavy rainfall and frequent flooding
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) Only 3 and 4
(c) Only 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 4

Sol.593.(d) 1,2 and 4. The northeastern part of India is marked by the presence of big rivers, dissected relief, dense forests, frequent floods, landslides,

international frontiers, etc. The first railway proposals for India were made in Madras in 1832. As a result, the country got its first train in the form of the Red Hill Railway which was built with the sole purpose of transporting granite for road-building in 1837.

Q.594. Which of the following is a mountain pass in the Pir Panjal range at a maximum altitude of 2832 meters that connects the Kashmir Valley in the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir with the Outer Himalayas and the plains in the south?

- (a) Mana Pass (b) Banihal Pass
(c) Bara-Lacha Pass (d) ZojiLa Pass

Sol.594.(b) Banihal pass (Jammu and Kashmir) is situated in the Pir - Panjal Range. It connects Banihal with Qazigund. Mana Pass (Uttarakhand) is located in the Greater Himalayas and connects Tibet with Uttarakhand. Bara lacha pass - Connects Himachal Pradesh's Lahaul area with Ladakh. ZojiLa Pass connects Leh and Srinagar.

Q.595. With reference to the major regions of the northern plains, Bhabar is:

- (a) the older alluvium along the river beds forming terraces higher than the floodplain
(b) a narrow belt of about 8 to 16 km that runs in the west-east direction along the foot of the Himalayas from the river Indus to Teesta
(c) composed of newer alluvium and forms flood plains along the river banks
(d) a broad long zone of northern India and southern Nepal running parallel to the lower ranges of the Himalayas

Sol.595.(b) Bhabar is a narrow belt lying parallel to the slopes of the Shiwaliks in Uttarakhand. It is narrow in the east and wide in the western and northwestern hilly regions. It comprises gravel and un-assorted sediment deposits. Crop cultivation is not possible in this tract, only giant trees with deep roots grow.

Q.596. In which of the following regions of India is the natural habitat of White-bellied Heron largely distributed?

- (a) North-east (b) Northern plains
(c) Deccan plateau (d) Western coast

Sol.596.(a) North-east India, the easternmost region of the country, comprises eight states: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura, and Sikkim.

Q.597. Deserts, rain, forests, coral reefs,

and mangroves are features of _____ diversity.

- (a) genetic (b) cultural
(c) species (d) ecological

Sol.597.(d) Ecological diversity includes species diversity, genetic diversity, and ecosystem diversity. They are collectively considered biodiversity. It is the sum of all kinds of animals and plants living on this earth along with their habitat.

Q.598. Consider the following statements:

1. Tawang is a tourism hotspot in Arunachal Pradesh.
2. Kalimpong district belongs to Sikkim.
3. Alipurduar and Jalpaiguri are districts of West Bengal.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Only 3 (d) 2 and 3

Sol.598.(b) Only 2. Kalimpong is in West Bengal.

Q.599. The archaeological site of Atranjikhhera is located in _____.

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Maharashtra

Sol.599.(c) Uttar Pradesh. This site was first identified by Sir Alexander Cunningham in 1862 but excavated by R C Gaur in 1962.

Q.600. In the state of _____, the general direction of the Himalayas is from southwest to northeast.

- (a) Manipur (b) Nagaland
(c) Mizoram (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Sol.600.(d) Arunachal Pradesh.

Himalayas in the Darjeeling and Sikkim regions lie in an east-west direction.

Q.601. Which of the following mountain is situated in the state of Uttarakhand?

- (a) Nathu La Pass
(b) Baralacha La Pass
(c) Bomdi La Pass
(d) Mangsha Dhura Pass

Sol.601.(d) Mangsha Dhura Pass. Other passes in Uttarakhand: Kalindi Pass, Lipulekh Pass, Mana Pass, Auden's Col, Muling La, Nama Pass, Niti Pass, Traill's Pass.

Q.602. Which among the following states does NOT share its border with Odisha?

- (a) Chhattisgarh (b) Jharkhand
(c) Bihar (d) West Bengal

Sol.602.(c) Bihar. Odisha is surrounded by 4 states: Andhra Pradesh from the

south, Chhattisgarh from the west and Jharkhand and West Bengal from the north.

Q.603. River Sutlej enters India through which pass?

- (a) Shipki La (b) Lipulekh
(c) Zoji La (d) Nathula

Sol.603.(a) Shipki La - From here, Satluj traverses through many Himalayan valleys before it merges with Chenab in Pakistan before landing into Indus.

Q.604. Which among the following is a western coast island?

- (a) Pamban (b) Elephanta
(c) Parikud (d) Sriharikota

Sol.604.(b) Elephanta island is located in Mumbai Harbour of the Arabian Sea. Pamban (between peninsular India and Sri Lanka), Parikud (Odisha), and Sriharikota (Andhra Pradesh).

Transportation

Q.605. Name the Indian port that is the largest exporter of iron ore ?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Paradip Port
(b) Chennai Port
(c) Visakhapatnam Port
(d) Marmagao Port

Sol.605.(d) Marmagao Port, Goa, is one of the oldest major ports on the west coast of India. It is the largest exporter of iron ore in the country, handling a substantial portion of India's iron ore exports due to its proximity to Goa's iron ore mining belt. Other ports: Paradip Port (Odisha) : Major port for coal, iron ore, and crude oil but not the largest in iron ore exports. Chennai Port (Tamil Nadu): Handles containers, cars, and general cargo, not primarily iron ore. Visakhapatnam Port (Andhra Pradesh): Handles iron ore and coal, but Marmagao surpasses it in ore exports.

Q.606. Which of the below statements is/are correct?

Statement 1: India supports connectivity through the North-South Transport Corridor.

Statement 2: The corridor strengthens India's trade with the Pacific Islands.

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Only Statement 2 is correct
(b) Only Statement 1 is correct
(c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
(d) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

Sol.606.(b) India supports connectivity through the International North-South

Transport Corridor (INSTC), which is a multi-modal network of ship, rail, and road routes aimed at connecting India with Central Asia, Russia, and Europe via Iran. This strategic corridor is designed to reduce transit time and cost in moving goods between India and Eurasia. However, Statement 2 is incorrect because the corridor has no direct relevance to India's trade with the Pacific Islands, which are geographically distant and lie in a completely different direction.

Q.607. What is the primary mission behind India's involvement in the International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC)?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) To promote clean maritime security
(b) To bypass China's CPEC route via Taiwan
(c) To improve connectivity with Eurasia via multimodal routes
(d) To facilitate transit trade through the Arctic

Sol.607.(c) The INSTC (International North-South Transport Corridor) is a multi-modal (ship-rail-road) transport network covering about 7,200 km. It connects India → Iran → Russia → Central Asia → Europe. Main goals: Provide India with a shorter, cheaper trade route to Eurasia compared to the Suez Canal route. Strengthen India's presence in Central Asia and Russia while bypassing Pakistan. Enhance trade and energy connectivity with Eurasia through integrated logistics.

Q.608. What is the length of the Indian Railways network, according to the Railway Yearbook 2019-20 ?

- (a) 67,956 km (b) 1,604 km
(c) 63,950 km (d) 2,402 km

Sol.608.(a) 67,956 km. The length of the Indian Railways network, according to the Railway Yearbook 2019-20 : Broad gauge - The distance between the rails is 1.676 meters, with a total length of 63,950 km. Metre gauge - The distance between the rails is 1 meter, with a total length of 2,402 km. Narrow gauge - The distance between the rails is either 0.762 meters or 0.610 meters, with a total length of 1,604 km.

Q.609. According to the Indian Railways (2019-2020), which state has the largest railway track in India?

- (a) Punjab (b) Haryana
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.609.(d) Uttar Pradesh. The longest railway track in India is the

Dibrugarh-Kanyakumari Vivek Express (approx 4200 km), running from Dibrugarh in Assam to Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu. The shortest railway line is the 3-kilometer route between Nagpur and Ajni in Maharashtra. The five states with the largest route kilometers are Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Andhra Pradesh.

Q.610. In which of the following states is the development of rail transport less, due to its geographical conditions?

- (a) Sikkim (b) Haryana
(c) Bihar (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.610.(a) Sikkim is predominantly mountainous, characterized by steep slopes and rugged terrain, which complicates the construction of rail infrastructure.

Q.611. Through which routes is the majority of India's international trade carried out?

- (a) Railway and air (b) Sea and air
(c) Only Railway (d) Sea and railway

Sol.611.(b) Sea and air. India has a coastline of approximately 7,516.6 km, making maritime transport essential for international trade. According to the Ministry of Shipping, about 95% of India's trade by volume and 70% by value is conducted via sea routes. A smaller portion of trade occurs through land routes to neighboring countries, including Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan.

Q.612. According to the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways' annual report (2020-2021), which position does India have in terms of road networks in the world?

- (a) First (b) Second (c) Fourth (d) Third

Sol.612.(b) Second. India has the second largest road network in the world after the USA. India's road network stands at over 63,71,847 km. This comprises National Highways, Expressways, State Highways, Major District Roads, other District Roads and Village Roads (Ministry of Road Transport & Highways Annual Report FY 2021-22).

Q.613. As of Financial year 2019, which of the following states has the highest road density in India?

- (a) Haryana (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) Punjab

Sol.613.(c) Kerala. As of the financial year 2019, Kerala had the highest road

density among states, with 6.7 thousand kilometers of roads per one thousand square kilometers. Among union territories, Chandigarh had the highest road density in India, with over 22.6 thousand kilometers per one thousand square kilometers. Road density refers to the total length of all roads in a country, including highways, national roads, and city or rural roads, compared to the country's land area.

Q.614. Consider the following statements:

- I. The delta channels of Mahanadi and Brahmani rivers along with the East Coast Canal are connected by National Waterway-5.
- II. National Waterway-3 connects Prayagraj in Uttar Pradesh to Haldia in West Bengal through the Ganga-Bhagirathi-Hooghly system.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.614.(a) Only I. NW 5 connects the states of Odisha and West Bengal, stretching 623 km in total, with 91 km in West Bengal and 532 km in Odisha. National Waterway-1 (NW-1) spans the Ganga-Bhagirathi-Hooghly river system from Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, to Haldia, West Bengal. National Waterway-3, also known as the West Coast Canal, is a 168 km route in Kerala from Kollam to Kottapuram.

Q.615. About what percentage of passenger traffic is carried by roads in India?

- (a) 77% (b) 87% (c) 57% (d) 67%

Sol.615.(b) 87%. The Road Transport Sector handles about 60% of freight traffic in India. For passenger traffic, roads account for 87%, railways for 12%, and both air and waterways contribute approximately 0.5% each, as per the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.

Q.616. Which of the following is an example of an eastern coast port?

- (a) Mumbai Port
(b) Chennai Port
(c) Mormugao Port
(d) New Mangalore Port

Sol.616.(b) Chennai Port started its commercial operations in 1881. The major ports on the eastern coast : Tuticorin - Tamil Nadu, Ennore - Tamil Nadu, Chennai - Tamil Nadu, Haldia and Kolkata - West Bengal, Paradip - Odisha,

Visakhapatnam - Andhra Pradesh, Port Blair - Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Q.617. Which of the following ports was developed as a Satellite port to relieve the pressure at the Mumbai port?

- (a) New Mangalore Port
(b) Marmagao Port
(c) Deendayal Port Authority
(d) Jawaharlal Nehru Port

Sol.617.(d) Jawaharlal Nehru Port

(Nhava Sheva), established on 26 May 1989, is India's second-largest container port, following Mundra Port. New Mangalore Port, in Karnataka, is operated by the New Mangalore Port Trust. Mormugao Port, commissioned in 1885, is located on Goa's western coast.

Q.618. In which year was the Konkan Railway constructed?

- (a) 1998 (b) 1978 (c) 1988 (d) 2008

Sol.618.(a) 1998. Indian Railways founded the Konkan Railway on 19th July 1990. Konkan Railways crosses 146 river streams, nearly 2000 bridges, and 91 tunnels. The states of Maharashtra, Goa, and Karnataka are partners in this undertaking.

Q.619. The Atal Tunnel has been built by Border Road Organisation at an altitude of 3000 metres. Which places are connected by this tunnel?

- (a) Manali to Shimla
(b) Shimla to Srinagar
(c) Shimla to Ladakh
(d) Manali to Lahaul-Spiti

Sol.619.(d) Manali to Lahaul-Spiti. Atal Tunnel (also known as Rohtang Tunnel) is a highway tunnel built under the Rohtang Pass in the eastern Pir Panjal range of the Himalayas on the Leh-Manali Highway in Himachal Pradesh. It reduces the distance between Solang Valley and Sissu by approximately 46 km. Pir Panjal Railway Tunnel - India's longest transportation railway tunnel.

Q.620. Match the following ports with their related states correctly.

Ports	States
1. Mormugao port	a. West Bengal
2. Paradip Port	b. Odisha
3. Haldia Port	c. Tamil Nadu
4. Tuticorin Port	d. Goa

- (a) 1-d, 2-b, 3-a, 4-c (b) 1-a, 2-b, 3-d, 4-c
(c) 1-b, 2-d, 3-a, 4-c (d) 1-b, 2-d, 3-c, 4-a

Sol.620.(a) 1-d, 2-b, 3-a, 4-c. Other major ports of India: Andhra Pradesh - Visakhapatnam Port. Tamil Nadu - Kamarajar Port, Chennai Port, Tuticorin

Port.

Q.621. When was air transport nationalised in India?

- (a) 1950 (b) 1952 (c) 1951 (d) 1953

Sol.621.(d) 1953. The Air Corporations Act of 1953 led to the nationalization of Indian airlines and the formation of two corporations: Indian Airlines for domestic routes and Air India International for international routes.

Q.622. Match the railway zones in column A with their headquarters in column B.

Column A (Railway zones)	Column B (Headquarters)
1. Central	a. New Delhi
2. Northern	b. Mumbai CST
3. Eastern	c. Chennai
4. Southern	d. Kolkata

- (a) 1-b, 2-d, 3-a, 4-c (b) 1-a, 2-b, 3-d, 4-c
(c) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c (d) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d

Sol.622.(c) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c.

Q.623. Consider the following statements:

- The Howrah Bridge was officially opened in 1943.
- It was renamed Rabindra Setu in 1965 in honour of Rabindranath Tagore.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.623.(c) Both I and II. The Howrah Bridge is a balanced steel bridge over the Hooghly River in West Bengal, India. At the time it was built the name given to it was the New Howrah Bridge. It was renamed Rabindra Setu in 1965 after the great Bengali poet Rabindranath Tagore. But it is still popularly known by the name Howrah Bridge.

Q.624. What is the total length of the Golden Quadrilateral, built by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)?

- (a) 5978 km (b) 4658 km
(c) 5790 km (d) 5846 km

Sol.624.(d) 5846 km. The Golden Quadrilateral is a major highway network connecting four megacities in India: Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, and Mumbai. The routes are Delhi-Kolkata via NH-2, Mumbai-Delhi via NH-8, Mumbai-Chennai via NH-4, and Chennai-Kolkata via NH-5. The National Highways Authority of India, established in 1988, operates under the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.

Q.625. Pipelines as a means of transport are looked after by the _____ of the Government of India.

- (a) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
(b) Ministry of Home Affairs
(c) Ministry of Railways
(d) Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Sol.625.(a) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Some major pipelines in India: Hazira - Bijaypur - Jagdishpur Pipeline - India's longest gas pipeline, which runs from Gujarat to Uttar Pradesh. Jamnagar-Loni LPG Pipeline - It transports LPG from Jamnagar to Loni near Delhi. Naharkatia-Nunmati-Barauni Pipeline - India's first crude oil pipeline, which runs from Assam to the Barauni refinery.

Q.626. As of 2022, which of the following is the longest national waterway in India?

- (a) Allahabad-Haldia stretch
(b) Sadiya-Dhubri stretch
(c) Godavari-Krishna stretch
(d) Kottapuram-Kollam stretch

Sol.626.(a) Allahabad-Haldia stretch (1,620 km). It is divided into three parts for developmental purposes - (i) Haldia-Farakka (560 km), (ii) Farakka -Patna (460 km), (iii) Patna Allahabad (600 km). National Waterways (NW) of India : NW 2 - Sadiya-Dhubri stretch (891 km). NW 3 - Kottapuram-Kollam stretch (205 km). NW 4 - Specific stretches of Godavari and Krishna rivers along with Kakinada-Puducherry stretch of canals (1078 km). NW 5 - Specified stretches of river Brahmani along with Matai river, delta channels of Mahanadi and Brahmani rivers and East Coast canals (588 km).

Q.627. How many major ports are there in India for maritime transportation?

- (a) 21 (b) 15 (c) 18 (d) 13

Sol.627.(d) 13. Ports and State : Chennai Port (Tamil Nadu), Ennore Port (Tamil Nadu), Shyama Prasad Mukherji Port (West Bengal), Deendayal Port (Gujarat), Kochi Port (Kerala), Port Blair (Andaman and Nicobar Islands), New Mangalore Port (Karnataka), Mormugao (Goa), Mumbai Port (Maharashtra), Paradip Port (Odisha), Tuticorin Port (Tamil Nadu).

Q.628. The historical Sher Shah Suri Marg is called the National Highway no. _____ between Delhi and Amritsar.

- (a) 9 (b) 3 (c) 1 (d) 7

Sol.628.(c) 1. Sher Shah Suri built the Shahi (Royal) Road to strengthen and

consolidate his empire from the Indus Valley to Bengal's Sonar Valley. This road was renamed the Grand Trunk (GT) Road during British rule, connecting Kolkata and Peshawar. Currently, it extends from Amritsar to Kolkata and is divided into two segments: National Highway (NH)-1 from Delhi to Amritsar and NH-2 from Delhi to Kolkata.

Q.629. In which of the following years was the air transport in India launched?

- (a) 1948 (b) 1932 (c) 1954 (d) 1911

Sol.629.(d) 1911. Air Transportation: Air transport in India was launched between Allahabad and Naini (10 km). George Light started Air Transport in India. The first airmail flight was piloted by French pilot Henri Pequet. Air transport was nationalised and two Corporations, Air India International and Indian Airlines were formed in 1953.

Q.630. In India, which of the following modes of transportation reduces trans-shipment losses and delays in supply of petroleum and gas?

- (a) Waterways (b) Railways
(c) Pipeline (d) Roadways

Sol.630.(c) Pipelines are cost-effective and can transport large volumes of liquids or gasses over long distances with minimal environmental impact. Advantages - Dedicated Infrastructure, Minimized Handling, Continuous Flow, Cost-Effective, Environmental Benefits, Energy Efficiency, Reduces Congestion. Naharkatia-Noonmati -Barauni Pipeline is the first crude oil pipeline constructed in India. Jamnagar-Loni LPG Pipeline is India's longest pipeline.

Q.631. Which of the following is NOT a part of the six communication mail channels in India?

- (a) Metro channel (b) Monthly channel
(c) Rajdhani channel (d) Business channel

Sol.631.(b) Monthly Channel. The six communication mail channels in India: Rajdhani (Yellow colored mailboxes are installed at post offices), Metro (Blue colored mailboxes are installed at post offices), Green (Green colored mailboxes are installed at post offices in large and metropolitan cities), Business (Physical mail that is commercial in nature), Periodical (Intended for newspapers, magazines, and other periodical publications) and Bulk (Consists of letters, newsletters, leaflets, and other similar products).

Q.632. Which of the following is NOT a

characteristic of National Highways in India?

- (a) Meant for inter-state transport
- (b) Connect state capitals and major cities
- (c) Construction of border roads in high altitude areas
- (d) Maintained by the Central Government

Sol.632.(c) Border Roads Organisation (BRO): Functions under the control of the Ministry of Defence. Formation - 1960. Headquarters - Seema Sadak Bhawan (New Delhi). National Highways Authority of India - Formed under the NHAI (National Highways Authority of India Act) in 1988. Headquarters - New Delhi. It operates under the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.

Q.633. Which project aims to develop state roads along coastal border areas, including connectivity of non-major ports?

- (a) Golden Quadrilateral
- (b) Setubharatam Pariyojana
- (c) District Headquarters Connectivity Scheme
- (d) Bharatmala

Sol.633.(d) Bharatmala. This centrally funded project is an ecosystem of road development which includes development of tunnels, bridges, elevated corridors, flyovers, overpasses, interchanges, bypasses, ring roads etc. Golden Quadrilateral - Highway network which links 4 largest metropolises: Delhi (north), Kolkata (east), Mumbai (west), and Chennai (south). Setu Bharatam - To make all National Highways free of railway level crossings.

Q.634. Consider the following statements:

- I. The Grand Trunk Road was built by Sher Shah Suri.
- II. It connects Amritsar and Kolkata in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.634.(c) Both I and II. Grand Trunk Road (built by Sher Shah Suri) - One of the oldest road routes in India. Length - 2400 km. It links Central Asia to the Indian Subcontinent. The route was called Uttarapatha. NH-44 - India's longest highway. NH-548 - India's shortest highways.

Q.635. Which waterway provides connectivity with mainland India through

the India - Bangladesh Protocol route?

- (a) NW-10 (b) NW-15 (c) NW-2 (d) NW-83

Sol.635.(c) NW - 2 (891 Km) Between Sadiya and Dhubri on river Brahmaputra. Pandu port (Assam) is the largest river port in Assam. NW - 1 (1620 km): Ganga - Bhagirathi - Hooghly River (Allahabad - Haldia). It is the longest and oldest National Waterways in India. NW-10: Amba River. NW-69: It is the smallest waterway (5 km).

Q.636. Asansol, Howrah, Malda and Sealdah division come under which railway zone of India?

- (a) West Central Railway
- (b) Northern Railway
- (c) Central Railway
- (d) Eastern Railway

Sol.636.(d) Eastern Railway. Formed on - 14 April 1952 by amalgamating three lower divisions of the East Indian Railway: Howrah, Asansol and Danapur, the entire Bengal Nagpur Railway (BNR) and the Sealdah division of the erstwhile Bengal Assam Railway. Headquarters - Kolkata. Kalka Mail of Eastern Railway is the oldest running train in the history of Indian Railways.

Q.637. Which autonomous body was operationalised under the Ministry of Surface Transport in 1995?

- (a) Border Roads Organization (BRO)
- (b) Centre for Railway Information System (CRIS)
- (c) Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI)
- (d) National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)

Sol.637.(d) National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) - Operationalised in 1995 and established under the National Highways Authority of India Act, 1988. Headquarters - New Delhi. Other organizations:- Border Roads Organization (BRO) - Formed, 7 May 1960. Headquarters - New Delhi. Center for Railway Information System (CRIS) - Founded, July 1986. Headquarters - New Delhi. Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI) - Founded, 27 October 1986 and headquartered - Noida (Uttar Pradesh).

Q.638. Which of the following is the only rack railway in India that was declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2005?

- (a) Nilgiri Mountain Railway
- (b) Kangra Valley Railway
- (c) Matheran Hill Railway
- (d) Kalka-Shimla Railway

Sol.638.(a) Nilgiri Mountain Railway. Darjeeling Himalayan Railway (In UNESCO list in 1999), Kalka Shimla Railway (2008) and Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus, Mumbai (2004). There are 43 World Heritage Sites in India. Out of these, 35 are cultural, seven are natural, and one, Khangchendzonga National Park, is of mixed type (As of October 2024).

Q.639. Select the natural port of India from the following.

- (a) Mumbai Port
- (b) Chennai Port
- (c) Deendayal Port
- (d) Kolkata Port

Sol.639.(a) Mumbai Port - India's largest natural port. Chennai Port (Madras Port) - It is a man-made, all-weather harbor with wet docks, the largest port in the Bay of Bengal. Deendayal Port (Kandla Port) - Largest port of India by volume of cargo handled. Kolkata Port (Shyama Prasad Mookerjee Port) - Oldest operating port in India, built by East India Company.

Q.640. Match the National Waterways with their respective states:

- A. NW-97 → (i) West Bengal
- B. NW-98 → (ii) Punjab & Himachal Pradesh
- C. NW-93 → (iii) Meghalaya
- D. NW-99 → (iv) Tamil Nadu
- (a) A-i, B-ii, C-iii, D-iv
- (b) A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i
- (c) A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii
- (d) A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii

Sol.640.(a) NW - 1 (Ganga - Bhagirathi - Hooghly): The longest waterways in India (Prayagraj to Haldia) - Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand & West Bengal. NW - 2 (Brahmaputra River) - Assam. NW - 3 (West Coast Canal and Champakara and Udyogamandal Canals) - Kerala. NW - 98 (Sutlej River) - Punjab and Himachal Pradesh. NW - 10 (Amba River) - Maharashtra. NW - 93 (Simsang River) - Meghalaya. NW - 83 (Rajpuri Creek) - Maharashtra. NW - 111 (Zuari River) - Goa. NW - 73 (Narmada River) - Gujarat and Maharashtra. NW - 97 (Sundarbans Waterways) - West Bengal.

Q.641. In India, roads are classified in the ____ classes according to their capacity.

- (a) seven
- (b) four
- (c) three
- (d) six

Sol.641.(d) Six. Classification of Roads : Expressways, National highways, State highways, District roads, Rural roads, and Border roads or Project roads. NH-44 is the longest national highway in India with a length of 3745 Kilometers running from Srinagar in the north to Kanyakumari in

the south.

Q.642. _____ is the deepest landlocked and well-protected port.

- (a) Kandla (b) Mumbai
(c) Visakhapatnam (d) Paradip

Sol.642.(c) Visakhapatnam - It is a major port (total 13 in India) located in Andhra Pradesh coast of Bay of Bengal. It is a natural harbor. The major commodities in this port include Iron ore, manganese ore, steel products, general cargo, coal and crude oil.

Q.643. The Vadhavan Port is located in _____.

- (a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) West Bengal (d) Maharashtra

Sol.643.(d) Maharashtra. It will be India's 13th port. Other ports of India: Largest Port - Mumbai Port. Deepest Sea Port - Gangavaram Port (Andhra Pradesh). Largest Artificial Port - Jawaharlal Nehru Port.

Q.644. Which among the following is India's first corporatised port?

- (a) Kochi (b) Kandla
(c) Mangalore (d) Ennore

Sol.644.(d) Ennore (Kamarajar port). Located - Coromandel Coast, Tamil Nadu. The Kochi International Container Transshipment Terminal (ICTT), locally known as the Vallarpadam Terminal, is the first transshipment terminal in India and the first container terminal to operate in a SEZ (Special Economic Zone).

Q.645. In Trans-Siberian railway system Vladivostok lies on _____ coast.

- (a) Atlantic (b) Antarctic
(c) Arctic (d) Pacific

Sol.645.(d) Pacific. Trans-Siberian Railway is the longest railway, connecting St. Petersburg to Vladivostok on the Pacific coast.

Q.646. The ancient port, Sopara is located in which of the following states?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Kerala
(c) Odisha (d) Tamil Nadu

Sol.646.(a) Maharashtra. The ancient port, Sopara (capital of the ancient Aparanta) - In ancient times, it was the largest township on India's west coast, trading with Mesopotamia, Egypt, Cochin, Arabia and Eastern Africa.

Q.647. National Highway No. 7 connects:

- (a) Fazilka to Mana
(b) Kashmir to Kanyakumari
(c) Varanasi to Kanyakumari

(d) Kanpur to Silchar

Sol.647.(a) Fazilka to Mana. Fazilka (Punjab) - Rishikesh - Badrinath - Mana (Uttarakhand).

Q.648. Which of the following ancient ports was situated on the Malabar Coast?

- (a) Barygaza (b) Muziris
(c) Tamralipti (d) Palur

Sol.648.(b) Muziris Port. It became popular when Babylonians, Assyrians, and Egyptians came to the Malabar Coast in search of spices in 3000 BC.

Q.649. What is the approximate length of the navigable inland waterways of India?

- (a) 14,500 km (b) 15,600 km
(c) 16,400 km (d) 12,800 km

Sol.649.(a) 14,500 km. To promote Inland Water Transport (IWT), 111 waterways (5 existing and 106 new) were declared National Waterways under the National Waterways Act, 2016, effective from 12th April 2016.

Q.650. What was National Highway 66 (NH 66) previously known as?

- (a) NH2 (b) NH8 (c) NH5 (d) NH 17

Sol.650.(d) NH 17. It connects Panvel in Maharashtra to Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu state.

Population

Q.651. Which Indian state has the highest proportion of its workforce population engaged in agriculture?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Bihar (d) Punjab

Sol.651.(b) Uttar Pradesh has the highest proportion of its workforce engaged in agriculture, with nearly 70% of its population depending on farming and allied activities for livelihood. Despite this, the state contributes relatively less to India's overall agricultural output due to small landholdings, low mechanization, and dependence on monsoon rains. Other states like Bihar, Rajasthan and Punjab also have large agricultural bases, but in terms of percentage of workforce engaged, Uttar Pradesh has the highest proportion.

Q.652. Which Union Territory has the highest population density as per Census 2011?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Chandigarh (b) Puducherry
(c) Lakshadweep (d) Delhi

Sol.652.(d) Delhi. As per Census 2011, Delhi has the highest population density among Union Territories with 11,297 persons per sq. km. Other UTs: Chandigarh - 9,252, Puducherry - 2,598, Lakshadweep - 2,149 persons/sq. km. Highest population density state - Bihar (1,106 persons/sq. km). Lowest population density state - Arunachal Pradesh (17 persons/sq. km).

Q.653. What is the term for the shift of workers from agriculture to industry and services?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Industrialization
(b) Urbanization
(c) Occupational diversification
(d) Economic transition

Sol.653.(c) Occupational diversification.

The shift of workers from the agriculture sector to industry and services is termed occupational diversification. It reflects structural changes in the economy as development takes place. In a developing economy, most of the workforce is initially engaged in agriculture. With industrialization and urbanization, workers gradually move to secondary (industry) and tertiary (services) sectors. This transition is also linked to economic development and is a sign of modernization. In India, despite progress, a significant proportion of the workforce is still dependent on agriculture, though the services sector contributes the highest share to GDP.

Q.654. What shape does a population pyramid take for a rapidly growing population?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Inverted triangle shape
(b) Circular shape
(c) Triangular shape
(d) Rectangular shape

Sol.654.(c) Triangular shape. A population pyramid for a rapidly growing population has a broad base and narrow top, forming a triangular shape. This indicates high birth rates, a large proportion of young people, and relatively fewer elderly individuals. Rectangular shape indicates a stable or slowly growing population where birth and death rates are low and the population is evenly distributed across age groups (seen in developed countries).

Q.655. Which of the following statements are correct?

1. Birth rate measures the number of children born per 1000 people annually.
2. Pull factors include opportunities that attract people to new regions.
3. Death rate is always higher than birth rate.
4. Push factors can include civil unrest and lack of jobs.

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) All of the above (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2, and 4 only (d) 1 and 3 only

Sol.655.(c) 1, 2, and 4 only. Birth rate is correctly defined as the number of live births per 1000 population in a year. Pull factors are positive conditions and opportunities, such as better jobs, education, or security, that attract people to a new location. Death rate is not always higher than birth rate; in fact, most countries experience higher birth rates, except in advanced economies with population decline. Push factors are negative conditions, such as poverty, unemployment, political instability, or civil unrest, that compel people to leave their home region.

Q.656. Which Indian Union Territory has the most Scheduled Castes?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Delhi (b) Chandigarh
(c) Ladakh (d) Lakshadweep

Sol.656.(a) Delhi. As per the 2011 Census of India, among all Union Territories, Delhi has the highest Scheduled Caste (SC) population in absolute numbers. Scheduled Castes constitute about 16.75% of Delhi's total population, which is the largest share compared to other Union Territories. Chandigarh also has a significant SC population (around 18.9%), but in absolute numbers, Delhi far exceeds all others because of its large population base. Lakshadweep and Ladakh, being small in population, have negligible SC representation.

Q.657. Which of the following statements best explains why certain regions exhibit high population density?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Regions offering fertile land, favorable climates, abundant natural resources, and robust economic opportunities are more likely to have high population densities.
(b) High population density is predominantly found in areas with poor infrastructure and limited access to essential services.
(c) Regions with limited natural

resources tend to have Areas with scarce natural resources have higher population concentrations because of greater competition for few materials.
(d) Areas characterized by mountainous terrain and arid climates often support dense populations because of their challenging living conditions.

Sol.657.(a) Population density is strongly influenced by physical and economic factors. Fertile soil and favorable climate support agriculture, ensuring food security. Access to water bodies and natural resources sustains livelihoods. Economic opportunities and infrastructure in such regions attract migration. Hence, such areas develop into population-dense centers.

Q.658. Which of the following statements best captures the essence of Malthus' theory as outlined in the passage?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) The natural imbalance between food supply and population growth leads to unavoidable hardships unless population is controlled.
(b) Voluntary checks on population are more effective than natural calamities in curbing overpopulation.
(c) Population grows in arithmetic progression, while food production grows geometrically.
(d) Agricultural production can grow faster than population with technological advancement.

Sol.658.(a) The statement perfectly encapsulates the core argument of Thomas Malthus's theory on population. He posited that there is a fundamental tension between the rates of population growth and food production. Population, when unchecked, increases at a geometric rate (e.g., 2, 4, 8, 16), while the food supply increases at a much slower, arithmetic rate (e.g., 2, 3, 4, 5). This "natural imbalance" inevitably leads to a point where the population outstrips the available resources, resulting in "unavoidable hardships" like famine, disease, and war. These are what Malthus called "positive checks." The only way to avoid this fate, he argued, is through "preventive checks"—conscious decisions to control the population, such as delaying marriage and practicing moral restraint.

Q.659. Which of the following statements is/are true regarding India's rural and urban population trends from 1901 to 2011?

1. The rural population has consistently increased in absolute numbers.
2. The percentage share of rural population in total population has steadily declined.
3. Urban population first exceeded 100 million in 1981.

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) All of the above
(c) Only 1 and 3 (d) Only 2 and 3

Sol.659.(a) Only 1 and 2. Despite rapid urbanization, India's rural population kept increasing in absolute numbers in every census from 1901 to 2011. It rose from about 212 million in 1901 to over 833 million in 2011. However, the share of the rural population declined from 89% (1901) to 68.84% (2011). India's urban population crossed 100 million in the 1971 Census, reaching about 109 million (10.78 crore), and further increased to around 159 million in 1981.

Q.660. Which of the following factors contributes to the low child sex ratio in some economically developed Northern states of India?

1. Increased accessibility to prenatal sex-determination methods
2. High levels of female literacy and empowerment
3. Societal preference for male children in inheritance and family support
4. Strengthened enforcement of gender-equal policies

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1 and 4

Sol.660.(c) 1 and 3. The low child sex ratio in some economically developed northern states of India can be attributed primarily to two key factors. Firstly, increased accessibility to prenatal sex-determination methods has led to the misuse of medical technology for sex-selective abortions, despite being legally prohibited. Secondly, a deep-rooted societal preference for male children, particularly due to traditional views on inheritance, family lineage, and support for aging parents, continues to influence family decisions.

Q.661. Read the following statements and choose the **correct** option:

Statement 1: Karnataka has the highest elephant population among Southern States.

Statement 2: A high number of juvenile elephant deaths in Karnataka are due to Elephant Endotheliotropic Herpesvirus (EEHV).

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Only Statement 1 is correct
- (b) Only Statement 2 is correct
- (c) Both Statements 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither Statement 1 nor 2 is correct

Sol.661.(c) Statement 1 is correct: Among the southern states, Karnataka has the highest elephant population, as per recent wildlife census data. Statement 2 is also correct: There has been a significant number of juvenile elephant deaths in Karnataka due to Elephant Endotheliotropic Herpesvirus (EEHV), a fatal disease affecting young elephants. Both statements are factually accurate.

Q.662. Which of the following states has the lowest population in India, according to the 2011 Census of India?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Odisha
- (c) Punjab (d) Madhya Pradesh

Sol.662.(c) Punjab. According to Census 2011, Punjab's population was about 2.77 crore, which is the lowest among the given options (Maharashtra - 11.24 cr, Madhya Pradesh - 7.26 cr, Odisha - 4.19 cr). A Census is the process of collecting, analyzing, and publishing demographic, social, and economic data of a country's population. In India, it is conducted every 10 years by the Registrar General & Census Commissioner (MHA). The first synchronous Census was held in 1881, and since then, it has been conducted regularly every decade till 2011. It is the largest administrative exercise in the world.

Q.663. Which of the following correctly matches the population growth phase in India with its key characteristics?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Phase IV (Post-1981) - Sudden increase in fertility rate due to migration
- (b) Phase III (1951-1981) - Population explosion caused by falling death rate and high fertility
- (c) Phase I (1901-1921) - Rapid population explosion due to low mortality and high fertility
- (d) Phase II (1921-1951) - High mortality rate and declining birth rate

Sol.663.(b) Phase III (1951-1981) - Population explosion caused by falling death rate and high fertility. India's population growth can be studied in four phases: Phase I (1901-1921) – Stagnant Growth / High Mortality. Characterized by very high birth and death rates, frequent famines and epidemics, resulting in

almost stagnant growth. Phase II (1921-1951) – Steady Growth. After the "Year of Great Divide" (1921), mortality began to decline due to improved health facilities, but birth rates remained high, leading to gradual growth. Phase III (1951-1981) – Population Explosion. This period saw a sharp fall in death rates due to medical and technological advancements, while fertility remained high, leading to rapid population growth (population explosion). Phase IV (Post-1981 – Present) – Declining Growth Rate. Birth rates started declining significantly due to family planning, urbanization, education, and awareness. There was no sudden fertility rise due to migration.

Q.664. In each of the following questions, a statement labeled Assertion (A) is given, followed by a statement labeled Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Migration can be driven by negative and positive circumstances.

Reason (R): Push factors make individuals migrate away from a region, whereas pull factors draw individuals to a region.

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) A is false, but R is true.
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (c) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (d) A is true, but R is false.

Sol.664.(c) Migration occurs due to a combination of negative pressures and attractive opportunities. Push factors like poverty, unemployment, natural disasters, and political instability compel people to leave their place of origin. On the other hand, pull factors such as better employment, education, healthcare, and safety motivate them to move toward a new region. These contrasting influences explain why migration is driven by both negative and positive circumstances.

Q.665. In each of the following questions, a statement labeled Assertion (A) is given, followed by a statement labeled Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Migrants who enter a new country or region are called immigrants.

Reason (R): Emigrants are people who leave their country to settle elsewhere.

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (b) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (c) A is true, but R is false.

(d) A is false, but R is true.

Sol.665.(a) The terms immigrant and emigrant describe the same act of migration but from different perspectives. A person leaving one country becomes an emigrant there but simultaneously an immigrant in the destination country. This dual usage explains why both statements are true and interconnected.

Q.666. Which state has the lowest population in India?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Manipur (b) Arunachal Pradesh
- (c) Sikkim (d) Mizoram

Sol.666.(c) Sikkim. Based on the 2011 Census of India, Sikkim has the smallest population among all Indian states, with 610,577 residents. Projections for 2025 also indicate that Sikkim will remain the least populous state. The Census 2011 was the 15th National Census of India, conducted in two phases – House Listing and Population Enumeration. It was carried out under the supervision of C. Chandramouli, the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India.

Q.667. According to Census 2011 which Indian State/UT has no Scheduled Tribe?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Kerala (b) Goa
- (c) Puducherry (d) Chhattisgarh

Sol.667.(c) Puducherry. Along with Puducherry, the states/UTs of Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, and Delhi also do not have any notified Scheduled Tribes. As per Census 2011, the lowest proportion of Scheduled Tribes was recorded in: Uttar Pradesh (0.6%), Tamil Nadu (1.1%), Bihar (1.3%), Kerala (1.5%), Uttarakhand (2.9%). The highest proportion of Scheduled Tribes was found in Mizoram. The Census of India is the most credible source of data on demography, literacy, education, economic activity, housing, urbanisation, fertility, mortality, etc. The 2011 Census was the 15th National Census, conducted with the slogan "Our Census, Our Future."

Q.668. Consider the following statements:

- I. Three phases are involved in the census operations in India
- II. The first phase of census operations is Houselisting/Housing Census.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.668.(b) Only II. The Two phases are involved in the census operations in India. First - Houselisting/Housing Census under which details of all buildings, permanent or temporary, are noted with their type, amenities, and assets. Second - Population Enumeration where more detailed information on each individual residing in the country, Indian national or otherwise is noted. The first non-synchronous census was conducted in 1872 under Lord Mayo's administration, while the first synchronous census took place in 1881 under W.C. Plowden. The 16th Census (2021) was postponed due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

Q.669. Which of the following statements is/are correct according to the Census of India-2011?

- A person aged seven years or above, who can both read and write with understanding in any language, is treated as literate.
- A person who can only read but cannot write is not literate.
- Both (a) and (b) are correct
- Only (b) is correct
- Only (a) is correct
- Neither (a) nor (b) is correct

Sol.669.(a) According to the 2011 Census of India, the overall literacy rate is 74.04%, with the youth literacy rate being about 9% higher than the adult rate. The female literacy rate is 65.46%.

Q.670. As per Census 2011, which of the following states recorded negative growth in child sex ratio ?

- Maharashtra
- Himachal Pradesh
- Punjab
- Haryana

Sol.670.(a) Maharashtra recorded a significant decline in child sex ratio, from 913 girls per 1,000 boys in 2001 to 894 girls per 1,000 boys in 2011. According to the 2011 census, India's sex ratio was 943 females per 1,000 males, and the child sex ratio was 919 females per 1,000 males.

Q.671. When the analysis of population density is done by calculating it through net cultivated area, then the measure is termed as :

- Agricultural density
- Physiological density
- Gross density
- Net density

Sol.671.(b) Physiological density. Density of population is expressed as the number of persons per unit area. Physiological density =

$\frac{\text{total population}}{\text{net cultivated area}}$. Agricultural density is the number of farmers per unit of arable land. The agricultural population includes cultivators and agricultural labourers and their family members.

Q.672. According to Census of India 2011, in rural India, which state has the maximum female workforce participation rate?

- Arunachal Pradesh
- Uttar Pradesh
- Himachal Pradesh
- Andhra Pradesh

Sol.672.(c) Himachal Pradesh. As per Census 2011, the workforce participation rate for females is 25.51% against 53.26% for males. Rural sector has a better female workforce participation rate of 30.02% compared with 53.03% for males whereas for the urban sector. In Rural, Himachal Pradesh has the highest female workforce participation rate (47.4) whereas Tamil Nadu has max (21.8) among major states.

Q.673. As per the definition of Census of India, a 'marginal worker' is a person who works for:

- less than 183 days (or six months) in a year
- more than 183 days (or six months) in a year
- eight months in a year
- 83 days in a year

Sol.673.(a) The population of India according to their economic status is divided into three groups, namely; main workers, marginal workers and non-workers. A Main Worker is a person who works for at least 183 days (or six months) in a year. Marginal Worker is a person who works for less than 183 days (or six months) in a year. The proportion of workers (both main and marginal) is only 39.8 per cent (2011) leaving a vast majority of about 60 percent as non-workers.

Q.674. The Accelerated Female Literacy Programme was initiated in districts where the female literacy rate, based on the 2001 census, was _____.

- below 35%
- below 45%
- below 30%
- below 50%

Sol.674.(c) below 30%. According to the 2001 Census, 47 districts in India had a female literacy rate below 30%. Most of these districts were located in Bihar, Jharkhand, Uttar Pradesh, and Odisha. The Accelerated Female Literacy Programme aims to empower women by

helping them develop literacy skills and gain access to information and services.

Q.675. According to Census of India 2011, what is the gap between male and female literacy rate in India?

- 21.59 %
- 18.30 %
- 24.84 %
- 16.68 %

Sol.675.(d) 16.68%. According to the 2011 Census of India, the overall literacy rate was 74.04%. The literacy rate for males was 82.14%, while for females, it was 65.46%. Literacy rates for States and Union Territories (UTs) : Kerala - 94% (highest among states), Bihar - 61.80% (lowest among states), Lakshadweep - 91.85% (highest among UTs), Dadra and Nagar Haveli - 76.24% (lowest among UTs), Mizoram - 91.33%, Goa - 88.70% and Delhi - 86.21%.

Q.676. According to the Census of India 2011, the percentage of adolescent population (10-19 years) from the total population is how much?

- 22.9%
- 21.9%
- 20.9%
- 19.9%

Sol.676.(c) 20.9%. The population of the country as per the provisional figures of Census 2011 is 1210.19 million of which 623.72 million (51.54%) are males and 586.46 million (48.46%) are females. The proportion of Child Population in the age group of 0-6 years to total population is 13.1 percent. From 2001 to 2011, the population in the 0-6 age group registered minus 3.08 percent growth with minus 2.42 for males and minus 3.80 for females.

Q.677. According to the Census of India 2011, which group of Union Territories recorded the highest sex ratio?

- Puducherry, Delhi, Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- Puducherry, Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- Chandigarh, Puducherry, Lakshadweep
- Chandigarh, Puducherry, Delhi

Sol.677.(b) The sex ratio. In the union territories, the sex ratios were as follows: Puducherry (1,037), Lakshadweep (946), Andaman and Nicobar Islands (876). Among the states, the highest sex ratios were found in Kerala (1,084), Tamil Nadu (996), and Andhra Pradesh (993).

Q.678. Consider the following statements:

- As per Census 2011, Delhi has the highest slum population among Union Territories.

II. Maharashtra has the highest slum population among Indian states.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.678.(c) Both I and II. Slum Population - Census 2011 : India - 5.41%. Maharashtra (10.54%) has the highest slum population in India. The Dharavi slum in Mumbai is considered one of the most educated slums in India, with an estimated literacy rate of 69%.

Q.679. According to the Census of India 2011, 'Other Religions and Persuasions (ORP)' comprise how much of the population?

- (a) 3.9 million (b) 7.9 million
(c) 5.9 million (d) 9.9 million

Sol.679.(b) 7.9 million (0.7%). The total population in 2011 was 121.09 crores, with Hindus comprising 96.63 crores (79.8%), Muslims 17.22 crores (14.2%), Christians 2.78 crores (2.3%), Sikhs 2.08 crores (1.7%), Buddhists 0.84 crores (0.7%), Jains 0.45 crores (0.4%) and Religion Not Stated 0.29 crores (0.2%).

Q.680. According to Census 2011, which district displays the highest population?

- (a) Kollam (b) Ajmer (c) Thane (d) Pune

Sol.680.(c) Thane is a district located in the state of Maharashtra. It is often referred to as the "City of Lakes" due to its large number of water bodies.

Q.681. Who published the logistic equation model of population growth in 1838 ?

- (a) Howard Thomas Odum
(b) Alfred Russel Wallace
(c) Pierre François Verhulst
(d) George Evelyn Hutchinson

Sol.681.(c) Pierre François Verhulst. He was a Belgian mathematician who earned a doctorate in number theory from the University of Ghent in 1825. He is renowned for the logistic growth model, which is widely applied in population growth modeling. This model, first proposed by Pierre-François Verhulst in 1838, states that the reproduction rate is proportional to both the existing population and the available resources, assuming all else is equal.

Q.682. According to the Census of India 2011, which group of Union Territories has the highest density of population?

- (a) Lakshadweep, Daman and Diu and Puducherry
(b) Delhi, Chandigarh and Daman and Diu

- (c) Delhi, Chandigarh and Puducherry
(d) Lakshadweep, Daman and Diu and Chandigarh

Sol.682.(c) Delhi, Chandigarh and Puducherry. In 2011, the population density of India was 382 persons per square kilometer, with Arunachal Pradesh having the lowest density at 17 persons per square kilometer; Bihar had the highest density at 1,106 persons per square kilometer, followed by West Bengal (1028), Kerala (860), Uttar Pradesh (829), and Haryana (573).

Q.683. Consider the following statements:

1. India's annual exponential growth rate as per Census 2011 was 0.64%.
2. The slogan of Census 2011 was "Our Census, Our Right".

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.683.(d) Neither 1 nor 2. India's annual exponential growth rate as per Census 2011 was 1.64%. The 2011 Census was the 15th census in India and the 7th since the country gained Independence. Its slogan was "Our Census, Our Future".

Q.684. According to Census of India 2011, female adolescents in the age group of 10-19 years had a share of:

- (a) 52.7% (b) 47.3% (c) 31.3% (d) 20.9%

Sol.684.(b) 47.3%.

Q.685. According to the Census of India 2011, most people had out-migrated from _____ to other states in India.

- (a) Rajasthan and Gujarat
(b) Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh
(c) Maharashtra and Gujarat
(d) Uttar Pradesh and Bihar

Sol.685.(d) Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. According to the 2011 Census, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar are responsible for the most number of migrants as 20.9 million people migrated outside the state from the two states. Reason for Migration : Lack of Employment opportunities, Lack of proper Educational and Healthcare Facilities, Marriage. Uttar Pradesh has the highest share of out-migrants while Maharashtra has the highest share of in-migrants.

Q.686. The growth rate of India's population has been declining since ____.

- (a) 1991 (b) 1951 (c) 1981 (d) 1971

Sol.686.(c) 1981. The pace of population

growth is slowing down in the country. Two major reasons behind this decline: a decrease in the fertility rate and improvements in family planning practices. The population growth rate was 23.6% in the decade 1981-1991, which declined to 21.5% in 1991-2001. This rate declined further to 17.6% in the decade 2001-2011.

Q.687. Consider the following statements regarding Census in India:

I. The Census Act was enacted in India in 1947.

II. The first census of Independent India was conducted in 1950.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.687.(d) Neither I nor II. The Census Act was enacted in India in 1948. The first census of Independent India was conducted in 1951, which was the seventh census in its continuous series. The enumeration period of this Census was from 9th to 28th, February 1951. The Census Act, 1948 - An Act to provide for certain matters in connection with the taking of Census.

Q.688. According to the Census of India - 2011, which state has the largest gap between male and female literacy rates?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Assam
(c) Rajasthan (d) Karnataka

Sol.688.(c) Rajasthan.

Q.689. According to Census of India 2011, how many districts are there in India?

- (a) 630 (b) 640 (c) 610 (d) 620

Sol.689.(b) 640. As per 2011 census, India has 28 States, 640 districts, 5,924 sub-districts, 7,935 Towns and 6,40,867 Villages. There is an increase of 47 Districts, 461 Sub Districts, 2774 Towns (242 Statutory and 2532 Census Towns) and 2279 Villages in Census 2011 as compared to Census 2001.

Q.690. According to the Census of India 2011, which group of states has the least urban population?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh and Bihar
(b) Himachal Pradesh and Meghalaya
(c) Himachal Pradesh and Bihar
(d) Uttar Pradesh and Bihar

Sol.690.(c) Himachal Pradesh and Bihar. According to the 2011 census of India : Urban Population - 31.16%. Rural Population - 69%. Goa is the most

urbanized state with 62.17% of the population living in urban areas. The total population percentage of people that lived in urban regions of Himachal Pradesh is 10.03%, Bihar is 11.29%, Odisha is 16.69%, and Rajasthan is 24.87%.

Q.691. According to Census of India 2011, what was the sex ratio recorded in the Union Territory of Puducherry?

- (a) 890 females/1000 males
- (b) 980 females/1000 males
- (c) 1037 females/1000 males
- (d) 1095 females/1000 males

Sol.691.(c) 1037 females/1000 males. According to the Census, the sex ratio in India has increased from 933 females per 1,000 males in 2001 to 943 females per 1,000 males in 2011, with Kerala recording the highest sex ratio at 1,084 and Haryana recording the lowest sex ratio among states at 879, while Delhi had the lowest sex ratio among Union Territories at 868.

Q.692. As per the Census-2011, the population growth during the decade remained _____.

- (a) 15.30%
- (b) 14.25%
- (c) 17.64%
- (d) 18.30%

Sol.692.(c) 17.64%. The Census 2011 is the 15th National census survey conducted by the Census Organization of India. Mr. C. Chandramouli is the Commissioner & Registrar General of the Indian 2011 Census. Top Growth Rated States/UTs: Dadra and Nagar Haveli (55.88%), Daman and Diu (53.76%), Puducherry (28.08%), Meghalaya (27.95%), Arunachal Pradesh (26.03%).

Q.693. On the basis of highest population growth rate (Census, 2011), select the option that arranges the following states in descending order.

- (A) Bihar
- (B) Arunachal Pradesh
- (C) Meghalaya
- (a) A, B, C
- (b) C, A, B
- (c) C, B, A
- (d) B, C, A

Sol.693.(c) C, B, A. As per Census 2011: Highest Populated State - Uttar Pradesh (19.98 crore), Least Populated State - Sikkim. Highest Populated Union territory - National Capital Territory of Delhi, Least Populated Union territory - Lakshadweep. Bihar has experienced the largest decadal population growth among the main states (25.4%).

Q.694. According to Census of India 2011, which district in India has the lowest literacy rate in India?

- (a) Aizawl
- (b) Alirajpur
- (c) Rampur
- (d) Madhubani

Sol.694.(b) Alirajpur : It is considered one of the poorest cities in India, with over 70% of the population living below the poverty line. According to the 2011 Census, the female literacy rate in Alirajpur (in Madhya Pradesh) is 31.0%, while the male literacy rate is 43.6%. In contrast, Serchhip, a town in Mizoram, was the most literate district, with an average literacy rate of 98.23%.

Q.695. Consider the following statements regarding Census 2011:

1. Kerala is the most urbanised state in India with 62.2% urban population.
2. Himachal Pradesh has the lowest urban population (10%) among Indian states.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.695.(b) Only 2. Goa has the highest urban population among states, at 62.2%, followed by Kerala at 47.7%. The National Capital Territory of Delhi (97.5%) and Chandigarh (97.25%) are the most urbanized Union Territories. Himachal Pradesh has the lowest urban population, at 10%, followed by Bihar at 11.3%.

Q.696. As per the Census of India-2011, the density of population per km² was _____ persons.

- (a) 382
- (b) 394
- (c) 345
- (d) 320

Sol.696.(a) 382. The density of population is the ratio between the numbers of people to the size of land. It is usually measured in persons per square kilometer. As per Census of India 2011, Bihar has the highest population density (1,106) in India while Arunachal Pradesh has the lowest population density in India with 17 people per square kilometer.

Q.697. According to the Census 2011 of India, which metropolitan has the second highest population ?

- (a) Chennai
- (b) Delhi
- (c) Kolkata
- (d) Mumbai

Sol.697.(b) Delhi. Census 2011: Highest populated metropolitan city - Mumbai (18 million), Second - Delhi (16 million), followed by Kolkata (14 million). Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Bangalore, Pune, Ahmedabad, Surat and Hyderabad are the metropolitan cities of India with a population of more than four million.

Q.698. According to the census of India 2011, which state has the lowest population growth rate ?

- (a) Jharkhand
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Uttar Pradesh
- (d) Nagaland

Sol.698.(d) Nagaland (-0.58%). Census 2011: India's population growth rate 17.64%. States/UTs with top population growth rates: Dadra and Nagar Haveli (55.88%), Daman and Diu (53.76%), Puducherry (28.08%), Meghalaya (27.95%), Arunachal Pradesh (26.03%). India's decadal growth rate was 13.31% from 1941 to 1951.

Q.699. What was the Child Sex Ratio in the country as per the Census of India 2011 ?

- (a) 189
- (b) 981
- (c) 919
- (d) 911

Sol.699.(c) 919. As per the Census, the child sex ratio has decreased from 927 females per thousand males in 2001 to 919 females per thousand males in 2011. Child sex ratio 2011: Highest in Kerala (964), Puducherry (967), Tamil Nadu (943), Andhra Pradesh (939), Chhattisgarh (969), Lowest in Haryana (834).

Q.700. As per Census of India 2011, in which of the following states was the total population less than 10 lakh?

- (a) Telangana
- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Tripura
- (d) Goa

Sol.700.(b) Sikkim (6.71 lakhs). Census 2011: India's most populated state is Uttar Pradesh (19.98 crores, 829 people/square km), followed by Maharashtra (11.24 crores, 365 people/square km), Bihar (10.41 crores, 1106 people/square km), West Bengal (9.13 crores, 1028 people/square km), and Andhra Pradesh (8.46 crores, 308 people/square km).

Q.701. As per the Census-2011, the total absolute increase in population during the decade is _____.

- (a) 18.19 crore
- (b) 16.41 crore
- (c) 17.21 crore
- (d) 15.23 crore

Sol.701.(a) 18.19 crore. The population density in India in 2011 was 382 people per square kilometer. Bihar has the highest population density (1106 people per square kilometer), followed by Bengal (1028) and Kerala (860). The state with the lowest population density is Arunachal Pradesh (17 persons/square km) and the Union Territory with the lowest density population is Andaman & Nicobar Islands.

Q.702. Match the following States/UTs with their Sex Ratio (Census 2011):

- A. Kerala → (i) 996
 B. Puducherry → (ii) 877
 C. Tamil Nadu → (iii) 1084
 D. Haryana → (iv) 1037
 E. Daman & Diu → (v) 618

(a) A-i, B-ii, C-iii, D-iv, E-v

(b) A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii, E-v

(c) A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii, E-v

(d) A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-v, E-iv

Sol.702.(c) A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii, E-v.

The sex ratio is the ratio of males to females in a population, usually expressed as the number of females per 1000 males. States with Highest Sex Ratio (census 2011): Kerala (1084), Puducherry (1037), Tamil Nadu (996), Andhra Pradesh (993), Chhattisgarh (991). Haryana has the lowest sex ratio (877) in Indian states while in union territory Daman & Diu has lowest sex ratio of 618.

Q.703. Consider the following:

Which of the following reasons may be considered as India's pull factors for migration?

1. Labour demand
2. Natural disaster
3. Protection of human and civil rights
4. High consumption and living standards

(a) Both 1 and 4 (b) Only 2

(c) Only 1, 3 and 4 (d) Only 2, 3 and 4

Sol.703.(c) Only 1, 3 and 4. Pull factors attract migrants to an area, like better job opportunities or quality of life. Push factors drive people to leave, such as poor living conditions or lack of jobs.

Q.704. What is the literacy rate of males in India as per the report published in the National Survey of India-2022 ?

- (a) 81.2% (b) 83.4% (c) 86.3% (d) 84.7%

Sol.704.(d) 84.7%. According to the National Survey of India 2022, the overall literacy rate in India is 77.7%, with female literacy at 70.3%.

Q.705. The _____ results from an increase in the proportion of workers relative to nonworkers in the population.

- (a) age structure of population
 (b) population momentum
 (c) old-age dependency ratio
 (d) demographic dividend

Sol.705.(d) Demographic dividend refers to the economic growth potential from changes in a population's age structure, typically when the working-age population grows larger relative to

dependents. Population momentum describes the potential for growth or decline based on age structure, even with constant fertility, mortality, and migration rates. The old-age dependency ratio (OADR) is the number of people aged 65+ compared to those aged 20-64, the working - age group.

Q.706. According to the Census of India 2011, which of the following states has the largest Buddhist population?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Uttar Pradesh
 (c) Maharashtra (d) West Bengal

Sol.706.(c) Maharashtra. As per Census 2011: Among 121.09 crores population (religions) are: Hindu 96.63 crores (79.8%), Muslim (14.2%), Christian (2.3%), Sikh (1.7%), Buddhist (0.7%), Jain (0.4%), others (0.9%). Muslims (14.2%) form the largest religious minority in India.

Q.707. With regard to the component of population density, which state is the odd one out of the following?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Bihar
 (c) Arunachal Pradesh (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.707.(c) Arunachal Pradesh.

According to the 2011 census, Arunachal Pradesh had a population density of 17 people per square kilometer, while the average for India was 382 people per square kilometer. Some other states and Union Territories had the following densities: Uttar Pradesh (829), Maharashtra (365), Bihar (1,106), West Bengal (1,028), Delhi (11,320), Puducherry (2,547), Andaman and Nicobar Islands (46), and Sikkim (86).

Q.708. What is the national female workforce participation rate as per the Census of India 2011?

- (a) 53.26% (b) 30.02%
 (c) 25.51% (d) 53.03%

Sol.708.(c) 25.51%. As per the 2011 Census, female workforce participation is 25.51% compared to 53.26% for males. Rural areas have higher female participation (30.02%) than urban areas. In Rural, Himachal Pradesh has the maximum female workforce participation rate (47.4) whereas Tamil Nadu has maximum (21.8) among major states. There is a significant gap between rural and urban female workforce participation, though male participation is similar in both sectors.

Q.709. According to Census 2011, which of the following languages is spoken by the least population in India ?

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Dogri
 (c) Assamese (d) Konkani

Sol.709.(a) Sanskrit. The 2011 census identified 31 languages with over 1 million native speakers. Sanskrit is the only scheduled language having fewer than 1 million speakers. According to the census, 43.63% of Indians speak Hindi as their mother tongue, followed by Bengali at 8.03%, Marathi at 6.86%, Telugu at 6.7%, and Tamil at 5.7%.

Q.710. Consider the following statements regarding Census 2011 literacy data:

1. Lakshadweep had the lowest literacy rate among Union Territories at 76.24%.
2. Tamil Nadu was the most literate state with 94% literacy.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
 (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.710.(d) Neither 1 nor 2. Dadra and Nagar Haveli had the lowest literacy rate among Union Territories at 76.24%.. According to census 2011, its literacy rate is 76.24% (Male 85.17, female 64.32). Top Literate States : Kerala (94.00%), Lakshadweep (91.85%), Mizoram (91.33%), Goa (88.70%), Tripura (87.22%).

Q.711. As per Census 2011, what is the percentage of rural population in India?

- (a) 52.4% (b) 59.3% (c) 65.2% (d) 68.8%

Sol.711.(d) 68.8%. Census 2011 : Urban Population in India : 31.16%. Level of urbanization increased from 27.81% in the 2001 Census to 31.16% in the 2011 Census. The proportion of the rural population declined from 72.19% to 68.84%.

Q.712. The density of population is the crude relationship between humans and _____.

- (a) land (b) family (c) growth (d) capital

Sol.712.(a) land. Population density is calculated by dividing the total population of a region by the total land area. This gives an idea of how crowded or sparsely populated a region is. According to Census 2011, the population density of India is 382 (per square km). State with highest population density - Bihar (1106 person per square km). State with lowest population density - Arunachal Pradesh (17 person per square km).

Q.713. As per the 2011 census, what is the density of population in Arunachal Pradesh?

- (a) 19 persons/km² (b) 18 persons/km²
(c) 20 persons/km² (d) 17 persons/km²

Sol.713.(d) 17 persons/km². As per census 2011, Arunachal Pradesh has lowest Population density. Bihar has the highest population density (1106) among states. The population density of India was 382. The 2011 Census motto was "Our Census, Our Future." The first successful Census occurred in 1881 under Lord Ripon, and since then, it has been conducted every ten years. Population density, defined as the number of persons per square Kilometer.

Q.714. What is the density of population in NCT of Delhi as per the 2011 Census?

- (a) 11320 (b) 11342 (c) 10265 (d) 10567

Sol.714.(a) 11,320.

Q.715. What is the name of the large-scale demographic survey conducted to provide reliable estimates of birth and death rates and other fertility and mortality indicators at the national and sub-national levels?

- (a) Sample Registration System (SRS)
(b) Enumeration of Human Resource system (EHRS)
(c) Direct Recruitment System (DRS)
(d) Creation and bifurcation System (CBS)

Sol.715.(a) The SRS employs a dual record system with a part-time enumerator and a full-time supervisor. The enumerator continuously tracks births and deaths in sample villages and urban blocks, while the supervisor conducts an independent survey every six months. Data from both sources is matched, and unmatched events are re-verified. It was launched by the Office of the Registrar General, India as a pilot in 1964-65, the SRS became fully operational in 1969-70.

Q.716. Which of the following is expressed as the total number of deaths per thousand population per year in India?

- (a) Death Rate
(b) Age Specific Death Rate
(c) Incidence Rate
(d) Infant Mortality rate

Sol.716.(a) Death Rate. Age-specific mortality rate is defined as the number of deaths in a specific age group per thousand populations in the same age-group in a given year. The Crude

Death Rate (CDR) is defined as Number of deaths per thousand population. Infant mortality rate refers to the number of deaths under one year of age divided by 1000 live births in a given year. Maternal Mortality Ratio refers to the number of women who die as a result of complications of pregnancy or childbearing in a given year per 100,000 live births in that year.

Q.717. According to Census 2011, what is the estimated percentage of people below the poverty line in rural areas?

- (a) 27.09% (b) 13.04%
(c) 18.90% (d) 25.70%

Sol.717.(d) 25.70%. In 2011-12, the poverty rate was estimated at 13.7% in urban areas, and 21.9% nationwide. The Below Poverty Line (BPL) is an economic benchmark that identifies individuals and households that are economically disadvantaged and may need government assistance. It is a minimum level of income required to maintain a basic standard of living.

Q.718. Consider the following statements regarding population change:

1. The three basic components of population change are Birth, Death, and Migration.
2. Demography is derived from the Greek words Demos (Population) and Graphy (Science).

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.718.(c) Both 1 and 2. The three components of population change (i) Birth (ii) Death and (iii) Migration are core to the domain of population studies. The word Demography has been derived from the Greek words 'Demos' and 'Graphy' which mean 'Population' and 'Science'. Thus, demography is the scientific study of the human population.

Q.719. What is the percentage share of the population working in the agricultural sector as per Census of India 2011?

- (a) 0.567 (b) 0.58 (c) 0.546 (d) 0.503

Sol.719.(c) 0.546. As per Census 2011, the total number of agricultural workers in the country has increased from 234.1 million (127.3 million cultivators and 106.8 million agricultural labourers) in 2001 to 263.1 million (118.8 million cultivators and 144.3 million agricultural labourers) in 2011. However, the share of the workforce engaged in the agriculture sector (comprising cultivators and

agricultural labourers) has come down from 58.2 per cent in 2001 to 54.6 per cent in 2011.

Q.720. According to the Census of India-2011, which of the following options represents a group of the most urbanized union territories in India?

- (a) Chandigarh and Lakshadweep
(b) Delhi and Chandigarh
(c) Puducherry and Delhi
(d) Lakshadweep and Puducherry

Sol.720.(b) Delhi and Chandigarh. As per Census 2011, the most urbanized state - Goa.

Q.721. According to the census of India 2011, which group of Union Territories of India has the highest literacy rate?

- (a) Lakshadweep and Daman and Diu
(b) Daman and Diu and Delhi
(c) Andaman and The Nicobar Islands and Puducherry
(d) Chandigarh and Daman and Diu

Sol.721.(a) Lakshadweep (91.85 %) and Daman and Diu (87.10 %).

Q.722. Match the following states with the percentage of population below the poverty line. According to the Planning Commission of India (2011-12).

States	% of population below poverty line
1. Gujarat	a. 8.06
2. Haryana	b. 11.16
3. Himachal Pradesh	c. 16.63

- (a) 1- c, 2- a, 3- b (b) 1- a, 2- b, 3- c
(c) 1- b, 2- c, 3- a (d) 1- c, 2- b, 3- a

Sol.722.(d) 1- (c), 2- (b), 3- (a). The Planning Commission of India estimated the poverty rate in India for 2011-12 to be 21.9%, based on the Tendulkar poverty line.

Q.723. The _____ birth rate indicates the number of live births occurring during the year per 1000 population estimated at midyear.

- (a) neutral (b) positive
(c) negative (d) crude

Sol.723.(d) crude. Birth rate is the total number of live births in a particular area (an entire country, a state, a district or other territorial unit) during a specified period (usually a year) divided by the total population of that area in thousands. Death rate is expressed as the number of deaths in a given area during a given time per 1000 population. Rate of natural increase refers to the difference between the birth rate and the

death rate.

Q.724. Consider the following statements regarding Census 2011 sex ratio:

- I. Lakshadweep recorded the lowest sex ratio in the Union Territory in India.
- II. Punjab had the highest sex ratio among Indian states.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.724.(d) Neither I nor II. Sex ratio is used to describe the number of females per 1000 of males. Daman and Diu recorded the lowest sex ratio in the Union Territory in India. Kerala had the highest sex ratio among Indian states.

Q.725. As per the Census of India 2011, which Union Territory recorded the lowest population growth rate?

- (a) Lakshadweep (b) Delhi
(c) Daman and Diu (d) Chandigarh

Sol.725.(a) Lakshadweep. Census of India 2011- Lowest Population Growth Rate : States - Nagaland, Kerala, Goa, Andhra Pradesh. UT - Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar, Chandigarh, New Delhi. Highest Population Growth Rate : States - Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Bihar. UT - Dadra and Nagar Haveli, Daman and Diu, Puducherry.

Q.726. According to the Census of India 2011, the female literacy rate was recorded as _____.

- (a) 75.35% (b) 65.46%
(c) 55.84% (d) 70.24%

Sol.726.(b) 65.46%. As per Census 2011: Literacy rate in India (74.04%) - Male (82.14%). Highest in Kerala (Male: 96.1%, Female: 92.07%). Lowest in Bihar (Male: 71.2%, Female: 51.5%).

Q.727. According to Census of India 2011, what was the total population of India (approx)?

- (a) 131 Crore (b) 121 Crore
(c) 111 Crore (d) 101 Crore

Sol.727.(b) 121 Crore. Census 2011: 833.5 million persons live in rural areas and 377.1 million persons live in urban areas.

Q.728. Which of the following states had the highest percentage of Scheduled Tribes in the country as per census 2011?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Maharashtra
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Chhattisgarh

Sol.728.(c) Madhya Pradesh. As per Census 2011: Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi and Puducherry have no population of Scheduled tribes. Uttar Pradesh has the largest Scheduled Caste population.

Q.729. According to Census of India 2011, which state in India has the highest female literacy rate?

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Kerala
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Maharashtra

Sol.729.(b) Kerala (94.0%): Literacy rate (male: 96.1%, female 92.7%).

Q.730. The population density of India as per the Census of 1951 is _____.

- (a) 117 per sq km (b) 324 per sq km
(c) 103 per sq km (d) 382 per sq km

Sol.730.(a) 117 per sq km. There has been a steady increase of more than 200 persons per sq km over the last 50 years. The density of population in India (2011) is 382 persons per sq km. Population density of States (2011) : Arunachal Pradesh (17, Lowest), Bihar (1106. Highest), West Bengal (1028), Uttar Pradesh (829), Kerala (860), Tamil Nadu (555), Delhi - (11,320, Most dense UT), Andaman and Nicobar Islands (46, Least Dense UT).

Q.731. What is the Crude Death Rate of India as per Census 2011?

- (a) 10% (b) 8.5% (c) 5.9% (d) 7.1%

Sol.731.(d) 7.1%. Percentage of infant deaths to total death - 13.6, Crude Birth Rate - 21.8 (Rural - 23.3, Urban - 17.6), General Fertility rate - 81.2, Percentage distribution of population by broad age group: (0 - 14) - 29.5, (15 - 59) - 62.5, (60+) - 8.0.

Q.732. What was the percentage of India's population that belonged to the Muslim religion in 2011?

- (a) 14.2% (b) 11.9% (c) 16.4% (d) 18.5%

Sol.732.(a) 14.2%.

Q.733. On the basis of tribal population (2011), identify the option that arranges the following states in ascending order.

- A. Madhya Pradesh B. Maharashtra
C. Odisha

- (a) (C), (B), (A) (b) (B), (A), (C)
(c) (C), (A), (B) (d) (B), (C), (A)

Sol.733.(a) Madhya Pradesh has the highest and Punjab has the lowest tribal population in India as per 2011 census. Tribal population percentage of these states to total ST population in India : Madhya Pradesh - 14.7, Maharashtra -

10.1, Odisha - 9.2.

Q.734. Which of the following periods is referred to as a period of stagnant or stationary phase of growth of India's population?

- (a) 1921-1941 (b) 1901-1921
(c) 1961-1981 (d) 1941-1961

Sol.734.(b) 1901-1921. The year 1921 is known as the year demographic divide because it is the only census year when there was a decrease in the growth of population.

Q.735. India can be considered to be a country with Demographic Dividend due to _____.

- (a) high population above 70 years
(b) high population between 15 - 64 years
(c) high population between 10 - 20 years
(d) high total population

Sol.735.(b) This working age group must support itself as well as those outside this age group (i.e., children and elderly people) who are unable to work and are therefore dependents.

Q.736. Consider the following statements:

1. The period 1951-1981 is called the period of population explosion in India.
2. During this period, India's population grew from 261 million to 683 million.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.736.(a) Only 1. During this period the population of India grew rapidly from 361 million (1951) to 683 million (1981). The average annual growth rate of this period was 2.14 percent.

Q.737. What does the Lincoln index measure?

- (a) Population Size
(b) Population Natality Rate
(c) Population Mortality Rate
(d) Population Density

Sol.737.(a) Population Size. Lincoln index described by Frederick Charles Lincoln (in 1930). Population Natality Rate - The number of births per unit of time in a population, often expressed as births per 1,000 individuals per year. Population Mortality Rate - The number of deaths per unit of time in a population, often expressed as deaths per 1,000 individuals per year.

Q.738. Consider the following statements:

- As per Census classification, the working age group is taken as 18–60 years.
- The National Youth Policy 2014 defines youth as persons in the age group of 15–29 years.

Which of the above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.738.(b) Only 2. The population of a nation in the working age group is generally grouped between 15-59 years. The 2011 Census has divided the working population of India into four major categories: Cultivators, Agricultural Labourers, Household Industrial Workers, Other Workers.

Q.739. In which of the following decades, there was a negative growth rate in the Indian population?

- (a) 1911-1921 (b) 1941-1951
(c) 1961-1971 (d) 1921-1931

Sol.739.(a) 1911-1921. Decadal Growth Rates in India: Census year (% of Growth) - 1911 (+ 5.75), 1921 (- 0.31). Percentage growth in 2001-2011 is 17.64%; males 17.19% and females 18.12%.

Q.740. According to census 2011, which is the second largest religious minority of India?

- (a) Christians (b) Buddhist
(c) Sikhs (d) Muslim

Sol.740.(a) Christians.

Q.741. According to the Union Home Ministry, the census 2021 (which got postponed due to COVID 19) was supposed to collect data for _____ for the first time.

- (a) Schedule Tribes
(b) Schedule Castes
(c) Economically weaker sections
(d) Other Backward Castes

Sol.741.(d) Other Backward Castes. Fifteenth Census (2011). The Socio - Economic and Caste Census (SECC) was conducted in 2011 for the first time since 1931. 29 questions canvassed during Population Enumeration in census 2011.

Q.742. As per census 2011, What is the Total Fertility Rate in India? (provide an approximate range)

- (a) 3.1 - 3.9 (b) 2.1 - 2.9
(c) 4.1 - 4.9 (d) 5.1 - 5.9

Sol.742.(b) 2.1 - 2.9.

Q.743. The long term objective of National Population Policy (NPP) 2000 is to achieve a stable population by _____

with sustainable economic growth, social development and environmental protection.

- (a) 2045 (b) 2035 (c) 2025 (d) 2055

Sol.743.(a) 2045. The immediate objective of the National Population Policy (NPP) 2000 is to address the unmet needs for contraception, health care infrastructure, and health personnel, and to provide integrated service delivery for basic reproductive and child health care.

Q.744. Consider the following statements:

- If the birth rate equals the death rate, the population remains constant.
- If the birth rate is higher than the death rate, the population decreases.

Which of the above is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Sol.744.(b) Only 2. If the birth rate of a country is more than the death rate then the population will increase. Birth Rate - The number of babies born every year per 1000 people in a population. Death Rate - The number of deaths every year per 1000 people in a population. If Birth Rate > Death Rate: Population will increase, Birth rate = Death rate: Population will remain constant, Birth rate < Death rate: Population will decrease.

Q.745. Which of the following factors can affect distribution of population?

- Geographical factors
- Social factors
- Cultural factors
- Economic factors

- (a) I, II, III only (b) I and II only
(c) I, II, III and IV (d) II and III only

Sol.745.(c) Geographical Factors - Availability of water, Landforms, Climate, Soils. Economic Factors - Minerals, Urbanisation, Industrialisation. Social and Cultural Factors - Religious beliefs attract people, better housing, health facilities, educational institutions and transport systems etc.

Q.746. Settlements in which houses are built close to each other are called _____.

- (a) Scattered settlement
(b) Compact settlement
(c) Line settlement
(d) Grid settlement

Sol.746.(b) Compact settlement. Grid settlements are settlements in which houses are built in a grid pattern, such as cities. Scattered settlements are

settlements in which houses are spaced apart, such as forests or deserts, rural areas. Line settlements are settlements in which houses are built along a road or river and canals.

Q.747. Officially, the first recorded data on transgenders in India was collected in which census?

- (a) 2011 (b) 2001 (c) 1991 (d) 1981

Sol.747.(a) 2011 - It was the 15th census and 7th after independence. The Registrar General of India (RGI), during Enumeration of Census 2011, for the first time provided three codes; these are Male-1, Female-2 and other-3 for enumeration.

Q.748. According to census 2011, what is the population (nearest value) of tribals in India?

- (a) 16.45 crore (b) 14.45 crore
(c) 10.42 crore (d) 12.45 crore

Sol.748.(c) 10.42 crore. According to the 2011 census, 'Scheduled Tribes' (ST) - 8.6% of the total population of the country. The state and Union Territory with the largest tribal population - Madhya Pradesh, and Lakshadweep. The population density in India is 382 per km².

Q.749. As per census 2011, which among the following states has the highest sex ratio?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Maharashtra
(c) Meghalaya (d) Uttar Pradesh

Sol.749.(c) Meghalaya. According to Census 2011: Sex Ratio of North East States (Highest to Lowest) - Meghalaya (989), Manipur (985), Mizoram (976), Tripura (960), Assam (958), Arunachal Pradesh (938), Nagaland (931).

Q.750. Which of the following states has the highest fertility rate in India according to the 2011 census?

- (a) Kerala (b) Punjab
(c) Maharashtra (d) Bihar

Sol.750.(d) Bihar. Total fertility rate (TFR): Total number of children born or likely to be born to a woman in her lifetime if she were subject to the prevailing rate of age-specific fertility in the population.

Q.751. Why is there low population growth in a society that is underdeveloped and technologically backward?

- (a) Because both death rate and birth rate are high
(b) Because both death rate and birth

rate are low

- (c) Because such countries usually have strict government policies related to population growth
(d) Because people migrate from underdeveloped countries

Sol.751.(a) The first stage is that of low population growth in society because both the death rate and the birth rate are very high so the difference between the two (or the net growth rate) is low. Stage II (Higher than death rate), Stage III (Low birth rate; Curves of both death and birth rate get closer; Population growth rate-Very low), and Stage IV (Birth rate curve further dips, more than the death rate curve; Net population goes down).

Q.752. According to the Socio-Economic Census 2015, which state has the largest population of households with 'destitute / living on alms'?

- (a) Chhattisgarh (b) Bihar
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Odisha

Sol.752.(d) Odisha. Socio-Economic Census 2015 is a study of the socio-economic status of rural and urban households and allows the ranking of households based on predefined parameters.

Q.753. Growth rate of population refers to the:

- (a) difference between birth rate and GDP
(b) addition of birth rate and death rate
(c) difference between birth rate and death rate
(d) difference between death rate and GDP

Sol.753.(c) Population growth rate is the change in the number of individuals over a specific period of time. The rate of population growth is the rate of natural increase combined with the effects of migration.

Q.754. The distribution of the population according to different types of occupation is known as _____.

- (a) occupational structure
(b) age composition
(c) adolescent population
(d) Migration

Sol.754.(a) Occupational structure refers to the aggregate distribution of the population according to different occupations in society, defined by skill level, and economic status. The age composition refers to the number of people in different age groups in a country.

Q.755. Which period in India is referred to as a steady population growth period?

- (a) 1921-1951 (b) 1921-1941
(c) 1921-1961 (d) 1921-1931

Sol.755.(a) 1921-1951. Four phases of population growth in India: Stagnant population (1901-1921), Steady growth stage (1921-1951), Rapid growth stage (1951- 1981) and high growth with definite signs of slowing down (1981-2011).

Q.756. What is the percentage of rural child population to the total child population of the country in India as per Provisional Population Totals of Census 2011?

- (a) 74.05 % (b) 79.03%
(c) 62.45% (d) 55.23%

Sol.756.(a) 74.05%.

Q.757. Consider the following statements:

- I. Neonatal mortality rate refers to the number of deaths during the first 30 completed days of life per 1000 live births.
II. Infant mortality rate refers to the number of deaths of children below 1 month of age per 1000 live births.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.757.(d) Neither I nor II. The number of deaths during the first 28 completed days of life per 1000 live births in a given year or period is defined as neonatal mortality rate. An age-specific mortality rate is a mortality rate limited to a particular age group. The crude death rate is calculated as the number of deaths in a given period divided by the population exposed to risk of death in that period. The Infant mortality rate (IMR) is the number of deaths of infants under one year of age per 1,000 live births

Q.758. What was the estimated national mortality rate of children under the age of five in the country as per Census of India 2011?

- (a) 34 (b) 55 (c) 76 (d) 13

Sol.758.(b) 55. As per Census 2011, the share of children (0-6 years) accounts for 13.1 % of the total population in the Country.

Q.759. As per the theory of demographic transition, the post-transitional stage of demographic transition is characterised

by _____.

- (a) low and nearly equal birth and death rates
(b) falling birth rates and high death rates
(c) high and nearly equal birth and death rates
(d) falling death rates and high birth Rates

Sol.759.(a) The demographic transition model has four stages: pre-industrial, urbanizing/industrializing, mature industrial, and post-industrial.

Atmosphere

Q.760. Read the following statements:

Statement 1: The process of vertical heating of the atmosphere is known as advection.

Statement 2: The transfer of heat through horizontal movement of air is called convection.

Statement 3: 'Loo' winds in northern India during summer are caused by advection.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) All three statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct
(b) Statements 2 and 3 are correct
(c) Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct
(d) Only Statement 3 is correct

Sol.760.(d) Only Statement 3 is correct.

The vertical heating of the atmosphere through the upward movement of heated air is known as convection. The transfer of heat through the horizontal movement of air is called advection. The 'Loo' is a hot, dry wind that blows horizontally across the plains of northern India during summer, which is a classic example of heat transfer by advection.

Q.761. Which layer of the Earth's atmosphere is primarily responsible for absorbing ultraviolet radiation from the Sun?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Thermosphere (b) Stratosphere
(c) Mesosphere (d) Troposphere

Sol.761.(b) Stratosphere. The stratosphere, lying above the troposphere (about 10–50 km altitude), contains the ozone layer, which absorbs most of the Sun's harmful ultraviolet (UV) radiation. This protective function shields living organisms from DNA damage, skin cancer, and other harmful effects of excessive UV exposure. The thermosphere absorbs X-rays and

gamma rays, while the mesosphere mainly helps burn up meteors. The troposphere is the lowest layer where weather occurs but does not absorb significant UV radiation. Thus, the stratosphere is primarily responsible for UV absorption.

Q.762. Read the following statements:

Statement 1: The temperature in Troposphere decreases at the rate of 1°C for every 165 meters of height.

Statement 2: The temperature in mesosphere starts to decrease with the increase in altitude and reaches up to -100°C at around 80 km.

Which of the following statements is/are correct?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) Only Statement 1 is correct
- (b) Only Statement 2 is correct
- (c) Both statements 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Both statements 1 and 2 are incorrect

Sol.762.(c) Both statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 1 describes the Normal Lapse Rate in the troposphere, where temperature decreases by approximately 1°C for every 165 meters (or 6.5°C per kilometer) of ascent. Statement 2 is also correct; in the mesosphere, temperature again decreases with increasing altitude, reaching the coldest temperatures in the Earth's atmosphere, around -90°C to -100°C , at the mesopause (approx. 80-85 km).

Q.763. Consider the following statements:

- I. Smog is a dense mass of water drops mixed with smoke and dust particles near the ground.
- II. Mist and fog differ mainly on the basis of visibility reduction.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.763.(c) Both I and II. Fog forms when an air mass with high water vapor suddenly cools, causing condensation on fine dust particles. It is essentially a cloud at or near the ground, leading to poor visibility, often reduced to zero. Fog is denser and thicker than mist. Fog reduces visibility to less than one kilometer, while mist reduces visibility to one to two kilometers. Frost forms on cold surfaces when condensation takes place below freezing point (0°C), i.e. the dew point is at or below the freezing point.

Q.764. Atmospheric temperature usually decreases with altitude, but sometimes this phenomenon gets reversed in the troposphere. This phenomenon is known as _____.

- (a) Temperature Inversion
- (b) Adiabatic Lapse Rate
- (c) Global Warming
- (d) Temperature Convection

Sol.764.(a) Temperature Inversion occurs when the normal pattern of temperature decreasing with altitude is reversed, and the air becomes warmer as you go higher. This phenomenon can lead to air pollution problems and is often seen in valleys or areas with stagnant air. Adiabatic lapse rate: Change of temperature with a change in altitude of an air parcel without gaining or losing any heat to the environment surrounding the parcel. Temperature Convection - The process by which heat is transferred through the movement of fluid (like air or water) due to temperature differences.

Q.765. What kind of radiation is absorbed by the ozone layer?

- (a) Green radiation
- (b) Infrared radiation
- (c) Visible radiation
- (d) Ultraviolet radiation

Sol.765.(d) Ultraviolet radiation. The UV radiation spectrum is divided into three types : UVA, UVB and UVC. These rays can affect our skin in different ways. Ozone layer : It is a region in the Earth's stratosphere that contains a high concentration of ozone (O_3) gas. This layer acts as a shield, protecting the Earth from the Sun's harmful ultraviolet (UV) radiation. Infrared radiation (IR), also known as thermal radiation, is that band in the electromagnetic radiation spectrum with wavelengths above red visible light between 780 nm to 1mm ($0.78\text{ }\mu\text{m}$ to $1000\text{ }\mu\text{m}$).

Q.766. The upper portion of the earth is known as:

- (a) Stratosphere
- (b) Troposphere
- (c) Lithosphere
- (d) Mesosphere

Sol.766.(c) Lithosphere. It is bounded by the atmosphere above and the asthenosphere (another part of the upper mantle) below. The stratosphere is the second-lowest layer of Earth's atmosphere. The troposphere, the lowest layer of the atmosphere, contains about 75-80% of the atmospheric mass. Most clouds form in the troposphere, where nearly all weather occurs. The

mesosphere is the third highest layer, situated between the stratosphere and the thermosphere.

Q.767. The zone separating the troposphere from the stratosphere is called the _____.

- (a) Tropopause
- (b) stratosphere
- (c) Stratopause
- (d) Tropopause

Sol.767.(a) Tropopause. The air temperature at the tropopause is about -80°C over the equator and about -45°C over the poles. The temperature in this region is nearly constant, and hence, it is called the tropopause. The stratosphere is found above the tropopause and extends up to a height of 50 km. One important feature of the stratosphere is that it contains the ozone layer.

Q.768. Consider the following statements:

- I. All weather phenomena like rainfall, storms, and winds occur in the Thermosphere.
- II. The ozone layer is present in the Troposphere.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I
- (b) Only II
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.768.(d) Neither I nor II. All the changes in climate and weather takes place in the Troposphere. It is the lowermost layer of the atmosphere and is often referred to as the "region of mixing". Its average height is 13 km and extends roughly to a height of 8 km near the poles and about 18 km at the equator. Stratosphere (contains the ozone layer) - 2nd layer of the Earth's atmosphere, extending from about 10 to 50 km in altitude. Mesosphere - 3rd layer of the Earth's atmosphere, extending from about 50 to 85 km in altitude. Most meteors burn up in this atmospheric layer. Thermosphere - 4th layer of the Earth's atmosphere, extending from about 85 to 500 km in altitude.

Q.769. Which of the following claims about chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) is accurate?

- (a) CFCs are used as repairers of the troposphere
- (b) CFCs are used as fuel for air crafts
- (c) CFCs are used as repairers of the ozone layer
- (d) CFCs are used as refrigerants

Sol.769.(d) CFCs, banned in India for depleting the ozone layer, were used in plastic foams, cleaning electronics, and aerosol cans. They are now replaced by

HFCs, which have an ozone depletion potential of 0.

Q.770. What is the purpose of the Earth's magnetic field?

- (a) To provide an energy source for life on Earth
- (b) To control the Earth's climate
- (c) To shield the Earth from solar wind and cosmic radiation
- (d) To cause the tides in the ocean

Sol.770.(c) Earth's magnetic field (Geomagnetic field) - The magnetic field that extends from Earth's interior out into space, where it interacts with the solar wind, a stream of charged particles emerging from the Sun. Earth's Magnetism - Generated by convection currents of molten iron and nickel in the earth's core. These convection currents are caused by heat escaping from the core, a natural process called a geodynamo.

Q.771. What is the main objective of the 'Graded Response Action Plan'?

- (a) legalizing illegal colonies
- (b) To control the cases of malaria
- (c) introduction of electric vehicles
- (d) controlling air pollution

Sol.771.(d) Controlling air pollution. Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP): It was formulated in 2016 and notified in 2017 for Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR) by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

Q.772. Which of the following statements is NOT correct regarding the stratosphere?

- (a) It lies above the mesosphere.
- (b) It extends up to a height of 50 km.
- (c) It contains a layer of ozone gas.
- (d) This layer is almost free from clouds.

Sol.772.(a) Stratosphere - Its height of the bottom varies with latitude and with the seasons. Aviation & Jet Streams fly in the Stratosphere.

Q.773. In which layer of atmosphere does the meteorites burn up on entering from space?

- (a) Stratosphere
- (b) Thermosphere
- (c) Mesosphere
- (d) Exosphere

Sol.773.(c) Mesosphere. Meteorites are space rocks that fall to Earth's surface. Meteorites are the last stage in the existence of these types of space rocks.

Q.774. Which layer of atmosphere helps in radio transmission?

- (a) Exosphere
- (b) Thermosphere
- (c) Mesosphere
- (d) Stratosphere

Sol.774.(b) Thermosphere. It is a layer of Earth's atmosphere that is directly above the Mesosphere and below the Exosphere. The temperature starts increasing again with increasing height in this layer. Aurora and satellites occur in this layer.

Q.775. At what height do the Jet Streams blow in India during winter months?

- (a) 9-15 km
- (b) 9-17 km
- (c) 9-16 km
- (d) 9-13 km

Sol.775.(d) 9-13 km. Jet Streams (geostrophic wind) are relatively narrow bands of strong wind. Types: Polar-Night Jet Stream, SubTropical Jet Streams (westerlies), Tropical Easterly Jet Stream.

Q.776. The climate of Assam can be described as:

- (a) subtropical humid climate
- (b) mountain climate
- (c) tropical dry climate
- (d) tropical monsoon rainforest climate

Sol.776.(d) Tropical Monsoon Rainforest Climate. Tropical monsoon climates have monthly mean temperatures above 18 °C (64 °F) in every month of the year and a dry season. Tropical monsoon climate is the intermediate climate between the wet Af (or tropical wet climate) and the drier Aw (or tropical savanna climate).

Q.777. _____ is a naturally occurring phenomenon that is responsible for the heating of the Earth's surface and atmosphere.

- (a) Radiation
- (b) Global warming
- (c) Greenhouse effect
- (d) Global heating

Sol.777.(c) Greenhouse Effect. When the Sun's energy reaches the Earth's atmosphere, some of it is reflected back to space and the rest is absorbed and re-radiated by greenhouse gases. The absorbed energy warms the atmosphere and the surface of the Earth.

Q.778. The term 'monsoon' is derived from a/an:

- (a) Italian word
- (b) Latin word
- (c) Arabic word
- (d) Greek word

Sol.778.(c) Arabic word 'mausim', meaning weather, was first used in English in British India to refer to seasonal changes in wind direction.

Rocks

Q.779. What is Karst topography primarily associated with?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

(a) Groundwater action in limestone or dolomite regions

(b) River meandering in alluvial plains

(c) Glacial deposition in polar regions

(d) Wind erosion in arid deserts

Sol.779.(a) Groundwater action in limestone or dolomite regions. Karst topography develops in regions where limestone, dolomite, or gypsum rocks are present. It is formed due to the chemical action of groundwater (carbonation and solution processes). Key features of karst landscapes: Sinkholes (dolines), Caves and caverns, Stalactites and stalagmites, Underground streams and disappearing rivers. Famous example in India: Karst landforms of Meghalaya (Krem caves).

Q.780. The igneous, sedimentary and metamorphic rocks are interconvertible through a continuous process called:

- (a) lithification
- (b) metamorphism
- (c) rock cycle
- (d) weathering and erosion

Sol.780.(c) rock cycle. It is a series of processes that create and transform the types of rocks in Earth's crust. Lithification: This is specifically the process by which sediments are compacted and cemented to form sedimentary rocks. Metamorphism is the process by which existing rocks (Igneous, Sedimentary, or even other Metamorphic rocks) are transformed into metamorphic rocks under high pressure, and temperature. Weathering and erosion: These are processes that break down existing rocks into smaller particles.

Q.781. The layer made up of unconsolidated rock, dust, soil, etc. that is deposited on a bed rock surface like a blanket is known as:

- (a) Talus
- (b) Regolith
- (c) Scree
- (d) Protolith

Sol.781.(b) Regolith. It can be found both at the surface and at varying depths. This layer of fragmented soil material forms the outermost covering of the land and is present almost everywhere, covering the underlying bedrock. Regolith is primarily inorganic and acts like a blanket over unbroken rock.

Q.782. Consider the following statements:

- I. Sedimentary rocks are formed by the deposition and compaction of sediments, usually in layers.
- II. Igneous rocks are also layered due to volcanic eruptions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.782.(a) Only I. Igneous rocks (primary rocks) form out of magma and lava from the interior of the earth. Examples - Granite, gabbro, pegmatite. Sedimentary rocks are formed by the deposition and compaction of sediments over time, often in layers. These layers, also called strata. Examples - Sandstone, conglomerate, limestone, shale, loess. Metamorphic Rocks form under the action of pressure, volume and temperature changes. Examples - Gneissoid, granite, syenite, slate.

Q.783. Exfoliation is a form of _____.

- (a) physical weathering
(b) chemical weathering
(c) mass wasting
(d) biochemical weathering

Sol.783.(a) Physical weathering is caused by the effects of changing temperature on rocks, causing the rock to break apart. The process is sometimes assisted by water. Exfoliation occurs as cracks develop parallel to the land surface, a consequence of the reduction in pressure during uplift and erosion.

Q.784. The outermost part of the Earth is known as _____.

- (a) volcano (b) the crust
(c) the core (d) the mantle

Sol.784.(b) the crust. The Earth's crust is the thinnest of all its layers, about 35 km thick on the continental masses and only 5 km on the ocean floors. The main minerals in the continental crust are silica and alumina, while the oceanic crust consists primarily of silica and magnesium. Beneath the crust lies the mantle, which extends to a depth of 2900 km. The innermost layer is the core, with a radius of about 3500 km, made mostly of nickel and iron.

Q.785. Which of the following is the correct match between column-A and column-B?

Column-A (Type of rock)	Column-B (Method of formation)
i. Sedimentary Rock	a. Transformed its chemical qualities from other type of rocks
ii. Metamorphic Rock	b. Derived from magma that was poured out or ejected at the Earth's Surface

iii. Igneous Rock	c. Formed from fragments of other rocks or the remains of plants or animals
-------------------	---

- (a) i-a, ii-b, iii-c (b) i-b, ii-a, iii-c
(c) i-c, ii-a, iii-b (d) i-a, ii-c, iii-b

Sol.785.(c) i-c, ii-a, iii-b. The rock cycle is a web of processes that outlines how each of the three major rock types - igneous, metamorphic, and sedimentary - form and break down based on the different applications of heat and pressure over time.

Q.786. Structural geology deals with:

- (a) the age of rocks
(b) the components and chemical nature of soil
(c) the form, classification, mechanism, and causes of rock structures' evolution
(d) the cause of volcano formation

Sol.786.(c) Petrology is the science of rocks. Rock: Any natural mass of mineral matter that makes up the Earth's crust.

Q.787. Which of the following is a yellowish green to green coloured gemstone often found in mafic and ultramafic igneous rocks such as basalt, gabbro, dunite, diabase and peridotite?

- (a) Bornite (b) Olivine
(c) Tremolite (d) Garnet

Sol.787.(b) Olivine. The mineral olivine is a magnesium iron silicate with the chemical formula $(\text{Mg,Fe})_2\text{SiO}_4$. It is a type of nesosilicate or orthosilicate. Bornite, also known as peacock ore, is a sulfide mineral with a chemical composition of Cu_5FeS_4 .

Q.788. The steep rocky coast rising almost vertically above sea water is called _____.

- (a) sea caves (b) sea cliff
(c) sea arches (d) ox-bow lake

Sol.788.(b) Sea cliffs are steep faces of rock and soil that are formed by destructive waves. A sea cave is a cave formed on a cliff by the wave action of an ocean or lake. A sea arch is a natural arch or bridge made of stone that has been created when water wears away the underside of a rock, leaving just the top behind.

Q.789. The core of the Great Himalayas is composed of _____.

- (a) Slate (b) Granite
(c) Sandstone (d) Limestone

Sol.789.(b) Granite rock (Igneous rock).

Lesser Himalaya consists of metamorphosed sedimentary rocks (quartzite, marble, slate, phyllite, schist and gneiss).

Q.790. Which of the following determines the colour, texture, chemical properties, mineral, content and permeability of the soil?

- (a) Parent rock (b) Time
(c) Relief (d) Climate

Sol.790.(a) Parent rock. The color in the soil is mainly due to two factors - organic content and the chemical nature of iron compounds found in the soil.

Q.791. How many types of igneous rocks are there?

- (a) Four (b) Two (c) Six (d) Five

Sol.791.(b) Two. Based on the texture of rocks, igneous rocks are classified into Intrusive igneous rocks (Plutonic rocks) and Extrusive igneous rocks (Lava or Volcanic rocks).

Q.792. Mushroom rocks are formed due to _____.

- (a) glacial deposition
(b) deposition of sea waves
(c) running water erosion
(d) wind erosion

Sol.792.(d) Wind erosion. A mushroom rock (perched rock) is a typical mushroom-shaped landform that is formed by the action of wind erosion. These rocks are mostly found in arid regions. Such rocks are found in the Thar Desert of India.

Q.793. What type of rocks were once igneous or sedimentary, but have metamorphosed as a result of intense heat and/or pressure within the Earth's crust?

- (a) Granite (b) Quartzite
(c) Sandstone (d) Basalt

Sol.793.(b) Quartzite. Granite is a coarse-grained (phaneritic) intrusive igneous rock composed mostly of quartz, alkali feldspar, and plagioclase. Sandstone is a clastic sedimentary rock composed mainly of sand-sized silicate grains. Basalt is a mafic extrusive rock, is the most widespread of all igneous rocks, and comprises more than 90% of all volcanic rocks.

Q.794. Which of the following rocks floats in water?

- (a) Granite (b) Obsidian
(c) Pumice (d) Slate

Sol.794.(c) Pumice is a light-colored,

extremely porous igneous rock that forms during explosive volcanic eruptions. Obsidian has been used for tools and ornaments. Granite is a hard igneous rock made of quartz, feldspar, and mica. Slate is a metamorphic rock.

Q.795. _____ plains are formed due to the weathering of soluble rocks such as limestone and dolomite.

- (a) Glacial (b) Karst
(c) Deposition (d) Desert

Sol.795.(b) Karst regions contain aquifers that are capable of providing large supplies of water. Typical karst forms include sinkholes, caves, natural bridges and sinking streams.

Mountain

Q.796. Read the following statements:

Statement 1: Diastrophism includes all processes that move, elevate, or build up portions of the Earth's crust.

Statement 2: Exogenic processes derive their energy from the atmosphere, influenced by solar energy and tectonic gradients.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Only Statement 1 is correct
(b) Both statements 1 and 2 are correct
(c) Both statements 1 and 2 are incorrect
(d) Only Statement 2 is correct

Sol.796.(b) Both statements 1 and 2 are correct. Diastrophism encompasses all slow, large-scale movements, such as uplift and folding, that deform and build up portions of the Earth's crust, leading to mountain building (orogeny) and continental warping (epeirogeny). Exogenic processes derive their energy from both the atmosphere, powered by solar energy, and from tectonic factors that create gradients. The Sun's energy influences atmospheric conditions like temperature and precipitation, which are key components of weather and climate.

Q.797. Consider the following statements:

I. K2 is the highest peak of the Karakoram Range.

II. Nanda Devi lies in the Zaskar Range. Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.797.(a) Only I. K2, also known as Mount Godwin Austen (8,611 meters), is the world's second-highest peak in the

Karakoram range, spanning Pakistan, China, India, and extending into Afghanistan and Tajikistan. Trishul Peak is in the Himalayas, while Kamet Peak (7,756 meters) is the highest in the Zaskar range. Nanda Devi (7,817 meters) is the third-highest peak in the Himalayas.

Q.798. Which of the following mountains of India is famous for tea and coffee production?

- (a) Nilgiri (b) Aravali
(c) Himalaya (d) Vidhyanchal

Sol.798.(a) Nilgiri Hills are where the Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats meet. They are located at the tri-junction of Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu. The highest peak in this region is Doda Betta. The Aravalli Range is known for its mineral resources, such as copper and zinc. The Himalayas are famous for saffron cultivation in the Kashmir region.

Q.799. What is the name of the highest peak of Indian Garhwal Himalayas located in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand state with a height of 7,816 metres?

- (a) Trisul (b) Hardeol
(c) Mukut Parbat (d) Nanda Devi

Sol.799.(d) Nanda Devi. It is the second-highest mountain in India, after Kangchenjunga (8598 m), and the highest entirely within the country. It ranks as the 23rd highest peak in the world. The Garhwal Himalayas lie between the Sutlej and the Kali river and is 320 km long. It is a part of the Himalayan Shivalik Hills (outermost hills of the Himalayas found in Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand).

Q.800. The Garo, Khasi and Jaintia hills are a subdivision of:

- (a) Assam valley (b) Barak basin
(c) Surma basin (d) Meghalaya plateau

Sol.800.(d) Meghalaya Plateau. The plateau is separated from the main block of the peninsular plateau by a gap called the Garo-Rajmahal gap. It is located on the northeastern flank of Peninsular India. It is one of the rainiest, most tectonically active areas in the world. Hills in North East India - Lushai Hills or Mizo Hills (Mizoram and Tripura), Chin Hills (Manipur to Chin State of Myanmar), Japfu Mountain Range (Nagaland), Barail Range (Assam), Dabla Hills and Abor Hills (Arunachal Pradesh).

Q.801. The holy mountain 'Kailash' is located in which neighbouring country of

India?

- (a) Pakistan (b) Afghanistan
(c) Bangladesh (d) China

Sol.801.(d) China. Mount Kailash - Located near Lake Mansarovar and Lake Rakshastal. The Indus River originates from Mansarovar lake (Tibet). Some highest mountain peaks : India - Kanchenjunga (8598m), Nanda Devi (7817m). Nepal - Mount Everest (8848.86 m), Dhaulagiri (8172m). Hindu temple outside India : Nepal - Pashupatinath Temple, Indonesia - Prambanan Temple, Bangladesh - Dhakeshwari temple, Cambodia - Angkor Wat.

Q.802. Name an oval-shaped range of hills sculpted by glacial flow.

- (a) Sandur (b) Drumlins
(c) Moraines (d) Esker

Sol.802.(b) Drumlins - It is formed by the filling of heavy rocky debris in the glacial crevices and its stay under the ice. One end of the drumlins facing the glacier called the stoss end and the other end called tail. Eskers: When glaciers melt in summer, the water flows on the surface of the ice. These waters accumulate beneath the glacier and flow like streams in a channel beneath the ice.

Q.803. Consider the following statements regarding famous hills in India:

- I. The Shevaroy Hills are located in Tamil Nadu.
II. Guru Shikhar is the highest peak in Rajasthan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.803.(c) Both I and II. Famous hills:- Chhattisgarh - Tulasi Dongar, Bailadila, Balaraja Gutta. Odisha - Devmali, Turia Konda, Mahendragiri, Devagiri. Rajasthan - Guru Shikhar, Mt. Abu, Sunda. Kangchenjunga (Sikkim) - Highest mountain peak in India.

Q.804. Which among the following is the highest peak of West Bengal?

- (a) Sandakphu (b) Saramati
(c) Doddabetta (d) Deomali

Sol.804.(a) Sandakphu (3636 m). It is located on the border between India and Nepal, belongs to the Singalila Mountain ranges. It is a part of the Purvanchal range. Doddabetta (2637 m) - It is the highest peak of Tamil Nadu and a part of Nilgiri Mountain Range.

Q.805. The Himalayan Mountain range was formed by the collision of _____.

- (a) African Plate and Australian Plate
- (b) Indian Plate and African Plate
- (c) Eurasian Plate and African Plate
- (d) Indian Plate and Eurasian Plate

Sol.805.(d) Indian Plate and Eurasian Plate. Plates - They are large, rigid pieces of the Earth's lithosphere that fit together like a jigsaw puzzle, and their movements are responsible for shaping the Earth's surface through processes such as earthquakes and the formation of mountains. Major plates (7) - African Plate, Antarctic Plate, Eurasian Plate, North American Plate, South American Plate, Pacific Plate and Indo-Australian Plate.

Q.806. Dhinodhar Hills is located in which Indian state/Union Territory?

- (a) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) West Bengal

Sol.806.(c) Gujarat. Dhinodhar Hill is a tourist and pilgrimage spot. Other hills in Gujarat - Chotila, Pavagadh, Palitana, Saputara, Girnar, Barda, Gabbar. Hills : Maharashtra - Mahabaleshwar, Panchgani, Matheran, Lonavala, Amboli etc. West Bengal - Gorgaburu Hill, Ajodhya Hills, Susunia Hill etc. Andaman and Nicobar Islands - Ross Island, Barren Island, Saddle Peak, Katchal, Narcondam Island etc.

Q.807. Which among the following peaks is the highest peak of Jharkhand?

- (a) Kangto
- (b) Girnar
- (c) Anamudi
- (d) Parasnath

Sol.807.(d) Parasnath. It is named after Lord Parshvanath (23rd Jain Tirthankara). Kangto peak (Arunachal Pradesh). State and Highest Peak - Gujarat (Girnar Peak), Rajasthan (Guru Shikhar), Andhra Pradesh (Arma Konda), Haryana (Karah Peak), Karnataka (Mullayanagiri Peak).

Q.808. Which of the following statements is NOT correct?

- (a) Mahendragiri is the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats.
- (b) The height of the Western Ghats progressively decreases from north to south.
- (c) The Western Ghats cause orographic rain.
- (d) The Eastern Ghats stretch from the Mahanadi Valley to the Nilgiris in the south.

Sol.808.(b) The height of the Western Ghats progressively increases from north to south. The highest peaks of Western Ghats include the Anai Mudi (2,695 metres) and the Doda Betta (2,637 meters). The Western Ghats, also known as the Sahyadri Hills, mainly traverse the States of Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra and Gujarat.

Q.809. Which among the following is the largest of all the mountain ranges of the Shiwaliks mountain range in India?

- (a) Patli Dun
- (b) Jammu Dun
- (c) Dehra Dun
- (d) Kotli Dun

Sol.809.(c) Dehradun (Length - 35-45 km, Width - 22-25 km). Dun - Valleys that lie between the Shivalik and Lesser Himalaya. Other duns of Uttarakhand - Kota dun, Patli dun, Har ki dun. Kotli dun - Himachal Pradesh. Kashmir Himalayas - Jammu dun and Pathankot dun.

Q.810. Kalsubai peak is located in which of the following Indian states?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Himachal Pradesh

Sol.810.(b) Maharashtra. Kalsubai (Everest of Maharashtra) is the highest peak of Maharashtra's Ahmednagar district in Akola taluka.

Q.811. Which of the following is NOT a type of a fold mountain?

- (a) Aravalli range
- (b) The Rhine Valley
- (c) Appalachians
- (d) Ural Mountains

Sol.811.(b) Rhine Valley. Fold mountains are the most common type of mountain in the world. The rugged, soaring heights of the Himalayas, Andes, Alps and Aravalli Range (oldest range) are all active fold mountains. Rhine Valley (Germany) is the valley of the river Rhine in Europe. It is also known as Alpine Rhine. The Appalachian Mountains are found in North America.

Q.812. Match the Following

List I (Peak) List II (Height in metres)

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| A. Mount Everest | (i) 8,598 m |
| B. Kanchenjunga | (ii) 8,172 m |
| C. Makalu | (iii) 8,848 m |
| D. Dhaulagiri | (iv) 8,481 m |

(a) A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii

(b) A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii

(c) A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i

(d) A-i, B-ii, C-iii, D-iv

Sol.812.(a) A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii. The great Himalayan range width varies between 160-400 km from north to south. Famous peaks of Himalayas: Mount Everest (8848 m), Mt.

Kanchenjunga (8598 m), Mt. Makalu (8481 m), Mt. Dhaulagiri (8172 m). The Himalayas consist of three parallel ranges - Himadri (Great Himalayas or the Higher Himalayas), Himachal (Lesser Himalayas or the Lower Himalayas) and Shiwaliks (Outer Himalayas).

Q.813. What is the average height of inner Himalayas?

- (a) 6000 metres
- (b) 4500 metres
- (c) 5200 metres
- (d) 7100 metres

Sol.813.(a) 6000 metres. The Himalayas consist of three parallel ranges, the Greater Himalayas or the Inner Himalayas or the Himadri, the Lesser Himalayas called the Himachal (with an average height of 3,700 to 4500 meters), and the Shivalik hills (with an average height of 900 to 1100 meters), which comprise the foothills.

Q.814. Asia is separated from Europe by _____ mountains.

- (a) Himalayan
- (b) Andes Mountains
- (c) Alps
- (d) Ural

Sol.814.(d) Ural. It is formed as a result of the compression of tectonic plates, leading to the formation of large fold-like structures on the Earth's crust. Alps mountain (natural boundary between France and Italy), Andes Mountains range (South American countries of Chile and Argentina), Himalaya (plains of the Indian subcontinent from the Tibetan Plateau). Caucasus mountains (Asia and Europe).

Q.815. Which of the following have mountain range young fold mountains?

- (a) Appalachians mountain range
- (b) Alps mountain range
- (c) Aravalli mountain range
- (d) Ural mountain range

Sol.815.(b) Alps mountain range. Fold mountains form when two or more of the Earth's tectonic plates collide. Types - Anticline, Syncline, Monocline, Isocline. Features - Rugged relief, imposing height (lofty), high conical peaks. Examples are the Rockies, the Andes, the Alps, the Himalayas, etc. Old fold Mountain - Appalachian mountain range, Aravalli mountain range, and Ural mountain range.

Q.816. The uplifted blocks of block mountains are called _____.

- (a) horsts
- (b) grabens
- (c) slopes
- (d) cones

Sol.816.(a) Horsts. Block mountains are formed due to the upward movement

of the middle block between two normal faults. The up-thrown block is also called a horst. Graben is bounded by normal faults dipping toward each other. These mountains include the Great African Rift Valley, the Rhine Valley (graben) in Germany, etc.

Q.817. Consider the following statements about mountain passes in India:

- I. Fotu La is the highest point in Ladakh.
- II. Namika La is located in Himachal Pradesh.
- III. Rohtang Pass is in Himachal Pradesh.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect?

- (a) Only II (b) Only I
(c) Only III (d) I and II

Sol.817.(a) Only II. Namika La is a high mountain pass in the Zaskar Range of the Himalayas in Ladakh. Fatu La is a mountain pass on the Srinagar-Leh highway in the Zaskar Range of the Himalayas in Ladakh, UT. It is one of two high mountain passes between Leh and Kargil, the other being Namika La.

Q.818. Which of the following is also known as the 'White Mountain'?

- (a) Cho Oyu (b) Makalu
(c) Dhaulagiri (d) Lhotse

Sol.818.(c) Dhaulagiri is in west-central Nepal. Cho Oyu lies on the Nepal-Tibet border. Makalu is southeast of Everest, on the Nepal-Tibet border. Lhotse is on the border between Tibet and Nepal's Khumbu region.

Q.819. Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct regarding mountains?

- I. Mountains may be arranged in a line known as range.
 - II. The Aravali range in India is one of the oldest fold mountain systems in the world.
 - III. Mt. Kilimanjaro in South America is an example of Volcanic Mountain
- (a) Only I and II (b) Only II
(c) I, II and III (d) Only I

Sol.819.(a) Only I and II. Mount Kilimanjaro is a dormant volcano in Tanzania. It is the highest mountain in Africa. It was formed when molten rock from the depths of the earth rose from the crust and piled up on its own. Top mountains in Africa:- Mount Kenya, Mount Stanley, Mount Speke, Mount Baker, Mount Emin.

Q.820. The Deomali is the highest

mountain peak of _____.

- (a) Assam (b) West Bengal
(c) Bihar (d) Odisha

Sol.820.(d) Odisha. The Deomali peak height is 1,762 m. The Borail Range is the highest Mountain Ranges in Assam. Someshwar Fort is the highest peak of Bihar. It is part of Shivalik hill.

Q.821. In which Indian state will you find Mount Tiya?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Odisha
(c) Himachal Pradesh (d) Nagaland

Sol.821.(d) Nagaland. Some other mountains: Japfu Peak, Changkikong Range, Mount Saramati, Veda Peak, Ongpangkong Range.

Q.822. Consider the following statements regarding the highest peaks in India:

- I. Gorichen Peak, with an elevation of 6858 m, is the highest peak in Arunachal Pradesh.
- II. Dhaulagiri is the highest peak in Himachal Pradesh.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.822.(a) Only I. Dhaulagiri is the highest in Madhya Pradesh, and Reo Purgil is the highest in Himachal Pradesh.

Q.823. Mountaineers refer to altitudes above about _____ meters as the 'death zone'.

- (a) 5,800 (b) 8,000 (c) 6,700 (d) 7,200

Sol.823.(b) 8,000. The death zone refers to altitudes where oxygen pressure is too low to sustain human life for extended periods.

Q.824. Which of the following is a mountain peak that rises above the surrounding peaks at the mountainous border of the Indian state of Nagaland and the Sagaing region of Myanmar?

- (a) Mount Kalsubai (b) Mount Doddabetta
(c) Mount Saramati (d) Mount Dhaulagiri

Sol.824.(c) Mount Saramati. Doddabetta is the highest mountain in the Nilgiri Mountains at 2,637 meters. Kalsubai (highest point) is a mountain in the Western Ghats, located in the Indian state of Maharashtra.

Q.825. Generally, a steep hill with an elevation of more than _____ meters is classified as a mountain.

- (a) 600 (b) 500 (c) 1000 (d) 800

Sol.825.(a) 600. Within the earth, a continuous movement is taking place. The internal process leads to the upliftment and sinking of the earth's surface at several places. The external process is the continuous wearing down and rebuilding of the land surface. Eg: Erosion and Deposition.

Q.826. _____ is created by the collision of convergent plate boundaries.

- (a) Mid-ocean ridge (b) Land erosion
(c) Oceanic trench (d) Mountain building

Sol.826.(d) Mountain building. A convergent boundary is an area on earth where two or more lithospheric plates converge or collide and one plate eventually slides beneath the other.

Q.827. 'Pidurutalagala' is the highest mountain peak in _____.

- (a) Bhutan (b) Sri Lanka
(c) Myanmar (d) Nepal

Sol.827.(b) Sri Lanka. Pidurutalagala (Mount Pedro) is the tallest mountain in Sri Lanka, standing at 2,524 m in Nuwara Eliya.

Q.828. Which of the following hills is situated in Assam?

- (a) Aravali Hills (b) Karbi Anglong Hills
(c) Javadi Hills (d) Shevaroy Hills

Sol.828.(b) Karbi Anglong Hills. Javadi Hills and Shevaroy Hills are located in Tamil Nadu.

Q.829. Where is Mount Diavolo, an important mountain peak in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, located?

- (a) Great Nicobar (b) North Andaman
(c) Middle Andaman (d) South Andaman

Sol.829.(d) South Andaman. It has an elevation of 295 meters. Middle Andaman is separated from North Andaman Island by Austen Strait, and from Baratang Island at the south by Homfray's Strait.

Q.830. Mount Jopuno is situated in which of the following states?

- (a) Uttarakhand (b) Sikkim
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Himachal Pradesh

Sol.830.(b) Sikkim. Mount Jopuno, located in western Sikkim at 5,603 meters, is situated within Khangchendzonga National Park.

Q.831. Which of the following hills is situated in Andhra Pradesh?

- (a) Kaimur Hills (b) Pachmarhi Hills
(c) Nagari Hills (d) Girnar Hills

Sol.831.(c) Nagari hills. Other hill

stations in Andhra Pradesh include Tirumala, Araku Valley, Horsley Hills, Lambasingi, Nallamala Hills.

Q.832. In which of the following states is the Shatrunjaya Hills located?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Karnataka

Sol.832.(a) Gujarat. Other prominent hills in Gujarat include– Bhujia Hill, Dhinodhar, Girnar, Kalo Dungar, Pavagadh Hill, Thaltej-Jodhpur Tekra, Wilson Hills.

Q.833. Which of the following mountains is situated near the Siachen region of Ladakh in India?

- (a) Kirat Chuli Mountain
(b) Kabru Mountain
(c) Kanchenjunga Mountain
(d) K12 Mountain

Sol.833.(d) K12 Mountain. Kirat Chuli Mountain or Tent Peak is a mountain in the Himalayas. Kabru is a mountain in the Himalayas on the border of eastern Nepal and India. Kanchenjunga is part of the Great Himalaya Range. K12 is the second highest peak in the Saltoro Mountains, a subrange of the Karakoram range in the Siachen region, in Ladakh.

Q.834. Borra Caves are situated on the East Coast of India in which of the following hills?

- (a) Nallamala Hills (b) Horsley Hills
(c) Nagari Hills (d) Ananthagiri Hills

Sol.834.(d) Ananthagiri Hills. Borra Caves, also called Borra Guhalu, are located on the East Coast of India, in the Ananthagiri hills of the Araku Valley of the Visakhapatnam district in Andhra Pradesh.

Volcano

Q.835. Which Indian plateau is formed primarily by volcanic activity?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Malwa Plateau
(b) Shillong Plateau
(c) Chota Nagpur Plateau
(d) Deccan Plateau

Sol.835.(d) Deccan Plateau. The Deccan Plateau was formed due to volcanic activity around 65 million years ago. The eruption created the Deccan Traps, one of the largest volcanic features on Earth. Malwa Plateau - Formed by lava flow partly, but not the largest volcanic plateau. Shillong Plateau - Tectonic origin. Chota Nagpur Plateau - Rich in minerals, formed due to uplift and erosion.

Q.836. Consider the following statements regarding volcanic eruptions:

- I. Caldera eruptions are the most explosive type of volcanic activity on Earth.
- II. Flood basalt provinces, like the Deccan Traps, are examples of highly explosive eruptions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.836.(a) Only I. A caldera eruption is the most explosive type of volcanic activity, occurring when a volcano's magma chamber empties and the ground above collapses, forming a large, circular depression. Example: Yellowstone Caldera. Dykes: It is a vertical or steeply inclined geological formation that occurs when magma cuts through rock layers and solidifies. Flood basalt provinces: Flood basalt refers to large, extensive lava flows that spread out over vast areas. Example: Deccan Traps in India.

Q.837. What is the name of the process of gases being outpoured from the interior of the solid earth?

- (a) Evaporation (b) Transpiration
(c) Degassing (d) Gas evolution

Sol.837.(c) Degassing is the process by which gases are released from the interior of the solid Earth, typically through volcanic activity or other geological processes. This includes gases such as water vapor, carbon dioxide, sulfur dioxide, and others that are expelled from magma or other subsurface materials.

Q.838. Which of the following statements is best related to the 'pacific ring of fire'?

- (a) Known for thermal power station
(b) Known for volcano and earthquakes
(c) Known for only glacial formations
(d) Known for tropical rainforests

Sol.838.(b) The 'ring of fire' is a ring of volcanoes in the Pacific Ocean.

World Geography and Map

Q.839. Which is the largest island of India in terms of area?

SSC Stenographer 6/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Rameswaram
(b) Great Nicobar Island
(c) Sriharikota
(d) Majuli

Sol.839.(b) Great Nicobar Island. Great Nicobar Island, located in the southernmost part of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, is the largest island of India with an area of about 1045 sq km. It is strategically important as it lies close to the Malacca Strait. Rameswaram is a small island in Tamil Nadu, Sriharikota is a barrier island in Andhra Pradesh housing ISRO's launch centre, and Majuli in Assam is the world's largest river island but not the largest overall island of India.

Q.840. Where is the Gulf of Mannar located?

- (a) Between the south-eastern tip of India and the eastern coast of Sri Lanka
(b) Between the south-eastern tip of India and the western coast of Sri Lanka
(c) Between the south-eastern tip of India and the north-western coast of Sri Lanka
(d) Between the south-eastern tip of India and the southern coast of Sri Lanka

Sol.840.(b) Gulf of Mannar: It is located in the Coromandel Coast region. The Gulf of Mannar is separated from the Palk Bay by a chain of islands and coral reefs known as Adam's Bridge or Ram Setu. It is bound to the northeast by Rameswaram (island), Adam's (Rama's) Bridge (a chain of shoals), and Mannar Island.

Q.841. Consider the following statements regarding straits separating continents:

- I. The Strait of Gibraltar separates Europe and Africa, connecting the Mediterranean Sea with the Atlantic Ocean.
- II. The Bosphorus Strait separates Europe and Africa.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.841.(a) Only I. Bosphorus Strait (the narrowest strait of the world)- It is a natural strait connecting the Black Sea to the Sea of Marmara.

Q.842. Which of the following is the largest inhabited riverine island in the world?

- (a) Peacock (b) Majuli
(c) Bhavani (d) Lakshadweep

Sol.842.(b) Majuli is a famous island in the River Brahmaputra, flowing in the state of Assam. It is the biggest district

island in the country and is quite close to Jorhat. The island is formed by the Brahmaputra River in the south and the Kherkutia Xuti, an anabranch of the Brahmaputra, joined by the Subansiri River in the north.

Q.843. A long, winding ridge of stratified sand and gravel is known as:

- (a) Moraine (b) esker
(c) Aquifer (d) Erratic

Sol.843.(b) Esker. An esker is formed by meltwater flowing beneath a retreating glacier or ice sheet during the last Ice Age. This debris was deposited through tunnels and channels under the ice, leaving behind a hill or mound once the ice melted. Eskers are commonly found in regions that were once glaciated, such as Canada, Northern Europe, and parts of the United States.

Q.844. How much percentage of Earth's water make up the oceans?

- (a) 57% (b) 7% (c) 37% (d) 97%

Sol.844.(d) 97%. Water covers 71 percent of Earth's surface. Distribution of Earth's water: Oceans (97.2%), Glaciers (2.1%), Groundwater (0.61 percent); Freshwater lakes (0.009 percent), Inland seas (0.008 percent), Soil Moisture (0.005 percent), Atmosphere (0.001 percent), Rivers (0.0001 percent).

Q.845. Which of the following are some regions in the world, known for their thriving citrus fruit production?

- (a) Africa (b) Equatorial regions
(c) Caribbean (d) Mediterranean regions

Sol.845.(d) Mediterranean regions - These are known as 'Orchards of the world'. Plants grow in Mediterranean regions - Citrus fruits like lemons, orange and grapefruit, Rosemary, Olive. Mediterranean woodlands are found in the Mediterranean Sea region, Central Chile, the Southwest United States, Australia, and Africa.

Q.846. Copacabana beach is situated in _____.

- (a) Australia (b) Brazil
(c) Peru (d) Mexico

Sol.846.(b) Brazil. Copacabana beach: It is located in the South Zone of the city of Rio de Janeiro. Some famous Beaches in the world: Praia do Cassino ("Cassino beach") is the longest beach in the world, located in Brazil. Monolithi beach, Greece (longest beach of Europe), Marina beach, Chennai (longest beach in Asia). Beaches in India - Puri Beach (Odisha),

Rushikonda Beach (Andhra Pradesh), Eden Beach (Puducherry), Radhanagar beach (Andaman and Nicobar), Minicoy Thundi beach (Lakshadweep).

Q.847. Mid-latitude deserts (BWK) are found between 35° and _____N and S, which are poleward of subtropical high-pressure areas.

- (a) 70° (b) 60° (c) 79° (d) 40°

Sol.847.(b) 60°. Mid-latitude deserts - An excessively dry region with an arid climate. Location - Found in the interior parts of the continents. Examples - Argentina's Patagonian Desert (Argentina), Gobi Desert (China and Mongolia), Turkestan (Kazakhstan), Ladakh (Jammu and Kashmir). Crops - Cacti, Prickly Shrubs, Long-rooted wiry grasses.

Q.848. According to the World Bank, what was the density of the population of Sri Lanka in 2020?

- (a) 554 Persons per sq. km.
(b) 300 Persons per sq. km.
(c) 354 Persons per sq. km.
(d) 364 Persons per sq. km.

Sol.848.(c) 354 Persons per sq. km. Other Countries' population density (Food and Agriculture Organization and World Bank population estimates in 2020) in square Km:- India (470), China (150), Myanmar (82), Nepal (205), Bangladesh (1286), New Zealand (19).

Q.849. Which of the following combinations of "animal" and "area they found" is INCORRECT ?

- (a) Kangaroo - Australia
(b) Orangutan - Caribbean islands
(c) Ostrich - Savanna and desert regions,
(d) Lemurs - Madagascar

Sol.849.(b) Orangutans - Caribbean islands. Scientific name (Pongo), Family (Hominidae). These are large, orange-haired apes that are native to the rainforests of Borneo and Sumatra. Kangaroos: Scientific name (Macropodidae), Phylum (Chordata). Ostriches: Phylum (Chordata), found in savanna and desert regions. Lemurs: Scientific name (Lemuroidea), Phylum (Chordata), found in Madagascar.

Q.850. As of 2025, which country has the largest proven coal reserves in the world?

- (a) India (b) China (c) USA (d) Russia

Sol.850.(c) The United States of America (Largest Coal Reserves). Largest coal producer (1st China, 2nd

India). Jharia Coal Field (Jharkhand) produces the highest coal in India. Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research (2007) - Dhanbad. Largest Producer: Bauxite (Australia), Gold (China), Diamond (Russia), Silver (Mexico), Chromium (South Africa), Copper (Chile), Uranium (Kazakhstan), Thorium (India).

Q.851. "Eskimos" are associated with which geographical region?

- (a) Arid Region
(b) Polar Region
(c) Savanna Grassland
(d) Tropical Rainforest Region

Sol.851.(b) Polar Region (the area around the Earth's North Pole or the South Pole). Igloo (small hut-like house made of snow where Eskimos live). Arid regions are dry and have little rainfall. Example - Central and western Asia, North and South America, central and northwest Australia.

Q.852. Consider the following statements regarding seas separating continents:

- I. The Black Sea separates Africa from the Arabian Peninsula.
II. The Caspian Sea separates Africa from the Arabian Peninsula.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.852.(d) Neither I nor II. The Red Sea separates Africa from the Arabian Peninsula.

Q.853. Which is the highest plateau in the world ?

- (a) East African Plateau
(b) Deccan plateau
(c) Western plateau
(d) Tibet plateau

Sol.853.(d) Tibet plateau (Roof of the world) is the largest and highest plateau in the world. It is a vast elevated plateau located at the intersection of Central, South and East Asia.

Q.854. In 'Andes Mountain' of South America animals which are used for transportation is _____.

- (a) Bullocks (b) Camels
(c) Donkeys (d) Llamas

Sol.854.(d) Llamas {Scientific name: Lama glama, Trophic level: Herbivorous}. Longest Mountain Ranges: Andes (South America, longest continental mountain), Rockies (North America), Great Dividing

Range (Australia), Transantarctic Mountains (Antarctica), Atlas Mountains (Africa) etc.

Q.855. Death Valley is a desert valley in the _____ that is the hottest and driest place with a world record highest air temperature of 134°F.

- (a) Mojave Desert of California
(b) Atacama Desert of Chile
(c) Lut Desert of Iran
(d) Sahara Desert of Africa

Sol.855.(a) Mojave Desert of California.

Death Valley is a desert valley in the northern Mojave Desert, bordering the Great Basin Desert. Rivers: Furnace Creek; Amargosa River.

Q.856. Which country has the most time zones in the world?

- (a) France (b) United States of America
(c) Russia (d) United Kingdom

Sol.856.(a) France (12). Russia has 11 time zones, the United Kingdom has 1 time zone and India has only one-time zone.

Q.857. A major portion of 'Sufed Koh' mountain range lies in _____.

- (a) Pakistan (b) China
(c) India (d) Myanmar

Sol.857.(a) Pakistan. Safed Koh is a mountain range on the Pakistan-Afghanistan border. It parallels the Kabul River. A spur of the range is crossed by the Khyber Pass.

Q.858. A mass of snow and ice that moves slowly under the influence of gravity along a confined course away from its place of accumulation is called a _____.

- (a) lagoon (b) glacier
(c) block mountain (d) plateau

Sol.858.(b) Glacier is a slowly moving mass or river of ice formed by the accumulation and compaction of snow on mountains or near the poles. A plateau is a flat area of land that is elevated above sea level.

Miscellaneous

Q.859. If a person view the Earth from above the North Pole, he will observe that the Earth rotates in:

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Anti-clockwise (b) No rotation
(c) Random spin (d) Clockwise

Sol.859.(a) Anti-clockwise. The Earth rotates west to east. If viewed from above the North Pole, this rotation

appears anti-clockwise. If viewed from above the South Pole, it appears clockwise.

Q.860. Consider the following statements about **Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves**:

1. These caves are near Bhubaneswar and were meant for Jain monks.
2. All caves are shaped like flowers and are carved from independent boulders.
3. Each cave has multiple shrines dedicated to different Buddhist deities.

Which of the above is/are correct ?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Only 1
(b) All 1, 2, and 3 are correct
(c) 1 and 2 Only
(d) 2 and 3 Only

Sol.860.(a) Only 1. Statement 2 is incorrect: The caves are rock-cut into hill faces, not from independent boulders. They are not shaped like flowers; instead, they are simple cells with some ornate carvings (e.g., Rani Gumpah). Statement 3 is Incorrect: These caves are Jain, not Buddhist. They are dedicated to Jain monks and Tirthankaras, not Buddhist deities.

Q.861. Match the columns:

Column A (Land-Use Category)	Column B (Description - Shuffled)
A. Miscellaneous Tree Crops & Groves	1. Land left fallow for more than 1 year but less than 5 years
B. Culturable Wasteland	2. Privately owned land under orchards and fruit trees
C. Current Fallow	3. Land left uncultivated for over 5 years
D. Fallow other than Current Fallow	4. Land left fallow for one or less than one year

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1 (b) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
(c) A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3 (d) A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Sol.861.(a) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1.

Q.862. What evidence supports the Big Bang theory of universe origin?

SSC Stenographer 7/08/2025 (Shift 3)

- (a) Sunspot cycles
(b) Redshift of galaxies
(c) Solar wind
(d) Volcanic eruptions on Earth

Sol.862.(b) The redshift of galaxies is a major piece of observational evidence

supporting the Big Bang Theory. Redshift refers to the phenomenon where light from distant galaxies shifts toward the red end of the spectrum, indicating that they are moving away from us. This supports the idea that the universe is expanding, and if it's expanding now, it must have originated from a singular point — as proposed in the Big Bang Theory.

Q.863. What is the main objective of ISRO's SCATSAT-1 satellite?

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 1)

- (a) Monitoring earthquake zones
(b) Measuring atmospheric ozone depletion
(c) weather forecasting and cyclone prediction
(d) Mapping forest cover across India

Sol.863.(c) Weather forecasting and cyclone prediction.

SCATSAT-1 (Scatterometer Satellite-1) was launched by ISRO in September 2016. Its main purpose is to provide continuous weather forecasting, cyclone detection, and tracking services. The satellite carries a scatterometer to measure ocean surface winds, which are crucial for predicting monsoons and cyclones. It was developed as a continuity mission for the Oceansat-2 scatterometer, which had ceased to operate.

Q.864. Match the port/corridor with its strategic benefit to India

Column A (Port/Corridor)	Column B (Strategic Benefit to India)
A. Chabahar Port	1. Links India with Europe via Middle East
B. IMEC	2. New age of transportation between the two countries India to Southeast Asia via Mizoram-Myanmar link
C. Sittwe Port	3. Access to Central Asia bypassing Pakistan

SSC Stenographer 8/08/2025 (Shift 2)

- (a) A → 3, B → 1, C → 2
(b) A → 2, B → 3, C → 1
(c) A → 3, B → 2, C → 1
(d) A → 1, B → 2, C → 3

Sol.864.(a) A → 3, B → 1, C → 2. Chabahar Port (Iran): Located on the Gulf of Oman, it is strategically important for India as it provides a trade route to Afghanistan and Central Asia, bypassing Pakistan. India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC): A planned corridor to enhance connectivity and economic integration between Asia, the

Persian Gulf, and Europe, boosting trade and development. Sittwe Port (Myanmar): A deep-water port in Rakhine State, built with Indian assistance and operationalized by India Ports Global (IPGL). It is India's second overseas port after Chabahar, forming a key part of the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project (KMMTTP), which connects India's northeast to the Bay of Bengal, reducing dependence on the Siliguri Corridor and promoting regional trade.

Q.865. A section of an active fault that has produced earthquakes in the past but is now quiet and is believed that the fault segment is capable of producing earthquake on some other basis is known as:

- (a) Hypocenter (b) Seismic Gap
(c) Epicenter (d) Seismic Wave

Sol.865.(b) Seismic Gap - A section of an active fault which has the potential to produce significant earthquakes. Hypocenter: The point of origin of an earthquake beneath the Earth's surface where the fault rupture begins, representing the actual location where seismic energy is first released. Epicenter: The point on the Earth's surface directly above the hypocenter, marking the geographical location where an earthquake's shaking is typically most intense and first felt. Seismic Wave: The energy waves generated and propagated through the Earth's crust during an earthquake, which can be classified into different types like P-waves, S-waves, and surface waves that cause ground motion.

Q.866. The earthquakes that are generated due to the explosion of chemical or nuclear devices are known as:

- (a) Collapse earthquakes
(b) Explosion earthquakes
(c) Tectonic earthquakes
(d) Reservoir-induced earthquakes

Sol.866.(b) Explosion earthquakes.

Types of Earthquakes: In regions with heavy mining activity, the collapse of underground mine roofs can cause minor tremors, known as collapse earthquakes. The most common type is tectonic earthquakes, which result from the movement of rocks along a fault plane. A subcategory of tectonic earthquakes, known as volcanic earthquakes, occur in areas with active volcanoes. Additionally, reservoir-induced earthquakes are triggered in regions where large reservoirs are present.

Q.867. Consider the following statements:

- I. Project Tiger was launched in 1973 at Corbett Tiger Reserve.
II. The Wildlife Protection Act was passed in 1975.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.867.(a) Only I. On April 1, 1973, Project Tiger was officially launched at the Corbett Tiger Reserve, initially including nine tiger reserves. International Tiger Day is celebrated annually on July 29. The Wildlife Protection Act was passed in 1972. Projects in India related to animals :Project Hangul (1970), Project Crocodile (1975), Project Elephant (1992), Project Rhino (2005), Project Gangetic Dolphin - (2009), Project Snow Leopard (2009), Project Great Indian Bustard (2012).

Q.868. Which of the following can be represented as a functional unit of nature?

- (a) Vehicles (b) Ecosystem
(c) Humans (d) Plants

Sol.868.(b) Ecosystem. This is because an ecosystem encompasses all living organisms (plants, animals, and microorganisms) interacting with each other and with the non-living components (like air, water, and soil) within their environment. These interactions allow for energy flow, nutrient cycling, and the maintenance of life-supporting processes, which are critical functions of nature.

Q.869. Which of the following is a man-made ecosystem?

- (a) Aquarium (b) Dessert
(c) Forest (d) Grassland

Sol.869.(a) Aquarium. It is a facility or park where a collection of aquatic animals and plants is maintained for study, conservation, and public display. A man-made ecosystem, also known as an artificial or anthropogenic ecosystem, refers to a human-created environment where biotic and abiotic components interact to sustain life. Examples of man-made ecosystems include tree plantations, urban landscapes, crop fields, managed ponds, zoos, and gardens.

Q.870. Which of the following are the two basic categories of an ecosystem?

- (a) Forest and Aquatic
(b) Terrestrial and Aquatic

(c) Lakes and Ponds

(d) Forest and Rivers

Sol.870.(b) Terrestrial and Aquatic. An ecosystem is a chain of interactions between organisms and their environment. The term "ecosystem" was first coined by English botanist A.G. Tansley in 1935. A terrestrial ecosystem refers to a land-based community of organisms and the interactions between biotic and abiotic components in a specific area. An aquatic ecosystem involves interacting organisms that rely on each other and their water environment for nutrients and shelter.

Q.871. Which branch of ecology deals with the characteristics of the ancient environment and their relationship with ancient plants and animals?

- (a) Demecology (b) Ichthyology
(c) Paleoecology (d) Mycology

Sol.871.(c) Paleoecology studies past ecosystems and their changes over time using fossils and geological data. Other branches: Demecology (ecology of populations), Ichthyology (study of fishes), and Mycology (study of fungi).

Q.872. Which of the following is the best definition of ecological efficiency?

- (a) The amount of energy utilised at different trophic levels in a food chain
(b) The amount of energy stored at different trophic levels in a food chain
(c) The ratio between the mass and the energy flow at different trophic levels in a food chain
(d) The ratio between energy flows at different points in a food chain

Sol.872.(d) Ecological efficiency describes the efficiency with which energy is transferred from one trophic level to the next. The number of trophic levels in the grazing food chain is restricted as the transfer of energy follows 10 percent law - only 10 percent of the energy is transferred to each trophic level from the lower trophic level.

Q.873. The record obtained by the measurement of earthquake is called a:

- (a) seismograph (b) seismogram
(c) seismology (d) seismic wave

Sol.873.(b) seismogram. Earthquakes are classified into three zones based on depth: shallow (0-70 km), intermediate (70-300 km), and deep (300-700 km). The vibrations produced during an earthquake are known as seismic waves.

Q.874. The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 empowers the _____ to

establish authorities charged with the mandate of preventing environmental pollution in all its forms.

- (a) State Government
- (b) Central Government
- (c) Supreme Court
- (d) local municipalities

Sol.874.(b) Central Government. The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 was enacted to safeguard and enhance the environment. The Central Government has the authority to: protect and improve the environment, set emission and discharge standards, regulate industrial locations, manage hazardous wastes, and protect public health and welfare. Some key environmental acts include the Biological Diversity Act (2002), Wild Life (Protection) Act (1972), Forest Conservation Act (1980), Indian Forest Act (1927), and Energy Conservation Act (2001).

Q.875. Who introduced the concept of virtual water?

- (a) MS Swaminathan
- (b) Glubler Triplets
- (c) John Anthony Allan
- (d) Norman Borlaug

Sol.875.(c) John Anthony Allan. Virtual water is the freshwater used to produce goods or services, which is then traded internationally as part of those products.

Q.876. In which of the following regions of India is the Mundari language spoken?

- (a) Chota-Nagpur plateau
- (b) Baghelkhand
- (c) Thar desert
- (d) Malwa plateau

Sol.876.(a) Chota-Nagpur plateau. This plateau covers parts of Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, and West Bengal. Mundari is a Munda language, belonging to the Austroasiatic language family. Chhota Nagpur plateau is called the "Heart of industrial India" because it is rich in minerals and power fuels. The highest mountain peak of Chota Nagpur Plateau is Parasnath.

Q.877. Which Greek term was first used by Ernst Haeckel in 1866 to refer to 'the relation of animals to both the organic as well as the inorganic environment'?

- (a) Ethnologie
- (b) Ecophagie
- (c) Oekologie
- (d) Oologie

Sol.877.(c) Oekologie. Ernst Haeckel, a German biologist and philosopher, made significant contributions to evolutionary biology. He coined terms like "ecology," "phylogeny," and "Protista" and is known

for his recapitulation theory, stating that an organism's development mirrors its species' evolutionary history.

Q.878. Which of the following is the characteristics of epilimnion?

- (a) Middle layer of a pond
- (b) Bottom layer of a river
- (c) Bottom layer of a lake
- (d) Top-most layer in a thermally stratified lake

Sol.878.(d) Thermal stratification occurs when the water in a lake forms distinct layers through heating from the sun. It led to the separation of the lake into three layers. Epilimnion: The upper layer of warmer water. Metalimnion: The middle layer with a zone of gradual decrease in temperature. Hypolimnion: The bottom layer of colder water.

Q.879. The depositional pattern of CaCO_3 and other materials that extend upwards from the floor of a limestone cavern is known as:

- (a) Stalactite
- (b) Dripstone
- (c) Stalagmite
- (d) Hatectite

Sol.879.(c) Stalagmite. It rises up from the floor of the caves. Stalactite - It is an icicle-shaped formation that hangs from the ceiling of a cave and is produced by the precipitation of minerals from water dripping through the cave ceiling. The stalagmites and stalactites eventually fuse to give rise to columns and pillars of different diameters.

Q.880. Epilimnetic, metalimnetic, and hypolimnetic water strata are example of:

- (a) different layers of underground water
- (b) typical thermal stratification of a lake
- (c) typical layers of hard rock
- (d) various ecological phases

Sol.880.(b) typical thermal stratification of a lake. These layers are referred to as Epilimnion (warm surface waters) - Top-most layer in a thermally stratified lake and Hypolimnion (cold bottom waters) which are separated by the metalimnion, or thermocline layer, a stratum of rapidly changing temperature.

Q.881. In which of the following schedules of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 is the most common wild cat in India 'Felis chaus' listed?

- (a) Schedule I
- (b) Schedule III
- (c) Schedule IV
- (d) Schedule II

Sol.881.(d) Schedule II. Under this schedule, the species receives protection, and poaching or capturing it

without proper authorization is prohibited. The Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972 is an Indian law enacted to protect plant and animal species.

Q.882. What is a population (or subspecies or race) that is adapted to local environmental conditions called?

- (a) Niche
- (b) Ecotype
- (c) Prototype
- (d) Biome

Sol.882.(b) Ecotype is a genetically distinct group within a species adapted to specific environmental conditions. An ecological niche describes how a species interacts within an ecosystem. A biome refers to a community of plants and animals naturally occurring in a region with shared characteristics.

Q.883. Identify whether the given statements about an earthquake are correct or incorrect.

Statement 1 : When the stress on the edge overcomes the friction, there is an earthquake that releases energy in waves that travel through Earth's crust and causes the shaking that we feel.

Statement 2 : An earthquake cannot be identified as a foreshock until after a larger earthquake in the same area occurs.

- (a) Only Statement 1 is correct
- (b) Both Statements 1 and 2 are correct
- (c) Only Statement 2 is correct
- (d) Both Statements 1 and 2 are incorrect

Sol.883.(b) Both Statements 1 and 2 are correct. When lithospheric plates move, the Earth's surface vibrates, causing earthquakes. The point inside the crust where movement begins is called the focus, while the point directly above it on the surface is the epicenter. Vibrations spread outward from the epicenter, with the strongest impact near this point, decreasing as they move away.

Q.884. Of the total water content available globally, how much percentage of water is received from freshwater resources?

- (a) 0.5%
- (b) 4.5%
- (c) 3.5%
- (d) 2.5%

Sol.884.(d) 2.5%. Although 71% of the Earth's surface is covered by water, only 2.5% of it is freshwater. Out of total water resources on earth Ocean comprises 97.25%, Ice caps- 2.05%, Groundwater- 0.68%, Lakes- 0.1%, Soil moisture- 0.005%, Atmosphere- 0.001%, Streams and river- 0.0001%, Biosphere- 0.00004%. India accounts for about 2.45% of the world's surface area, 4% of the world's water resources, and approximately 16% of the global population.

Q.885. The highly viscous, mechanically-weak and ductile region of Earth's upper mantle is called:

- (a) lithosphere (b) asthenosphere
(c) mesosphere (d) exosphere

Sol.885.(b) Asthenosphere. Lithosphere : The rigid outer layer of Earth, consisting of the crust and the uppermost part of the mantle. It is divided into tectonic plates. Mesosphere : The mesosphere is the third highest layer of atmosphere and occupies the region above the stratosphere and below the thermosphere. Exosphere : The outermost layer of Earth's atmosphere, where air is extremely thin, and particles can escape into space.

Q.886. Consider the following statements:

- I. Hydrology is the study of distribution and movement of water on and below the Earth's surface.
- II. Ecology is the study of inter-relationship between living organisms and their environment.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.886.(c) Both I and II. Different Branches and Their Studies: Bryology - The Study of Bryophytes. Biology - The study of living things and their vital processes. Floriculture - The Study of flowers and flowering plants.

Q.887. Which of the following is NOT considered a method of conservation of natural resources?

- (a) Extraction (b) Afforestation
(c) Recycling (d) Terrace farming

Sol.887.(a) Extraction refers to the process of removing natural resources from the Earth, such as mining, drilling for oil, or harvesting timber. Conservation is the proper management of a natural resource to prevent its exploitation, destruction or degradation. Method of conservation of Natural Resources : Reforestation, Rainwater Harvesting, Treatment of Industrial Effluents, In-Situ conservation of Biodiversity, Ex-Situ conservation of Biodiversity, Sustainable development, Crop rotation, Contour ploughing, etc.

Q.888. The Vienna Convention is related to _____.

- (a) protection of wild life
(b) protection of ozone layer
(c) Disposing of harmful electronic waste
(d) sustainable agriculture

Sol.888.(b) protection of ozone layer.

The Vienna Convention multilateral environmental agreement was signed in 1985, came into effect in 1988, and achieved universal ratification by 2009. The primary goal of the Vienna Convention is to safeguard human health and the environment from the harmful effects caused by ozone layer depletion.

Q.889. Select the correct statement.

- (a) The pyramid of energy is always upright.
(b) The pyramid of biomass is always inverted.
(c) The pyramid of mass is always upright.
(d) The pyramid of number is always upright.

Sol.889.(a) The pyramid of energy is always upright, and can never be inverted. According to the 10% law proposed by Raymond Lindeman of energy flow, only 10% of energy is transferred from one trophic level to another and 90% of the energy remains at the former trophic level for its needs like respiration and digestion processes. The direction of energy flow in an ecosystem is always unidirectional.

Q.890. Select the correct statement about climax community.

- (a) It is an ecological community in which populations of plants or animals, which are very unstable and exist for very few time.
(b) It is a very first community of the ecosystem.
(c) It consists of only plant population that makes a new ecological system.
(d) It is an ecological community in which populations of plants or animals remain stable and exist in balance with each other and their environment.

Sol.890.(d) A climax community is the "endpoint" of succession within the context of a particular climate and geography. The climax community remains stable as long as the environment remains unchanged.

Q.891. Which concept was proposed by Hutchinson in 1957 to express the relationship of an individual or population to all aspects of its environment?

- (a) Ecological stratification
(b) Ecological pyramid
(c) Ecological succession
(d) Ecological niche

Sol.891.(d) Ecological niche - A term for the position of a species within an ecosystem. It refers to the

Interrelationship of a species with all the biotic and abiotic factors affecting it.

Q.892. Which of the following companies had constructed Asia's first cross-country pipeline as a mode of transport for liquids and gasses over long distances?

- (a) Oil and Natural Gas Corporation
(b) Indian Oil Corporation
(c) Bharat Petroleum
(d) Oil India Limited

Sol.892.(d) Oil India Limited. Naharkatia (Assam)-Barauni (Bihar) Pipeline (First cross-country pipeline). The Pipeline between Naharkatia and Nunmati became operative in 1962 and that between Nunmati and Barauni in 1964.

Q.893. The term physical geology was coined by _____.

- (a) William Hopkins (b) Georgius Agricola
(c) Louis Agassiz (d) Aziz Ab'Saber

Sol.893.(a) William Hopkins. Fathers of Various Fields - Economics (Adam Smith), Telephone (Alexander Graham Bell), Modern Chemistry (Antoine Lavoisier), Classification/ Taxonomy (Carl Linnaeus), Evolution (Charles Darwin), Geography (Eratosthenes).

Q.894. Who was the first ecologist to describe the specific shape of eco-trophic interactions, which he called the pyramid of numbers, in the 1920s?

- (a) Ernst Haeckel
(b) Howard Thomas Odum
(c) Edward O Wilson
(d) Charles Elton

Sol.894.(d) Charles Elton. He introduced the concept of food web, food chain and ecological niche in the classic textbook "Animal Ecology" in 1927. Ernest Haeckel - He coined the term 'Ecology' in 1866. Edward O Wilson - Proponent of Sociobiology.

Q.895. The Karewa formations are found in the _____.

- (a) North Easter Hills
(b) Kashmir Himalayas
(c) Uttaranchal Himalayas
(d) Terai Region

Sol.895.(b) Kashmir Himalayas. The Karewa term means "elevated table land". Firstly, this term was used by Godwin Austin in 1859. "Vudr" is the local name for it in Kashmiri language. Karewa formations are useful for the cultivation of Zafran (Saffron), almond, walnut, apple, and orchards in Kashmir valley.

Q.896. Siachen in Himalayas is:

- (a) a glacier (b) a dam
(c) a national park (d) a lake

Sol.896.(a) A glacier. The Siachen Glacier is located in the Eastern Karakoram range in the Himalayas. It is the world's highest battlefield. Nubra river originates from Siachen Glacier. It is situated to the North of Nubra Valley.

Q.897. _____ is characterized by abundant dissolved oxygen, sunlight, nutrients, generally high wave energies and water motion, and, in the intertidal subzone, alternating submergence and exposure.

- (a) The Lentic Zone
(b) The Limnetic Zone
(c) The Littoral Zone
(d) The Benthic Zone

Sol.897.(c) The Littoral Zone - It is an area close to the shore and submerged in water to some degree. Lentic Zone - Ecosystem entails a body of standing water, ranging from ditches, seeps, ponds, seasonal pools, basin marshes and lakes. Benthic Zone - The lowest ecological zone in a water body. Limnetic zone - The top layer of lake water distant from the coast, and extends only as deep as sunlight can penetrate (200 m).

Q.898. Which ecologist showed in a long-term experiment on outdoor plots that biodiversity is of central importance to the productivity, stability, resistance to the invasion of ecosystems and fertility of their soils?

- (a) Karl Mobius
(b) David Tilman
(c) Herbert Spencer
(d) Edward Osborne Wilson

Sol.898.(b) David Tilman. Edward O. Wilson - Father of biodiversity. Karl Möbius - First to develop the concept of ecological community, biocenosis, or living community.

Q.899. Which hypothesis was proposed by Paul Ehrlich to suggest the importance of species richness in the maintenance of ecosystems?

- (a) Portfolio hypothesis
(b) Redundancy hypothesis
(c) Predation hypothesis
(d) Rivet popper hypothesis

Sol.899.(d) Rivet popper hypothesis. The hypothesis suggests the importance of species richness in the maintenance of the ecosystem. Redundancy hypothesis - It predicts that the species redundancy in a plant community enhances community stability. Predation

hypothesis - It predicts that group-living animals are adapted to make alarm calls that distract or confuse predators.

Q.900. Which states are involved in the joint venture of the Chambal Project?

- (a) Rajasthan and Haryana
(b) Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh
(c) Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh
(d) Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh

Sol.900.(d) Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh. Chambal Project : Initiated in - 1954. Aim - Harnessing the Chambal River for irrigation, Power generation and for prevention and control of soil erosion in the valley.

Q.901. In the context of ecology, the given equation shows the relationship between the size of an area and the number of species present in it. Accordingly, by which letter is the regression coefficient denoted?

$$\log S = \log C + Z \log A$$

- (a) S (b) A (c) Z (d) C

Sol.901.(c) Z. The species-area relationship is often evaluated in conservation science in order to predict extinction rates in the case of habitat loss and habitat fragmentation. The equation: $\log S = \log C + Z \log A$, where S = species richness, A = area, C = Y-intercept.

Q.902. In the 1930s, which of the following theories was propounded by Arthur Holmes about the mantle?

- (a) Theory of Faunal Succession
(b) Slab Pull Theory
(c) Convectional Current Theory
(d) Theory of Faulting

Sol.902.(c) Convectional current Theory. The Convectional currents are generated due to radioactive elements causing thermal differences in the mantle portion. **Arthur Holmes** - The first earth scientist to grasp the mechanical and thermal implications of mantle convection, which led eventually to the acceptance of plate tectonics.

Q.903. Name a unit designed for wet and dry bulb thermometers to protect temperature sensors from being affected by direct or reflected sunlight.

- (a) Stevenson screen (b) Skywarn screen
(c) Clarinet screen (d) Cardinal screen

Sol.903.(a) Stevenson screen - It is also known as a cotton region shelter, an instrument shelter, a thermometer shelter, a thermoscreen, or a thermometer screen. Skywarn screen - It

is a national network of volunteer severe weather spotters. It was established to obtain critical weather information by the National Weather Service.

Q.904. Which state is also known as the 'Molasses basin', which is made up of soft unconsolidated deposits?

- (a) Mizoram (b) Manipur
(c) Nagaland (d) Meghalaya

Sol.904.(a) Mizoram (The Land of rolling mountains). Manipur is known as 'The Jewel of land' in India. Nagaland - The falcon capital of the world. Meghalaya - The Abode of Clouds.

Q.905. In which year was an approach and program named Joint Forest Management (JFM) launched in the context of National Forest Policy?

- (a) 1965 (b) 1988 (c) 1996 (d) 1947

Sol.905.(b) 1988. Joint Forest Management is about involving local communities in the management and restoration of degraded forests.

Q.906. Consider the following statements:

- I. Arthur G. Tansley is regarded as the "Father of Modern Ecology".
II. Eugene P. Odum coined the term "Ecosystem" in 1935.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only I (b) Only II
(c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II

Sol.906.(d) Neither I nor II. Eugene Odum is well known for Contribution in ecology. Eugene Pleasants Odum (Father of modern ecology). Alexander von Humbolt - Father of ecology. Arthur G. Tansley - First to coin the term ecosystem in 1935. Vladimir Vernadsky - Founded the biosphere concept.

Q.907. Which of the following is the scientific discipline concerned with the description and classification of the Earth's topographic features?

- (a) Geomorphology (b) Acarology
(c) Ethology (d) Meteorology

Sol.907.(a) Geomorphology is a term that studies change in the earth's surface due to these exogenic and endogenic forces, where exogenic forces are the external forces originating within the earth's atmosphere and endogenic forces are internal forces generated from within the earth. **Acarology** - Study of mites and ticks. It also involves the study of the Acarina order - it means study of arachnids like spiders, scorpions, etc.

Q.908. _____ species are those species of plants and animals which are found exclusively in a particular area.

- (a) Endemic (b) Endangered
(c) Threatened (d) Critically Endangered

Sol.908.(a) Endemic. Example of Endemic Species - Kangaroos originally endemic to Australia and found nowhere else in the world. Endemic Species of India - Asiatic Lion (Gir Forest), Kashmir Stag (Kashmir Valley), Purple Frog (Western Ghats), Sangai Deer (Loktak Lake), Nilgiri Tahr (Nilgiri Hills).

Q.909. In countries like Japan, _____ birth rates make the population pyramid _____ at the base.

- (a) Low, Broad (b) High, Broad
(c) Low, Narrow (d) High, Narrow

Sol.909.(c) Low, Narrow. A population pyramid is a way to visualize age and sex of a specific population. Decreased Death rates allow numbers of people to reach old age. A country in which birth and death rates are high, the pyramid is broad at the base and rapidly narrows towards the top (Kenya).

Q.910. Which is the second largest family in modern Indian languages?

- (a) Sino-Tibetan (Kirata)
(b) Indo-European (Aryan)
(c) Austric (Nishada)
(d) Dravidian (Dravida)

Sol.910.(d) Dravidian (Dravida). Major Dravidian Languages - Tamil, Telugu, Kannada and Malayalam. They are mainly spoken in southern India, central India, north-east Sri Lanka.

Q.911. The point on the surface, nearest to the focus of the earthquake, is called _____.

- (a) hypocentre (b) epicenter
(c) centripiece (d) semi centre

Sol.911.(b) Epicenter. Hypocenter - A point beneath the Earth's surface where the vibrations of an earthquake originate. Richter scale is the most common standard of measurement for earthquakes. The Richter Magnitude - It is a measure of the amount of energy released during an earthquake and expressed by the Richter scale.

Q.912. Identify the southernmost range of the Himalaya from the following.

- (a) Shiwaliks Range
(b) Trans Himalaya Range
(c) Lesser Himalaya Range
(d) Greater Himalaya Range

Sol.912.(a) Siwaliks Range. Himalayan Ranges: Himadri (Greater Himalayas or

Inner Himalayas), Himachal (Lesser Himalayas), Shiwaliks (Outer Himalayas). Divisions (West to east) : Punjab Himalayas (between rivers Indus and Sutlej), Kumaon Himalayas (Between Sutlej and Kali rivers), Nepal Himalayas (between rivers Kali and Teesta), Assam Himalayas (between rivers Tista and Dihang), Purvanchal (beyond the Dihang river).

Q.913. The western Ghats and the Eastern Ghats meet at which of the following places in southern India?

- (a) Satpura Hills (b) Nallamala Hills
(c) Nilgiri Hills (d) Mahendragiri Hills

Sol.913.(c) Nilgiri Hills: Highest Peak - Doda Betta. Located at the tri-junction of the states of Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu. Named after the Neelakurinji flowers (purplish-blue flowers) found in Shola forests. **Satpura Hills** - The range begins in eastern Gujarat and runs east through Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh before ending in Chhattisgarh. **Nallamala Hills** - Andhra Pradesh, eastern ghats. **Mahendragiri Hills** is located in the district of Gajapati, Odisha (eastern ghats).

Q.914. Which of the following earthquake waves are longitudinal waves?

- (a) L waves (b) P waves
(c) N waves (d) S Waves

Sol.914.(b) P waves. They vibrate parallel to the direction of the wave. This exerts pressure on the material in the direction of the propagation. Earthquake waves (Seismic waves) are vibrations in the earth that transmit energy.

Q.915. _____ species are the species which are not found after searches of known or likely areas where they may occur.

- (a) Extinct (b) Endangered
(c) Normal (d) Vulnerable

Sol.915.(a) Extinct. An endangered species is a type of organism that is threatened by extinction. Examples: Black Rhino, Tiger, Whale, Red Panda, Chimpanzee, Asian Elephant etc.

Q.916. Which of the following is a vulnerable species?

- (a) Himalayan brown bear
(b) Horn bill
(c) Asiatic cheetah
(d) Asiatic elephant

Sol.916.(d) Asiatic elephant. A vulnerable species is a species which has been categorized by the International

Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) as being threatened with extinction.

Q.917. Which of the following pairs of "term - definition" is correct?

- I. Strait - a narrow strip of land joining two landmasses
II. Isthmus - a narrow passage of water connecting two large water bodies
(a) Only II (b) Both I and II
(c) Neither I nor II (d) Only I

Sol.917.(c) Neither I nor II. Strait - Narrow body of water that connects two larger bodies of water, Examples - Cook strait (New Zealand), Malacca strait (Indonesia-Malaysia), Messina strait (Italy-Sicily), Bering strait (Alaska-Russia), Hormuz strait (Gulf of Persia-Gulf of Oman), etc. Isthmus - Narrow strip of land that connects two larger landmasses and separates two bodies of water, Examples - Isthmus of Panama, Isthmus of Suez.

Q.918. In 1962, who published 'The History of Ocean Basins', which outlined the theory of how tectonic plates could move, later called 'sea floor spreading'?

- (a) George Edward Backus
(b) Alfred Wegener
(c) Louis Bauer
(d) Harry Hammond Hess

Sol.918.(d) Harry Hammond Hess. According to the theory of plate tectonics, the earth's lithosphere is broken into distinct plates which are floating on a ductile layer called asthenosphere.

Q.919. The national census does NOT recognise _____ groups within India.

- (a) tribal (b) ethnic
(c) religious (d) scheduled caste

Sol.919.(b) Ethnic. Census is the process of collecting, analyzing, and sharing demographic, economic, and social data of all people in a country or specific region at a given time.

Q.920. Which of the following mountains is formed as a result of the compression of tectonic plates, leading to the formation of large fold-like structures on the Earth's crust?

- (a) Ural mountain in Russia
(b) Vosges mountain in Europe
(c) Mt. Kilimanjaro in Africa
(d) Harz mountains in Germany

Sol.920.(a) Ural mountain in Russia. Fold Mountains - Himalayan Mountains in Asia, the Alps in Europe, the Andes in South America, the Rockies in North America.

Q.921. Which of the following mountains were formed when molten rock from the depths of the earth rose from the crust and piled up on its own?

- (a) Mount Kilimanjaro in Africa
- (b) Rockies in North America
- (c) Ural mountain in Russia
- (d) Alps in Europe

Sol.921.(a) Mount Kilimanjaro in Africa (Tanzania). Top mountains in Africa:- Mount Kenya, Mount Stanley, Mount Speke, Mount Baker, Mount Emin.

Q.922. 'Anaconda' , one of the world's largest snakes, is found in _____.

- (a) Tropical evergreen forest
- (b) Monsoon forest
- (c) Temperate evergreen forest
- (d) Temperate grasslands

Sol.922.(a) Tropical Evergreen Forests (Amazon forest). They are categorized under the genus Euneetes (great swimmers) and family (Boidae). They thrive very well in hot, humid places with dense foliage. Tropical rainforests are found in South America, Africa, and Southeast Asia around the equator.

Q.923. Which floating fern damages aquatic ecosystems by outgrowing and replacing native plants that provide food and habitat for native animals and waterflow?

- (a) *Salvinia minima*
- (b) *Osmunda regalis*
- (c) *Giant salvinia*
- (d) *Azolla pinnata*

Sol.923.(c) Giant salvinia (aquatic fern, native to south-eastern Brazil, Scientific name - *Salvinia molesta*). *Salvinia minima* (common salvinia or water spangles), *Osmunda regalis* (Royal fern), *Azolla pinnata* (mosquito fern, feathered mosquito fern and water velvet).

Q.924. _____ refers to a sanitation system in which toilets collect human excreta in sealable, removable cartridges that are transported to treatment facilities.

- (a) Ecological sanitation
- (b) Container-Based sanitation
- (c) Community-led total sanitation
- (d) Dry sanitation

Sol.924.(b) Container Based Sanitation. Ecological sanitation is that protects human and ecosystem health while preventing water pollution, conserving energy, and capturing nutrients.

Q.925. Which of the following mountain ranges is home to the second highest peak of the world, K2?

- (a) Karakoram Range
- (b) Ladakh Range
- (c) Pir Panjal Range
- (d) Zaskar Range

Sol.925.(a) Karakoram Ranges is known as the 'backbone of high Asia'. It is also known as *Krishnagiri* which is situated in the northernmost range of the Trans-Himalayan ranges.